SUPER AWESOME NEWSLETTER

WindowVision | leMoniteur | BauInfoConsult | Geb | GlasWelt | Kunstof | CePro | Orgalim | CodeConfiance | Puertas y Automatismos

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Corporate

60 articles

Celery is 2027's color.

WindowVision · source

Sherwin-Williams has announced Celery as its Color of the Year for 2027, highlighting a soft green shade with yellow undertones. This color reflects current trends emphasizing wellness and nature-inspired interiors. Its versatility allows it to complement both contemporary spaces and traditional designs.

Wilson Fabrics celebrates 100 years.

WindowVision · source

Wilson Fabrics is celebrating its 100th anniversary in 2026, highlighting a century of innovation in Australian manufacturing. Founded in 1926, the company has evolved from wholesaling decorative fabrics to becoming a global supplier. As it enters its second century, Wilson Fabrics aims to focus on further innovation while maintaining its roots in local manufacturing.

Leborgne names new director.

leMoniteur · source

Thibaut Natoli has been appointed as the new General Director of Leborgne, succeeding Florence Hocq, who retired after 11 years. With 30 years of industry experience, Natoli’s role will focus on enhancing synergies among Novalia’s three tool brands. He has an extensive background in various sectors, including automotive and industrial sectors.

Tandem restructures Belfort's economy.

leMoniteur · source

SEM immobilière Tandem is set to restructure the Nouvelles Galeries building in Belfort, furthering local economic development. Established in 1988, Tandem has transformed significant industrial sites, managing over 270,000 m² for various industries. With a strong financial track record, the SEM aims to enhance its local contributions through ongoing projects.

Mialot leads CDC Habitat.

leMoniteur · source

Anne-Claire Mialot is being considered for the role of CEO at CDC Habitat, with the decision set for October 2nd. Currently the head of the National Agency for Urban Renovation, she has extensive experience in public service and urban development. If appointed, she will report to the Executive Chairman Clément Lecuivre, filling a position that has been vacant since March.

China opposes EU preference rules.

leMoniteur · source

China opposes the EU's proposed public procurement reform, which aims to implement a European preference mechanism. The Chinese Chamber of Commerce criticized any measures that could restrict the participation of non-EU countries in public contracts. This move underscores the ongoing trade tension between the EU and China.

Espace Émeraude supports direct supplies.

leMoniteur · source

The Espace Émeraude network develops an efficient logistics system for the direct supply of its stores, with 64 points of sale and 96,000 references. The cooperative group Garem optimizes the flexibility of deliveries, 80% of which come directly from suppliers. In 2025, they achieve approximately €300 million in turnover, focusing on sustainability.

Eiffage wins German contract

leMoniteur · source

Eiffage and NSORe have secured a new contract from 50Hertz for a 2 GW offshore conversion station for the LanWin3 project in the North Sea. This project follows a previous collaboration for the LanWin6 project, demonstrating a significant commitment to expanding offshore wind energy in Germany. The contract involves comprehensive system design, delivery, installation, and commissioning of the station.

Heidelberg Materials closes Ranville site.

leMoniteur · source

Heidelberg Materials France plans to close its Ranville site amid declining cement sales in France. The restructuring will impact 87 employees, although the company intends to offer them alternative positions within the group. This move is part of a broader strategy to improve economic competitiveness and invest in decarbonization efforts.

Alliance gains five new firms.

leMoniteur · source

Two months after its launch, the Action Béton et Ciment Durables alliance welcomes five new companies, including Vinci Construction. The association now comprises 26 firms aiming to reduce the carbon footprint of concrete and cement. Their priorities include substituting clinker and optimizing binding materials to minimize greenhouse gas emissions.

Essor group restructures operations.

leMoniteur · source

Essor, based in Pyrénées-Atlantiques, has emerged from judicial reorganization by restructuring its operations. The group is consolidating its entities, terminating its general contracting activities, and reducing its workforce from 240 to 166 employees. The leadership is now directed by David Pouyanne, with a focus on enhancing engineering and consultancy roles.

Enedis invests in network.

leMoniteur · source

Enedis is investing in underground electrical networks in Nouvelle-Aquitaine to withstand extreme summer heat. The company has adapted its infrastructure over the past 20 years, replacing outdated materials and renovating extensive underground systems. A significant investment of over €51M was made in 2025 to specifically address challenges posed by high temperatures.

Holcim to buy Fermacell.

leMoniteur · source

Holcim is set to acquire Fermacell, a manufacturer of gypsum fiber boards, from James Hardie for approximately €830 million. The transaction is expected to be finalized by early 2027. Fermacell anticipates a revenue of €430 million in 2026, supported by a workforce across six production sites in Europe.

Construction labor shortage looming now.

BauInfoConsult · source

The construction industry is facing a significant skills shortage, with 41% of firms reporting severe impacts. A survey indicates that 96% of companies recognize a lack of skilled labor among their employees. Innovations and increased attractiveness of jobs are seen as potential solutions to alleviate this crisis.

Construction materials find little help.

BauInfoConsult · source

The German construction industry is skeptical about the government's special fund, as only 18% of manufacturers believe it will boost investments in 2026. Many remain pessimistic, with 43% envisioning limited benefits and a third expecting no positive effect at all. This caution is attributed to slow reforms and limited opportunities from infrastructure projects.

Growth overshadowed by shortages.

BauInfoConsult · source

The article discusses major trends in the construction industry up to 2027, highlighting staff shortages and rising construction costs as dominant issues. While sustainability and technological advancements are considered important, they are overshadowed by these pressing concerns. A recent survey indicates that nearly half of manufacturers view the shortage of skilled labor as the most significant trend.

Bureaucracy cut by 2030.

BauInfoConsult · source

The German government's push to reduce bureaucracy in the construction industry aims to streamline processes and boost construction volume. However, manufacturers express skepticism, with most believing that current efforts will not achieve significant results by 2030. A market study reveals that most industry players find the proposed timeline unrealistic.

Social media boosts construction.

BauInfoConsult · source

By 2026, social media is no longer an exotic novelty but a standard for 95% of German users over 16, particularly within the construction industry. The study reveals that construction firms without social media profiles have become rare and that their online presence has significantly professionalized over the past 14 years. A third of construction professionals now actively use social media for marketing purposes, indicating a shift towards more strategic engagement.

Construction revenue to rise.

BauInfoConsult · source

The German construction industry is navigating a challenging environment, yet businesses report improving order situations. A survey reveals that two-thirds of industry players expect revenue growth in 2026, driven by public investments. Despite uncertainties ahead, optimism prevails, particularly among construction firms in the West and South.

Easy post, it works!

BauInfoConsult · source

LinkedIn is evolving beyond a job search platform, serving as a vital tool for construction material suppliers to increase visibility and showcase expertise. Effective engagement on LinkedIn requires personal connections and valuable content rather than mere postings. Success on the platform hinges on understanding audience needs and building trust through meaningful interactions.

People key to success.

BauInfoConsult · source

The article emphasizes that transformation within companies often fails not due to strategy but due to poor communication. It highlights the importance of involving people in the change process and facilitating meaningful dialogue. Effective communication is presented as a critical factor for successful transformations in organizations.

Batteries boost Oktoberfest power.

Geb · source

The article discusses how Tesvolt's large battery storage units are being utilized to ensure uninterrupted power supply at the Oktoberfest amidst increasing electrification and limited grid capacity. As demand for electricity grows, particularly due to the shift away from gas, these systems help prevent power outages by offering a buffer during peak times. This innovative solution not only reduces infrastructure costs but also aligns with sustainable energy practices.

Efficiency conference: Climate-neutral building paths.

Geb · source

The 18th Efficiency Conference on climate-neutral construction and modernization will be held on November 20-21, 2026, in Hannover, gathering experts from various fields. The event focuses on practical experiences and solutions in sustainable building, discussing key planning aspects and innovations. Participants will have opportunities for networking and insight into energy-efficient products and services.

Solar parks pose risk.

Geb · source

BSW-Solar warns that planned regulatory changes in Germany could significantly increase the costs of building new solar parks, thereby hindering their expansion. The proposed measures could raise electricity generation costs by more than a cent per kilowatt-hour without improvements. The association calls for the government to reconsider these regulations to avoid creating market barriers.

Serial renovation cuts emissions.

Geb · source

A recent study by dena highlights the significant climate protection potential of serial renovation, showing it can reduce greenhouse gas emissions by up to 81%. The analysis compared lifecycle emissions of serial versus conventional methods, demonstrating that serial approaches are more efficient. Key factors include optimized material choices and a focus on renewable resources.

Roto celebrates 30 years.

GlasWelt · source

Roto celebrates 30 years of production in Löv■, Hungary, evolving into a key manufacturing site for window and door technology. The site is recognized for its high manufacturing competence and efficient processes, merging with a galvanizing company to enhance production. Upcoming investments aim to improve quality and supply reliability, benefiting customers worldwide.

4JET Group becomes 4JET GmbH

GlasWelt · source

4JET has restructured its legal framework, merging four companies into a single entity named 4JET GmbH as of January 2026. This move aims to streamline operations and reduce administrative burdens. The glass processing activities will now be centralized in Alsdorf, while the previous location in Krailling will close by the end of 2026.

K■ty challenges Italian Metra.

GlasWelt · source

Grupa K■ty has signed an agreement to acquire the Italian aluminum giant Metra, a move to expand its operations into North America. The €450 million deal aims to enhance Grupa K■ty's position in the aluminum sector and improve its market reach. With Metra's capacity and expertise, the acquisition is expected to significantly strengthen Grupa K■ty's competitive edge in Europe.

Frerichs celebrates 150 years.

GlasWelt · source

Frerichs Glas, a renowned glass processor, is celebrating 150 years since its founding in 1876, transitioning from selling paints and wallpapers to specializing in glass and plastic solutions. Under the leadership of the fourth generation, Simon Cordes, the company emphasizes innovation and sustainability, adapting to changing market demands. Today, Frerichs Glas operates from three locations, offering advanced glazing solutions and focusing on energy-efficient products.

Revenue achieved in 2025.

GlasWelt · source

Forel, an Italian manufacturer of flat and insulating glass machinery, reported a revenue of 80 million euros in 2025, a slight increase from 79 million euros in the previous year. Seventy-five percent of its sales were generated in international markets, with significant expansions in Germany. The company also invested 21 million euros in infrastructure and filed two new patents, emphasizing its growth strategy in response to market demands.

Clearer view of the frame.

GlasWelt · source

Gestellpool Europe and BOX ID have partnered to enhance transparency in the management of transport frames in the glass and window industry. Their joint solution, GESAid, offers a cost-effective tracking system that allows businesses to efficiently manage their inventory and logistics processes. This collaboration aims to solve industry-wide challenges by providing real-time location data, reducing search times, and improving asset availability.

Otto-Chemie wins EcoVadis Gold

GlasWelt · source

Otto-Chemie has been awarded the EcoVadis Gold Medal for the second consecutive time, improving its rating from 78 to 81 points. This places the company in the top 5% of evaluated firms worldwide, reaffirming its commitment to sustainability. The recognition highlights the increasing importance of transparency and robust ESG evidence in industrial supply chains.

Kömmerling expands accessory range.

GlasWelt · source

Kömmerling and Dr. Hahn have formed a strategic sales partnership to offer Dr. Hahn door hinges directly to customers starting September 2026. This collaboration aims to develop innovative, compliant, and efficient door system solutions that go beyond traditional components. The partnership is expected to enhance product alignment and meet future European standards more effectively.

Company insolvencies remain high.

Kunstof · source

In Germany, the number of large bankruptcies remains high, with 209 companies filing for insolvency in the first half of 2026. This figure, while slightly lower than the previous year, exceeds the five-year average of 142 cases. Notably, the automotive suppliers led this year’s insolvency requests.

Aramco considers Arlanxeo sale.

Kunstof · source

Saudi Aramco is considering selling stakes worth approximately $35 billion, including the elastomer producer Arlanxeo. The state-owned oil company has reportedly engaged J.P. Morgan for the sale, aiming for revenue estimates of €2.9 billion for Arlanxeo in 2026. Initial inquiries to both companies for confirmation received no responses.

BASF starts new plant

Kunstof · source

Schütz is investing over €40 million in a new production and logistics center for Intermediate Bulk Containers in Ludwigshafen, with construction starting on September 14, 2026. The facility will create approximately 60 jobs initially, expanding to 100 in later stages. The center aims to serve BASF and other industrial customers in the Rhine-Neckar region.

Trinseo raises PMMA prices.

Kunstof · source

Trinseo is announcing a price increase for PMMA under the 'Altuglas' brand, raising prices by €250 per ton starting October 1, 2026. This increase will affect the European, Middle Eastern, and African markets. The change reflects ongoing market dynamics and cost pressures in the plastics industry.

Alpla expands Turkish operations.

Kunstof · source

Alpla, an Austrian packaging manufacturer, is expanding its production facilities in Turkey with a €30 million investment in new locations in Izmir and Adana. The Izmir plant will produce PET preforms and bottles, while the Adana facility focuses on PET and HDPE packaging. Both sites aim to serve clients in the beverage, food, dairy, and personal care industries.

UBA pays out funds.

Kunstof · source

The German Federal Environment Agency (UBA) has established a point value for the initial payout from the single-use plastics fund, amounting to €0.274 per point for 2024. This fund will distribute approximately €205 million to municipalities for waste collection and management. Since January 2024, manufacturers of specific single-use plastic products have been required to contribute to the cost of waste disposal in public spaces.

New tool eases buying.

CePro · source

Integration Controls has launched "Shop the Look," a tool designed to simplify the buying process for home technology upgrades by providing a common vocabulary for project scope and pricing. This digital platform allows homeowners to visualize various technology solutions tailored to their aesthetics and needs. It aims to improve client understanding and enhance the buying experience in the integration industry.

Sales team growth strategy.

CePro · source

Audio Advice is expanding its sales team due to significant growth, adding local experts in Miami and relocating staff from Charlotte to maintain high customer service standards. New hires include Sebastian Simon and Aleksei Panov in Miami, and Chad Fagin in Charlotte, all bringing valuable experience. This strategic move reflects Audio Advice's commitment to providing exceptional support as home technology evolves.

LG denies privacy claims.

CePro · source

LG has responded to accusations from Gamers Nexus that its smart TVs collect sensitive user data without user consent. The company clarifies that voice data is only processed upon activation of a wake word and does not engage in continuous audio recording. This controversy highlights growing consumer concerns regarding privacy in smart technology.

Integration: Relationships, not products.

CePro · source

At CEDIA Expo 2026, industry leaders emphasized the shift from product-focused sales to experience-driven client relationships. They discussed the crucial role of AI in enhancing service efficiency while maintaining the human touch in customer interactions. Future integrators must reposition themselves as advisors to continue fostering lasting client connections.

Steel vote hinders Europe.

Orgalim · source

Europe’s electrification goals face significant challenges due to a proposed safeguard measure on essential grain-oriented electrical steel. Industry representatives warn that this measure could divert over €700 million annually from the transformer sector to only a few steel producers without guarantees for increased output. The absence of binding commitments for capacity expansion risks undermining

both the competitiveness of the transformer industry and Europe’s clean energy objectives.

Rules boost single market.

Orgalim · source

The article discusses the importance of revising product rules to enhance the EU Single Market, enabling easier cross-border trade and reducing costs for manufacturers. It highlights that a strong Single Market can boost competitiveness and innovation while ensuring consumer safety. The upcoming European Product Act aims to modernize regulations and strengthen enforcement for better compliance and accessibility.

Europe invests in industry.

Orgalim · source

Orgalim leaders visited ABB’s Mannheim campus to explore technologies for improving energy efficiency, finding that 60% of motors lack variable speed drives. A subsequent visit to Stockholm highlighted the need for cooperation among industry, research, and policymakers to enhance Europe’s industrial competitiveness. The focus is on utilizing existing technology to close the deployment gap in advanced manufacturing and electrification.

Ormazabal’s message prioritizes member work.

Orgalim · source

In his recent Town Hall, Orgalim President Javier Ormazabal emphasized the importance of learning, adapting, and innovating within Europe’s technology industries as they face global challenges. He highlighted the critical role of teamwork and individual contributions in driving progress and sustainability. The event concluded with a Q&A, fostering an open dialogue about industry challenges.

Electrification plan explained now.

Orgalim · source

The Electrification Action Plan is a European Commission strategy aimed at increasing electrification across various sectors to support decarbonization and enhance energy security. It addresses challenges such as electricity affordability and grid access while promoting existing technologies for efficient energy use. The plan seeks to bolster the competitiveness of European industries by providing a supportive and flexible framework for electrification investments.

Europe’s strategy fails now.

Orgalim · source

The EU’s new steel tariffs aim to protect its producers, but raise concerns about their impact on downstream industries vital for electrification. This contradiction undermines the EU’s industrial strategy, which should support innovation and long-term goals. Without addressing these issues, Europe risks damaging the very sectors needed for its clean technology future.

Industry, academia need to sync.

Orgalim · source

The article discusses a webinar hosted by Orgalim focused on enhancing collaboration between industry and academia in Europe. Key speakers emphasized the importance of robust governance in research funding and the need for distinct but complementary programs under Horizon Europe and the European Competitiveness Fund. The aim is to bridge the innovation gap and effectively translate excellent research into market applications.

EUSEW 2026: Electrification Needs More

Orgalim · source

At the EU Sustainable Energy Week 2026, speakers highlighted high upfront costs and grid constraints as major barriers to industrial electrification. Despite the importance of electrification for reducing fossil fuel dependence, progress has been slow. The discussion emphasized the need for better financing, regulatory support, and coordinated energy policies.

Ambition drives tech sovereignty.

Orgalim · source

The European Commission’s Technology Sovereignty Package aims to strengthen Europe’s digital and industrial technology position while addressing dependencies. Orgalim emphasizes the need for ambitious regulatory simplification to support industrial demand and innovation in semiconductors and AI. The strategic approach must balance competitiveness, efficiency, and rising energy consumption driven by digitalization.

Digital sovereignty: intentions are done.

CodeConfiance · source

The article discusses the urgency for France to achieve digital sovereignty amid concerns over reliance on foreign tech companies. A recent survey shows that a significant majority of the French population wants their data hosted locally and support for using domestic solutions. The upcoming conference aims to translate this political aspiration into concrete procurement criteria.

Verified ID won't suffice.

CodeConfiance · source

The EUDI Wallet aims to streamline identity verification but will not replace the need for KYC measures. It offers verifiable identity attributes, yet does not assess risk or monitor client activities independently. Financial institutions must adapt their KYC processes to integrate with this new system while maintaining vigilance.

France faces European wallet choice

CodeConfiance · source

Germany is set to launch its digital identity app d-you on January 2, 2027, which aims to provide citizens with a digital equivalent of their ID on smartphones, enhancing private sector use. France's existing France Identité app leads with more accessible services for identity verification, banking, and public administration. The competition will focus on compatible services and user trust rather than mere technological capabilities.

AI chaos, regain control.

CodeConfiance · source

Organizations struggle to manage their vast data assets, facing issues like duplication and inadequate governance, exacerbated by evolving AI technologies. The article emphasizes the importance of data integrity, control, and strategic protection against cyber threats. A comprehensive overview of solutions from various providers aids organizations in navigating this intricate landscape.

Faulty parts, do we know?

CodeConfiance · source

The article discusses recent issues in the aerospace industry concerning defective parts and the challenges in tracking them due to inadequate documentation. It highlights the importance of both physical quality and reliable electronic records in maintaining aircraft safety. The complexities of global supply chains further complicate tracing components back to their installations.

Persax celebrates 50 years.

Puertas y Automatismos · source

Persax recently celebrated its 50th anniversary with a gala honoring its team and commitment to quality. The event highlighted the company’s enduring values and recognition of employees who have shaped its identity over the years. As it moves forward, Persax reaffirms its dedication to quality and innovation as essential to its future.

Interempresas partners with amec Forum

Puertas y Automatismos · source

Interempresas strengthens its commitment to the industry as a media partner of the Forum amec, a key event for industrial companies with an international focus. The forum facilitates the exchange of knowledge, experiences, and growth strategies among business leaders. As a media partner, Interempresas enhances visibility for vital discussions and trends in the industry.

Doorcats rebrands for clarity.

Puertas y Automatismos · source

Grupo Doorcats has launched a new brand architecture to better differentiate its business lines after over sixty years in the industry. The restructuring introduces Doorcats and Los Gatos as service brands under the corporate identity, aiming to clarify their distinct target audiences. The transition is being progressively implemented across various business contact points.

Events

12 articles

IWCE 2027 unveils speakers.

WindowVision · source

IWCE 2027 will feature industry experts discussing various topics at the Tampa Convention Center from March 14-16. Keynote speaker Tracee Murphy will present on the importance of understanding human behavior in business. The event aims to provide practical strategies for window covering professionals.

Line project meeting today.

leMoniteur · source

The upcoming public utility declaration (DUP) regarding a high-voltage power line between Fos-sur-Mer and Jonquières-Saint-Vincent has sparked significant opposition from local environmental groups. Supporters argue the project is essential for securing electrical supply and supporting industrial decarbonization in the region. Concerns remain about its environmental impact, particularly on agricultural land and biodiversity.

France competes in Shanghai.

leMoniteur · source

From September 22 to 27, 2026, Shanghai will host the WorldSkills competition featuring eleven French competitors in ten construction trades. This event will showcase young professionals under 23, representing the best in vocational skills globally. France aims to continue its strong performance following a third-place finish at the last competition in 2024.

Sonepar hosts future energy event

leMoniteur · source

Sonepar France held its 'Salon des Énergies du Futur' in Orléans, gathering nearly 500 local clients to showcase the latest in energy solutions. The event reflects Sonepar’s strong organizational changes and growth, enhanced by the government’s electrification initiatives. With multiple regional salons planned, Sonepar emphasizes maintaining close relationships with its clients and addressing current demands in the electrical sector.

DEN-GRE-Congress in Kassel

Geb · source

The DEN-GRE Congress on energy efficiency and climate change will be held on September 23-24 in Kassel, combining science and energy advice to explore practical approaches for a sustainable future. Attendees include architects, engineers, and decision-makers, offering networking opportunities and insights from research. Participants can earn 12 educational units, with registration fees varying based on membership status.

Geothermiekongress 2026: 300+ Beiträge

Geb · source

The Geothermal Congress 2026 will take place from October 20 to 22 in Potsdam, featuring over 300 presentations across 28 forums and 14 workshops, addressing the latest research and practical applications in geothermal energy. The program emphasizes topics like geothermal energy storage and community heat planning, reflecting the industry's dynamic growth. The event will also include excursions to significant geothermal sites in the region.

Fenster days move location.

GlasWelt · source

The Bad Wildungen Fenstertage Fachtagung (special event) will take place on October 15-16, 2026, moving to the Wandelhalle. This event includes exhibitions, lectures on law and digitalization, and opportunities for networking among industry professionals. Key topics will address new building regulations and the role of artificial intelligence in window construction.

NFF grows to 250.

GlasWelt · source

The NFF in Brockel became a key event in the northern window and facade industry with 250 participants and 30 exhibitors showcasing innovations. Positive feedback from attendees highlights valuable networking and insightful presentations, leading to strong interest in the 2027 event. A quarter of visitor slots for next year have already been booked, indicating robust industry demand for such gatherings.

Garden trade exchange meeting.

GlasWelt · source

The Wintergartentage event will take place on November 12-13, 2026, in Berlin, organized by the Bundesverband Wintergarten e.V. The program includes keynotes, workshops, and discussions on market trends and legal issues affecting businesses in the sector. Participants can also engage in networking and explore innovations in the industry.

Solar panels in buildings.

GlasWelt · source

The BF (Bundesverband Flachglas) is hosting an online seminar on October 27, 2026, focused on building-integrated photovoltaics (BIPV) and its role in energy production and architectural design. Experts will discuss current developments, legal requirements, and practical applications of BIPV in the construction industry. The seminar is aimed at architects, planners, builders, and anyone interested in sustainable building concepts.

Z-Wave programming summit announced.

CePro · source

The Z-Wave Fall Summit 2026 will begin on September 29 with a member-only Unplug Fest, followed by public programming featuring various industry experts. Interactive sessions will cover smart home trends, professional installation, and emerging cybersecurity needs. The event will conclude with exclusive sessions for Z-Wave Alliance members on October 1.

Locksmiths meet on October 3

Puertas y Automatismos · source

The 6th Technical Day of UCES will be held on October 3, 2026, focusing on AI, professional training, and technological innovations in locksmithing. Key participants include representatives from the Ministry of Education and major companies like Silca and CISA Allegion. This event aims to enhance professional experience sharing and tackle sector challenges.

Regulation

9 articles

AI data center halted.

leMoniteur · source

The Grenoble administrative court suspended a construction permit for an AI data center due to the absence of an environmental impact study. The ruling emphasizes that projects cannot be fragmented to evade environmental evaluation obligations. Inadequate documentation regarding the project's adherence to local regulations also contributed to the suspension.

Water sector expects benefits

leMoniteur · source

The CSFE presented an impact study on the new EU Directive for urban wastewater treatment, highlighting potential yearly benefits of €3 billion versus €2 billion in investments. This modernization of sanitation systems is crucial and will require integrated management plans by 2033. Timely publication of requirements is essential for local authorities to strategize effectively.

GModG rules change now.

BauInfoConsult · source

GModG introduces significant changes to Germany's building energy regulation, eliminating the previous 65% renewable energy requirement for new heating systems. From 2029, fossil fuels must gradually include increasing portions of climate-friendly alternatives, leading to a complete shift to renewable heating by 2045. Additionally, heating costs will be shared between landlords and tenants, with new funding conditions for heat pumps.

ReAKT tests building regulations.

Geb · source

The ReaKT project, funded by the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy, assesses whether existing technical standards in the building sector fulfill future demands arising from climate change and the energy transition. It systematically analyzes the impacts of shifting climatic, technical, and socio-cultural conditions on the heating and cooling requirements of buildings. The project seeks to generate practical recommendations for adapting technical regulations to guarantee sustainable energy solutions for the future.

Solar deal strengthens partnership.

Geb · source

The revised PV agreement introduces binding standards for photovoltaic installations effective September 2026. It includes new trades and clear responsibilities to enhance safety, quality, and efficiency in the installation process. Key goals include ensuring safe operations on rooftops and effective collaboration among various skilled trades.

EU ETS boosts decarbonization.

Orgalim · source

The EU Emissions Trading System (ETS) is the EU’s primary tool for reducing greenhouse gas emissions, established in 2005. It operates on a cap-and-trade principle, covering about 40% of emissions and expanding to bring more sectors under its scope. The ETS promotes industrial decarbonisation while balancing climate ambitions with competitiveness through market incentives and technological investments.

Wallet: Fighting document fraud.

CodeConfiance · source

KIPMI introduces a wallet that actively verifies and converts document data into reliable attestations to combat increasing document fraud. This tool integrates with businesses, reducing manual checks and enhancing KYC processes. As regulations evolve, the wallet aims to simplify identity verification while maintaining high security.

AI surveillance becomes permanent.

CodeConfiance · source

The algorithmic video protection law, initially set as a temporary measure for the Paris 2024 Olympics, has now been extended to 2030 despite inconclusive effectiveness. This technology uses AI to monitor public spaces for potential hazards, but evaluations indicate variable performance and minimal successful alerts. As a result, the debate over automated public surveillance intensifies, raising questions about the balance between security and personal liberties.

Cybersecurity products get bigger.

CodeConfiance · source

As of September 11, 2026, digital product manufacturers in the EU must report exploited vulnerabilities and serious incidents, marking a significant shift in cybersecurity responsibility. The Cyber Resilience Act mandates that cybersecurity be integrated into product design, requiring compliance beyond simple reporting. This new regulation emphasizes continuous security improvements throughout a product’s

lifecycle.

Residential

19 articles

School upgrades heating system.

leMoniteur · source

The Henri Matisse school in Serris has upgraded its heating system with a rooftop hybrid heat pump, enhancing energy efficiency while maintaining existing heating infrastructure. This solution, featuring a combined air/water heat pump and a gas boiler, operates optimally across varying seasonal demands. The installation is straightforward, eliminating the need for significant construction work, and effectively lowers carbon emissions.

Sommer Foundation builds wildlife center.

leMoniteur · source

The Fondation François Sommer has inaugurated a new wildlife study center shaped like a hamlet in the Ardennes, comprising nine pavilions within a 1050-hectare site. This project, emphasizing artistic creation, research, and training, involved an investment of €13 million. Designed by architects Frédéric Denisart and Paul Landauer, the pavilions blend harmoniously into the natural landscape with eco-friendly materials.

Post office building being renovated

leMoniteur · source

The former post office building in Evry-Courcouronnes is being dismantled to pave the way for a revitalization project in the city center. This essential step follows a year of preparatory work and aims to create a new central public space. The project, covering 2.8 hectares and costing 52 million euros, will transform the area by lowering public spaces and improving connectivity.

Bridge collapse, structural damage occurs.

leMoniteur · source

In Isère, the metal framework of the new Brignoud bridge has been positioned, set to replace an old bridge destroyed by fire in 2022. This 120 meters long and 20 meters wide structure will facilitate traffic between Crolles and Villard-Bonnot. The construction, costing €27 million, is scheduled for completion by the end of the year and includes plans for a pedestrian bridge to be built by 2027.

Nature wood living veranda.

leMoniteur · source

Vie & Véranda introduces the Nature range, a 100% wooden extension designed as a genuine living space. It features effective insulation and high-performance glazing for year-round comfort while ensuring ample natural light. Each project is tailored to integrate harmoniously with the existing architecture, allowing for versatile use.

Reuse project underway now.

leMoniteur · source

In Romainville, the demolition and reconstruction of an old gym has commenced due to soil pollution. The project emphasizes reusing materials on-site, with careful coordination between demolition and design teams. The new facility is expected to open in 2028, prioritizing sustainability despite challenges in material reuse.

Wooden cocoon for students

leMoniteur · source

The newly inaugurated maintenance workshop for Erea Le Corbusier in Pessac is designed with eco-friendly materials such as wood and straw. This building, reflecting a commitment to both environmental sustainability and social responsibility, provides a supportive workspace for students facing educational challenges. Built over seven months with a budget of €2 million, it embodies innovative architectural practices.

Lourdes promotes wood certification.

leMoniteur · source

The new daycare center in Lourdes utilizes local pine wood, enhancing material traceability and supporting the local economy. Designed by Goubert & Landes, it emphasizes mass timber over glued laminated timber due to local availability issues. This project not only provides a functional space for children but also serves as a model for sustainable forestry practices in the region.

Apartments drive construction growth

BauInfoConsult · source

The construction forecast for 2027 and 2028 predicts a slight recovery in building completions in Germany, with an expected growth of 14.2% in 2027. However, stagnation is anticipated in 2028, particularly in the single-family home segment. The report highlights the necessity for accelerated approval and realization cycles to meet housing market demands.

New homes shortage looming.

BauInfoConsult · source

A recent study by Jones Lang LaSalle highlights a significant imbalance in the German housing market, revealing a shortage of new homes in urban areas while an oversupply occurs in less populated regions. The report criticizes the construction of large single-family homes, which do not meet the actual market demand for affordable housing. To address this issue, experts recommend improving economic conditions for the construction of multi-family units.

Concrete module house printed.

Geb · source

Rupp Gebäudedruck GmbH has successfully created the first modular house, named 'Pluto', using a new 7-axis 3D printing system. This innovative project aims to make construction more efficient and scalable through the use of standard concrete instead of specialized recipes. The model is designed as part of a modular housing park, showcasing the potential of modern printing technologies in building.

Old building to efficiency house

Geb · source

A comprehensive renovation transformed a 1970s two-family house in Wilnsdorf-Niederdielfen into an energy-autarkic Effizienzhaus 40, achieving a significant reduction in energy consumption. With features like a heat pump, photovoltaic system, and heat recovery ventilation, the building’s annual energy demand plummeted from 52,379 kWh to just 5,146 kWh. This project demonstrates the complexity and potential of full renovations in achieving energy efficiency and enhanced living comfort.

Balcony power plants grow fast.

Geb · source

The German plug-in solar market reaches mass-market status in 2026, with a shift towards increased average system performance due to fewer new installations. Roughly 1.49 million systems are operational, generating around 1.619 GWp of power. Despite a decline in new installations, the market shows a rise in installed capacity per system.

Retrofitting buildings quickly, efficiently.

Geb · source

The Herbstforum Altbau 2026 focuses on the energy-efficient modernization of building stock, emphasizing the need for swift action in the construction sector. The event will feature various experts discussing innovative strategies and successful case studies on renovations. It aims to enhance cooperation among architecture, energy consulting, and political sectors to boost sustainability in

building practices.

UBM launches wood hybrid project.

Geb · source

UBM has begun sales for the "Charlie" project in Munich-Altperlach, featuring 106 apartments in a hybrid wood construction. The project creatively integrates existing buildings with new additions, aiming to address the housing shortage in Munich. This transformation emphasizes sustainability and retains the area’s historical character.

Solar networks grow rapidly

Geb · source

By September 2026, Germany has a total of 75 solar heating networks with an installed collector area of 339,203 square meters. Recent years show significant discrepancies in the expansion of these systems. Meeting the political goals for 2045 requires a substantial annual increase in capacity.

Birds in facade renovations.

Geb · source

The article emphasizes the integration of bird and bat nesting sites into facade renovations, promoting species conservation alongside energy efficiency. It highlights that existing structures often lose essential nesting spaces during renovations, impacting local biodiversity. By including specific nesting options in energy-efficient upgrades, both climate protection and biodiversity can be advanced.

Housing construction permits rise.

GlasWelt · source

In the first seven months of 2026, construction permits for new residential units in Germany increased by 13.5% compared to the previous year. However, the growth rate slowed down to just 1.9% in July. Despite the slowdown, overall permits from January to July reached a total of 148,800.

PVC windows recycled increase

GlasWelt · source

In 2025, Rewindo achieved a significant increase of 32.3% in the recycling of PVC windows, totaling 141,595 tons. The recycling rate reached 94.5%, reflecting efforts to meet eco-friendly goals. This growth is attributed to rising renovation projects and an expanded recycling network.

Access Control

3 articles

Robots control access now.

GlasWelt · source

The pilot project by dormakaba, ANYbotics, and LEGIC tested a robot at access controls, integrating autonomous robots into secure environments. The ANYmal robot uses digital credentials to request access, ensuring efficiency in industrial inspections. This initiative highlights the potential for robots to operate alongside humans while maintaining strict access regulations.

Modular sliding gate system.

GlasWelt · source

Roto Patio Alversa offers a modular hardware system for sliding elements, streamlining production with interchangeable parts and efficient processes. This system caters to price-sensitive customers, focusing on manufacturing ease and flexibility. Its features include high durability, intuitive operation, and compatibility with various frame materials.

SmartDoors: Future construction access.

Puertas y Automatismos · source

SmartDoors 2026 will take place from November 10 to 13 at Ifema Madrid, focusing on the future of access technology within the construction industry. The event highlights the evolving role of automatic doors in enhancing security, energy efficiency, and user experience in modern buildings. This edition aims to establish itself as a global platform for innovation and professional knowledge sharing in the sector.

Air conditioning

1 article

Airflow tested in lab.

Geb · source

The article discusses the innovative airflow technology tested in the Platinum office building in Wiesbaden, which implements a high-induction slot outlet system to optimize indoor air quality. It details how the building minimizes CO2 emissions and generates more renewable energy than it consumes. Laboratory tests confirm that the airflow design provides thermal comfort without drafts, aligning with sustainability goals.

Glazing

2 articles

Society Social launches fabric collection

WindowVision · source

Society Social has launched a new performance fabric collection in collaboration with Sunbrella Interiors, featuring over 25 exclusive stain-resistant fabrics. The collection combines vibrant patterns with durable textiles, suitable for everyday living. It aims to bridge the gap between aesthetics and functionality in home furnishings.

Thin glass ISO series.

GlasWelt · source

Edgetech and Forel have developed Skinny Triples, a cost-effective solution for producing thin triple insulating glass units. This innovation promotes energy efficiency with minimal weight and allows for installation in tight spaces, particularly useful in renovation projects. Additionally, it integrates with existing manufacturing systems without requiring significant new investments.

Heating

2 articles

Heat network expands northwards.

leMoniteur · source

The Strasbourg Eurometropolis is expanding its heating network in the north with the installation of 33 km of new pipelines by 2030. The first phase, consisting of 11 km primarily in La Robertsau, is projected to be completed by the end of 2027. This project, funded with an investment of 89 million euros, will provide 110 GWh of heat annually, sufficient for approximately 14,000 homes.

Heat pumps see high demand.

Geb · source

The recent BEG reporting highlights a significant demand for heat pumps in the first half of 2026. Out of over 335,000 renovation measures, 182,114 were for heat pumps, representing 89.28% of the supported measures for heating systems. Emphasis remains on individual measures, indicating a trend towards efficient heating solutions.

Lighting

4 articles

Sunlight, intense and limited.

Geb · source

A study by HTWG Konstanz investigates the solar coverage of a photovoltaic (PV) heating system in a tiny house, reporting a solar efficiency of up to 68%. The research highlights the economic viability of direct electric heating combined with a hot water boiler for small, well-insulated buildings. The findings suggest that with adequate PV systems, solar energy can significantly meet heating demands, especially in transitional seasons.

Tuck Lights enter market

CePro · source

WAC Group's TUCK series has introduced heat-resistant models for spas and saunas, combining style with functionality. These fixtures, featuring 600 lumens at 3000K CCT, aim to meet the growing demand for connected bath solutions. Integrators should note the rise in interest for spa and sauna installations, emphasizing the importance of ambient lighting.

Vintage speakers, high-resolution audio.

CePro · source

Mozaic Smart Technology Design integrated vintage KLH electrostatic speakers into a high-resolution audio system in a Brownsboro smart home. The project uniquely preserved the speakers' legacy while incorporating modern technology for a seamless audio experience. The design showcases a hybrid architecture that blends aesthetics with acoustic excellence.

Doors boost energy savings.

Puertas y Automatismos · source

The digitization of loading and unloading points in packaging improves operational efficiency and reduces energy consumption. Connected sectional doors, such as the Crawford OH1142P Dual Drive, enhance real-time monitoring and data management, streamlining logistics. This integration allows for smarter decisions and greater visibility in industrial operations.

Window

12 articles

Scientists make new discoveries.

WindowVision · source

The September article highlights innovative product launches in window fashion, showcasing collaborations that blend style and function. Features include motorized blinds with new technology and bathroom textiles from luxury brands. Key industry expansions and developments signal growth in manufacturing capabilities.

Curtain design contest winners.

WindowVision · source

TWOPAGES has announced the winners of its 2026 ‘Curtain as Art’ Design Contest, with British designer Heather Cantrill taking first place for her collection. The competition attracted 1,082 entries from 825 designers across 56 countries. All three winning collections are now available for purchase on the TWOPAGES website.

Vote for your brands.

WindowVision · source

Window Fashion VISION invites industry professionals to nominate their favorite brands for the 2026 Readers’ Choice Awards, celebrating excellence across various categories in the window covering sector. The nominations are open until October 15, 2026, with the voting round starting shortly after. This awards program aims to recognize trusted partners and innovative brands that enhance business practices in the industry.

Window Fashion VISION issue released

WindowVision · source

The September/October issue of Window Fashion VISION features a coastal-inspired primary bedroom designed by Sandra Asdourian in Marco Island, Florida. Utilizing a blue palette, the room includes custom drapery and layers of color, creating a calming retreat. Key design elements include a hand-knotted rug and motorized blackout shades for optimal light control.

Coastal style window coverings.

WindowVision · source

SelectBlinds and Nautica have partnered to launch a new collection of window treatments inspired by coastal style. The Nautica Home collection features customizable designs with nautical motifs and modern aesthetics. This collaboration aims to bring Nautica’s signature coastal aesthetic into customizable blinds and shades.

Window covering safety webinar.

WindowVision · source

A free webinar titled "Powering Safety" will discuss electrical safety and compliance in the window covering industry. Scheduled for October 13, 2026, it features expert panelists and covers crucial safety standards for motorized products. Attendees will learn about compliance, the risks of uncertified products, and identifying certified items.

Visit the window collection center.

GlasWelt · source

The VILLUM Window Collection Centre in Copenhagen showcases a fascinating history of windows, from ancient Roman glass to modern designs. Visitors can explore unique exhibits, including a copy of a Sainte-Chapelle panel, and learn about the evolution of window technology. The museum captivates audiences with its blend of art, history, and the interplay of light.

Wheat separates from chaff.

GlasWelt · source

The window market is undergoing a significant transformation, with notable companies investing contrary to market trends while others struggle for survival. A high number of mid-sized businesses face extinction due to unclear positioning during this downturn. The podcast discusses strategies for innovation and market consolidation as the industry navigates these challenges.

Facade becomes visitor card.

GlasWelt · source

The Wagner Design Lab, designed by architects Titus Bernhard and Andreas Weißenbach, showcases innovative architecture in Langenneufnach with large glass facades and Trespa panels. The structure, embodying the company’s philosophy, is a creative workspace that integrates minimalism and precision in design. It has already received recognition, including the German Design Award.

TCL adds more features.

CePro · source

TCL has expanded its Designer Series of art TVs, introducing the A300L and A400U models featuring sleek, flush-mountable designs. Both series operate on Google TV and include an Art Library for showcasing artwork without a subscription. Enhanced picture quality is achieved with QD-Mini LEDs in the A400U, along with superior audio support.

Doors now have tech.

Puertas y Automatismos · source

The Kronos panel has revolutionized armored doors with its unique fiberglass structure that combines technology, aesthetics, and durability. It offers personalized design options and exceptional mechanical resistance, making it ideal for diverse environments. As Spain’s housing market evolves, these panels provide an affordable and efficient way to refresh aging door aesthetics.

School uses Vicaima solutions

Puertas y Automatismos · source

King’s College School Cascais has integrated Vicaima solutions to enhance safety, acoustic insulation, and design in its new educational campus. The facility, which spans over 40,000 square meters and cost 75 million euros, aims to create innovative and secure learning environments. Key features include advanced classrooms, creative arts facilities, and fire-resistant door systems for added safety.

Others

10 articles

Fire texts released Monday.

leMoniteur · source

On September 21, 2026, new official texts were issued addressing fire-related aid for small businesses, extending the eligibility period for assistance. Updates to the French activity nomenclature were introduced to better recognize artisanal occupations. Additionally, two decrees modified administrative boundaries to facilitate local developments.

Orano builds future talent.

leMoniteur · source

The article indicates that there was an Internal Server Error, suggesting a problem with the server handling the request. This type of error typically prevents the user from accessing the desired page or resource. Such issues often require backend corrections to resolve.

Climate change impacts assessed now.

leMoniteur · source

A comprehensive study evaluates the vulnerability of France’s national road network to climate change, exploring various risk scenarios and the costs of inaction. The analysis reveals that a significant portion of the roads may face increased exposure to extreme weather, necessitating adaptive strategies. Key findings include potential economic impacts of €4 billion over ten years if no adaptation measures are implemented.

Digital users replace tradition.

BauInfoConsult · source

BauInfoConsult’s recent study reveals a significant shift in communication within the construction industry, highlighting the rise of digital information sources over traditional media. Personal interactions, once prioritized, have been surpassed by online platforms, driven by user preferences and AI technology. Four distinct communication types have emerged, reflecting the evolving needs of professionals in architecture and construction.

Hydrogen key to energy.

Geb · source

Hydrogen plays a crucial role in the energy transition by enabling long-term storage of renewable energy and is essential for decarbonizing industries like steel and aviation. However, it is less viable for building heating and passenger vehicles, where electric solutions are more efficient. The future of hydrogen relies on its production from renewable sources and addressing risks related to its integration into the energy system.

Buildings need flexible energy now.

Geb · source

Buildings must evolve to meet future demands for energy distribution, moving from passive consumers to active participants in the energy system. The integration of technologies like photovoltaics and electric vehicle infrastructure necessitates flexible and scalable electrical infrastructures. Effective planning that anticipates future energy needs will be crucial for sustainable building operations.

Tech plans need resolution now.

CePro · source

Integrators must ask experiential questions to enhance technology's role in construction, moving beyond simple installations. Early collaboration involves understanding how technology impacts human experiences within a space. Ultimately, success relies on defining measurable performance that enriches lives, rather than focusing solely on products.

Devialet Pulse Blue released.

CePro · source

Devialet has launched the limited edition Phantom Ultimate 98 dB – Pulse Blue, revisiting their blue branding with a new gloss finish. This model boasts advanced streaming capabilities and retains acoustic performance in a compact design. Pre-orders are available at $2,200 for the speaker and $349 for the matching stand.

Card health security questioned.

CodeConfiance · source

The article discusses the security features of the digital Carte Vitale application, emphasizing its potential to reduce fraud compared to the physical card. While it offers enhanced identification verification and is less susceptible to theft, the application does not eliminate fraud risks related to healthcare professionals. Overall, it is a step forward but should not be viewed as a complete solution to fraud.

Data security conference announced now.

CodeConfiance · source

This article discusses the importance of data governance for organizations in effectively managing their critical data. It highlights the risks associated with data and emphasizes the need for solid strategies to protect and utilize data, particularly in the context of AI projects. It serves as a guide for decision-makers on implementing effective data management solutions.

FULL ARTICLES

Cleaned text

WindowVision

Society Social launches fabric collection

https://www.wf-vision.com/fabric-collection/society-social-x-sunbrella-interiors-debuts-pe

Performance fabric is getting a colorful update. Society Social has teamed up with Sunbrella Interiors on a new collection that brings the lifestyle brand’s playful, pattern-forward aesthetic to durable textiles designed for everyday living.

The Society Social x Sunbrella Interiors collection includes more than 25 exclusive stain- and liquid-resistant fabrics, ranging from lively patterns and classic stripes to versatile solids. Standouts include Veranda Vine, a fresh botanical motif, and Performance Pinstripe, a tailored take on a timeless stripe.

Founded by Roxy Owens in 2011, Society Social has built its identity around a spirited approach to traditional design, favoring color, pattern and personality over pared-back neutrals. The new collaboration translates that signature look into performance fabrics made to handle the realities of busy homes.

The collection is available by the yard and across several of Society Social’s best-selling furniture designs, including the Aurora Roll Arm Tight Back Ruffle Sofa, Hudson Wingback Chair and Hadley Wavy Bench.

With its mix of practical performance and unapologetically pretty design, the collection makes a case for furniture that doesn’t have to choose between looking good and living well.

Scientists make new discoveries.

https://www.wf-vision.com/design-and-trends/new-noteworthy-finds-for-september/

New & Noteworthy Finds for September

This month’s latest launches pair smart innovation with plenty of style. Clever motorization, fresh textiles, unexpected collaborations and handcrafted design are giving us plenty to talk about, along with a few industry developments worth watching.

Bathing Beauty

Heritage textile house Lee Jofa brings some of its most recognizable patterns to the bath in a new collaboration with luxury linens brand Weezie. Designed as a coordinated wardrobe for the bathroom, the collection spans plush towels and robes, shower curtains and accessories, reimagining archival florals, stripes and botanicals for everyday use. Signature Lee Jofa patterns, including Palermo and Davenport, mingle with Marciana, an exclusive design created for the collaboration, while Weezie's piped edges and customizable monograms add a personalized finishing touch.

Smooth Operator

DualMotion by Carsan Window Fashions goes beyond traditional motorized horizontal blinds. Where other motorized faux wood systems tilt only, DualMotion delivers both lift and tilt from a single integrated motor, giving full control of light, privacy and view-through. Paired with Carsan's ScrolControl remote, a precision scroll wheel dials in exact slat position. The engineering earned Carsan the 2025 WCMA Best New Technical Innovation Award for Horizontal Blinds (All Finishes) and Motorization and Automation. Built by a 50-year vertically integrated manufacturer selling exclusively to the trade, DualMotion gives dealers one clean, cordless motorized solution to specify and sell.

On a Roll

Coulisse refreshes a staple with its new Roller Collection, bringing together an expanded assortment of performance-driven and design-forward fabrics. Organized across five dedicated books, the collection includes Light Filtering, Black-out, Nature, Screen Textile and Screen Function options. New recycled and nature-inspired textiles join proven bestsellers, offering designers and dealers a broad range of colors, textures and performance features, all in stock and ready to ship.

Wicker Dreams

While we may never get a wicker husband who looks like Alexander Skarsgård, we can weave a little cottagecore into our homes with ferm LIVING's Dou Floor Lamp ahead of Wicker's October 23 release. Meticulously hand-braided from natural rattan, the sculptural lamp features a conical shade supported by a durable iron frame. Its open weave casts a warm glow while adding texture and organic appeal, with subtle variations in color and shape making each handcrafted piece one of a kind.

Small but Mighty

Somfy is expanding motorization possibilities with the Roll Up 30 Short, a compact motor designed for narrow windows that may have previously required manual shades. Approximately 3 inches shorter than the standard Roll Up 30, it delivers 2Nm of lifting capacity while helping maximize visible glass. Compatible with existing Sonesse accessories and available with Power over Ethernet or Somfy Digital Network, the motor gives dealers and designers greater flexibility to bring automated shading to smaller openings while maintaining a consistent look across a project.

Room to Grow

Inpro is expanding its U.S. manufacturing footprint with a new 165,000-square-foot facility in Mint Hill, North Carolina, bringing two previously separate operations under one roof and adding capacity to support its growing customer base. The company is also investing in its Muskego, Wisconsin, headquarters, where it recently opened a new Design Center + Showroom and plans to open a 30,000-square-foot manufacturing facility later this year. Together, the expansions strengthen Inpro's manufacturing capabilities and support continued growth across its portfolio of commercial architectural products, including window treatments.

Curtain design contest winners.

https://www.wf-vision.com/design-and-trends/twopages-names-winners-of-2026-curtain-as-art-

TWOPAGES Announces Winners of 2026 'Curtain as Art' Design Contest

Three winning curtain collections are now available for purchase following a global competition that drew 825 designers from 56 countries.

TWOPAGES announced the winners of its 2026 TWOPAGES X Design Contest, themed "Curtain as Art," during a finale in New York on Sept. 16, awarding top honors to British designer Heather Cantrill for her collection, "The Cotswold Way."

Cantrill received the $10,000 first-place prize, followed by American designer Hailey Kiefer, who earned second place and $8,000 for "Villa Chinoiserie." Canadian designer Gabrielle De Winter took third place and a $6,000 prize for "Heirloom Studies."

All three winning collections launched on the TWOPAGES website the same day, turning the designers' concepts into commercially available curtain collections.

Now in its second year, the contest attracted 1,082 entries from 825 designers representing 56 countries. The competition was created to bring original textile and pattern designs from concept through product development and ultimately into consumers' homes. All six winning collections from the inaugural 2025 competition also remain available through TWOPAGES.

During the New York finale, finalists presented their collections through videos and live presentations. Building on the "Curtain as Art" theme, the event featured large-scale fabric installations inspired by the three collections, along with dance performances based on the designs.

The 2026 jury included interior designer Jennifer Farrell; Leatrice Eiseman, executive director of the Pantone Color Institute; Ingrid Abramovitch; and Bari J. Ackerman. The judges evaluated the finalists following their presentations and discussions.

The event also marked the third anniversary of TWOPAGES' collaboration with interior designer and content creator Sara Le.

“We want designers’ ideas to be seen and, more importantly, to become part of everyday life,” said Ray Chen, founder and CEO of TWOPAGES. “Through this competition, we bring different cultures and personal stories into curtain design and work with designers to turn their ideas into something that can truly belong in people’s homes.”

The Heather Cantrill x TWOPAGES, Hailey Kiefer x TWOPAGES and Gabrielle De Winter x TWOPAGES collections are available now.

Vote for your brands.

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/nominate-your-favorite-brands-for-visions-second-a

Nominate Your Favorite Brands for VISION’s Second Annual 2026 Readers’ Choice Awards!

Window covering professionals are invited to recognize the brands, products and partners they know, trust and love.

Nominations are officially open for Window Fashion VISION’s Second Annual 2026 Readers’ Choice Awards, giving professionals across the window covering industry the opportunity to recognize their favorite brands, products and industry partners. Following an incredible inaugural year with more than 21,000 votes cast, the awards return with 43 categories celebrating excellence across fabrication, motorization, textiles, outdoor products, technology, hardware, retail and more.

Dealers, designers, workrooms, installers, retailers, manufacturers and other industry professionals are encouraged to nominate the companies they know, trust and value. Whether it is a go-to fabric supplier, a trusted fabrication partner, an innovative motorization brand or a company delivering outstanding service, the Readers’ Choice Awards put industry recognition directly in the hands of the professionals who work with these brands every day.

“The Readers’ Choice Awards give our industry a direct voice in recognizing the brands, products and partners that make a meaningful difference in their businesses,” said Lindsay Brown, Managing Editor. “After the tremendous response to our inaugural awards, we are excited to once again invite professionals across the industry to celebrate the companies and innovators they believe are setting the standard.”

Nominate your favorite brands now through October 15, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. Eastern Time. The nominees receiving the strongest industry support will advance to the official voting round, beginning October 19, 2026, at 1:00 a.m. Eastern Time.

2026 Readers’ Choice Award Categories:

Components:

- Best Hardware Supplier

- Best Motor Manufacturer

Fabrication:

- Best Custom Workroom

- Best Shade Fabrication

- Best Workroom Partner for Designers

Motorization:

- Best Control Systems/Smart Home Integration

- Best Integrated Smart Solution

- Best Motor Manufacturer

- Best Motorized Drapery Hardware

- Best Motorized Solution

- Best Retractable Awning

- Power & Battery Innovation

Hardware & Trimmings:

- Best Decorative Hardware

- Best Decorative Trimming

- Best Motorized Drapery Hardware

Textiles:

- Best Decorative Fabrics

- Best Exterior Shade & Screen Fabric

- Best in Sustainability

- Best Interior Shade Fabric

- Best Performance Fabrics

Outdoor:

- Best Decorative Fabric

- Best Decorative Hardware

- Best Exterior Shade/Screen

- Best Outdoor Living Innovation

- Best Retractable Awning

Commercial:

- Best Exterior Solution

- Best Interior Solution

Franchise & Retail:

- Best Franchise

- Best Retail/Showroom Experience

Groups & Associations:

- Best Buying Group & Association

Machinery & Equipment:

- Best Machinery Supplier

- Best Workroom Supplies & Tools

Niche & Noteworthy:

- Best Child Safety Innovation

- Best Dealer Experience

- Best Designer Collaboration

- Best Social Impact & Community

- Best Trade Program

- Industry-Leading Innovator

PR, Marketing & Consulting:

- Best Consulting & Education

- Best Marketing & Social Media

Technology:

- Best Design Visualization Tools

- Best Measuring/Quoting Software

- Power & Battery Innovation

Industry professionals may submit nominations in as many applicable categories as they choose. Once voting opens, the window covering community will have the opportunity to support the finalists and determine who earns the title of a 2026 Window Fashion VISION Readers' Choice Award winner.

About Window Fashion VISION:

Window Fashion VISION is the leading publication serving the window covering industry, delivering business insights, design inspiration, product innovation and industry news to designers, dealers, retailers, fabricators, workrooms, installers, manufacturers and other professionals. Through its print and digital platforms, educational initiatives and industry programs, VISION connects and celebrates the people and companies shaping the future of window coverings.

Celery is 2027's color.

https://www.wf-vision.com/design-and-trends/sherwin-williams-names-celery-its-2027-color-o

Sherwin-Williams Names Celery Its 2027 Color of the Year

Green is staying in the spotlight for 2027. Sherwin-Williams and HGTV Home by Sherwin-Williams have named Celery their shared 2027 Color of the Year.

A soft, muted green with subtle yellow undertones, Celery SW 6421 brings a fresh, airy feel to interiors while tapping into the continued pull toward nature-inspired color and restorative spaces.

Part of Sherwin-Williams' 2027 Colormix Trend Forecast, Rewild, Celery is designed to feel both calming and uplifting. Its versatility allows it to move easily from contemporary and transitional spaces to heritage-inspired and nature-driven interiors.

"Celery was chosen as the 2027 Color of the Year because it reflects today's priorities: wellness, balance and connection," said Ashley Banbury, color marketing manager at Sherwin-Williams.

The shade can be paired with soft neutrals and earthy greens or pushed in a bolder direction with colors including Kirsch Red, Plum Brown, Potentially Purple and Georgian Bay.

Celery SW 6421 is available through Sherwin-Williams and as Celery HGSW6421 through HGTV Home by Sherwin-Williams.

Window Fashion VISION issue released

https://www.wf-vision.com/discover/discover-the-sep-oct-issue-of-window-fashion-vision/

Discover the September/October issue of Window Fashion VISION.

With water views from every window, this Marco Island, Florida, primary bedroom offered designer Sandra Asdourian plenty of inspiration for its dreamy blue palette.

Part of a new-build home designed by Sandra Asdourian Interiors, the bedroom was created as a quiet, calming retreat where the homeowner could unwind and sleep peacefully. Asdourian embraced the home's coastal surroundings, color-drenching the ceiling, trim and walls in Sherwin-Williams' Smoky Azurite.

A hand-knotted rug in shades of blue, green and teal helped set the palette for the rest of the room. At the windows, Asdourian selected Kravet's Lost Coast fabric for the custom drapery and roman shades. "I sourced a fabric that felt like the waves on the beach and built the colors and textures around those elements," Asdourian said.

Even with color covering nearly every surface, the room never feels overwhelming. Asdourian balanced the saturated blues with soothing wood tones and other quieter elements. "When I go bold with color, I also add places for the eye to rest."

The window treatments add another layer of color while providing the light control essential to a restful bedroom. The drapery and roman shades are fully lined, and motorized blackout shades at every window make it easy to darken the room when needed.

Satin brass hardware adds warmth to the window treatments, while Peacock Alley's Biagio Jacquard bedding and Visual Comfort lamps in a glazed Blue Lagoon finish carry the palette throughout the space. Custom pillows and a one-of-a-kind rug complete the room's mix of color, pattern and texture.

Coastal style window coverings.

https://www.wf-vision.com/new-product-annoucements/selectblinds-and-nautica-bring-coastal-

Coastal style is making its way to the window with a new collaboration between SelectBlinds and Nautica.

The newly launched Nautica Home collection translates the lifestyle brand's classic Americana aesthetic into customizable window treatments, pairing familiar nautical influences with a more relaxed, contemporary approach. Clean stripes, subtle maritime motifs, botanicals, woven textures, and easy neutrals give the collection a coastal feel without leaning too heavily into theme.

The assortment spans roller shades, roman shades, and drapery, offering options suited to everything from traditional Cape Cod-inspired interiors to more modern spaces where texture and pattern provide a subtle nod to the coast.

“We’re incredibly excited to partner with Nautica to bring their iconic coastal-inspired style into the home through a new window treatment collection,” said Ashley Damico, VP of Merchandising for SelectBlinds. “Nautica is a brand known for timeless design and effortless lifestyle appeal, and this collaboration allows us to translate that aesthetic into beautifully crafted, customizable blinds and shades.”

For SelectBlinds, the partnership also brings a recognizable lifestyle name into the custom window coverings category. Each design is made to measure and available exclusively through the company’s online platform.

The collection extends Nautica’s signature coastal aesthetic into a new category, bringing its mix of classic pattern, texture, and relaxed color to window treatments.

Wilson Fabrics celebrates 100 years.

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/wilson-fabrics-celebrates-100-years/

Wilson Fabrics is celebrating its 100th anniversary in 2026, marking a century of Australian manufacturing, innovation and growth in the soft furnishings industry.

Founded by Arthur G. Wilson in 1926, the company began by wholesaling Australian-made and European decorative woven fabrics for drapery and interiors. Today, Wilson Fabrics is 100% Australian owned and supplies drapery, blind and sheer fabrics to markets around the world.

Much of that evolution has centered on manufacturing. From its fully vertically integrated mill in Wangaratta, Victoria, Wilson Fabrics manages weaving, dyeing, finishing and coating in-house. Over the decades, the company expanded from decorative textiles into coated drapery fabrics, introduced roller blind fabrics in 2000 and continued investing in new weaving and coating technologies.

More recently, Wilson Fabrics has expanded its reach and product offerings, entering the U.S. and European markets in 2015, launching its Australian-made Whitsundays sheer in 2023 and introducing its color-coordinated COLOUR FLOW range in 2024.

To commemorate its centennial, the company recently gathered current and former employees and local representatives at its Wangaratta mill to celebrate the people, history and partnerships behind the milestone.

A 100 year milestone is not achieved alone. The company shared, "We are incredibly grateful to the generations of employees, our valued customers, suppliers and industry partners who have supported Wilson Fabrics throughout our journey."

As it enters its second century, Wilson Fabrics says it plans to continue investing in innovation and collaboration while maintaining its Australian manufacturing roots.

IWCE 2027 unveils speakers.

https://www.wf-vision.com/industry-news/iwce-2027-announces-keynote-speaker-education-line

IWCE 2027 Announces Keynote Speaker & Education Lineup

Industry experts will lead sessions across business, design, sales, motorization, installation, marketing, finance and more, March 14-16 at the Tampa Convention Center.

The International Window Coverings Expo has announced its keynote speaker and education lineup for IWCE 2027, taking place March 14-16 at the Tampa Convention Center in Tampa, Florida. The 2027 education program brings together experts from across the window covering, design and business communities, with seminars and panel discussions covering finance, sales, leadership, design, color, marketing, AI, motorization, commercial shading, exterior shading, installation, workroom craftsmanship and more.

Headlining the program is keynote speaker Tracee Murphy, The Design Biz Therapist, presenting “The Human Advantage: Why Understanding People Is Your Greatest Competitive Edge.” Murphy will explore how understanding human behavior and emotional intelligence can help professionals strengthen communication, leadership, teams and customer relationships. Additionally, Murphy will also lead “Conflict Without the Chaos: Turning Difficult Conversations into Stronger Relationships,” focused on navigating challenging conversations while building trust and accountability.

Speaker Lineup:

- Deb Barrett, Window Dressings — Design, trends, sustainability, AI and business

- Kim Boynton, 3/8 and Co., LLC — Exterior shading and outdoor living

- Elle Cole, Elle Cole Interiors — Color and luxury design

- John MacKenzie, Cronopower — Motorization and commercial shading

- Madeleine MacRae — Sales and leadership

- Roger Magalhaes, Shades In Place and Trading Up Consulting — Installation and measuring

- O’D McKewan, Smart Shade Services — Motorization and smart home automation

- Tracee Murphy, The Design Biz Therapist — Business and leadership

- Vince Nigara, Exciting Windows — Business growth and leadership

- Audra Tomme, Creekmore Marketing — Marketing, social media, digital strategy and AI

- Linda Tully, Tully Drapery Shop — Drapery, hardware, design and sales

- Vita Vygovska, Vitalia Inc. — Design and soft treatments

- Michele Williams, Scarlet Thread Consulting — Finance and business strategy

Additional panelists and industry experts will join the program throughout the event. The 2027 seminar lineup is designed to address both the day-to-day needs of window covering professionals and the changes shaping the future of the industry. Attendees can choose from sessions focused on profitability and financial planning, sales, digital marketing and AI, luxury and color, motorization and smart home technology, exterior and commercial shading, measuring and installation, drapery and hardware, and emerging industry trends.

Show leadership shared that education has always been at the heart of IWCE, and that the 2027 program reflects the many different ways our industry is evolving.

“We’re bringing together experts who understand the realities of running and growing a profitable window covering business and can give attendees practical ideas, strategies and knowledge they can take home and use.”

In addition to education, IWCE 2027 will feature two days of exhibits, networking and special events, including the Pirates & Paradise Welcome Party and the 2027 Grace Awards Ceremony. IWCE 2027 takes place March 14-16, 2027, at the Tampa Convention Center, with education beginning Sunday, March 14, followed by the exhibit hall Monday and Tuesday, March 15-16.

About IWCE

The International Window Coverings Expo (IWCE) is North America’s premier trade show and educational conference dedicated to the window covering industry since 1986. IWCE brings together window treatment professionals, designers, dealers, installers, workrooms, manufacturers, suppliers and industry leaders for education, product discovery, networking and business development.

Window covering safety webinar.

https://www.wf-vision.com/webinars/free-webinar-to-address-electrical-safety-compliance-in

Free Webinar to Address Electrical Safety & Compliance in the Window Covering Industry

The “Powering Safety” panel will bring industry experts together to discuss electrical, battery and wireless safety requirements.

As motorization, battery power and connected technology continue to expand across the window covering industry, understanding the safety and compliance requirements behind these products is increasingly important for manufacturers, dealers, fabricators and installers.

Window Fashion VISION will present “Powering Safety: What You Need to Know About Electrical Safety & Compliance,” a free, 60-minute webinar on Tuesday, October 13 at 1:00 p.m. ET. The live panel discussion will bring together industry experts to explore the electrical, battery and wireless

safety standards that apply to today's window covering products and components, including motors, controls, remotes, batteries, charging systems, sensors and cables.

The discussion will use the industry white paper The Importance of Electrical, Battery and Wireless Safety Certifications for the Window Covering Industry as a resource, translating complex requirements into practical information professionals can use when manufacturing, selling, specifying and installing window covering products.

Attendees will learn:

- Key electrical, battery and wireless safety requirements

- Risks and potential liabilities associated with uncertified products

- How to identify certified products and components

- Questions to ask suppliers about certification and compliance

- What manufacturers, dealers and installers should know before products reach the customer

Electrical safety considerations extend throughout the product chain, from manufacturing and sourcing to transportation, installation and use. The webinar is designed to give window covering professionals a clearer understanding of their role in navigating compliance and reducing potential risk.

"Powering Safety: What You Need to Know About Electrical Safety & Compliance" is free to attend, but advance registration is required.

Webinar Details

Tuesday, October 13, 2026

1:00 p.m. ET

60 minutes

Free to attend | Registration required

BONUS RESOURCE: Attendees will also receive access to the free industry white paper, The Importance of Electrical, Battery and Wireless Safety Certifications for the Window Covering Industry, which will serve as a resource for the panel discussion.

leMoniteur

Leborgne names new director.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/negoce/arvillard-savoie-le-fabricant-doutillage-a-main-leborgne-

Arvillard (Savoie): the manufacturer of hand tools Leborgne (Novalia group) names Thibaut Natoli as General Director

The new leader succeeds Florence Hocq, who has retired. Thibaut Natoli, who has spent his entire career in the industry, will notably strengthen the synergies between the three tool brands of the Novalia group.

Thibaut Natoli was appointed by Thibaut and Arnaud Moulin, directors of the Novalia Group, to the general direction of Leborgne, a Savoyard manufacturer of hand tools for gardening, construction, and woodcutting since 1829. He takes over from Florence Hocq, now retired, after 11 years of leadership. From the site in Arvillard (Savoie), the new General Director will have to strengthen the complementarity of the three tool brands of the Novalia group: Leborgne, Mob, and Mondelin.

Thibaut Natoli has 30 years of experience in the industry. After a degree in Mechanical Engineering and Production followed by a degree in plastics engineering, he worked in the automotive industry for 14 years, successively at Forvia, Harman, and Volvo. He then served as Industrial Director at the Piroux Group (mechanical welding and industrial painting), then at MLT Group (conveyor belt joints), before taking the general management of Bony (refractory bricks).

School upgrades heating system.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/artisans/renovation-energetique-une-ecole-modernise-son-chauffag

Energy renovation: a school modernizes its heating with a hybrid heat pump on the roof

Installed on the roof, this monobloc hybrid heat pump has provided an effective energy renovation solution for the school group: it has decarbonized heat production while maintaining existing networks and without occupying ground space.

Published on September 21, 2026

Like many establishments in France, the Henri Matisse school in Serris (Seine-et-Marne) was heated by an aging system supplying high-temperature radiators. For its energy renovation, the aim was to optimize heat production while retaining the heating emitters and existing network, in order to control costs and avoid heavy construction work.

To meet these constraints, the community opted for the solution of the T-Duo 90 monobloc hybrid heat pump (from Terris Energy), with 90 kW capacity, combining in a single block an air/water heat pump

with inverter compressor and a modulating condensing gas boiler (reaching up to 85 °C), with the choice between the two technologies being automatically controlled by an integrated regulation.

The advantage of hybridization lies in making the heat pump and boiler operate in their optimal performance zone. Thus, the heat pump covers the needs in mid-season and partial load, when the outside air is mild and the demands moderate, and the boiler takes over during peak winter cold or high-temperature demands. In a school, the balance is favorable to the thermodynamic part (long mid-seasons, holidays, short peaks). For optimized performance, the heat pump includes native regulation, automatically switching between 4 modes (heat pump only, heat pump + gas, gas only, defrosting) and is remotely accessible for monitoring and diagnosis.

The T-Duo 90 heat pump, installed directly on the school group's rooftop, integrates a flue gas evacuation through a duct and a sealed and factory-tested refrigerant circuit with R290, requiring no refrigerant connections or fluid handling on site. No boiler room needs to be created for the heat pump installation. Only a technical room houses the pre-mounted hydraulic decoupling module, which separates the primary circuit from the distribution substation. From there, departures lead to the conserved network and existing radiators.

"This decarbonization solution is pragmatic. In schools, as in many public buildings, existing heating networks cannot be entirely rebuilt. We need technologies that can simply integrate without heavy work while improving energy performance. The T-Duo heat pump meets this equation with a rooftop installation, retained radiators, secured winter peaks, and optimized operation," emphasizes Antoine Cohignac, CEO of Terris Energy.

Heat network expands northwards.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/grand-est/strasbourg-le-reseau-de-chaleur-etendu-au-secteur-nord

Strasbourg: the extended heat network in the northern sector

The new heat network of the Eurométropole of Strasbourg, deployed in the north of the agglomeration, has begun its works this summer. These works plan the installation of a backbone of 33 km of new pipelines by 2030. A first phase of 11 km until the end of 2027 is divided into 11 sections, mostly located in the La Robertsau district, in the northeast of Strasbourg. The delegating company, Decarbonized Energies Eurometropolis North (Eden), associating the operator Urban Heat Networks Alsace (R-CUA, 65%) and the Bank of Territories, assisted by BET Lollier Ingénierie, has divided the contracts into three lots: two awarded to Sogea (Vinci Construction group, earthworks) and SGD Réseaux and one to Pontiggia (NGE group). The next phase will focus mainly on the towns of Schiltigheim and Bischheim. "Its schedule and exact scope still need to be specified," indicates François Evrard, general director of Eden. The advancement of the installation is linked, in part, to the Eurométropole's own planning for simultaneous renovations of water and sanitation networks.

The program also includes connections to the main network, starting in late 2027 for the earliest ones, and two secondary networks in the slightly more peripheral municipalities of Souffelweyersheim and Mundolsheim, with densifications until 2035, the creation of a substation in the autonomous port area of Strasbourg, and its connection to that network, also managed by R-CUA. In total, Eden is investing €89 million, of which 43% comes from Ademe assistance and energy savings certificate products. The cumulative 40 km of pipes will produce 110 GWh per year of heat, equivalent to the needs of 14,000 homes, 75% of which will be from the recovery of heat from companies and the metropolitan wastewater treatment plant.

Sommer Foundation builds wildlife center.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/vie-du-btp/dans-les-ardennes-la-fondation-francois-sommer-instal

In the Ardennes, the François Sommer Foundation has established a center for the study of wildlife in the form of a hamlet of nine pavilions.

To give a new dimension to its historical site of Belval (Ardennes), a domain of 1050 hectares, the François Sommer Foundation for hunting and nature has chosen to expand its center dedicated simultaneously to training, research, and artistic creation. To this project inaugurated in early July, it has allocated an investment of 13 million euros inclusive of taxes, of which 8 million euros for construction work. The architectural duo it selected, formed by Frédéric Denisart (Atelier Matières d'Architecture) and Paul Landauer (Atelier Landauer), has conveyed this intent through the design of a "hamlet" of nine pavilions (2500 m2) for various functions – including one for artistic creation at one end of the site – as well as accommodation and dining facilities.

"This layout introduces into the project the dimension of its landscape integration, on a slightly sloped northwest-oriented terrain between forest and plain, which makes the 15-meter square buildings, designed to be at the scale of this landscape, easily visible," describes Frédéric Denisart.

The roofs give the whole ensemble its main visual identity. They are made of flat terracotta tiles, which is one of the many implementations of natural materials and short supply chains with local companies: wooden frame structures and laminated beams (Le Bâtiment Associé), straw insulation, stone cladding and masonry for generously thick walls of 70 cm, interior cladding and oak flooring from the Belval forest.

Tandem restructures Belfort's economy.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/bourgogne-franche-comte/dans-le-territoire-de-belfort-la-sem-imm

In the Territory of Belfort, the real estate SEM Tandem continues its restructuring projects for the benefit of local economic development.

Strongly associated with the image and actions of the construction of the Techn'Hom industrial district in Belfort, the local real estate SEM Tandem does not limit its scope to this area alone. Its next major project serves as a reminder of this. Starting in 2027 and for a duration of twenty-four to thirty months, it will restructure the building of the Nouvelles Galeries in the city center, covering 12,092 m2 across four floors, acquired for 6 million euros from its private owner. The project represents a total construction cost of 14 million euros excluding taxes, supervised by Sud Architects. On this occasion, Tandem once again acts as the "armed arm" of local authorities (the City of Belfort, in this case), which form the main core of its shareholders: the Grand Belfort agglomeration community and the municipality, which hold 35% of the capital, and the Burgundy-Franche-Comté region, responsible for economic development, holds 18%.

Since its establishment in 1988, Tandem has been characterized by the creation and renovation of professional premises, which makes it the owner today of 270,000 m2 for industry, services, and crafts, occupied by more than 130 companies of various sizes. The revenue generated by technical and legal studies, the realization and monitoring of works, as well as rental management, amounts to 27.7 million euros in 2025 with a net profit of 3 million euros. "Profitable in every financial year except for the year of Covid-19, our model thus generates regular dividends and allows for reserve incorporations that add to capital increases to bring it to 60 million euros: a high but necessary amount in light of the scale of our projects," explains General Director Pierre-Etienne Pérol.

The SEM primarily acts as a reshaper of the vast historical sites of Bull and Alstom in Belfort. It united them to give birth to Techn'Hom, which forms a complex of 110 hectares and 200,000 m2 of buildings, of which 35,000 m2 are still available for rent. It has allocated 200 million euros to this park since its inception, including 41 million euros to adapt 60,000 m2 of General Electric to the successive developments of activities on-site by the American group. For Alstom, which has refocused on railway equipment, Tandem oversees the construction, carried out by the local SME group L'Aube, of a testing hall of 5,700 m2 (10 million euros) by early 2027. It also restructures spaces for new activities, such as the manufacture of Inocel fuel cells since last year over 11,000 m2. "We have also developed a crossing axis within Techn'Hom to connect it to the city center," notes Emilie Tankéré, Deputy General Director.

Moreover, Tandem has led the construction of the first two buildings (23,000 m2) of the economic zone of La Jonxion opposite the Belfort-Montbéliard TGV station, while awaiting projects for extension. In 2027, it will construct the second phase of 1,500 m2 of the Morvillars artisan village, still within the Belfort agglomeration.

AI data center halted.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/reglementation/droit-de-l-urbanisme/quand-lexecution-dun-permis-

When the execution of a building permit for a data center dedicated to artificial intelligence is suspended due to lack of an impact study.

With its decision dated July 10, 2026, the Administrative Court of Grenoble reminds operators that a project cannot be fragmented to evade obligations regarding environmental assessment.

The judge in Grenoble has suspended the execution of a building permit for an artificial intelligence dedicated data center due to the absence of an impact study.

The impact study for a project of an artificial intelligence dedicated data center is not optional. This is the essence of the decision by the emergency judge of the Administrative Court of Grenoble.

The mayor of a commune in Drôme issued a building permit to a company for the realization of a “computer center.” These infrastructures, belonging to the family of data centers, have very high computing power for hosting AI solutions. Their operation requires significant power supply capabilities, as well as backup technical equipment. The installation is to be located within an economic park, near the TGV station of Valence and highways. Several associations opposed to this project have filed a request with the Administrative Court to suspend the execution of the decree authorizing the construction.

Emergency and serious doubt about the legality of the permit

Among the reasons invoked: the absence of an environmental impact study, the insufficiency of the building permit file that does not specify that the project is subject to environmental assessment, and the disregard for the regulations of the local urban planning plan (PLU). The latter prohibits, in the concerned area, installations classified for environmental protection (ICPE) requiring authorization and constructions used for industry that pose risks and nuisances.

For reference, two conditions are necessary for the judge to grant a request for suspension of a decision: urgency and a serious doubt regarding the legality of the decision.

Regarding the first condition, the judge from Grenoble recalls, in accordance with the article L. 122-1 of the Code of the Environment, that projects must be considered as a whole, “even in cases of fragmentation over time” to evaluate their impacts on the environment in their entirety. Thus, while the disputed project indeed plans “two phases of work,” it has been “authorized in its entirety, as evidenced by the land occupancy plan which shows the installation upon completion of the second phase.”

Authorization ICPE and environmental assessment

In the end, the judge continues, the data center will require a power exceeding 60 megawatts (MW). And the generators intended to ensure its operation in case of power supply failure must have a nominal thermal power even higher.

Now, combustion installations with a nominal thermal power of at least 50 MW are subject to authorization under ICPE regulations (item 3110 of the nomenclature). For these installations, environmental assessment - and thus the realization of an impact study - is necessary.

Therefore, given these characteristics, the “computer center” project should have been preceded by an impact study. In its absence, the building permit must be suspended in accordance with the article L. 122-2 of the Code of the Environment. This article indeed provides that “if a challenge is founded on the absence of an impact study, the emergency judge must grant it as soon as this absence is established.”

Regarding the second condition, the judge considers that a serious doubt exists regarding the legality of the building permit insofar as the ICPE necessary for the functioning of the project cannot be implanted on the project site due to its classification by the PLU.

Mialot leads CDC Habitat.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/nominations/de-la-renovation-urbaine-a-la-production-renovation-

From urban renovation to residential production-renovation: Anne-Claire Mialot is expected to take over the general management of CDC Habitat.

The supervisory board of the landlord will decide on October 2 whether to appoint the current director general of the National Agency for Urban Renovation (Anru).

Published on September 21, 2026.

Former housing advisor to Emmanuel Macron, Anne-Claire Mialot has been leading the National Agency for Urban Renovation (Anru) since 2022.

From Anru to CDC Habitat. The candidacy of Anne-Claire Mialot, the current director general of the National Agency for Urban Renovation, will be reviewed on October 2 by the supervisory board of the subsidiary of the Caisse des dépôts, chaired by former socialist minister Myriam El Khomri.

If approved, Anne-Claire Mialot will “report” to the chairman of the executive board, Clément Lecuivre, as the general director, explains her potential new employer on September 21. This position has been vacant since last March when Clément Lecuivre transitioned from general director to chairman of the executive board, succeeding Anne-Sophie Grave.

Housing advisor to Valls, Cazeneuve and Macron.

A graduate of the Institute of Political Studies in Bordeaux and holding a DEA in economics and international finance from the University of Paris Dauphine, Anne-Claire Mialot has been “dedicated for over twenty years to public action and territorial development,” summarizes CDC Habitat.

At the beginning of her career, Anne-Claire Mialot held various leadership positions within local authorities, including the urban community of Cergy-Pontoise (Val d'Oise). She later worked at the

Court of Auditors as a rapporteur.

In 2016, she joined the cabinet of socialist Prime Minister Manuel Valls as an advisor on territorial communities, cohesion of territories, and housing. When she left for the PS primary during the presidential election in 2017, Anne-Claire Mialot stayed on to advise fellow socialist Bernard Cazeneuve.

Following Emmanuel Macron's election in May 2017, Anne-Claire Mialot became his advisor on these same matters. She served the President of the Republic until December 2019 when she was appointed as the delegated prefect for equal opportunities to the prefect of Seine-Saint-Denis.

CDC Habitat: a producer and renovator of housing.

Three years later, she took over the direction of Anru, the public institution that oversees the transformation of entire neighborhoods. Alongside Cédric Van Styvendael, the socialist mayor of Villeurbanne (Rhône), and Jean-Martin Delorme, then president of the housing section of the General Inspectorate of Environment and Sustainable Development (IGEDD), she co-wrote in 2024 a report that influenced the reflections of the governments of François Bayrou and then Sébastien Lecornu on the third urban renewal program. This program will succeed the National Program for Urban Renewal (NPNRU), with Anru 2 nearing completion.

Trained at the National Institute of Territorial Studies (Inet), Anne-Claire Mialot joined the state administrative corps in 2023, after being tenured in the prefectural corps in 2021.

CDC Habitat manages a portfolio of 573,400 housing units, some located within one of the 447 neighborhoods to be transformed under the ongoing Anru 2. In 2025, the national operator decreased its renovation pace, but maintained a good production pace.

Line project meeting today.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/transition-ecologique/energie/a-la-veille-de-la-dup-rentree-elec

* As the state has initiated the procedure for the public utility declaration of the aerial 400,000 volt power line project between Fos-sur-Mer in the Bouches-du-Rhône and the Jonquières-Saint-Vincent substation in the Gard, voices of opponents and supporters are rising. Supported by RTE, the infrastructure aims to secure the electrical supply of the Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur region and assist in the decarbonization of the industrial area of Fos-Berre.

The 400 kV line project between Fos-sur-Mer (Bouches-du-Rhône) and Jonquières-Saint-Vincent (Gard) is facing strong opposition.

"It was the demonstration of the last chance." With these words, Jean-Luc Moya, administrator of the Nature Environment Federation (FNE) of Bouches-du-Rhône and member of the Stop THT 13/30 collective, defined the gathering organized on Saturday, September 19, at the ancient theater of Arles

(Bouches-du-Rhône) against the 400,000 volt overhead line project that is to link the Jonquières-Saint-Vincent (Gard) electrical substation to Fos-sur-Mer (Bouches-du-Rhône) via the Camargue and Crau. The demonstration reportedly brought together about 2,000 participants, according to the organizers.

According to RTE, the 65 km long infrastructure, estimated to cost around 400 million euros, is designed to meet the needs for re-industrialization of the Fos-Berre industrial port area and especially to meet the current connection demands of over 6,000 MW (buildings, transport, industry, and crafts), equivalent to the current instantaneous consumption of the Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur region.

The Stop THT 13/30 collective proposes to bury a 200,000 volt line along the banks of the Rhône levees. "Buried on public land, it has the advantage of not consuming any agricultural land and not impacting biodiversity," asserts Jean-Luc Moya.

"It was important to show our dissatisfaction at this key moment. We are just before the public utility declaration of a project that we contest. The arguments put forward by RTE against the burial solution proposed by our collective do not convince us," he tells Le Moniteur, recalling the third-party expertise report led by Centrale Supélec which deemed it technically relevant.

The Stop THT 13/30 collective could count on the mobilization of local elected officials. About a hundred had announced their presence, including around twenty mayors from various political backgrounds, all united against the infrastructure which, according to Jean-Luc Moya, would have "irreversible impacts on the most precious aspects of the territory in terms of biodiversity, agricultural land, and landscapes." "About 90% of the 180 pylons will be located on agricultural land," he said.

Among the supporters of the collective are Carole Delga (PS) and Renaud Muselier (Renaissance), respectively, president of the Occitanie region and president of the Sud-Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur region. In a letter addressed to Jacques Witkowski, prefect of the Paca region and the Bouches-du-Rhône, and made public on September 17, the socialist elected representative, "aware of the importance of the transition project of the Fos-sur-Mer port," also wishes to protect the Gard territory, its agriculture, economy, and its inhabitants. "This project risks heavily impacting an already weakened agricultural activity and will have visible effects on the Gard landscape, even though no counterpart or tangible benefit for the local economy is expected," she wrote.

Carole Delga agrees with her colleague who asked the state in June to "find a position of balance with a clear definition of the electricity needs, accompanied by a precise schedule of industrial projects." Both elected officials, advocating for a buried line, believe that "the currently proposed project does not address the overall issue and cannot alone constitute an acceptable prerequisite for the development of the territory."

The gathering at the ancient theater of Arles took place ten days after a joint press conference held on September 9 in Marseille by representatives of employers and employees. On this occasion, Medef

Sud, UPE 13, Force Ouvrière 13, CFE-CGC Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur, UIMM Alpes-Méditerranée, and France Chimie Méditerranée spoke with one voice. This "unprecedented" gathering, according to its participants, is motivated by a shared conviction: "without massive reinforcement of the electrical supply, part of the announced industrial projects around the Fos-Berre area might not see the light of day and existing industries would be weakened in their energy transition." They mentioned potential investments of 10 to 15 billion euros that could be made in the territory, preserving around 40,000 existing jobs and potentially several tens of thousands of direct and indirect jobs linked to new projects. They mainly demand the state set a schedule and not let electoral deadlines delay decisions.

"We are in favor of job creation and supportive of the decarbonization of the Fos-Berre area," counters Jean-Luc Moya, "but this must not come at the expense of the 46,000 current jobs related to agriculture and tourism."

These mobilizations come in the wake of the critical opinion of the Environmental Authority, adopted on August 27 and made public recently. It notably states that "the justification for electricity needs, their schedule, and the choice of solution must be concurrently reinforced." In its dossier, it points out several shortcomings, particularly regarding the environmental impact of the approximately 160 pylons that will reach heights of up to 60 meters. The project "does not sufficiently compare the impacts on the environment and human health of the various strategies, particularly phased solutions and those examined by the third-party expertise. (...) This requirement is, however, relevant in a territory where complex hydraulic networks overlap, vulnerable aquifers, flood expansion zones, wetlands, natural habitats, and national or European ecological corridors of importance." It focuses on the protection of fauna and flora, especially birds, including a protected species of partridge, which could suffer from a "barrier effect" caused by the future pylons.

During a visit to Marseille in June, the Minister Delegate for Ecological Transition, Mathieu Lefèvre, praised "the Notre-Dame method" that President Emmanuel Macron intends to apply to 150 industrial projects in France. Among the operations that would benefit from the administrative validation acceleration device is the connection of the Fos-Berre area via the THT line.

As the THT dossier becomes increasingly charged, industrial projects continue to progress. Following RTE’s validation of the lower impact corridor proposed, the state initiated in May the procedure for the public utility declaration of the THT line project, 65 km long supported by 180 pylons with heights ranging from 40 to 60 meters. The challenge is to start construction in 2028 for commissioning in 2030.

"Even once the maximum technical capacity of existing works is reached, mere optimization will not be enough: constructing a new 400,000 volt line is essential to secure the power supply for the entire region by 2030," can be read on RTE's site. Moreover, partial or total underground placements studied by RTE require "a technology and infrastructure incompatible with the energetic transition dynamic initiated in the territory." This results in extended deadlines, "until at least 2035 for a total burial," a larger land footprint (soil artificialization of 9 ha for a 6 km burial and 36 ha for a total burial), and higher

costs for the community (3.6 to 4 billion euros for a fully underground solution against about 400 million euros for the aerial solution).

China opposes EU preference rules.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/reglementation/la-chine-soppose-aux-mesures-de-preference-europe

China opposes the European preference measures outlined in the proposed regulation on public procurement and concessions. The primary target of the mechanism introduced by Brussels in its reform proposal presented at the beginning of September, China hopes to relax the provisions. This was made clear through its Chamber of Commerce to the European Union.

Public procurement is the stage for an intense battle between the European Union and China. Unsurprisingly, China opposes European preference in the public procurement of member states. This is stated by the China Chamber of Commerce to the European Union (CCCUE) in a statement issued following Brussels' presentation on September 9 of its proposed regulation on public procurement and concessions, which is meant to replace the currently applicable 2014 directives. "We are strongly opposed to any measure that would exclude or restrict the participation of companies from third countries in EU public procurement on the basis of what we call non-market factors, such as the country of origin of the company," the CCCUE states.

The text proposed by the European Commission contains a chapter dedicated to European preference. This preference is not intended to benefit only EU member states. Third countries that are parties to the WTO Agreement on Government Procurement (GPA), to a trade agreement, or to a customs union with the Union are also targeted, subject to reciprocity—meaning they must actually make their public procurement markets accessible to European companies and products.

The proposed regulation allows public buyers to integrate restrictions against economic operators and goods, services, and works originating from a third country that would not benefit from European preference. If the text were adopted as is, a European buyer could decide not to allow the affected companies to participate in a public procurement contract bidding process. They could also reject an offer from such a company during the bidding procedure.

Another option includes requiring that goods, services, and works proposed are wholly or partially originated from a state covered by European preference. Buyers could also favor offers submitted by companies from a covered country or those that contain the highest share of products originating from such a country.

The text further provides the setting aside of offers whose value of goods, services, or works from the EU or a covered third country is below 50% of the total offer value. It is noted that the regulation specifies that the European Commission could, "when it is in the Union's interest," impose these restrictions on public buyers.

These measures target China directly. Stéphane Séjourné made this clear during the presentation of the proposed regulation. The Executive Vice-President of the European Commission in charge of Prosperity and Industrial Strategy specifically cited the example of purchasing Chinese buses when explaining the mechanism conceived by Brussels.

The CCCUE wishes to maintain dialogue with European institutions throughout the legislative process that has just begun, aiming to influence the Union's position. "We hope that the new public procurement framework will further strengthen market transparency, predictability, and regulatory clarity while offering a fair and stable environment that allows companies of all origins to participate in public procurement," it stated in its release.

However, it seems unlikely that the China Chamber of Commerce will achieve its goals. In the European Parliament, the three co-reporters of the Industrial Accelerator Act are looking to strengthen the conditions under which third countries could benefit from this preference similarly to member states. They aim to reserve it for states that respect a certain number of social and environmental commitments.

As for the Commission, it has been particularly aggressive against China in recent months. "Chinese companies already face significant market access barriers in EU public procurement in several areas," lamented the CCCUE. The European executive has repeatedly applied the provisions of regulations providing for an instrument concerning international public procurement and those on foreign subsidies to restrict access for operators and products originating in China to public procurement contracts, particularly in the medical devices, rail, and renewable energy sectors.

Espace Émeraude supports direct supplies.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/negoce/le-reseau-espace-emeraude-garem-developpe-une-double-logi

* The Espace Émeraude network (Garem) develops a dual logistics system to support direct supplies from suppliers.

Direct delivery from suppliers is the main supply model for Espace Émeraude stores. The group's logistics provides flexibility and agility to this scheme.

In rural and peri-urban environments, the 64 Espace Émeraude retail outlets stand out for their extensive offerings. This diversity also benefits the 36 unbranded stores supplied by its purchasing center SA 2E. "Our article base has more than 96,000 items in eight categories, with the two main ones being gardening equipment and the DIY and materials sector. Espace Émeraude is a proximity brand with members who are often family businesses established long ago in their territory," explains Jean-Marc Hupé, managing director of Espace Émeraude.

The stores of this brand, organized as the cooperative Garem, generate around €300 million in revenue. For retail outlets with a materials yard, a quarter of their turnover comes from the building and

outdoor development sector. With nearly 28,000 references, the DIY and materials offering covers all building trades.

Two Logics

With an average size of 1,200 m², sometimes supplemented by materials yards, the stores that utilize the purchasing center of the Espace Émeraude group—owned by Garem since 2025—rely on two logistics systems. "The majority of supplies to the stores—80%—are delivered directly by 400 active suppliers. The rest of the store needs go through a warehouse in Carquefou (Loire-Atlantique), which then delivers to the retail outlets," explains Patricia Bertaudeau, logistics manager for the group. She adds that during peak season, Espace Émeraude stores are delivered weekly by the warehouse. The management of its 3,000 m² is outsourced to the transport and logistics provider Alainé.

"The outsourcing of the warehouse brings flexibility and agility to our supply chain," Patricia Bertaudeau explains. With areas that vary according to seasons and activity peaks, this tool "offers products at the best prices to the stores."

A Logic of Flows

The site, operated by the Alainé group, is managed with the WMS Reflex, provided by Hardis, and is interfaced with the ERP Proginov of the Espace Émeraude group. In 2025, the warehouse shipped 21,000 pallets and prepared 110,000 packages.

"Storage is valuable for anticipating seasonalities and commercial opportunities," says Patricia Bertaudeau, emphasizing the economic rationale of delivering to stores directly or via the Carquefou platform. "This evaluation is always made in the economic interest of the retail outlet," insists Jean-Marc Hupé. Several criteria can justify passing through the warehouse, including access to more competitive pricing by pooling product purchases across multiple stores.

More than 80% of the flows managed by the platform are therefore cross-dock. "Upon receipt, the goods delivered to the warehouse by suppliers immediately depart for the stores," confirms Patricia Bertaudeau. They are dispatched along with the products that are stored there. "Storage represents only a thousand references and meets specific needs of the stores." For instance, the manager cites "long and/or unreliable supplier delays, anticipating seasonalities, and commercial opportunities."

One Transporter Per Store

The supply to the warehouse "also benefits the suppliers, who only deliver to a single point instead of several stores," she highlights. It is also a way for the group to reduce its logistical carbon footprint. "We pay close attention to the load rate of the trucks and are sensitive to the decarbonization of our flows. This ambition complements actions taken on our referenced products: eco-design, electrification, and reparability of products, with workshops present in all our retail outlets," adds Jean-Marc Hupé.

Created in 1980 in Maine-et-Loire, the Espace Émeraude group brings together 100 stores under brands and affiliates in rural and semi-rural areas. This growing network targets individual and professional clientele, including building artisans.

Since January 2025, its purchasing center SA 2E has been owned by its 33 members united within the cooperative Garem (Group of Members of the Espace Émeraude Network), headquartered in Ponts-de-Cé, near Angers.

Transport from the Carquefou warehouse is provided by five carriers, including Malherbe and its new parent company Geodis. "We prioritize carriers with their own vehicle network and try to minimize the share of chartering. A unique transporter per store is an asset. It brings regularity, reliability, and quality of service throughout the year," adds the leader. The type of equipment used is another selection criterion for carriers: the retail stores being without loading docks require delivery by tarpaulin-covered trailers that can be opened from the sides. Finally, depending on the type of products, last-mile delivery to customers can be organized by each store.

Post office building being renovated

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/vie-du-btp/evry-courcouronnes-essonne-lancien-batiment-de-la-pos

Evry-Courcouronnes (Essonne): the former Post Office building in the center is being demolished by an excavator as part of the city center renewal.

Published on September 9, 2026 at 10:50

Lucie Romano

The former Post Office building is being dismantled by a large-arm excavator, ahead of public space developments. This is a crucial step in the renewal of the city center of Evry-Courcouronnes (Essonne), which has been underway for several years. The former Post Office building is currently being reduced by a hydraulic excavator, which has already brought down a former daycare center, community spaces, and a bridge overlooking parking lots. The operation, carried out by Bouvelot TP, follows a year of clearing and asbestos removal. At its conclusion in November, it will have produced 13,900 tons of waste, mostly concrete sent for recycling, while 64 tons of rubble will be reused.

Once this strategic land is freed up, public space developments will commence for a little over three years, aimed at creating the central square that the municipality lacks. This area bears the mark of new towns built on agricultural plateaus under the guidance of the State in the 1960s. The heart of Evry was then designed primarily for functionality. It was equipped with a regionally significant shopping center, the RER (line D), and infrastructures such as a national theater, a large performance hall (the Arènes, renovated for €37M in 2024), as well as an ice rink and a swimming pool.

“The new city, with its two-level slab urbanism, has many flaws, but we also inherit structuring facilities that the project aims to enhance,” emphasizes Emmanuelle Gaubert, director of development for Grand Paris Sud. The operation is included in the OIN (National Interest Operation) of the southern gateway of Greater Paris, for which the State has delegated the responsibility for permit approval to the concerned territories.

After the slabs, rediscover the ground

The agglomeration is piloting this operation, registered since 2022 within the partnership development project “Grand Paris Sud Left Bank Urban Cores.” “For now, we do not navigate there. We want to create a “walkable city.” To achieve this, we will bring public space back down to ground level,” continues Emmanuelle Gaubert. This new walkable area will thus be situated 2.5 meters lower than the current slab. The 11 preserved trees will be naturally raised on small mounds. A gentle slope will lead from the high point of the shopping center to this new floor. The landscaped path will connect the new square to already refurbished squares (the Terrasses, the Agora), will make visible facilities, including the media library that will also be rehabilitated, and will allow rainwater infiltration. The operation is also expected to give a new boost to Blaise-Pascal Boulevard, already commercial but trapped between tangled buildings.

The project, covering 2.8 hectares and mobilizing €52M, is conducted by the community without recourse to a developer. A possible follow-up could involve the train station hub and the Butte Creuse building, a complex designed by architect Pierre Riboulet. However, this is contingent upon the ANRU 3 extending public action in this sector. In the meantime, the community can also count on private initiatives, notably converting the vacant Evry 2 office building into student housing, or the neighboring LCL tower. Furthermore, a tactical urbanism approach, carried out with an organization specialized in overcoming urban obstacles, is quietly activating certain spaces.

Fire texts released Monday.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/reglementation/textes-officiels/incendies-vos-textes-officiels-d

Fires... Your official texts for Monday, September 21, 2026

The editorial team of "Moniteur" offers you a daily selection of official texts relevant to the sector. On the menu: construction law, urban planning, public and private procurement, technical regulations, housing, social...

Exceptional aid for the consequences of the fires. A decree extends **until October 4, 2026 (instead of August 30) the reference period during which companies with fewer than 250 employees can benefit from exceptional aid** when they have suffered the consequences of forest fires and have been subject to an evacuation or containment measure. This aid, created by decree n° 2026-776 of August 14, 2026, aims to **bring the partial activity allowance to the level of the partial activity compensation.** The

decree updates the list of communities eligible for this aid, for the period from August 31 to October 4, 2026.

Activity nomenclature. A decree **updates the codes and labels of the French activity nomenclature of crafts (Nafa)**, assigned by the chambers of trades and crafts to companies, when they carry out a formality on the single electronic window for business formalities. “This update takes into account the expectations expressed by professional organizations regarding the recognition of the specifics of artisan trades,” the notice of the text indicates.

Local Authorities

Change of administrative constituencies. Two decrees modify the territorial limits of municipalities and cantons. The operation concerning the municipalities of Fameck and Hayange in Moselle aims to **unblock a housing estate located in the municipality of Fameck** by linking it to the municipality of Hayange. The one affecting the municipalities of Alençon and Condé-sur-Sarthe in Orne aims to **facilitate the establishment of the new intercommunal hospital center of Alençon-Mamers** (Chicam).

Appointment

Label "management of difficult condominiums". The Minister of Justice grants [the label "management of difficult condominiums"] to Me Nicolas Deshayes, judicial administrator.

This is a summary of the official texts relevant to various sectors in the context of the laws and regulations that govern them.

Bridge collapse, structural damage occurs.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/auvergne-rhone-alpes/isere-la-charpente-du-pont-de-brignoud-ripe

On August 26, the metal framework of the new bridge in Brignoud (Project Manager: Setec; Architect: AEI agency), connecting Crolles to Villard-Bonnot (Isère), was positioned on its supports. Of bow-string type, the 120 m long and 20 m wide artwork, featuring two lanes in each direction, will replace the former bridge downstream, which was damaged by a fire in 2022. Manufactured in Bas-Rhin, Loiret, and Haute-Loire, all elements of the framework were assembled on site. The 200 pre-cast reinforced concrete slabs for the future deck are being produced in Romagnieu, in the department. Once this bridge is put into service at the end of the year, the old one will be partially demolished: the abutments and piers will be kept as supports for a footbridge expected by the end of 2027.

Costing 27 million euros, this project is led by Campenon Bernard Centre-Est, Gagne, Eurovia, Terélian, Midali, and Menard.

Nature wood living veranda.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/stores-et-fermetures/fabricants/extension-bois-nature-de-vie-ver

Vie & Véranda launches the Nature range, a wooden extension designed as a true room of the house. When temperatures vary, the Nature extension relies on a design intended to maintain a pleasant indoor atmosphere, in winter as well as in summer. Its efficient insulation minimizes heat loss and cold wall sensations, while the large glazing surfaces of the Eclaz range from Saint-Gobain allow for natural light contributions while aiding the overall thermal efficiency. Controlled ventilation also participates in air renewal and indoor comfort regulation. In summer, the design of the extension allows for better control of solar gains to limit the risk of overheating. These performances are based on a holistic approach, integrating the characteristics of the building, its orientation, the flow between spaces, and openings to the outside.

Each project is studied tailor-made to ensure coherent integration with the existing house. The balance of volumes, perspectives, implantation, and uses are considered from the design stage. This process allows for creating an extension that naturally fits within the architecture of the dwelling while offering a versatile space that can accommodate a living room, dining room, workspace or reception area.

Made in France, the Nature range relies in particular on Saint-Gobain glazing, Sherwin-Williams wood stains, and PEFC certified wood. Vie & Véranda is also QUALICOAT certified for the coating of its products and CEKAL for the quality of its glazing.

France competes in Shanghai.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/artisans/worldskills-shanghai-2026-onze-competiteurs-francais-en

Worldskills Shanghai 2026: Eleven French Competitors in the Construction Trades

From September 22 to 27, 2026, China will host the 48th edition of the WorldSkills competition in Shanghai. An event gathering around 1400 young champions from 73 countries. In the Construction category, eleven French competitors will represent ten different trades.

The Worldskills, created in 1950 under the name of the World Skills Olympiad, are the largest international skills competition in the world. Now seen as the equivalent of the Olympic Games for vocational training and trades, they bring together young professionals under 23 years old (in training or active) to undertake high-level challenges in public and within a limited time frame.

The event serves as a showcase to highlight apprenticeship, alternation, and technical education among young people and the general public. For the competitors, the stakes are twofold: to achieve technical excellence and to become ambassadors for their trades. The 2026 edition promises to be of historic significance. Held at the National Exhibition and Convention Center in Shanghai over 360,000 m², the competitions will take place under the gaze of around 350,000 international visitors.

11 French competitors in 10 construction trades

France, which currently holds 3rd place in the world following the last edition (Lyon 2024), will participate this year in 32 trades (in the categories of Food, Arts, Communication, Construction, Industry, Mobility, Services, Plant), with 36 competitors (who have already passed the regional competitions and the national finals). The Construction category will see 11 young competitors in ten trades:

- Tiling: Nathanael Ball (Grand Est)

- Carpentry: Benjamin Blegean (Grand Est)

- Reinforced concrete construction: Valentin Etcheverry and Mathéo Graff as a team (Normandy)

- Digital construction: Aude Castanheira (Bourgogne-Franche-Comté)

- Electrical installation: Swann Clamart (Pays de la Loire)

- Masonry: Emilien Gallot (Sud Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur)

- Joinery: Thibault Landais (Nouvelle-Aquitaine)

- Painting and Decoration: Yann Mercier (Pays de la Loire)

- Plastering and Dry Construction: Enzo Delpech (Brittany)

- Plumbing and Heating: Louis Sontot (Grand Est)

The importance of partnerships

Many partners support the French Team in the trades. They enable the financing and organization of the technical preparation of the competitors, who follow an intensive program in the months leading up to the competition (internships, skills improvement, English courses, physical preparation sessions...) and to achieve the international aspect of the adventure. Among the partners for 2026, some are particularly linked to the construction industry, such as CCCA-BTP (institutional partner) and brands like Coverguard (global partner), DeWalt, and PPG Seigneurie (trade partners), which provide equipment and tools.

The opening ceremonies (Tuesday, September 22 from 20:00 to 21:30 local time) and the closing ceremonies (Sunday, September 27 from 19:00 to 22:00 local time) will take place at the Shanghai Expo Cultural Centre.

Sonepar hosts future energy event

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/negoce/a-orleans-loiret-sonepar-france-convie-ses-clients-locaux

In Orléans (Loiret), Sonepar France invited its local clients to its "Future Energies Exhibition" at a regional level.

During its tour of local exhibitions, the electrical specialist gathered nearly 500 clients in Orléans focused on “future energies.” This was an opportunity to unveil the good health of the trade, supported by the government’s electrification plan.

On September 17, 2026, Sonepar set up its stand at the “Future Energies” exhibition with 80 stands and nearly 500 visitors. Clients of the French group Sonepar were welcomed to Orléans for the second exhibition of the year, out of five planned in total. This visit is part of the electrical specialist’s routine, which changes regions with each exhibition, but always gathers local clients. After a meeting in June in Chambéry (Savoie), the next venue will be Bordeaux (Gironde) on September 24, followed by Saint-Etienne (Loire) and Nantes (Loire-Atlantique) on October 1 and 15, with a total of 3,500 visitors expected.

The smaller exhibitions, away from Paris, typically organize seven each year on average. “Maintaining this proximity with our clients is essential for us,” noted Christelle Velay, operational marketing director of Sonepar France. The electrical specialist, which recorded a revenue of 2.3 billion euros in France in 2025 and has 400 sales points, covers various sectors including lighting, tools, heating, and connectivity. At the Orléans exhibition, brands like Thermor, Came France, Legrand, Hager, Knipex, Yageo, and Ilme were showcased, as well as two exclusive Sonepar brands: Tradeforce for tools and Lit By Cardi for lighting.

After a transitional period, Sonepar France is flourishing. “In recent years we have transformed our internal organization and our various customer journeys,” recalls Christelle Velay. In September, the growth in revenue has been above market trends for the eighth consecutive month. “Sonepar is experiencing a strong dynamic across all product families,” emphasizes the operational marketing director. It’s no surprise, given that electricity is under more spotlight than ever, particularly with the electrification plan for France presented last April, which the trade worked on in collaboration with the government.

At the exhibitions, topics on energy sobriety were highlighted. In Orléans, there were several conferences, including two on the energy performance of tertiary and residential buildings—60% of network clients are involved in the residential sector. Another presentation detailed the latest developments in the electrical standard NFC 15-100. “There has always been a demand for training around regulations,” comments Christelle Velay. According to her, the noticeable change is the unprecedented media attention on electricity-related topics, evolving user behavior. Clients are now well-informed and often have a specific project in mind. “It’s essential for installers and contractors to know how to meet these precise demands,” she adds.

In Orléans, Sonepar unveiled a new solution launched in June 2026 to manage charging stations: an application in partnership with Reev, an electric vehicle charging platform. “Just like heat pumps, electric mobility has become an indispensable topic,” notes Christelle Velay. With the government’s goal to increase electrical consumption in France by 30% by 2035, electric vehicle sales have surged

by 63% compared to last year. “This figure is particularly driven by professional vehicle sales,” specifies Christophe Thivard, product and business manager at Sonepar. Through Reev, the trade offers an app and a kit (license, SIM card, RFID card...) that allow for precise tracking of an electric vehicle fleet, including charging billing, optimizing stations, and remote management. This solution was also presented during the conference.

“The aim of these exhibitions is to provide an inspiring day for our clients, who do not always have the time to train amidst their projects. We offer them a condensed array of themes and products that may encourage them to explore new niches and promote these topics to the end-user,” summarizes Christelle Velay. The emphasis remains on this strong local connection. “Our exhibitions are organized with our local teams. It’s also a point of pride for them to have their own day and clients come to spend time with them,” she concludes.

Orano builds future talent.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/publiredac-marque-employeur/relance-du-nucleaire-comment-orano-m

Internal Server Error

Eiffage wins German contract

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/electricite/eolien-offshore/eolien-en-mer-eiffage-et-nsore-rempo

Offshore wind: Eiffage and NSORe have won a new contract for a conversion station in Germany.

Awarded by 50Hertz, the transmission system operator of northern and eastern Germany, this contract involves a 2 GW conversion platform intended for the LanWin3 project in the North Sea.

Published on September 21, 2026, at 10:31 AM.

In June 2026, NSORe, in partnership with Siemens Energy, had already been entrusted by 50Hertz with the construction contract for a 2 gigawatt conversion station for the offshore connection project LanWin6.

A member of the NSORe joint venture (Neptun Smulders Offshore Renewables), the Belgian metal construction subsidiary of Eiffage, Smulders, has just won a second contract awarded by 50Hertz (the transmission system operator of northern and eastern Germany) for an **offshore conversion station.** With a power of 2 GW, it is intended for the LanWin3 project in the North Sea.

The contract encompasses **the overall system design, parts delivery, construction, installation both onshore and offshore, as well as commissioning.** NSORe is responsible for the complete implementation and turnkey delivery of the facilities. Siemens Energy will provide the high-voltage components for the recently awarded LanWin3 project.

Main elements such as the topside – the main structure of the offshore platform – will be manufactured at NSORe's factory in Rostock-Warnemünde. **Smulders will ensure the fabrication of the steel structures (jacket foundation) in its factory in Vlissingen, Netherlands.**

Second Contract

In June 2026, NSORe, in collaboration with Siemens Energy, had already been awarded by 50Hertz the construction contract for a 2 gigawatt conversion station for the offshore connection project LanWin6.

These two contracts will allow for **the production of significant volumes of offshore wind electricity in the North Sea for the German electricity grid.

Heidelberg Materials closes Ranville site.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/industrie/industriels/heidelberg-materials-france-envisage-de-fe

Heidelberg Materials France is considering closing its site in Ranville, Calvados, as part of a restructuring of its industrial operations.

This project comes during a period of significant decline in sales volumes for the German cement manufacturer in France between 2021 and 2025.

Published on September 17, 2026, at 06:00.

The Ranville cement plant is threatened with closure. In the context of a pronounced economic slowdown, Heidelberg Materials France announces a project to restructure its industrial operations for its cement activity. This is expected to result in the closure of the Ranville site in the Calvados department. The restructuring project was presented on September 16, 2026, to employee representatives gathered for an extraordinary CSE (Social and Economic Committee) meeting.

The company is committed to supporting each of the 87 employees at the site whose positions would be eliminated, offering at least one job within the group to allow them to continue their careers. "We will work throughout the project in close collaboration with employee representatives, as well as with local authorities and state services in the Calvados department to ensure the vitality of the territory," stated Heidelberg Materials France.

This restructuring project occurs during a period of significant decline in sales volumes (-30.7% just for cement activity). Since 2023, this has resulted in a substantial reduction in revenue, according to the group, as well as an increase in its production overcapacity.

Moreover, the need to address the climate challenge has led Heidelberg Materials France to invest 650 million euros in decarbonization to transform its sites in Airvault, Beaucaire, Bussac-Forêt, and Couvrot.

"The redesign project for the company's industrial operations aims to safeguard its economic competitiveness in France while preserving its ability to invest in decarbonization to continue production," concluded the industrial.

Alliance gains five new firms.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/industrie/industriels/deux-mois-apres-son-lancement-lalliance-ac

Two months after its launch, the Action Concrete and Sustainable Cement alliance has welcomed five new companies, including Vinci Construction.

The association now brings together 26 companies and four honorary members, united by a common goal: to accelerate the deployment of solutions aimed at reducing the carbon footprint of concrete and cement.

At the end of June 2026, Bouygues Construction, CB Green, Ecocem France, and Point.P formed an alliance with the objective of promoting the use of solutions that prevent greenhouse gas emissions at the source.

Named Action Concrete and Sustainable Cement (ABCD), it held its first general assembly and confirmed the adherence of five new companies: the Audemard group (specialist in aggregates and ready-mixed concrete), Sibelco (silica producer), Tanguy Matériaux (focused on trading and manufacturing materials), Vinci Construction, and a new associate member, Master Builders Solutions France (which offers additives).

“The arrival of Audemard, Sibelco, Tanguy, Vinci Construction, and Master Builders Solutions France confirms the willingness of the entire value chain to take concrete action. The more representative our collective is of the diversity of the sector, the better we can evolve standards, practices, and market demand,” comments Thierry Legrand, president of ABCD.

The first general assembly allowed the alliance members to clarify their priorities for the upcoming months: the substitution of clinker, the use of new binders or the optimization of formulations. ABCD aims to create the conditions for the generalization of these priorities by removing barriers, whether they are technical, regulatory, normative, or cultural.

To do this, several options have been discussed: speeding up the market launch of recognized and already available innovations, making carbon performance a structuring criterion for public and private procurement, supporting the evolution of construction practices, and mobilizing the entire ecosystem around a common decarbonization trajectory.

Climate change impacts assessed now.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/technique/les-effets-du-changement-climatique-passes-au-crible.K

* # Routes: the effects of climate change scrutinized

For the first time, a study evaluates the vulnerability of the national road network under various scenarios, as well as the cost of inaction and loss of functionality.

Published on September 21, 2026, at 08:00

In 2023, the Road Mobility Directorate (DMR) launched, along with highway concessionaires, an analysis of the climate change vulnerability of the national road network, both conceded and ungranted. "In total, 21,073 km, including 11,629 km of highways, in metropolitan France and overseas," specifies André Horth, head of the Lyon branch of the DMR and lead of the study. Dictated by the third edition of the National Adaptation Plan to Climate Change published in March 2025 (Pnacc-3), this analysis assesses the physical and functional vulnerability of a network valued at 311 billion euros. Its results also quantify the cost of inaction, while a third part outlines adaptation pathways.

Funded by the General Directorate of Infrastructure, Transport, and Mobility (DGITM) and the highway concessionaires proportionate to their linear extent, the study was assigned to Setec Organization, assisted by the consultancy specialized in climate change risks, RiskWeatherTech. Two years of work resulted in extremely precise deliverables reserved for the sponsors, but the methodology and summaries are accessible to the entire road community—local authorities, design offices, or construction companies. The diagnosis was guided by the ASAIT method (systemic approach to the adaptation of transport infrastructures) of Cerema, which played the role of project manager. This approach frames a uniquely dimensioned initiative. "It was the first time in France that a network manager initiated a study across such a broad geographic area and with such a wide range of climate hazards," emphasizes André Horth.

Evolution of the exposure of the national road network

Exposure to temperatures above 35 °C:

In the reference period, 98% of the national road network (RRN) is slightly exposed to extreme heat and 2% is moderately exposed. In the Tracc +2 °C scenario, only 34% of the RRN is slightly exposed, 39% is moderately exposed, 20% is strongly exposed, and 7% is very strongly exposed. In the Tracc +3 °C scenario, these numbers shift respectively to 13%, 14%, 30%, and 43%. The extreme scenario sees 74% of the network very strongly exposed to that hazard.

Sensitivity to hazards

Eleven events are examined: heatwaves, freeze/thaw, fire risk, drought, landslides, rockfalls, extreme precipitation, marine submersion, and three types of flooding. For each, the study compares to the reference period 1976-2005 two scenarios derived from the warming trajectory for climate change adaptation (Tracc), one of +2°C globally by 2050 (+2.7 °C for France), the other of +3 °C by 2100 (+4 °C for France), along with a maximalist scenario. Four levels of exposure are defined for each hazard in

each scenario. The physical sensitivity of the national network is determined by dividing it into 13,400 hexagons of 1 km each, where each component—road surface, bridge, tunnel, noise barrier, toll station...—is cataloged, and its sensitivity to hazards is assessed. Functional sensitivity, meaning the consequences for users of a climate hazard, is also analyzed. These efforts produce a veritable atlas of the network's vulnerability.

The study had to circumvent a significant obstacle as many data exist with road managers, while other useful data for analyzing the risk related to climate change are currently lacking for components, and traffic data can sometimes be heterogeneous or incomplete. "Each manager knows the condition of their structures and roads due to IQOA and IQRN inspections, but this is not always the case for embankments, fills, or hydraulic works, which can be points of weakness," explains François Dorey, project manager and head of physical vulnerability analysis for Setec Organization. These elements have thus been reconstructed using open-source data and by cross-referencing the hydrographic network and the road network. "And to recreate the traffic-related data, we used a model developed internally, through which we carried out 200 simulations," adds Laetitia Voegelin, in charge of analyzing functional vulnerabilities and the cost of climate inaction at Setec International.

"This is one of the limits of this study," admits André Horth. "While it allows for national insights, its precision is less significant at the local level. It cannot replace a detailed diagnosis." The combination of exposure levels and the physical sensitivity of the network highlights the most problematic hazards, the most vulnerable sectors, and those whose evolution is expected to be rapid.

The economic aspect shows that the cost of physical degradation of the network solely related to climate overexposure without adaptation measures, calculated over ten years in the +2 °C scenario, amounts to 1.8 billion euros, while socio-economic costs related to loss of functionality are estimated at 2.2 billion euros. "Route diversions, giving up certain trips, inability to access goods or services... the effects of these climate change consequences are far from negligible," emphasizes Laetitia Voegelin. "It is now up to each manager to take ownership of the study and method and go further at their level," notes François Dorey. The initiative has inspired local departments as Setec is currently conducting a similar study for Pyrénées-Atlantiques and is preparing to do the same for Bouches-du-Rhône.

Some elements have been reconstructed using open-source data and by cross-referencing the hydrographic network with the road network.

Main conclusions of the vulnerability study.

Water sector expects benefits

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/eau/eaux-usees/etude-dimpact-de-la-directive-deru-2-les-acteurs-

Impact study of the Deru 2 directive: stakeholders in the water sector anticipate benefits that exceed investments

The Strategic Committee of the water sector (CSFE) presented an impact study on the new European Directive regarding the treatment of urban wastewater (Deru 2), whose transposition into French law is set for July 31, 2027. Its conclusions demonstrate that the modernization of wastewater systems is a major challenge, with benefits potentially reaching €3 billion per year, compared to €2 billion in investments. A success that will depend primarily on the visibility given to territories.

“This text is as much an opportunity as a challenge for all of us.” President of the CSFE and General Director of Suez, Xavier Girre revealed on Thursday morning, at the premises of the Banking of Territories, the results of an impact study on Deru 2. This revised European Directive on urban wastewater treatment follows Deru 1, adopted in 1991, which aimed to set minimum obligations regarding the collection, treatment, and monitoring of wastewater.

For local authorities, the shift to Deru 2 requires compliance with a logic of risk prevention, integrated management and resilience of territories. To make this leap, it will be necessary “to adapt sanitation to the challenges of our time,” warned Xavier Girre.

After its transposition on July 31, 2027, the first significant milestone of Deru 2 will occur in 2033 with the establishment of integrated management plans for municipalities with more than 100,000 inhabitants, as well as a phasing step for strengthening treatments (tertiary/quaternary) and reducing micropollutants for the largest wastewater treatment plants.

In detail, the study, the result of 18 months of work among industry stakeholders and the state, has anticipated costs and benefits for the period 2028-2045. Thus, investments and operating costs are estimated at €2 billion per year (of which €1.2 billion for collection and €812 million for wastewater treatment).

On the flip side, expected benefits are estimated at €3 billion per year (of which €1.73 billion for the environment and water resources, €1.093 billion for public health and economic activity, and €214 million for energy and climate).

To anticipate now, the sector calls “to simultaneously publish all areas concerned by the most stringent requirements and the rules for application no later than July 31, 2027, to enable local authorities to define their investment strategies and avoid an investment wall in the mid-2030s.”

Other important points of Deru 2: the lowering of the mandatory collection threshold to 1,000 equivalent inhabitants (compared to 2,000 today) and the integrated urban water management plans (PGI).

The indicative objective for reducing discharges due to stormwater is set at 2% of the collected load for PGI. “But before reaching that point, we propose a requirement level of 5% as a pragmatic approach,” affirmed Jean-Pierre Hangouët, Technical Director of water activities at Suez in France and co-leader of the study.

Director of BE Setec Hydratec, Frédéric Maurel insisted on the “obligation to treat nitrogen and phosphorus, responsible for the eutrophication of water bodies.” Only 40% of water bodies are in good ecological condition. As for the micropollutant challenge, it would exceed that of nitrogen and phosphorus treatment. However, the quaternary treatment of micropollutants (deadline 2045), predominantly financed by the extended producer responsibility (REP), must be put in place before July 31. “Hence the importance of sensitivity zoning which conditions the application of the directive, to be carried out as soon as possible,” for Frédéric Maurel.

While planning for investments is not yet determined and the framework for transposition remains to be precisely defined by the state, it is now essential to gather all stakeholders. “It is a long-term endeavor. Decisions must be made now, otherwise, we will not meet the objectives for the water sector,” warned Xavier Girre.

Reuse project underway now.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/ile-de-france/course-au-reemploi-dans-un-ancien-gymnase.LDNRFKQF

Demolition and Design Coordination for a Reuse Initiative in an Old Gymnasium in Seine-Saint-Denis

The frame and floor of a sports facility will be partially recovered on-site after meticulous removal.

Guénolé Boillot

Published on September 21, 2026

In Romainville, soil pollution accelerated the demolition and reconstruction of an outdated gymnasium. The first step is completed! In Romainville (Seine-Saint-Denis), the dredging and demolition of the old Paul-Baldit gymnasium at the Stalingrad stadium, which began in June, will conclude this September. The building, constructed in the 1950s on former quarries, was slated for rehabilitation as early as 2022, according to Clémence Bours, project manager for the municipality. However, a soil study conducted in 2024 revealed lead and hydrocarbon pollution—typical pollutants from poor-quality fill used to fill cavities. These findings accelerated the site’s closure and delayed the start of construction by a few months to incorporate a depollution contract.

Following demolition, depollution will take place, then the construction of new facilities, which are expected to open in 2028. The uniqueness of this future complex lies in the significant emphasis placed on reusing materials on-site. Demolition and design teams therefore coordinate their efforts during the removal processes. “If the PEMD diagnosis, mandatory for buildings over 1,000 m² since 2023, characterizes and quantifies potentially reusable resources, our job is to foresee and specify the technical conditions for their reuse on-site,” explains Baptiste Brisedou, project director and partner at the Albert & Co study office.

Some exterior joinery had been initially considered potentially reusable in the initial diagnosis. “However, their thermal and sealing performances are incompatible with the goals of a new building,” specifies the engineer. Therefore, we could not retain them. The PEMD diagnosis identified over 30 types of materials. Ultimately, only half of them are considered valuable for the new project (the rest will be directed towards specific recycling channels or considered ordinary industrial waste, depending on their nature). However, their removal has yielded some surprises.

The most complex example concerns the gymnasium’s metal frame, composed of 14 elements weighing 9 tons each, totaling 126 tons. It required a complex intervention to be reused in the future covered outdoor area. “The structure was encased in a concrete shell, which had to be pried off centimeter by centimeter using a crane equipped with a hydraulic claw before we could retrieve it,” indicates Rémi Maire, project manager for the deconstruction company Wanty. This operation alone lasted a month, a third of the project’s duration, and ended with the cutting of the base of each post with a blowtorch.

Additionally, 600 m² of flooring from the old multipurpose room were identified as reusable. These planks could form the exterior cladding of the new gymnasium. However, their second life faces a major obstacle: it is impossible to determine the composition of the paint that covers them, and therefore to guarantee their fire behavior. Legitimately, the inspection office requires laboratory testing. However, these tests might only be completed within six months, threatening to disrupt the project’s timeline. To overcome this obstacle, the teams from Albert & Co have proposed to conduct the tests directly on-site.

Technical Information

Project Owner: City of Romainville.

Design Office: Albert & Co (reuse).

Main Company: Wanty (dredging, reuse, demolition).

Control Office: BTP Consultants.

Budget: €677,751 including tax (deconstruction lot).

Essor group restructures operations.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/vie-du-btp/pyrenees-atlantiques-le-groupe-essor-se-restructure.F

Pyrénées-Atlantiques: The Essor Group is Restructuring

Essor emerged from judicial rehabilitation on August 4, following the approval of its recovery plans by the commercial court of Bordeaux. To ensure its sustainability, the group based in Lons (Pyrénées-Atlantiques) is fundamentally changing its organization. It has ceased its general contracting activity, reduced its real estate promotion, and sold off targeted assets and projects. It has also

liquidated supporting entities of projects and strengthened its engineering and consulting missions.

The group now combines the legal entities of Essor, Essor Développement, Essor Ingénierie, Essor AMO and Conseil, and Essor Investissement; it has reduced its workforce from 240 to 166 employees. Its governance is led by David Pouyanne (CEO), assisted by Aurélie Bergdoll (Deputy CEO) and Nicolas Bouscaud (Delegate General Director).

Wooden cocoon for students

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/vie-du-btp/pessac-un-cocon-en-bois-pour-les-eleves-de-lerea.DB5B

Pessac: a wooden cocoon for students of the Erea

The new workshop where maintenance of the green space maintenance equipment is carried out has been designed with biosourced materials, such as straw or wood.

The Erea Le Corbusier, a structure accommodating young people facing educational, social difficulties, or disabilities, has just inaugurated its maintenance workshop. For the design of this nearly 300 m2 building, intended for work on green space maintenance equipment, the regional council of Nouvelle-Aquitaine wanted an “original” approach based on biomimicry. The Charente agency Xodó Architecture envisioned a structure formed by wooden frame walls with straw bale infill and wood insulating frame with a lime plaster for the interior walls.

Air intake limitation

High-level openings covered with opaque honeycomb plastic ensure diffused light while limiting solar gains. The architect chose two openings rather than one large one to limit air entrances and thus maintain a bearable temperature.

Beyond its environmental approach, this project has a social commitment from the client, who seeks to provide a quality and reassuring work environment for students with particular needs. It began seven years ago and was constructed in seven months, involving an investment of 2 million euros.

Enedis invests in network.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/nouvelle-aquitaine/nouvelle-aquitaine-nous-avons-enregistre-jusq

In New Aquitaine, Enedis is investing in the underground electrical network to withstand high summer temperatures.

Interview with Céline Vautrelle, regional director of Aquitaine Nord at Enedis.

Published on September 20, 2026.

The electrical network suffered during the heatwaves this summer. How are you managing the situation?

We handled it well thanks to our rapid response team. And above all, we have been adapting our infrastructure to climate change for twenty years. In overhead lines, this means replacing bare wires with twisted wires or burying networks where possible. Underground, we are replacing the impregnated paper cables used in the 1970s with synthetic cables. In the Bordeaux metropolitan area, we are renovating 20 km of underground network each year, at a cost of 2 million euros. About 150 km need to be changed.

What made this period particularly unique?

The high temperatures caused outages. During the heatwaves, we recorded up to 80 °C under the asphalt. With the expansion, the ground shifted and the junction boxes were no longer connected. In 2025, over 51 million euros were invested in New Aquitaine to adapt the underground network to very high temperatures.

However, your investments are not solely focused on adapting the network to climate change…

Indeed, this represents 25% of the 630 million euros invested annually in New Aquitaine. We allocate 29% of this budget to connections, while the rest is targeted towards renewable energy development. We plan to install 18 source substations by 2030 in the region, adding to the existing 305. In the last five years, seven have been created. We are currently finalizing our plan based on needs for the years 2027 and 2028.

Holcim to buy Fermacell.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/negoce/le-groupe-holcim-en-passe-dacquerir-lactivite-de-la-marqu

The Holcim group is poised to acquire the activities of the Fermacell brand, which primarily manufactures gypsum and cement boards for floors and walls. To become the owner of the brand, the Swiss group will need to pay 784 million Swiss francs, or approximately 828 million euros, to the American group James Hardie. The finalization of the operation is expected for early 2027.

In Europe, Fermacell projects a revenue of 430 million euros in 2026, achieved with a thousand employees spread across six production sites, with its products distributed in 13 countries. Fermacell’s sites have a production capacity of 18 million square meters annually of gypsum fiber.

This operation would complement Holcim’s offer, which also holds companies such as Lafarge France, Alkern, Xella, and PRB. Globally, Holcim recorded a global activity of 15.7 billion Swiss francs (about 16.6 billion euros) in 2025, with a presence in 45 countries. For reference, Xella had sold the Fermacell entity to James Hardie for 473 million euros in 2017.

Lourdes promotes wood certification.

https://www.lemoniteur.fr/occitanie/a-lourdes-la-nouvelle-creche-devient-un-demonstrateur-

In Lourdes, the new daycare center becomes a demonstrator for certification of wood from the Pyrenees and thus promotes the local economy.

Published on September 20, 2026

The designers of the daycare center “Les Petits Explorateurs”, which will welcome the first children this autumn, have favored quality, traceability of materials, and short supply chains.

After a first project abandoned in 2014, also designed by the architecture agency Goubert & Landes, the new daycare center in Lourdes (Hautes-Pyrénées) will be delivered this autumn. The program included a major element: wood from the Pyrenees. A certification brand created by the Association for the Valorization of Woods from the Pyrenees in March 2023, with the support of the Regional Union of Forest Communities Occitanie Pyrénées Méditerranée and other partners, aimed to promote better forest management, support the local economic ecosystem, and ensure traceability and quality. “This is about enhancing a mountain economy,” specifies Denis Martin, president of the Grand South Union of Forest Municipalities of the Pyrenees, a sector lagging in the structuring of its supply chain.

To facilitate the preparation of the specifications, the use of local wood is necessary from the project’s conception. “It is essential to recommend solid material since laminated wood does not exist locally,” states Jean-Baptiste Bouillaguet, project manager for wood from the Pyrenees. No glue-laminating suppliers are currently operating in the area.

Regarding the daycare center, spruce and fir species were primarily used for part of the structure, timber frame walls, and the roof structure of the atrium, as well as for the peripheral caps and the battens of the atrium’s underside. “We had excluded laminated wood from the structural elements,” states architect Philippe Landes. The rational architecture of the building allowed us to integrate solid wood posts into the partitioning to free up space. Due to supply difficulties, the cladding was made from wood from the Landes.

“With better organization of the supply chain, we could achieve 75% of wood from the Pyrenees,” says Loïc Austruy, architect at the Goubert & Landes agency. Only the interior underside is made of laminated wood. With solid wood, we would have had to include posts and trusses, which would have created a volume too large in the atrium, deviating from the desired architectural approach at “child’s height”.

The architect and the construction company – Pyrénées Charpente, certified under this contract – managed to design a facility of 1,120 m2 SP consisting of 50% locally sourced wood, totaling 71 m3. Through analyzing the economic impact on the local economy, the Regional Union of Forest Communities calculated that €585,654 had been injected into the territory, compared to €249,319 if the material had been purchased abroad. Sourced from forests in the Hautes-Pyrénées and Ariège, the

wood was then processed at the Sanguinet sawmill in Juillan (Hautes-Pyrénées) and transformed at Pyrénées-Charpente in Agos-Vidalos before being integrated into the Lourdes project. A total of 128 km was traveled.

This daycare center is the second demonstrator project after the Rosa-Bonheur school group delivered in Aucamville (Haute-Garonne) in 2024, which included 42% wood from the Pyrenees. About fifteen others have already been delivered or are underway. To date, five sawmills and thirteen construction companies are certified.

BauInfoConsult

Apartments drive construction growth

https://bauinfoconsult.de/bauprognose-2027-und-2028-mehrfamilienhaeuser-als-wachstumsmotor

* **Düsseldorf, 08.09.2026**: The completion of residential buildings in new construction will also remain declining in 2026 despite a now constant recovery of building permits – however, the sector can score positively in 2027. For 2028, there is, however, no further growth in sight. These are the core results of the residential building forecast from BauInfoConsult for 400 districts and independent cities. From the perspective of Düsseldorf's market researchers, one thing is crucial: By the end of the forecast period, the level of permits is expected to reach a level comparable to the figures from the construction boom at the beginning of the decade, thus indicating a comprehensive recovery. However, for the construction industry to meet the housing market's expectations for a balanced housing supply, a fundamental acceleration of the approval and realization cycles in residential construction would be necessary.

The completion forecast from BauInfoConsult is based on regional developments and the ratio of permits to completions, which are expected based on experiences from previous years in the various sectors. Permits began rising again in 2024, mainly due to the more favorable interest rate developments and therefore better financing options. Nevertheless, many approved projects continue to be postponed or canceled, slowing actual construction output.

Good (New Build) Regions, Bad Regions? The Harvest Comes Sooner or Later

When looking at regions, a different pace and varying intensity of completion developments are expected during the forecast period. While the east and south will still be significantly hampered by the low permit dynamics of previous years in 2026, there are already lower single-digit percentage increases in the north and west in 2026.

In 2027, the hour of the "smaller" new build regions strikes: in the north and east, construction companies will reap double-digit growth rates, thanks to permits sown from the second half of 2024. In the north, the upward trend is also expected to continue slightly in 2028, while the construction level in the east is expected to stagnate around the level of 2027.

Now looking at the populous regions with correspondingly larger construction volumes: the west can maintain the growth level of the current year for completions in 2027, but growth will be throttled thereafter. In the south, significant increases are expected again in 2027, but the turnaround in completions will be missed in the following year: south German completion times are expected to drop in 2028 from previously achieved levels.

Single-family Homes Decline Again Towards the End of the Time Horizon

Nationwide, completions can gradually recover from the declining approval and order figures of previous years during the forecast period: Only a slight minus is expected in 2026, before a growth result with 14.2 percent is expected in the following year. On the contrary, no increase is expected for 2028.

This is mainly due to the largest housing construction segment, the single-family home construction, which is expected to stagnate after a strong boost in 2027. In contrast, the multi-story construction segment is on the rise, not least supported by a strengthening economic environment and the expected easing of permits for serial projects from 2027.

Decisive Factor: Permits Recover

A decisive factor amidst the stagnation expectations for 2028 is something else - and that is the permit level reached by 2027 according to our forecast. In the majority of regions, it is expected that a level will be reached in 2027 and 2028 that was common before the major drop in permits in 2023. Thus, the completions in Germany should return to figures seen at the beginning of the decade.

The doom and gloom messages currently circulating are thus premature from our point of view. However, what is true: Our forecast assumes a pace in the construction cycles that has been customary so far. Without accelerations in the awarding (building type E, shortened approval processes) and processes (seriality, standardization, and simplified conversion of existing spaces into living space), achieving the demanded increase in annual housing completions beyond the levels of the late teens and early twenties will hardly be possible.

About the Study

The complete forecast - including a precast construction forecast by federal states and forecast scenarios at the district level for residential and non-residential new development - can be found in the new "Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027" from BauInfoConsult, which will be published this week. Results from telephone surveys of approximately 400 market participants, including construction companies, architectural firms, roofing and carpentry businesses, painters, drywallers, and SHK craft businesses, as well as 40 online interviews with manufacturers of building materials and installation materials are included in the comprehensive construction economic and trend study from BauInfoConsult on the current developments in the construction and installation industry in Germany.

Based on our own market research and desk research, trends and developments from the industry are clearly presented and documented in about 200 pages with 257 graphics and tables covering topics such as:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/national)

- Trends in construction 2026/2027

- Skilled labor shortages and their consequences

- Cost of errors and error culture in construction

- Sustainable construction and heating transition

- Artificial intelligence and the building materials industry

- Digital construction, smart building, sensor technology, BIM

- Construction economy I: permits and completions in residential construction

- Construction economy II: permits and completions in non-residential construction

- Potentials for modernization & renovation

- Marketing and budget in the building materials industry

- Purchasing and distribution trends in the construction industry

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Deep and road construction

- Overall economic developments

- Opportunities and limits of reducing bureaucracy as a construction booster

The complete annual analysis, including current market forecasts, will be available this week in PDF format for the price of 750 € plus VAT.

About BauInfoConsult

BauInfoConsult is a company specialized in the construction, installation, and real estate industry. We continuously analyze market data and information on the German construction industry and create analyses and forecasts of current construction trends and developments based on our own surveys, which can serve as a basis for your market-relevant decisions. To always have an overview of current market developments, you can subscribe to our free newsletter.

Construction labor shortage looming now.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/fachkraeftemangel-am-bau-2026-bei-41-prozent-der-firmen-wird-es-

Düsseldorf, 31.08.2026: In the construction industry, a specter is haunting – namely a specter called a skilled labor shortage – this is no longer just a rather worn-out phrase but simply false: The supposed specter is (unfortunately) very much alive. In our trend analysis for 2026 and 2027, the skilled labor shortage dominates the list of topics that processors and manufacturers in the construction industry are most concerned about. We conducted a practical test and asked construction companies about the

extent of skilled labor they notice is missing in the companies they cooperate with. No less than 96 percent of the companies observe a shortage of skilled labor at their partner companies – and 41 percent even observe a severe shortage. In which professional groups is the most personnel missing?

Skilled labor shortage and demographic change have long been abstract topics that one only encountered sporadically in daily life. Construction companies have now moved far from that – personnel bottlenecks have long characterized their project work. This is demonstrated by the results of a telephone survey conducted in early 2026 among 125 construction companies in Germany, which will be published in the new annual analysis by BauInfoConsult. Almost all companies with whom the respondents are in contact are grappling with the problem.

Sixteen percent of the surveyed companies perceive their partners' skilled labor shortage as ‘extreme’ – on the other end of the spectrum, 18 percent experience only ‘a little’ problem with missing personnel. In the middle of the two assessments ('moderate' or 'some' problems) sits a strong quarter of the companies.

Construction companies observe skilled labor bottlenecks across all trades. Professions such as bricklayers, carpenters, joiners, as well as concrete and formwork builders are the scarcest. But missing skilled labor in painters, roofers, HVAC, and electrical trades is also not an exception according to the experiences reported by those surveyed.

No solution in sight? Construction companies hope for an innovation boost

Regarding remedies against the skilled labor shortage, some obvious yet important solutions (making the trades more attractive, gaining more apprentices) are limited by declining demographics. Many construction companies in our survey hope that technical innovations can at least mitigate the effects of demographic decline somewhat. In doing so, construction professionals are especially relying on prefabrication, robotics, automation, and digital planning tools.

About the study

Results from telephone surveys among approximately 400 market players such as construction companies, architectural firms, roofing and carpentry businesses, painting, drywall, and HVAC companies, as well as 40 online interviews with manufacturers of construction materials and installation materials, will be included in the upcoming new ‘Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027’, which is a comprehensive construction and trend study from BauInfoConsult on current developments in the construction and installation industry in Germany.

Based on proprietary market research and desk research, trends and developments from the industry are presented clearly and thoroughly on approximately 200 pages with 257 graphics and tables including the following topics:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/national)

- Trends in construction 2026/2027

- Skilled labor shortage and its consequences

- Error costs and error culture in construction

- Sustainable construction and energy transition

- Artificial intelligence and the construction materials industry

- Digital construction, smart building, sensor technology, BIM

- Construction economy I: Approvals and completions in residential construction

- Construction economy II: Approvals and completions in non-residential construction

- Potential for modernization & renovation

- Marketing and budgeting in the construction materials industry

- Purchasing and distribution trends in the construction sector

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Civil and road construction

- Overall economic developments

- Opportunities and limitations of bureaucracy reduction as a construction booster.

The complete annual analysis, including current market forecasts, will be available in a few weeks in PDF format for the price of 750 € plus VAT.

About BauInfoConsult

BauInfoConsult is a company specialized in the construction, installation, and real estate industry. We continuously analyze market data and information on the German construction industry and create analyses and forecasts based on our own market surveys concerning current construction trends and developments that can be used as a basis for your market-relevant decisions.

Construction materials find little help.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/die-baustoffindustrie-findet-das-sondervermoegen-hilft-uns-kaum/

Düsseldorf, 25.08.2026: The German state deficit has significantly increased in the first half of the year – an equally expected and obvious reason is the additional spending for the investment special fund, from which the construction industry particularly benefits. However, a survey by BauInfoConsult reveals

that the federal government's special fund hardly brings any optimism to the construction materials sector. While 18 percent of the manufacturers of building materials surveyed online by BauInfoConsult are fully confident that the special fund will stimulate investments that they can benefit from as manufacturers by 2026, an overwhelming majority remains skeptical. What is the reason for this fundamental sobriety regarding the largest (construction) economic measure of the federal government?

After all, 43 percent can at least very limitedly imagine that the special fund will spur construction investments by 2026 from which their own company can benefit in the current year. A third (33 percent) does not anticipate even the slightest positive effect at all.

Many suppliers in the construction sector remain grounded. The widespread disappointment in the economy regarding the all-too-slow pace of reforms in Germany may contribute to this harsh assessment. But, of course, it is also due to the fact that many segments heavily reliant on construction realistically see fewer opportunities arising from public infrastructure measures – resulting in skepticism, particularly among manufacturers in areas such as interior finishing, exterior walls, kitchens, doors and gates, or bathrooms.

At the same time, segments such as raw construction materials and electrical installation materials are hoping for some recovery from the measures in 2026. However, even in some high construction segments (for example in heating), some respondents expect positive effects from the special fund in 2026. This is likely due not least to the increased funds associated with the special fund for schools, daycare centers, or administrative buildings, which are sometimes overlooked.

The results of 40 online interviews with manufacturers of building materials and installation materials, as well as telephone surveys of about 400 market participants such as construction companies, architectural firms, roofing contractors, carpenters, painters, drywall and HVAC craft businesses will be included in the upcoming new "Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027", which is a comprehensive construction economic and construction trend study by BauInfoConsult on current developments in the construction and installation industry in Germany.

Based on its own market research and desk research, trends and developments from the industry will be presented clearly and addressed in approximately 200 pages with 257 graphics and tables covering the following topics:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/national)

- Trends in construction 2026/2027

- Skilled labor shortage and its consequences

- Error costs and error culture in construction

- Sustainable construction and energy transition

- Artificial intelligence and the construction materials sector

- Digital construction, smart buildings, sensor technology, BIM

- Construction economy I: Approvals and completions in residential construction

- Construction economy II: Approvals and completions in non-residential construction

- Potentials for modernization & renovation

- Marketing and budget in the construction materials industry

- Purchasing and distribution trends in the construction sector

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Civil engineering and road construction

- Macroeconomic developments

- Opportunities and limits of reducing bureaucracy as a construction booster.

The complete annual analysis, including current market forecasts, will be available in a few weeks in PDF format for the price of 750 € plus VAT.

Growth overshadowed by shortages.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/bautrends-2027-personalmangel-und-preisanstiege-ueberschatten-wa

* Düsseldorf, 10.08.2026: The Düsseldorf market research firm BauInfoConsult asked central players in the construction materials industry for a forecast of construction trends. Specifically, the aim was to identify those trends that will particularly shape developments from an industry perspective until 2027. Every second manufacturer assumes that currently the shortage of skilled workers as well as rising construction costs and material prices dominate the construction landscape. These classic crisis topics are currently so overwhelming that numerous prominent trend topics are only mentioned in passing. This applies to sustainability and seriality. Even AI applications are only mentioned by one in six manufacturers as a development that can significantly impact the construction industry in the next two years.

In the online survey, 40 manufacturers of construction and installation products such as heating and air conditioning, building materials, finishing materials, tools, roofing, doors, and windows were asked about trend expectations. It once again became clear: The shortage of skilled workers is increasingly seen as a pressing issue in the construction industry. Given the retirement of entire employee cohorts, companies particularly lament the rapid loss of accumulated experiences and competencies. Thus,

from the manufacturers' perspective, the shortage of skilled workers retains its top position in 2026 as the most influential industry trend (48 percent).

Equally highly rated are construction costs and material prices – two negative developments, the dominance of which seemed to ease somewhat in the second half of 2025. However, since the renewed flare-up of the crisis in the Middle East, the price increase for material production and construction logistics has forcefully returned, posing a latent threat to the current recovery trend of construction demand.

Most manufacturer segments expect material cost increases in the near future – only slightly less drastic for tool manufacturers and producers of finishing materials.

Many other developments currently playing a significant role in the industry are clearly overshadowed by these three negative factors. This applies, for example, to sustainable, energy-efficient, modular, and serial construction or building with BIM. Even the relatively young and widely discussed trend of AI applications is only perceived by just over one in five manufacturers to potentially become a dominant trend in 2026 and 2027.

The development trend topics that were less prominently positioned when asked about the determining construction trends for 2026 and 2027 are, therefore, still considered important by the companies – they just do not expect them to be industry-defining trends anymore.

This was different in the 2010s when topics such as energy efficiency and sustainability were seen as the most critical influencing trends from the manufacturers' perspective. The fact that the industry sees no way around them is demonstrated by the current survey's development trends. Environmental or climate protection topics were mentioned prominently as currently important research and development trends within the companies. Likewise, digital and technology topics stand out in the drawers of R & D departments.

Results from 40 online interviews with manufacturers of building materials and installation materials, as well as from telephone surveys of about 400 market players such as construction companies, architectural firms, roofing and carpentry companies, painting, drywall, and HVAC trades, will be included in the new "Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027," which will comprehensively study construction trends in the German construction and installation industry, due out at the end of July.

Based on its own market research and desk research, trends and developments from the industry are systematically prepared and cover the following topics, among others:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/nationwide)

- Trends in construction 2026/2027

- Shortage of skilled workers and its consequences

- Error costs and error culture in construction

- Sustainable building and energy transition

- Artificial Intelligence and construction materials industry

- Digital construction, smart building, sensor technology, BIM

- Construction economy I: Approvals and completions in residential construction

- Construction economy II: Approvals and completions in non-residential construction

- Modernization & renovation potential

- Marketing and budgets in the construction materials industry

- Purchasing and distribution trends in the construction industry

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Civil and road construction

- Overall economic developments

- Opportunities and limits of deregulation as a construction boost.

The complete annual analysis, including current market forecasts, will be available from the end of August 2026 in PDF format for 750 € plus VAT.

BauInfoConsult specializes in the construction, installation, and real estate industries. We continually analyze market data and information related to the German construction industry and produce analyses and forecasts on current construction trends and developments based on our market surveys, which can serve as a basis for your market-relevant decisions.

Bureaucracy cut by 2030.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/buerokratieabbau-am-bau-bis-2030-hersteller-der-branche-winken-f

Düsseldorf, 28.07.2026: It is one of the clear goals of the Federal Government and is intended to streamline processes in the construction industry and promote construction volume. However, the manufacturers of building materials and installation materials have little hope for the success of bureaucratic reduction – at least if it continues at the current pace. This is shown by the results of the soon-to-be-published market study “Annual Analysis 2026/2027” by BauInfoConsult.

Bureaucratic reduction in Germany is one of the central projects of the federal government and affects all areas of society and the economy. In the construction industry, it is primarily about accelerating

administrative approval processes, simplifying regulations and standards that prolong and increase the costs of construction projects, and not least about standardizing the patchwork of construction regulations that severely complicates the use of scalable construction methods and technologies in Germany.

With the regulation of DIN standards and federal regulatory branches in construction, the Federal Ministry of Building faces a Herculean task. However, wouldn't it be possible within a timeframe of four to five years to significantly increase construction output in Germany by reducing bureaucratic hurdles?

Manufacturers in the construction industry are reacting almost sarcastically to the question of whether the current pace of bureaucratic reduction is sufficient to increase German construction output by 2030. Just one-sixth can imagine this (and moreover mostly only in a limited way). Four-fifths consider this timeframe to be extremely unrealistic – more than half of the surveyed manufacturers completely disagree with the statement.

The few optimists are mainly found among the large companies. Less skeptical segments regarding bureaucratic reduction are the manufacturers of windows and doors as well as roofs, exterior walls, and heating.

Results from telephone surveys of about 400 market participants such as construction companies, architectural firms, roofing and carpentry companies, painting companies, drywall construction, and HVAC trades, as well as 40 online interviews with manufacturers of building materials and installation materials will be included in the new "Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027", which is a comprehensive construction momentum and trend study by BauInfoConsult on current developments in the construction and installation industry in Germany.

Based on proprietary market research and desk research, trends and developments from the industry are clearly presented and cover topics such as:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/national)

- Trends in construction 2026/2027

- Labor shortage and its consequences

- Cost of errors and error culture in construction

- Sustainable building and heating transition

- Artificial intelligence and the building materials industry

- Digital building, Smart Building, sensor technology, BIM

- Construction momentum I: Approvals and completions in residential construction

- Construction momentum II: Approvals and completions in non-residential construction

- Potential for modernization and renovation

- Marketing and budget in the building materials industry

- Procurement and distribution trends in the construction industry

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Civil and road construction

- Macroeconomic developments

- Opportunities and limits of bureaucratic reduction as a construction booster.

The complete annual analysis, including current market forecasts, will be available in PDF format for €750 plus VAT starting at the end of August 2026.

GModG rules change now.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/gmodg-neue-abkuerzung-neue-regeln-fuer-die-gebaeudeenergie-das-a

* GModG: new abbreviation, new rules for building energy – what is changing

One must give credit to the governing coalition: They have not been deterred and, against all resistance (and some might say, against all reason), passed the Building Modernization Act (GModG) in a form that largely corresponds to the much-discussed draft from February. The most significant change from the previously valid GEG is generally known: The 65 percent rule is abolished. But after that, it gets complicated: How exactly do increasing mandatory shares for climate-friendly fuels apply starting in 2029, and what other changes are there? Here is a summary of the central innovations, as this time the building heat regulation is likely to remain stable for more than two years (at least until the next election...)

The new GModG largely fulfills the conditions already envisaged in the draft from February. Unlike the previous GEG stipulation, new heating systems no longer need to be 65 percent renewable. However, fossil heating systems must gradually be operated with increasing shares of climate-friendly fuels starting in 2029. By 2045, heating must, according to climate protection goals, be 100 percent renewable. In case of heating failures, there are consumer-friendly transition periods. Tenants and landlords are expected to share the costs largely equally in the future. The funding conditions for new heat pumps remain in place but will be gradually reduced every six months.

1. The 65 percent rule goes into the technical museum

The big "Heating Hammer" dispute in 2023 revolved around a single paragraph (the infamous § 71) of the Building Energy Act. From 2024, it was required that newly installed heating in new building areas

be operated with at least 65 percent renewable energies – a obligation that was supposed to gradually expand. In accordance with the central campaign promise of the CDU/CSU, this paragraph was completely abolished in the GModG. Thus, new 100 percent fossil heating systems remain allowed. End of story?

2. Bio-staircase from 2029 pours water into the wine, um, gas or oil

Acquiring a new standard gas or oil heating system is legally no longer a problem, but it doesn't mean much for the economic viability of these systems: Starting in 2029, a binding "Bio-Staircase" comes into play, according to which climate-friendly alternatives must be blended into the fuels – gradually, stair-stepwise.

This means: The heat provided by the heating systems must contain certain proportions of biomethane, bio-oil, biogenic liquid gas, or green, blue, orange, or turquoise hydrogen, namely:

- from January 1, 2029: at least 10 percent

- from January 1, 2030: at least 15 percent

- from January 1, 2035: at least 30 percent

- from January 1, 2040: at least 60 percent

For newly acquired fossil heating systems, it is urgently advisable to rely on technologies that meet the conditions for this gradual fuel adaptation during ongoing operation. Moreover, for existing heating systems, a moderate quote of up to one percent is already planned starting in 2028. However, as of now, no one really knows how much climate-friendlier fuels will be available in the future and especially at what acquisition costs, so the option of "fossil new heating" at the moment is a risky bet for the future – unless one is as optimistic as the Federal Ministry of Economics.

Under certain conditions and accompanied by documentation obligations, combinations of fossil peak load and renewable heat generation remain possible.

3. 100 percent climate-neutral fuels from magic hand by 2045

The GModG attempts the balancing act between liberalizing the heat market and the applicable climate protection requirements by 2045. In this respect, it is still exciting: From 2045 on, no new fossil installations may be operated – but the installations still running must be operated 100 percent on bio-fuels.

To allow this requirement and the stepwise blending of shares, the federal government must present a separate law on green gas and green heating oil quotas by December 1, 2026. This task is, to put it mildly, quite demanding. The drama continues...

4. The feared GAU: heating failure

For heating owners, the protection of existing units remains in place, including the possibility for repairs during ongoing operation. But what does the law specify for the actual worst-case scenario in the heating cellar, the irreparable total failure of the heating system?

In the case of an urgently needed replacement, the law grants special leniencies for 12 months. Only after this period does the current level of the Bio-Staircase apply.

5. The battle for the buffet, or the bill for the buffet

The question of heating costs is always also a social question in primarily tenant-occupied Germany. With the heating pump technology, which can be operated 100 percent renewable and is significantly more cost-efficient in operation, but initially expensive in acquisition costs, there was a dispute regarding the GEG, whether landlords could pass on the investment costs for heating replacement to tenants.

With the GModG, this question regarding bio-staircase-compatible fossil heating systems seems even more urgent, as here not only the acquisition costs but also the completely unpredictable height of future operating costs are at stake. After all, it is unclear how secure the supply (and therefore pricing) for the "green fuel" will be.

Therefore, landlords and tenants are to equally share 50 percent of the gas network costs as well as the legally recorded carbon dioxide costs (both from 2028) and from 2029 the additional costs for the mandatory climate-friendly fuel shares, with the limitation of the equal cost distribution to a maximum of 30 percent – meaning: only up to the stair-step level of 2035.

6. Funding conditions remain but are less favorable

The heat pump is also silently the favorite in GModG's camp – only that the currently unattractive fossil alternatives are being sold as (likely future complicated detail regulation) choices in the heating cellar.

Regardless of the GModG, the KfW funding for heat pumps was adjusted starting July 21. The fact that the funding has even been maintained speaks volumes, as the broadly regulated Bio-Staircase is not seen as actually being the major supplier of future heating provision.

Crucially, the maximum funding amounts and climate speed bonuses will continue to decline every six months starting February 1, 2027.

The income bonus will be granted at 40 percent for households with taxable household income up to 30,000 euros or 30 percent for up to 40,000 euros, and 10 percent for up to 50,000 euros. Additionally: Households with at least one minor child may reduce their taxable income by 10,000 euros once, which often moves them up to the next bonus tier.

7. When does it take effect?

Back to the GModG. Even though the law has now passed all instances, it will only take effect once it is published in the Federal Law Gazette (and has undergone some formal steps beforehand). After that, all regulations will come into effect the day after the announcement. Most regulations will only be relevant in two years: the new cost distribution starts partially in 2028, the Bio-Staircase begins on January 1, 2029.

8. And how does it go on?

By the end of the year, the currently only roughly outlined Bio-Staircase must be detailed. Moreover, the law must be evaluated again in 2030 regarding the climate protection effect it intends to achieve... the story continues, as we all age four years (and maybe become wiser).

Social media boosts construction.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/social-media-in-der-baubranche-2026-mehr-nutzer-mehr-professiona

* **Düsseldorf, 21.07.2026**: Social Media are no longer an exotic topic but a standard for 95 percent of German users aged 16 and older. In the construction industry, companies without their own social media profiles have now become the exceptions. The study "Kommunikationsmonitor 2026" by BauInfoConsult examines for the ninth time since 2012 the relationship of the construction industry to social media. One thing is clear: the social media behavior of construction and planning companies has significantly professionalized in the past 14 years. Gone are the days when the social media profiles of construction companies were merely a private hobby. The majority of professional profiles are also used professionally and by more than one-third with their own marketing agenda. The study also clarifies in its analysis of eight social networks relevant to professional construction users which profiles are primarily used passively as information sources and where self-representation is primarily aimed at target groups and contacts.

Almost nine out of ten construction players engage in social media activities

The Düsseldorf market research company BauInfoConsult surveyed 400 architectural firms, construction companies, roofing and carpentry businesses, painting and drywall companies, as well as HVAC installation firms in telephone interviews in April and May 2026 regarding which social networks they use and for what purposes. The presence of social media among construction players has more than doubled compared to the very first survey in 2012, currently standing at 86 percent of respondents having at least one social media profile. On average, construction professionals have 2.5 profiles per person – fewer than the overall German average (5.11 profiles in various networks per person aged 16 and older) – but considering that this survey explicitly inquired about professional use, it still indicates a reasonably high level of use.

Regardless of your user profile: you likely have a social media profile

The study also investigates the information behavior of construction professionals regarding their media preferences. Based on the respondents' preferences and behaviors, we differentiate between digitally savvy, personal networkers, print-oriented, and socially web-socialized individuals. However, it is noteworthy regarding social media usage: when it comes to whether construction players have a social media profile, those with different media priorities hardly differ from each other.

Very conscious cross-media behavior: different networks are used for different purposes

Of course, that doesn’t mean everyone is constantly glued to their smartphones and fiddling around on social media profiles. There are also "ghost" profiles in the construction field. Yet, the regular and conscious professional use may not be the rule, but it is certainly not a rare exception anymore. It, however, depends on the platform: as the detailed results for various social networks show, the activities of construction professionals vary significantly depending on the character of the network. Passive consumption (e.g., following information or profiles) and active marketing activities (e.g., self-presentation through posts) typically balance each other out.

A very notable one-third also utilizes social media for their own marketing. More than one-third of construction players (38 percent) report that they consciously operate their social media activities for marketing purposes, with painting and drywall companies, followed by HVAC trades, pursuing a conscious social media strategy.

Who writes, stays – even old-schoolers are active on social media

Differences among various media user types become particularly visible where it comes to the actual use of social media: thus, besides the socially interactive, particularly print-oriented construction players are also engaged in social media marketing activities (the old print wisdom "Who writes, stays" evidently applies to postings in the digital realm).

About the study

Current developments in communication and orientation behavior among a total of 400 architectural firms, construction companies, roofing and carpentry businesses, painting and drywall companies, as well as HVAC installation firms are presented in the "Kommunikationsmonitor 2026" through representative survey results. Based on a broad data basis, the report contains detailed information on communication and information behavior in the industry:

- Use and evaluation of information sources

- Information research on the internet & AI usage

- Information behavior by product group/construction segment

- Manufacturer websites

- Information through personal contact (trade fairs, field service)

- Use of specialist magazines & top trade journals by target group

- Social media usage:

- WhatsApp

- Instagram

- YouTube

- Facebook

- LinkedIn

- Xing

- TikTok

- X

- Use of apps

- Development since 2012

The new "Kommunikationsmonitor" by BauInfoConsult can be obtained for €1,450 plus VAT from BauInfoConsult.

About BauInfoConsult

BauInfoConsult is a company specialized in the construction, installation, and real estate sectors. We continuously analyze market data and information related to the German construction industry and produce analyses and forecasts on current construction trends and developments based on our own market surveys, which can serve as a foundation for your market-relevant decisions.

Construction revenue to rise.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/bock-auf-2026-zwei-von-drei-bauakteuren-erwarten-solides-umsatze

Düsseldorf, 15.07.2026: The German construction industry is currently navigating a difficult environment, but the order situation for companies has improved significantly in the first quarter of the year. Public investment from the special package, which the construction industry directly benefits from, is contributing to this. Processing companies and architectural firms are therefore largely unconcerned and predominantly expect increases in revenue or, at the very least, no deterioration compared to 2025. This is indicated by a telephone survey conducted by BauInfoConsult among 400 construction actors at the end of the second quarter, as part of the upcoming market study “Annual Analysis 2026/2027.”

The Düsseldorf market research institute asked architectural firms, construction companies, roofing companies, carpenters, painters, drywall companies, and HVAC installation firms, among others, about their revenue expectations for 2026. More than a third (36 percent) anticipate a significant increase in revenue. Another third of respondents (34 percent) expect results to be on par with the previous year.

Pessimists are in the minority – as uncertainty remains

This leaves the truly pessimistic voices in the minority: About one in six companies (16 percent) fear declining revenues this year. However, the outlook for the German economy remains highly uncertain. Accordingly, 14 percent of respondents did not want to commit to a specific revenue outlook.

Especially new construction actors in the west and south are optimistic

Nonetheless, the optimistic results present a remarkable signal for the construction outlook in 2026. Companies expecting a revenue increase this year include, but are not limited to, more firms focused on structural engineering, such as construction companies or painters and drywall firms, which are significantly involved in the exterior facade.

This indicates a stimulus from the resurgent new construction sector, which, as is well-known, begins in structural engineering and generates value or revenue. Traditional new construction regions seem to be leading the way: especially companies in the west and south of the country expressed optimism more frequently.

About the study

Results from telephone surveys of approximately 400 market players, including construction companies, architectural firms, roofing companies, carpenters, painters, drywall, and HVAC contractors, as well as 40 online interviews with manufacturers of building materials and installation materials, will be included in the new “Annual Analysis Germany 2026/2027” to be published at the end of July. This comprehensive study of construction trends and currents in the construction and installation industry in Germany synthesizes trends and developments in the sector clearly, covering various topics such as:

- Construction forecast 2027 and 2028 (regional/national)

- Construction trends 2026/2027

- Skilled labor shortage and its consequences

- Error costs and culture in construction

- Sustainable building and the energy transition

- Artificial Intelligence and the building materials sector

- Digital construction, smart buildings, sensors, BIM

- Construction I: Permits and completions in residential construction

- Construction II: Permits and completions in non-residential construction

- Potential for modernization and renovation

- Marketing and budget in the building materials industry

- Purchasing and distribution trends in the construction industry

- Demographics and construction

- Real estate market

- Civil and road construction

- Macroeconomic developments

- Opportunities and limits of bureaucracy reduction as a construction booster

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Easy post, it works!

https://bauinfoconsult.de/linkedin-einfach-posten-laeuft-schon/

LinkedIn and building materials? At first glance, this may not seem like a perfect match. However, it is precisely here that a second look is worthwhile. A guest contribution by Sybille Kunzelmann.

LinkedIn is no longer just a platform for job searching, careers, and corporate communication. In the construction industry, people are also seeking information digitally, comparing solutions, following expert insights, and building trust with companies and individuals—often long before a specific inquiry arises.

For providers of building materials, LinkedIn therefore offers a significant opportunity: to become visible, showcase expertise, and stay in the minds of relevant target groups.

Becoming visible before the inquiry comes

LinkedIn is no longer a niche channel in the German-speaking B2B landscape. By the end of 2025, the potential reach in Germany, Austria, and Switzerland together was around 32 million members.

This is particularly exciting for building material providers, as building materials are rarely chosen spontaneously. Architecture, planning, processing, and client requirements must be understood, contextualized, and evaluated within the project.

Those who regularly provide helpful insights on LinkedIn will be visible earlier—not just when a specific inquiry arises, but already when people begin to engage with a topic.

Another point is becoming increasingly important: Public LinkedIn content can also become visible outside the platform, for instance in search engines or AI-supported search results. LinkedIn is thus not just a social media channel but an additional building block for digital discoverability, professional positioning, and trust.

“LinkedIn does not become effective because a company posts. LinkedIn becomes effective when people become professionally visible and approachable.”

Sybille Kunzelmann, copywriter and content strategist for B2B & industry.

How it works with LinkedIn and building materials

LinkedIn is not a second website. It is not enough to simply drop content there and wait for reactions. LinkedIn thrives on exchange, personality, and repetition.

For building material providers, this means: The company profile remains important—as an anchor point for brand, products, references, and company news. However, more impact often arises through personal profiles. If management, sales, application technology, or product management provides insights, it tends to appear more approachable and credible than a post “from the logo.”

It’s not about posting as often as possible. More important is a realistic regularity and a clear guiding thread: What do we stand for? What questions do our target groups have? Where can we provide guidance?

Equally important is what happens between your own posts: making connections, commenting, responding to inquiries, and continuing conversations. LinkedIn is not a digital billboard but rather a virtual trade show.

Good content emerges where product knowledge meets genuine questions from practice: processing, standards, sustainability, common mistakes, references, or insights behind the scenes. By communicating this way, one avoids crude product advertising and showcases competence.

Tips for everyday use: What helps—and what doesn’t

Here’s how to further increase the reach of your posts:

About the author

Sybille Kunzelmann assists SMEs from the mechanical engineering, construction, and technology sectors in shaping their marketing communication more clearly, strategically, and authentically. She brings more than 15 years of experience in technical B2B marketing, including from the mechanical engineering, tunneling, and ERP environments. With auf1WORT, she develops communication strategies, LinkedIn content, and expert texts that make complex topics understandable and make companies visible as relevant solution providers.

Digital users replace tradition.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/die-4-typen-der-baukommunikation-digital-gepraegte-nutzer-ueberh

* The 4 Types of Construction Communication: Digitally Influenced Users Overtake the Traditional Fraction

Düsseldorf, 29.06.2026: For 14 years, BauInfoConsult has been investigating the information and orientation behavior in the construction industry. This involves not only the media most frequently used—where the internet has been highly valued for a long time—but also the types of information that are particularly favored by professional users in architecture, construction, and craftsmanship companies. Two years ago, traditional media were again in the lead: after the sparse contacts during the COVID period, construction professionals particularly enjoyed personal contact again. However, the current survey suggests that the trend toward digitalization may be stronger in the long term: Traditional media such as trade fairs and professional journals continue to lose significance, while online research has gained speed due to increasingly individualized search results thanks to pervasive AI tools. Social media, too, although not only an information medium but also a tool for exchange and self-presentation within the framework of one's own marketing, is increasing in reach within the construction industry. Overall, four types of communication can be identified in the companies, the differing preferences and needs of which the study details.

The ‘most important’ communication channels—the assessments are naturally subjective...

In our CATI survey conducted in April and May 2026 among 400 architecture firms, construction companies, roofing and carpentry businesses, painting and drywall companies, as well as HVAC installation firms, users from the industry rated the importance of various information sources independently of the separately queried frequency of use. Even an information source that I may use significantly less frequently can still have a much more sustainable influence on my decision than previous occasional inquiries.

... yet meaningful and 2026 shows a clear trend

In this sense, industry actors have previously assigned particularly high importance to information from personal conversations, although the internet has steadily increased in usage frequency since 2016. By

2022—still lingering in the aftermath of lockdowns and the nearly two-year custom of living and working ‘at a distance’—digital media had unambiguously replaced personal conversations as the most important information source in the respondents' minds. Even in the first lockdown in 2020, the situation was slightly tighter, albeit still favoring the traditional personal media category.

In the 2024 survey, after the end of lockdown restrictions, construction actors apparently enjoyed personal encounters so much that in 2024 personal information routes were again deemed the most important, and this was the case for more than half of all construction professionals across all examined professional groups.

However, now it seems that the digital burden of daily life is demanding its toll even in the awareness of construction actors: Digital information has once again climbed to the top of the podium—perhaps to securely establish itself there even in the long run. Whereas in 2024 a significant number of processing companies still belonged to the ‘personal’ fraction, digital media are currently recognized as the most important information means by at least half of the respondents across all target groups.

There are the ‘Personal’—those who evaluate information from first-hand sources—the colleagues or business partners they trust, contacts in trade or field service, deeper conversations at trade fairs or other events— as the most valuable information. This user group was clearly in the majority in the past but now finds itself clearly relegated to a solid second place, remaining particularly relevant for communication strategies.

In comparison, the again third-placed ‘Print-Affiliated’ are increasingly becoming mere bystanders. However, this old-school faction should not be underestimated, as their focus on printed, detailed information allows them to be reached with significantly less effort than the ‘Personal’ or even those who, with constant SEO and AI-optimized measures, can only be engaged in the internet-savvy sector.

This group of ‘Digital’ users is now clearly at the forefront of user types. As in previous years, this group mainly comprises professionals in architecture. Their former preference for print (2012) has long since been clearly overshadowed by preferences for information on the internet. While the planners' preference for quick online searches for product characteristics and alternatives can be explained by creative design work at the desk, for processing companies it relates to increasingly available online information regarding pricing, availability, and processing inquiries on the construction site.

Yet another avant-garde group is the ‘Social-Interactive’ who particularly value information from their social networks. Their share of the target group may be small, but their inclination towards social media creates a sort of magnifying glass for all industry participants—because the majority of respondents from our four user groups have a social media profile (or even several on average).

In fact, this applies generally to all user types: irrespective of the preferences of industry actors for one medium or another, all types of media preference nonetheless use more or less all four types of media to inform themselves—even though (depending on type and preference) more or less intensively. To

make this comprehensible to the readers of the ‘Communication Monitor’ and to provide useful insights for their own communication work regarding the thinking of construction actors concerning information and media, we present all results to the posed questions in the data appendices of the study sorted by user type.

About the Study

The latest developments in communication and orientation behavior at a total of 400 architecture firms, construction companies, roofing and carpentry businesses, painting and drywall companies, and HVAC installation firms are outlined in the Communication Monitor 2026 based on representative survey results. The report, based on a broad data basis, contains detailed information about communication and information behavior in the industry: usage and evaluation of information sources, internet research & AI usage, information behavior by product group/construction segment, manufacturer websites, personal contact information (trade fairs, field service), professional journal usage & top professional journals per target group, social media usage for the eight most important social networks in the construction industry, use of apps, development since 2012.

The new Communication Monitor from BauInfoConsult can be obtained for €1,450 plus VAT from BauInfoConsult.

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People key to success.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/top-management-thema-kommunikation-in-der-transformation-der-men

A guest contribution by Christian Haak.

Transformation rarely fails due to strategy; it fails due to communication.

This central observation and years of refined understanding shift the focus back to people as the decisive factor for success.

Companies in the construction industry are investing billions in digitalization, automation, and artificial intelligence. Businesses develop strategies, define target images, and launch transformation programs. Nonetheless, many changes fall short of expectations.

Even worse, the same patterns also manifest in daily project operations.

Therefore, it is crucial to view the topic differently and think from the end point.

The fundamental question is: What exactly do I want to achieve? Where is the goal, and what will the path to get there look like?

This clarity provides orientation and leads to the subsequent consideration of what will be necessary to arrive there.

The answers typically do not initially involve technology, systems, IT, AI, etc. They revolve primarily around who in the organization should be involved and how. Who might be supporters, opponents, or neutral?

This leads to dialogues and interactions with those involved.

Communication means dialogue.

People want to understand, they want to ask questions, they want to be able to address uncertainties, and they want to experience that leadership listens and does not just send out messages.

The essential task of leadership fundamentally changes as a result.

In the past, expertise, experience, and decision-making competence were central. Today, another core task is added. Leaders must convey meaning. They must explain changes. They must provide orientation, even when not every answer is yet established.

People think very carefully about whether they want to invest their energy into a change. They are only willing to do so if they recognize a sense of purpose for themselves.

People in an organization expect clarity. This does not require information through emails, etc., but good communication.

Successful companies, or rather successful leaders, often do not have better strategies or superior expertise; they stand out because they are better at winning people over for these strategies.

Thus, communication becomes a hard factor and moves out of the realm of the nice “add-ons.”

Good communication reduces resistance, speeds up decisions, strengthens collaboration, increases identification with the company, and transforms change into a shared project.

In the end, it is not the best strategy that determines the success of a transformation.

What matters is whether people are willing to support it.

The question about tools is secondary.

They support, organize, simplify, and harmonize the exchange.

If I have a sports car and a compact car to choose from, both vehicles can get me to my destination—provided they have gasoline in the tank.

Good communication is the fuel of every successful change. Without this fuel, even the best sports car remains stuck at the starting line.

Do you recognize this from your company, from the last project?

Transformation does not begin with technology; it begins with good communication among people.

That is measurable in hard euros.

Fuel yourself and your organization up!

New homes shortage looming.

https://bauinfoconsult.de/immobilienmarktstudie-sieht-verborgenes-neubaudefizit-und-stellt

* The real estate market study sees a hidden new construction deficit – and questions the home ownership segment.

While there is a shortage of available apartments in urban centers, new housing is mainly being created in regions with high demand. So is Germany building in the wrong places? A new analysis by the real estate service provider Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL) comes to this conclusion. In terms of the pure number of new apartments, the study may be correct. However, the actual issue is different: those who criticize construction in rural areas are effectively targeting traditional single-family home construction. The authors perhaps unintentionally connect to a nearly forgotten debate from the late 2010s: the demand for multi-family homes instead of single-family houses. How valid is the JLL analysis?

According to an analysis by Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL), the slight recovery of German construction activity since the end of 2024 is off target. Apartments are primarily being built in regions with calming real estate markets, leading to an oversupply there, while the shortage in urban areas worsens. JLL also criticizes that excessively large and misaligned residential units are being built. This obviously refers to single-family homes. However, there are good reasons why especially affluent private builders currently have the opportunity to realize a construction project. According to the JLL analysis, the high construction costs are a significant factor that makes multi-family house projects unprofitable for developers outside the luxury segment. Therefore, a targeted improvement in the economic framework conditions for the non-premium rental housing sector would be the best solution to the dilemma.

Too little is being built – and when it is, it's in the wrong places.

The international service provider Jones Lang LaSalle, known for its presence in the commercial real estate sector and investment management, has analyzed the regional distribution of new construction in relation to the respective regional housing needs.

It is well known that new construction activity in Germany has significantly declined and is currently much lower since 2022. This has not eased the situation in housing markets with high demand and limited availability of residential space. The gradual recovery of building permit activity since the end of 2024 is, according to the analysts, not only proceeding too slowly and at too low a level. Furthermore, JLL notes that construction is systematically overlooking demand – particularly in areas where the real estate market is already calmed.

According to JLL's calculations, around 50,000 new apartments are created each year in regions where housing demand is stagnating or declining. These units would be much more urgently needed elsewhere: particularly drastic evidence comes from the eight largest German cities: Here, according to JLL's calculations, on average 42 new housing units are available for every 10,000 existing apartments – but 62 new units per 10,000 are actually needed.

In contrast, in rural areas, 41 new units are being built – however, JLL estimates that the actual need there is only for 23 units.

The real estate analysts let the cat out of the bag.

In addition to the regional imbalance, there is also a demographic factor: in numerous local markets, primarily small housing units are needed for small or elderly households. However, construction is focused on large units, leading to an oversupply according to JLL.

On about a fifth of regional markets, JLL recognizes this overweight of larger units. These cannot easily be converted into the smaller units that are so often needed – as they are usually large single-family homes. In the coming years, according to JLL predictions, this mismatch will lead to an additional demand of 16,300 apartments per year.

Here, the analysis reveals the real issue: predominantly single-family homes are built in rural areas. A brief look at the most current data on the completion of new residential buildings at the district level (as of 2024) confirms this – and these data are no outliers; they follow a long-term trend.

On average across the country, 72 percent of newly completed residential buildings are single-family homes – in the top seven major cities, it is an average of 46 percent. In independent cities and urban districts, it is 59 percent, and in other regions, 76 percent.

The nationwide leaders with particularly low home ownership rates are affluent, urban, and densely populated districts and independent cities (Top 3: Ulm, Jena, and Freiburg im Breisgau with home ownership shares between 30 and 31 percent).

Conversely, the top three regions almost entirely dominated by new single-family home construction belong to those criticized by JLL as rural areas with calmed or stagnating markets but with a clientele capable of purchasing private homes (the top 3: districts of Görlitz, Salzlandkreis, and Elbe-Elster with single-family home shares between 98 and 96 percent). Even in urban spaces and major cities with

generally low purchasing power, private construction predominates – meaning only a few new residential buildings arise there – and when they do, it is mostly privately used single-family homes.

"Barking at the wrong tree" – Investors think longer-term than self-users.

Opponents of new single-family home construction frequently cite land consumption and the ecological footprint per unit – an environmental policy debate that can certainly be taken seriously. However, JLL is concerned only about the imbalances in relation to the demand in housing markets.

Households urgently seeking housing in a specific region do not usually consist of those looking to build homes who have sufficient purchasing power for a new construction. Here, JLL's argument seems to skirt the issue: the actual dynamics of the revival in construction activity or at least the approval activity since the end of 2024 have primarily occurred among private home builders.

For this group, particularly interest rates are critical – as soon as they become attractive again, more private homeowners can seize the opportunity to embark on their dream project.

The fact that this occurs mainly in rural areas is also due to the fact that living costs there make it easier to secure a building loan. Additionally, it is often somewhat easier to acquire building land – a significant reason why construction is stalling in urban areas.

Construction costs primarily hinder multi-family home construction.

Construction costs are often and rightly cited as a major hurdle for new construction. For private residential construction, the deterrent effect is somewhat less than for commercial investors. The reason is clear: affluent private builders grudgingly accept high construction costs if only loan conditions are affordable. This group typically builds only once in a lifetime – the critical point is: Can I afford it at all? Less so: Is the investment actually sensible from a rational perspective?

For financially-minded housing companies and project developers – without whom there would be little multi-family home activity in shortage regions and thereby less relaxed housing offering markets – on the other hand, construction costs are more than just another unpleasant hurdle. Together with interest and land costs, excessively high prices often stifle profitability right from the start.

What JLL directly suggests in its analysis: the higher technical requirements since 2002 have long been seen as cost drivers by the real estate sector. In addition to the material price shock during the first lockdown-induced shortages in early 2021, there has been a rise in interest and capital costs since the start of the Ukraine war, which has drastically reduced profitability for project developers.

Although profitability has slowly been recovering since 2024 thanks to lower interest rates – the gap between the cost-covering minimum rent and the achievable market rent for new construction has narrowed again since then – the international situation remains unsettled and further cost increases due to the war seem predictable.

As a result, according to JLL, construction projects are almost exclusively profitable in the upper price segments with high rents above €21.50 per square meter – a segment for which, according to JLL estimates, only 10 percent of households qualify as potential customers.

Thus, the current activity in multi-family home construction is similar to a niche like (at least from a real estate market perspective) the construction of single-family homes for private self-users.

JLL analysts see only an improvement in profitability as an effective lever to make projects in broader rental segments profitable again – otherwise, the marketing risk for operators is too high. The authors of the study hope for cost innovations such as modular construction and regulatory simplifications like the planned (and unfortunately postponed again until next year) "Building Type E".

In the construction industry, there is also a call for the well-established (but unfortunately expensive for policymakers) means of subsidies. From our perspective, a program aimed at creating more planning and investment security for the non-premium rental segment would make sense (but again, this is another long-expressed wish that is yet to be fulfilled).

Geb

Airflow tested in lab.

https://www.geb-info.de/lueftung/luftstroemung-im-labor-getestet

Air flow tested in the laboratory

On September 21, 2026.

Airflow visualization with white fog fluid for qualitative assessment of room airflow during reduced ventilation operation.

In the DGNB-certified wooden hybrid office building Platinum in Wiesbaden, slot outlets ensure optimal indoor air quality. Kiefer experts have simulated their function in the in-house airflow laboratory.

The Platinum office building, realized by Neumann Architekten and OFB Projektentwicklung, showcases what sustainable and energy-efficient construction can achieve today. The Hessen Agentur economic development company headquarters saves around 1,160 tons of carbon dioxide annually compared to a conventionally constructed office building. The building also generates more regenerative energy than it consumes. Solar modules cover 1,300 square meters on the roof and facade, alongside a 400 cubic meter underground ice storage.

Ventilation technology

Platinum in Wiesbaden is a lighthouse project for sustainable office buildings, certified with the highest DGNB seal in platinum.

Kiefer Klimatechnik from Stuttgart was responsible for the planning and installation of the system technology. The ventilation system, designed by the company, consists of two central ventilation units located in the basement and on the fifth floor, serving different usage areas. One unit ventilates the basement rooms, while the other conditions the air for all above-ground office and sanitary rooms.

Outside air is drawn in at the facade, processed and conditioned in the RLT system with high efficiency. An integrated heat recovery with adiabatic cooling ensures sustainable and environmentally friendly temperature control. The conditioned supply air is then fed into the office and meeting rooms via induction slot outlets, without drafts.

A variable volume flow system continuously evaluates data from integrated air quality sensors and dynamically adjusts air volumes to the respective room usage. In office areas, an air exchange of one to 1.8 per hour is achieved. If conference rooms are heavily occupied, the system increases the air exchange rate to up to six per hour, while supply air in less used office floors is reduced energy-efficiently.

Exhaust air from the offices is directed through Indusilent overflow elements into the corridor area and then centrally extracted. They meet high sound absorption requirements and prevent speech transmission outside.

Laboratory tests

Beforehand, it was necessary to demonstrate whether and to what extent the slot outlet meets thermal requirements, especially in summer, due to its installation near the facade and window. The outlets were planned in the ceiling area close to the facade and window, which could influence airflow patterns and thermal comfort. During planning, surface and radiation temperatures of the enclosing surfaces were considered.

Characteristic of the induction slot outlet is its high induction, which quickly mixes room air through fine jets, reducing temperature differences and air speed, preventing drafts. Visually, the outlet profiles blend unobtrusively into the modern ceiling architecture.

Kiefer's development center in-house airflow laboratory enables quick and efficient measurements or optimizations under real conditions. Kiefer engineers reviewed the air outlet's discharge behavior and air distribution in the room based on numerous flow measurements.

Furthermore, the three-dimensional flow measurement was visualized with fog fluid. Local thermal comfort was evaluated according to DIN EN ISO 7730 in the full load cooling case and reduced operation, all under the assumption of a seated person (1.2 m = 58.2 W/m2), dressed for summer (0.5 clo = 0.080 m2 K/W) and a relative room air humidity of around 50 percent.

Kiefer built a representative section of Platinum, simulating personnel and machine loads, installing an 800 millimeter long induction slot outlet with asymmetric discharge geometry, and setting it according to required operating parameters.

In the subsequent measurement series, a special device recorded data from 20 individual measurement points at foot, knee, and head height (standing/sitting) for calculating thermal comfort. These include local room air speed and temperature, or draft risk calculations. Testing was conducted for both the full load cooling case (45 cubic meters per hour) and reduced operation (25 cubic meters per hour), each with a six Kelvin temperature difference between supply and room air.

The test series showed that with the induction slot outlet, regardless of the set air quantity, a uniform and optimal airflow pattern is achieved, ensuring undercooling and room air speeds are optimally reduced until entering the occupied zone. The fresh air distributes evenly both horizontally and vertically, without disturbing draft risks or local discomfort. In all evaluation criteria, the best category A (I) for thermal comfort in the occupied area according to DIN EN 16798-1 was achieved.

Concrete module house printed.

https://www.geb-info.de/bautechnik/3d-drucker-erstes-modulhaus-aus-normbeton-realisiert

3D Printers: First Modular House Made of Standard Concrete Completed

21.09.2026

Rupp Gebäudedruck GmbH

The printed modular house “Pluto” is taking shape thanks to the 7-axis printing system and the project partners Rupp Gebäudedruck, Avenco, Kuka, M-Tec, and Sievert.

Rupp Gebäudedruck has for the first time manufactured a modular house with a new mobile 7-axis printing system. In Weißenhorn, the company printed the model “Pluto.”

A home from a 3D printer? For the first time, Rupp Gebäudedruck GmbH has manufactured a modular house from its architecture series “Ready4Space” using a new mobile 7-axis printing system. The “Pluto” model is a modern residential unit with 23 square meters of living space, a gabled roof, and a characteristic 3D-printed facade structure. The building is planned to be part of a modular house park in the Weißenhorn region.

After just five hours, about half of the modular house “Pluto” has been printed.

Michael Oßwald, Managing Director of Rupp Gebäudedruck, explains: “Our goal is to bring building printing out of its niche into broader application. For that, we need solutions that are economical, flexible, and practical. This project showcases that.” Oßwald adds: “With the new printing system and a standard-compliant concrete, we are creating the conditions to produce modular houses even more efficiently and scalably in the future.”

A central point of the project is the use of a 3D-recycling concrete. Previously, specialized recipes were often required in building printing. The new process relies on a standard concrete from Quick-Mix, which can be processed safely, easily, and accurately. Oßwald explains: “The use of standard concrete opens new possibilities for 3D building printing. The technology thus becomes more economical and more readily available. This is an essential step towards broader market penetration.”

The printed modular house is part of the architecture series “Ready4Space.” Rupp Gebäudedruck offers flexibly usable modular buildings. The units can be utilized as guest houses, holiday homes, home offices, residential extensions, or for tourism concepts. The “Pluto” model is among the most compact variants in the series. It demonstrates how architecture, industrially prefabricated processes, and digital manufacturing can be combined. All the exterior walls were completely produced using 3D printing.

The project originated from close cooperation among several specialists. The planning and printing execution was undertaken by Rupp Gebäudedruck, which now manages the expansion of the module. Oßwald emphasizes: “Innovations arise where different competencies come together.” Oßwald adds: “This project impressively illustrates the potential in strong partnerships. Together, we are developing

technologies that can make building faster, more flexible, and more economical."

With the 3D printing of the first module, the project partners see another step towards the industrially scalable manufacturing of residential and modular buildings. The initiative in Weißenhorn is meant to serve as a reference project for future applications and make the possibilities of modern printing technologies in construction visible.

Batteries boost Oktoberfest power.

https://www.geb-info.de/elektrotechnik/batteriespeicher-sichern-stromversorgung-auf-dem-ok

Battery Storage Secures Power Supply at Oktoberfest

09/20/2026

No more power outages: Two Tesvolt Forton battery storage systems are capping peak loads at the Pschorr-Bräurosl tent at Oktoberfest.

Given the increasing electrification and limited grid capacities, Tesvolt large storage systems ensure an uninterrupted power supply for the festival tents and provide a flexible solution for the future energy supply of the folk festival.

Oktoberfest in Munich is experiencing an increasing electrification that poses challenges to the existing grid infrastructure. Since the Ukraine war and due to strict exhaust regulations for gas, operators are pushing for a switch to electric solutions. In the past, this has led to grid overloads and power outages in the festival tents. To ensure operational reliability, electrical engineer Matthias Poeting from MP Elektrotechnik Munich is now relying on the use of large battery storage from the Wittenberg-based provider Tesvolt.

The battery storages were installed two weeks before the start of the festival.

Electricity demand exceeds grid limits.

The Munich city utilities provide the large festival tents with a connection capacity of about 420 kW. However, during peak times, the actual electricity demand regularly exceeds 500 kW, causing a permanent overload of the grid connection. Last year, these bottlenecks led to power outages in the Löwenbräu tent and in the Pschorr-Bräurosl tent.

The increased electricity demand results from the abandonment of gas and new, strict emissions regulations for gas-powered plants. Switching to purely electric kitchens allows operators to save costs for expensive exhaust systems and measurement paths. At the same time, comfort needs are increasing, for example, through heaters in outdoor areas that require up to 150 kW per tent. In cooler weather, this leads to high load peaks.

Battery storage as a buffer for operational reliability.

To solve this problem, MP Elektrotechnik secures the operation of the Pschorr-Bräurosl and Löwenbräu festival tents with three Tesvolt large battery storage systems. These systems provide a buffer of two hours in case of grid overload. This enables targeted load reductions in case of need, thereby preventing power outages. The battery storages supply consumers decently and thus relieve the central grid connection of the tents.

Economic and technological advantages of the storage solution.

The investment in the battery storage is significantly lower compared to a comprehensive overhaul of the grid infrastructure. Poeting predicts a payback period of two to three years. Another advantage is the small space requirement of the systems and their flexibility: as demand increases, the battery systems can be expanded.

Tesvolt supplied Forton large storages that use modern high-temperature cells. These cells are robust and long-lasting. Another technical advantage on the narrow festival grounds is the avoidance of liquid cooling, which saves space and avoids the use of environmentally hazardous coolants.

The limitations of traditional grid expansion.

According to Poeting, a classic expansion of the grid infrastructure on the festival grounds is hardly feasible. The surrounding transformer stations operate at their limits during Oktoberfest. An extension of the medium voltage as well as the low voltage main distributor would be economically and logistically disproportionate.

Perspectives for a sustainable energy future of Oktoberfest.

Oktoberfest serves as a stress test for the technology deployed under extreme conditions. The smart storage technology provides a more cost-effective and flexible solution than expanding the grids and can respond to future energy situations. The festival operators are open to intelligent, green energy systems. Future developments might involve utilizing waste heat from the tents, wind energy, or integrating solar module films on tent roofs.

Sunlight, intense and limited.

https://www.geb-info.de/gebaeudekonzepte/viel-sonne-auf-wenig-raum

* # A Lot of Sun in a Small Space

09/19/2026

How high can the solar coverage of a PV-led heat supply actually be in practice? A study by the University of Konstanz shows it for a tiny house.

Heating directly with electricity instead of a heat pump: is this feasible for small, well-insulated buildings? The University of Konstanz has studied a PV-connected underfloor heating system with a

hot water boiler in real operation and recorded solar coverage rates of up to 68 percent.

How high can the solar coverage of a PV-led heat supply actually be in practice? A study by the University of Konstanz demonstrates this for a tiny house. The research project

“IR-Bau 2 – Additional Investigations on the Potential of IR Heating Systems” delivers reliable measurement results. Professor Thomas Stark, Jan Heider, Nicole Conrad, and Niklas Bachmann have, among other things, measured a micro house in Singen over two heating seasons. The result: for suitable buildings and adequately sized PV systems, a continuously regulated direct heating system combined with a controlled hot water boiler can be economically and technically sensible.

The Tiny House

A photovoltaic system with 8.6 kilowatts of power is installed on the tiny house.

The micro house in Singen was planned by Kupprion – Sustainable Architecture 2020 and built on a leftover plot in line with infill development. The single-story cube offers space for two residents in 50 square meters and three rooms. The building is constructed in timber-frame style with wood fiber insulation and features a visible solid wood ceiling on the inside.

Internally, the building is divided into three areas: the central living area and the side-arranged private rooms with a bedroom and bathroom. The building is generously glazed to the south, while the remaining exterior wall surfaces are almost entirely closed.

The use of a heat pump was examined for the heat supply of the house. However, for the small building expecting low heat demand, the heat pump system was comparatively expensive in investment costs. As an alternative, a self-consumption optimized direct electric heating system was installed.

The system consists of four components:

- an electric underfloor heating (4.3 kW from Devi Danvoss) with two heating circuits, which was directly poured into the 22 cm thick concrete floor slab of the building,

- an electric hot water flat boiler from Austria Email with 120 liters,

- an 8.6-kilowatt PV system (east-west orientation, five degrees inclined, partially shaded by trees on the neighboring property),

- and a continuously regulated photovoltaic power manager AC•THOR 9s, to maximize the self-consumption of the PV electricity.

The Results

Over two heating seasons, the micro house was examined. The specific annual heating energy consumption was 37 kilowatt-hours per square meter in the survey year, which corresponds to an annual consumption of 1,834 kilowatt-hours. The insulation level of the building is very high. However,

the unfavorable surface-to-volume ratio for small buildings and a ventilation system without heat recovery noticeably impact energy demand.

The power consumption for heating domestic hot water was 694 kilowatt-hours per year (approximately 14 kWh/m²a). For a one-person house, this value is comparatively high. This is primarily due to the storage losses of the boiler, which sum up to 537 kilowatt-hours per year – around 77 percent of the hot water electricity demand.

This loss is a direct result of the chosen control strategy: during PV surplus, buildings (concrete floor slab) and the drinking water storage tank are intentionally over-tempered. This builds thermal storage mass and shifts electricity consumption during periods of high solar generation. The storage losses are thus part of the desired load shifting.

Around 91 percent of the heating energy demand occurs during the heating period from October to April. The months of December and January, in particular, have a significant effect, together accounting for about 41 percent of the annual heating energy demand. These two months significantly determine the annual balance – in terms of both consumption and solar coverage.

Energy Autarky

About 21 percent of the solar power was used to cover the heat demand.

Despite partial shading and an unusually low generation in December – caused by prolonged snow cover and fog over Lake Constance – the PV system achieved an annual yield of 8,118 kilowatt-hours. This corresponds to a good specific yield of 990 kilowatt-hours per kilowatt.

In the annual balance, the solar coverage of heat generation was about 68 percent. Especially during transitional periods, solar coverage is very high.

Of the generation, approximately 36 percent accounts for the heating period, while only about three percent accounts for December and January. In the annual balance, the PV system produced more than three times the amount of electricity needed for heat supply. 21 percent of the solar power could be directly used to cover the heat demand. This results in a solar coverage of 68 percent of the total heat generation in the annual balance and 61 percent solar coverage of heating energy.

Especially during transitional periods, solar electricity was able to nearly entirely meet the heat demand. Here, the control strategy demonstrates its effectiveness depending on the PV output. In the months of December and January, the low solar availability naturally becomes more pronounced. This systemic limitation affects every form of solar-based heat supply.

The evaluation of the solar coverage shares and grid references gives a calculated annual work number of 3.16 for hot water and heating with photovoltaics. This means: relative to the grid electricity used, more than three times the amount of heat was provided. The grid electricity reference is, therefore, at a comparable level to that of an air/water heat pump – albeit with a lower investment cost.

ReAKT tests building regulations.

https://www.geb-info.de/normen-und-zertifizierung/projekt-reakt-prueft-technische-regeln-i

Project: ReaKT examines technical regulations in the building sector

Climate change, the energy transition, and changing user behavior increasingly call into question existing technical standards and guidelines in the building sector. The project "ReaKT - Resilient, energy-adapted concepts and technologies for the heat and cold supply of buildings," funded by the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy (BMWi), investigates whether existing standards, guidelines, and planning approaches for supply concepts in buildings meet tomorrow's requirements.

The project captures changing parameters that affect the requirements for buildings and their use: factors such as energy-efficient renovations in existing buildings and climatic changes, as well as socio-cultural developments like home office and demographic shifts, are reshaping building usage.

Numerous regulations inadequately reflect current and future requirements for buildings. They are based on historical parameters, outdated climate data, user profiles, and fossil energy systems.

To ensure that future supply systems are safely and economically sustainable for long-term operation, current standards and guidelines must be checked for their future viability. This is precisely where ReaKT comes in.

Since June 1, 2026, ReaKT has been systematically analyzing the effects of changing climatic, technical, and socio-cultural parameters on the heat and cold demands of buildings. The project also assesses the resilience of existing supply concepts.

The goal of the project is to derive reliable parameters and recommendations for action for adjusting technical standards, guidelines, and planning approaches for future heat and cold supply of buildings.

The project is being carried out by the Steinbeis Innovation Center Energyplus, the Chair of Technical Thermodynamics at the Technical University Bergakademie Freiberg, DBI Gas and Environmental Technology GmbH, and the German Institute for Standardization (DIN). A comprehensive project advisory board supports the partners involved. The advisory board consists of numerous practical partners, associations, energy agencies, and chambers of crafts, who contribute their experience and expertise to the project.

At the beginning of the project, a short survey is being conducted to identify action and adaptation needs of currently applicable standards and guidelines. Participation is possible (external link) here.

Old building to efficiency house

https://www.geb-info.de/denkmal-und-altbau/vom-altbau-zum-effizienzhaus-40-autarkie-durch-

* From Old Building to Efficiency House 40: Autarky through Renovation and Self-Generated Power

A two-family house from 1970 in Wilnsdorf-Niederdielfen has been extensively modernized to improve its energy efficiency. The building has reached the Efficiency House 40 level with thermal insulation, battery storage, a ventilation system, photovoltaic panels, and a ground/water heat pump. The owner reports that by 2025, they will only be relying on about 700 kilowatt-hours of grid electricity—despite using electric heating and electric mobility.

Bringing a residential building from the 1970s up to the Efficiency House 40 level is technically challenging. This is exemplified in a renovation project in Wilnsdorf-Niederdielfen in the district of Siegen-Wittgenstein. The two-family house had two living units and a heated living area of around 230 square meters, along with a heated basement and a partially finished attic. Prior to the renovation, the building envelope had not been upgraded for energy efficiency; only the oil heating system had been replaced in 2003.

Apart from the high energy consumption, there was significant need for structural renovation due to issues with the roof and drainage, moisture problems in the oil storage area, defective drainage, cracks in the plaster at the base, deteriorating cellar windows, and uninsulated pipes. The foundation for planning was an individualized renovation plan.

The renovation aimed not only to reduce heating costs but also to eliminate the backlog of repairs, create additional living space, enhance living comfort, and completely transform the building aesthetically. Architecturally, the concept was inspired by a black pavilion seen by the owner about 25 years ago in the Autostadt Wolfsburg. The result is a strikingly designed house with dark cladding.

Energetically, the building was developed to the level of Efficiency House 40 EE. According to project documents, the calculated annual final energy demand decreased from 52,379 kilowatt-hours to 5,146 kilowatt-hours. Ground-contacting components, the base slab, roof, facade, as well as windows and doors were renewed.

The roof received a multilayer insulation with a total height of up to 480 millimeters. The specified U-value is 0.06 W/(m²K). The facade was executed as a ventilated slate facade with a planned U-value of 0.135 W/(m²K). For the cellar and other ground-contacting components, a 200-millimeter thick perimeter insulation, new sealing, and renewed drainage were implemented. New wooden-aluminum windows with triple glazing and passive house doors complete the thermally bridge-free envelope.

The heating supply is managed by a modulating ground/water heat pump with a heating capacity of 0.8 to six kilowatts. It operates with a ring trench collector as the heat source. This collector consists of two PE pipes, each 300 meters long, installed in a trench that is roughly 65 meters long and 1.8 meters deep. The owner dug and installed the ring trench collector himself.

The heat pump supplies a newly installed underfloor heating system that operates with low flow temperatures below 30 degrees Celsius. The calculated annual performance ratio is 5.1. Additionally, a

central supply and exhaust ventilation system with heat recovery is included. An enthalpy exchanger is designed to recover not only heat but also moisture. An additional ground collector preheats the supply air in winter and conditions it in summer.

To achieve maximum energy self-sufficiency, the roof is fully covered with photovoltaic panels. The system has a capacity of 30.42 kilowatts, approximately evenly divided on the south and a 35-degree inclined north side. It is complemented by a battery storage capacity of 30.76 kilowatt-hours and a charge/discharge capacity of 18 kilowatts. The system is structured as three-phase and has a backup power function.

Electric mobility is integrated as well: Two wall boxes with 11 and 22 kilowatts are available. According to planning calculations, about 10,027 out of roughly 10,429 kilometers driven annually are powered by solar energy.

The simulation predicted an annual yield of approximately 22,179 kilowatt-hours for the photovoltaic system. For the total electricity demand from electric mobility, household use, heating, ventilation, and hot water preparation, the project calculated a self-sufficiency rate of 83.4 percent. Additional PV panels on the garage and carport could increase the self-sufficiency rate to about 94 percent.

Remarkably, the estimated consumption data for 2025, shared by the project team, indicates that the building will only draw around 700 kilowatt-hours from the grid. This figure specifically refers to grid usage; it does not equate to the total electricity consumption of the household.

Before the renovation, the projected annual expenses for heating oil, household electricity, and gasoline were around 7,110 euros, or about 593 euros per month. The total renovation costs were estimated at about 410,000 euros. After the promised subsidies of 172,400 euros, project documents showed a financing need of 177,600 euros, plus 60,000 euros of personal funds for areas like bathrooms, kitchen, and outdoor facilities.

The modeled monthly burden from financing, electricity consumption, and feed-in remuneration was around 443 euros. Thus, the ongoing monthly costs should remain below the previously estimated energy expenses despite the extensive modernization. In addition to the energy balance, the project team highlights a significant increase in comfort, a larger living space of now 27 square meters, the elimination of the renovation backlog, and an increase in the building's value.

The project illustrates the boundaries and opportunities of full renovation.

This example makes clear that renovation to Efficiency House 40 goes far beyond individual measures. Only the interplay of very good building envelope, low-temperature heat distribution, efficient heat sources, ventilation with heat recovery, along with photovoltaics, storage, and demand management allows for high self-sufficiency.

At the same time, such a project remains a complex overall task: besides technical planning, the inventory, funding strategy, financing, and coordination of numerous trades are crucial.

Heat pumps see high demand.

https://www.geb-info.de/foerderung/beg-reporting-zeigt-hohe-nachfrage-nach-waermepumpen

The BEG reporting for the second quarter has been published. In the first half of 2026, individual measures dominated the funding. Heat pumps were at the forefront among heat generators.

The Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy (BMWE) has published a current report on the Federal Funding for Efficient Buildings (BEG). The overview consolidates the funding measures in the BEG renovation funding at the KfW Development Bank and the Federal Office for Economic Affairs and Export Control (BAFA) for the second quarter and partially for the first half of 2026. It shows a strong demand for individual measures and particularly for the installation of heat pumps.

The reporting for the first six months of 2026 shows a total of 335,117 measures in the renovation sector. Of these, 6,475 measures relate to the renovation of residential buildings and 315 measures to non-residential buildings.

The largest proportion consists of individual measures. The BMWE lists 318,130 individual measures for residential buildings and 10,197 individual measures for non-residential buildings. Thus, most of the funded measures in the reporting fall into this category.

In terms of heat generators, renovations are still highly demanded for residential buildings under the BEG individual measures. From January to June 2026, 203,989 individual measures for heat generators were funded. The installation of heat pumps was particularly encouraged: 182,114 of these funding measures relate to heat pumps, corresponding to 89.28%. Biomass follows with 12,360 funding measures and 6.06%.

For the first half of 2026, the reporting of the BMWE thus shows high funding figures for individual measures, with a clear focus on heat pumps among the heat generators.

DEN-GRE-Congress in Kassel

https://www.geb-info.de/expertenwissen/den-gre-kongress-findet-am-23-24-september-kassel-s

The DEN-GRE Congress on "Energy Efficiency and Climate Change - Bridging Research and Practice" will take place in Kassel on September 23-24, 2026. The focus will be on concrete approaches for a climate-compatible future. The program includes lectures and a networking evening.

The congress connects research with everyday life. Solutions for a climate-compatible future are continuously being developed; they reach their full potential where science meets practical application.

This is where the congress steps in. Researchers and energy consultants will jointly explore what already works and what is needed for scientific approaches to find their way into everyday life. In addition to technical content, networks and practical feasibility will also be in the spotlight.

The consulting network brings together many professionals, particularly engineers and architects with extensive experience and diverse perspectives on building and energy transition. The congress provides an opportunity to personally meet these individuals, establish new contacts, explore potential collaborations, and exchange ideas with colleagues from the industry.

The event also provides current and research-relevant impulses from science. It opens up the possibility to look beyond one's own daily work, learn about the current state of the industry, and follow ongoing developments and progress.

The Society for Rational Energy Use (GRE) operates as the scientific department of the German Energy Advisors Network (DEN) and maintains research projects. It also illuminates scientific, technological, and political aspects of the energy consulting industry at the national and European level.

The congress is targeted at several professional groups, including energy consultants, specialized planners, engineers, scientists in the field of energy, architects, urban planners, and decision-makers from politics and practice.

Participation includes 12 teaching units. The congress is recognized with 12 teaching units in all three categories of the Energy Efficiency Experts List (EEE). The participation fee for external attendees is 380 euros plus VAT, or 452.20 euros gross. DEN members pay 323 euros plus VAT, or 384.37 euros gross. The fee for students is 100 euros plus VAT, or 119.00 euros gross.

Included in the price is access to the entire congress, as well as dinner and the evening event.

Efficiency conference: Climate-neutral building paths.

https://www.geb-info.de/denkmal-und-altbau/effizienz-tagung-wege-zum-klimaneutralen-bauen-

Efficiency Conference: Paths to Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation

09/16/2026

Energy and Environment Center at Deister

The 18th Efficiency Conference on Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation focuses on exchanging practical experiences and solutions for professional everyday life.

Under the motto "Getting to work. Now more than ever!" the 18th Efficiency Conference on Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation will bring together experts from architecture, energy consulting, trades, and sciences at the Hannover Congress Centrum on November 20 and 21, 2026.

Using concrete renovation and construction projects, central aspects of planning and implementation, such as optimized use of existing structures, monument protection, and costs will be discussed during the 18th Efficiency Conference on Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation. Additionally, insights into interconnected energy systems, heat pumps, and energy consulting in times of AI and political shifts will be provided.

The program of the 18th Efficiency Conference on Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation

The plenary lectures traditionally provide a broader perspective. Sebastian Herkel from the Fraunhofer Institute for Solar Energy Systems presents future scenarios for energy and heat supply. Dr. Ines Verspohl, a political scientist and director of the Social Climate Council, illustrates how the climate transformation can be designed in a socially acceptable manner. She incorporates the realities of life and the action spaces of households in Germany.

Interactive formats, such as a building physics workshop, allow for in-depth discussions on issues regarding internal insulation, new windows, and thermal bridges. Insights into practical implementation will be offered through a tour of the historic music college in Hannover, which has been undergoing renovation while still in operation for two years.

The 18th Efficiency Conference on Climate-Neutral Construction and Renovation invites builders from all over Germany to Hannover to share their practical experiences regarding energy-efficient renovations and energy and heat supply for buildings.

At the accompanying specialist exhibition, participants will receive a compact overview of products and services for energy-efficient and sustainable construction and renovation. Companies with suitable offerings are invited to present themselves to a knowledgeable audience. Apart from professional dialogue, there will be opportunities for networking at the evening event on Friday.

This industry meeting is organized by the Energy and Environment Center at Deister in collaboration with the Enercity Fund pro Klima from Hannover. The supporters and sponsors of the conference include the Hannover Region, Hannoverimpuls, the Climate Protection and Energy Agency Lower Saxony, and the company Pro Clima Moll ecological products.

The German Energy Agency (dena) recognizes participation with a total of seven teaching units for the extension of entries in the energy efficiency expert list.

Solar parks pose risk.

https://www.geb-info.de/solartechnik/solarparks-verband-warnt-vor-investitionsbremse

Solarparks: Association Warns of Investment Brake

The planned changes to the Renewable Energy Sources Act (EEG) and the grid regulations (“network package”) could significantly increase the construction costs of new solar parks and slow down

expansion nationwide. The Federal Association Solar Industry calls for a withdrawal of planned regulatory market barriers and cost drivers.

BSW-Solar estimates that the cost of electricity generation from new solar parks could increase by more than one cent per kilowatt-hour without improvements. Cost drivers include the planned partial elimination of compensation payments during temporary network bottlenecks, the intended limitation of feed-in capacity, planned grid fees for feeding solar power into the grid, and additional municipal charges.

Carsten Körnig, Managing Director of BSW-Solar, emphasizes: “Solar systems are a cost reducer of the energy transition. Burdening them with new charges and regulations does not make electricity cheaper; it makes it more expensive.”

The BSW-Solar urges members of the Bundestag to fundamentally revise the draft laws and to refrain from creating new market barriers. The maximum bid price in the solar park tenders is legally set at 5.9 cents per kilowatt-hour. Without adjustments, this value could become an insurmountable financing hurdle for the majority of future solar park projects. If the planned measures remain in place, BSW-Solar calls for an increase to 7.5 cents per kilowatt-hour to secure the expansion goals for photovoltaics and maintain sufficient competition in the EEG tenders.

Particularly problematic is the planned redispatch reservation. As a result, new solar parks in regions with frequent network bottlenecks could receive less favorable funding conditions. BSW-Solar fears that new solar parks may become economically unattractive in large parts of Germany.

Körnig warns: “It must not happen that temporary network bottlenecks practically lead to solar exclusion zones. Network problems must be solved through faster grid expansion, storage, and smarter usage of the networks – not by halting the construction of new solar parks.”

BSW-Solar also criticizes the proposed design of the Contracts for Difference (CfD) and cites feed-in grid fees as another burden. Both would noticeably increase the construction and operation costs of photovoltaic ground-mounted installations.

The economic conditions for new solar parks have already worsened. The BSW-Solar cites rising costs for grid connections, additional charges in individual federal states, and increasing revenue losses during periods of negative electricity prices. Körnig explains: “When multiple new burdens come down on projects simultaneously, previously viable solar parks can become unprofitable.” The association sees projects with EEG funding as well as solar parks selling their power directly on the market without funding being affected.

The expansion of so-called special solar installations is also at risk for BSW-Solar. This includes Agri-PV systems, which combine agriculture and solar electricity generation on the same area, as well as peatland PV, parking lot PV, and floating solar installations. BSW-Solar criticizes that the previous separate tender segment for these systems is to be eliminated. Instead, a bonus of 0.5 cents per

kilowatt-hour is planned for Agri-PV and peatland PV.

Körnig states: “The intended bonus is not sufficient for a broad market ramp-up of Agri-PV and peatland PV. At the same time, parking lot and floating solar installations would not be taken into account.” BSW-Solar therefore demands a separate bidding volume for such installations because of their construction, which generally results in higher costs than traditional solar parks. Without a dedicated volume, they would remain a niche application.

Balcony power plants grow fast.

https://www.geb-info.de/solartechnik/balkonkraftwerke-2026-markt-waechst-ueber-leistung-st

Balcony Solar Power Plants 2026: Growth Through Performance Rather Than Quantity

The German plug solar market will reach the mass market phase by 2026. While the number of new installations decreases, the average performance per system increases. The energy magazine has created a market report – here are the key results.

The German market for plug solar has reached the mass market phase – but the growth logic is shifting. According to the Balcony Power Plant Market Report 2026 from the energy magazine, the market will grow less through new installations and more through the installed performance per installation. The evaluation is based on 1,526,182 data sets from the market’s master data register (MaStR) and a supplementary, non-representative user survey with 25,000 participants (data status as of September 3, 2026).

Established Mass Market

As of the cut-off date, around 1.49 million installations are registered with the status “in operation” (valid operating number: 1,492,531), together providing around 1.619 GWp of operating capacity. Thus, plug solar is firmly established as a market segment – even if it accounted for only about 0.5 GW or 3.2% of the total solar additions in 2025 according to the Federal Network Agency.

Fewer New Installations but Larger Systems

The boom in quantities is flattening: from January to July 2026, around 11.5% fewer new installations were commissioned compared to the same period last year. At the same time, the newly installed module capacity increased by 1.9%, and the average capacity per new installation even rose by 15.2% (from 1,198 to 1,380 Wp). Nonetheless, over twelve full months (August 2025 to July 2026), 395,607 installations were added – roughly 1,084 per day.

Trends Relevant for Practice

The 2026 cohort presents a clear standard setup:

- 800 Watts are standard: 88.7% of the 2026 operating cohort are reported with exactly 800 W inverter capacity.

- Four modules surpass two: 49.3% of the 2026 installations have four modules; two-module systems make up 40.8%. Thus, four-module configurations replace the classic set for the first time.

- The overall median still lies at 2 modules; 207,672 units are reported exactly with 2,000 Wp.

Legal Framework (Overview)

- EEG Special Rules: up to 2,000 Wp of module capacity and a maximum of 800 VA inverter capacity at the same extraction point; MaStR registration is sufficient for free-of-charge acceptance.

- Product standard ≠ EEG: According to product standard, the module limit for household plugs (with defined protective measures) is at 960 Wp; up to 2,000 Wp, a special energy plug is required.

- Rental and WEG Law: Plug solar devices have counted as privileged structural changes since October 2024; approval may be necessary but cannot be refused without substantive reason.

Important for Consultation: The MaStR category is not a safety certificate. Manufacturer documents and the actual installation are decisive – this summary does not substitute legal or electrical specialist advice.

Regional Distribution

North Rhine-Westphalia leads in absolute numbers with 297,156 installations, followed by Bavaria (226,811) and Baden-Württemberg (200,296). Per capita, Lower Saxony leads with 23.7 installations per 1,000 inhabitants, ahead of Rhineland-Palatinate (22.3) and Brandenburg (21.1). Friesland is the leader among counties with 34.1 installations per 1,000 inhabitants.

Who Installs – and How

The (non-representative) user survey shows a pronounced do-it-yourself character: 95.1% install themselves or with assistance; only 4.9% hire a professional company. 86% own their homes; 73% live in single-family houses. The locations for installation predominantly include gardens/flat roofs (37.6%) over pitched roofs (19.0%) – hence the term “balcony power plant” is too limited in practical terms.

Classification / Data Boundaries

The MaStR is the best public market source

Retrofitting buildings quickly, efficiently.

https://www.geb-info.de/denkmal-und-altbau/herbstforum-altbau-2026-wie-der-gebaeudebestand

* Herbstforum Altbau 2026: How the building stock can be energetically modernized – and as quickly as possible

"Bringing the building sector to the finish line" and "Continue building instead of demolishing" – these are the titles of two lectures at this year's Autumn Forum for Old Buildings. The renowned specialist conference for experts in building renovation will take place on November 19, 2026, in Stuttgart – for the 28th time.

The trends in energetic building renovation are the focus of the Autumn Forum 2026. New: This year it is part of a double event organized by the KEA Climate Protection and Energy Agency of Baden-Württemberg (KEA-BW). The day before, on November 18, the focus will be on heating networks and renewable energies during "Compact Energy Transition." Both events will take place at the Sparkassenakademie near Stuttgart's main train station. Virtual participation is also possible at the Autumn Forum 2026. The conference will be complemented by an industry exhibition showcasing current products and trends related to energetic modernization. 1,000 participants from architecture, energy consulting, crafts, municipalities, and politics are expected.

"Advancing energetic renovation in the state"

"Decarbonizing our energy supply is not only an issue of climate protection and economic viability but also one of geopolitical security and independence," says Thekla Walker, Minister for Environment, Climate and Energy Management of Baden-Württemberg, in her greeting for the Autumn Forum. She will report on the state of climate protection in Baden-Württemberg and the new government’s goals in this regard. It is pointed out that Baden-Württemberg needs a significant increase in its renovation rate, and how this goal can be achieved will also be the topic of further lectures at the Autumn Forum.

"More speed in exiting fossil fuels, fewer demolitions"

The first speaker is Barbara Metz, the federal managing director of the German Environmental Aid (DUH). The DUH sharply criticizes the current building modernization law and warns against delaying the exit from fossil fuels. In her contribution "To the Point! Bringing the building sector to the finish line," Metz outlines why there should be no more time wasted in transforming the energy supply towards renewables. She calls for swift implementation of the possibilities already available to make buildings more efficient, resilient, and future-proof.

Architect Mariette Beyeler is the founder of the non-profit organization Metamorph House. In her contribution "Continue building instead of demolishing: How Switzerland is developing single-family homes," she explains how the single-family home stock can be qualitatively further developed and individually adapted with future-proof building concepts.

Jan Münster, a new member of the management of KEA-BW, summarizes the contents of "Compact Energy Transition" from the previous day and the insights gained there. The planned Bar Camp sessions focus on the expansion and further development of heating networks in conjunction with

renewable energies. It is becoming increasingly important for municipalities, energy suppliers, planners, and regional energy agencies to think integratively about and implement power and heating systems.

"Energy transition simply explained, renovation sprints, and serial renovations"

Concrete pathways out of the energy crisis into climate neutrality, from single-family homes to the economy, are shown by Professor Michael Sterner from the Institute for Energy Storage at the University of Regensburg. He clarifies how renewable electricity replaces fossil energy – especially in buildings – and how wind and solar can be made permanently and reliably available to sectors through networks, storage, and hydrogen, how the major transformation can be achieved cost-effectively, and why a change in awareness is needed.

Felix Schweikhardt and Thabo von Roman present highlights and the latest solutions regarding successful renovation sprints in Baden-Württemberg. Schweikhardt is the project manager for renovation sprints at Zukunft Altbau, while von Roman leads the energy consulting efforts there. The goal of renovation sprints is to demonstrate that energetic renovations do not necessarily have to be lengthy projects but can be implemented within 22 working days. This offers efficiency advantages for all involved, from the building owners to the contracting companies.

"Energy sprint – serial renovation with the local carpenter" – energy consultant Erol Ari has engaged in a local small-scale experiment with his agency EA2. When the terms "serial renovation" or "energy sprint" come up, most think of renovations on a large scale. However, Ari demonstrates, based on the example of a multi-family house renovation in Ostalb, that the concept can also be economically worthwhile for smaller projects and can be designed regionally efficiently. A Swabian energy sprint indeed.

"Guideline for Sustainable Building and EH-55 Heritage"

Speaker Dietmar Lenz is managing director of the Agency for Sustainable Building and also of LNB Guideline for Sustainable Building. The LNB is a building evaluation and planning system for sustainable construction, particularly developed for public building projects. Lenz showcases how municipalities can work with the guideline to successfully implement renovation projects sustainably based on a showcase of municipal building projects such as kindergartens, gymnasiums, and schools.

Architect Stefanie von Heeren reports directly from practice on how a heritage-protected half-timbered ensemble from the 17th century was renovated to become an efficiency house 55. Although ten years passed from planning to completion, von Heeren clearly shows, using an example project from Hanover, that flexibility in planning pays off. She addresses many diverse challenges that had to be overcome both in the planning and in the later construction phase.

"Challenge: Greenhouse Gas Neutrality by 2045"

With a furious finale in multiple respects, participants can expect from speaker Burkhardt Schulze Darup, a Berlin architect and urban planner, to round off the conference with his 50 years of experience in renovating existing buildings. His most valuable insights are conveyed under the provocative title: "Why for the building stock 2045 starts earlier than we would like."

UBM launches wood hybrid project.

https://www.geb-info.de/wohnungsbau/ubm-startet-vertrieb-fuer-holz-hybrid-projekt-charlie-

UBM begins sales for the wood-hybrid project Charlie in Munich-Altperlach

On the former research site of Kraft Foods and Mondelez, a residential quarter with 106 apartments is being developed. UBM combines preserved existing buildings with new buildings in wood-hybrid construction. Sales started in September 2026.

Where food researchers from Kraft Foods, later from Mondelez, once worked on chocolate creations, UBM Development Deutschland GmbH (UBM) is planning the project “Charlie - Sweet Living” in the south of Munich-Altperlach. For the wood-hybrid new building, UBM has achieved a legal reallocation. Thus, the project is among the first major office transformations in Munich.

Reallocation creates 106 apartments

“106 apartments with one to four rooms are planned, including compact apartments as well as larger family apartments and penthouses. Part of the existing buildings will be preserved and renovated, complemented by new buildings in wood-hybrid construction,” says Christian Berger, chairman of the management board at UBM Development Deutschland. He anticipates high demand due to the improved location: the Perlacher Forst is only 3.7 kilometers away, and from the upper floors, the view extends to the Alps. At the same time, the project contributes to closing a gap in the tense Munich housing market with the achieved reallocation.

Architects activate existing structures instead of replacing them

The project developer incorporates the industrial past of the area on Unterbiberger Straße into the new usage concept. The project name “Charlie” references the character from “Charlie and the Chocolate Factory” – symbolizing imagination, experimentation, and creative renewal. “The project can be described with the terms transformation, adaptive reuse, and addition. The goal was to further develop the existing buildings and activate their potentials instead of replacing them. By remodeling, expanding, and building new, new living space is created, while the history of the site remains discernible,” explains Florian Zielinski, architect at the Munich firm su und z Architekten, from whose design the project originates.

For his colleague Reinhard Unger, also an architect at su und z, it is a multi-layered process that his firm understands as a kind of palimpsest. “Like a medieval manuscript, where the original text was

scraped off and re-inscribed, we uncover layers and transform them into a new use without giving up the medium," he says.

Wood-hybrid construction combines core and surface

The partially planned object in wood-hybrid construction unites the advantages of different construction methods: a robust core ensures durability, while the warm, diffusion-open surfaces of the wooden structures create a pleasant indoor climate. "By combining old and new and the materials, a building is created that is sustainable, livable, and has grown," says Berger. "Wood is the building material of the 21st century. On one hand, because it ensures a healthy living and working environment. On the other hand, because it drives the construction and real estate industry forward – both in terms of efficiency and the necessary decarbonization."

The building fits into the historic town center of Altperlach in eastern Munich. The village character around the former village square is shaped by traditional houses, old tree structures, and the Hachinger Bach. "The positioning in a developed environment like Altperlach utilizes existing structures, neighborhoods, and infrastructures," says Zielinski.

Solar networks grow rapidly

https://www.geb-info.de/solartechnik/marktentwicklung-solarer-waermenetze-erreicht-75-anla

Market development of solar heating networks reaches 75 systems.

Germany counts a total of 75 solar heating networks in September 2026. The installed collector area stands at 339,203 square meters. To achieve the political goals for 2045, the annual expansion must increase significantly.

Solites has updated the market development of solar heating networks in Germany. The 75 systems in operation together reach 222 MW thermal output. The expansion over the past two years is distributed very unevenly across the number of systems and area.

Eleven systems go online in 2025.

In 2025, eleven systems with a total of 69,963 square meters of gross collector area and around 42 MW of capacity commenced operations. The largest one is located in Stralsund (Mecklenburg-Vorpommern) with 24,361 square meters of vacuum tube collectors, followed by Tübingen-Au (Baden-Württemberg, 12,000 square meters of vacuum tube collectors) and Bracht (Hessen, 11,637 square meters of flat collectors).

Other systems that went online include: Delitzsch (Saxony, 5,493 square meters of vacuum tube collectors), Föhr (Schleswig-Holstein, 3,076 square meters of flat collectors), Edingen (Mecklenburg-Vorpommern, 3,000 square meters of flat collectors), the parking roof in Regensburg (Bavaria, 2,937 square meters of vacuum tube and flat collectors), Wolmirstedt (Saxony-Anhalt, 2,400

square meters of vacuum tube collectors), Jungnau (Baden-Württemberg, 2,193 square meters of vacuum tube collectors), Dresden (Saxony, 2,000 square meters of vacuum tube collectors), and Renquishausen (Baden-Württemberg, 866 square meters of vacuum tube collectors).

Leipzig-Lausen shapes the year 2026.

In the ongoing year 2026, two systems commenced operations - with 67,094 square meters of gross collector area and also around 42 megawatts of capacity. The decisive factor is Germany’s largest solar thermal plant in Leipzig-Lausen (Saxony) with 65,208 square meters of vacuum tube collectors. Additionally, Waldalgesheim (Rhineland-Palatinate) has 1,886 square meters of vacuum tube collectors.

Two systems not only supply heating networks but also industrial processes: Bad Rappenau (28,871 square meters of flat collectors, in operation since 2024) and Dettenhausen (2,312 square meters of vacuum tube collectors, in operation since 2022). Thus, they partially belong to the solar process heat market segment.

Seven projects are in planning and construction.

Currently, seven more systems are being built. Steyerberg (Lower Saxony), Erkrath (North Rhine-Westphalia), and Lübeck (Schleswig-Holstein) will each have between 12,000 and 14,000 square meters of gross collector area. Amöneburg-Rüdigheim (Hessen) will come to around 5,500 square meters, Schönwald (Baden-Württemberg), Coswig (Saxony), and Neutraubling (Bavaria) each with just under 3,000 square meters. Together, they will add a further 52,727 square meters and approximately 32 MW capacity upon commissioning.

Concentrating solar thermal is currently lacking in Germany.

In addition to vacuum tube and flat collectors, solar heat can also be utilized through concentrating solar thermal technology, for instance, with parabolic trough collectors. In Turnhout, Belgium, Campina Energie cv operates a parabolic trough facility that provides temperatures up to 330 degrees Celsius for the location of Avery Dennison. A novel high-temperature concrete storage facility was also created on site.

Such systems can also provide process heat and district heating in Germany. The German joint venture ProSolNetz is examining the technology. Large concentrating systems for heating networks are currently not operating in Germany.

The study "Perspective of District Heating" by Prognos AG from June 2024 envisions 4 terawatt-hours per year from solar thermal energy in the German district heating mix by 2045. This covers only a fraction of the heating demand for heating networks, equivalent to around ten million square meters of gross collector area. To achieve this, approximately 50

Geothermiekongress 2026: 300+ Beiträge

https://www.geb-info.de/erneuerbare-energien/geothermiekongress-2026-programm-bietet-ueber

Geothermal Congress 2026: Program Offers Over 300 Contributions

From October 20 to 22, 2026, the national and international geothermal industry will meet at the Geothermal Congress 2026. In the Congress Hotel Potsdam, they will discuss current research findings, practical experiences, and new developments regarding the use of geothermal energy.

With over 300 contributions in 28 specialized forums and 14 workshops, as well as an extensive poster exhibition, the program for the Geothermal Congress 2026 is comprehensive. “We are pleased with the numerous high-quality submissions. We have noticed that geothermal energy storage, petrothermal systems, and even non-technical topics such as municipal heat planning and public acceptance are gaining importance,” says Professor Horst Rüter, who leads the scientific committee of the Congress. The large number of submissions underscores the dynamic development of the geothermal industry and the growing interest in innovative solutions for the heat and energy transition. Thus, the Geothermal Congress reinforces its development as a central platform for the professional exchange about geothermal energy.

The workshop day on October 20 will provide practical insights into numerous fields in 14 sessions. Topics will include drilling technical issues, the development of deep geothermal district heating projects, and assessing local potentials, as well as using shallow geothermal energy in conjunction with cold district heating networks, heat storage, district heating networks, planning software, and acceptance research.

On the two congress days, October 21 and 22, the diverse application possibilities of geothermal energy will be the focus in 28 specialized forums. The range extends from exploration, development, and drilling technology to EGS, geothermal waters, and lithium extraction, as well as shallow geothermal energy, covering topics like geothermal probes, planning, and system optimization. Other focuses will include municipal heat planning, heating networks and storage, modeling, and the legal and financial framework conditions. Submissions came from a total of 16 countries, including numerous contributions from Hungary, the partner country of the Geothermal Congress 2026.

The accompanying poster exhibition with the poster competition of the Science Bar offers particularly young scientists the opportunity to present their research and university theses to a broad professional audience at the Geothermal Congress. The best presentation will be awarded by the Federal Association of Geothermics.

In addition to the scientific program, the Geothermal Congress offers numerous opportunities for personal exchange - at the Icebreaker evening on Tuesday, October 20, as well as at the social evening with a boat trip on Wednesday, October 21.

Insights into the practical implementation of geothermal energy will also be provided through five excursions in Potsdam and the Berlin-Brandenburg region. Among other things, the first deep geothermal heating plant of the state capital Potsdam and the Potsdam Süd power plant will be visited. Additionally, a joint day trip organized by the energy supply companies Energie und Wasser Potsdam, BTB Blockheizkraftwerks-Träger- und Betreibergesellschaft Berlin, and the renowned research institution GFZ Helmholtz Center for Geosciences will take place, during which the real laboratory GeoSpeicherBerlin and the geothermal research platform Groß Schönebeck can be visited.

Birds in facade renovations.

https://www.geb-info.de/foerderung/gebaeudebrueter-der-fassadensanierung-mitdenken-artensc

Considering building nest areas for wall-nesting birds during facade renovations: Species protection as an eligible ancillary measure.

Roof and facade renovations can effectively combine energy efficiency and species protection. The guest contribution shows how nest and roost sites for wall-nesting birds can be preserved or newly created and considered as ancillary measures in the federal funding for efficient buildings.

Energy-efficient renovations not only provide the opportunity to reduce the energy consumption of buildings and thus protect the climate. They simultaneously create and secure habitats for species living in buildings (so-called wall-nesters). It is still little known that the preservation and creation of nesting sites for wall-nesting birds during a roof or facade renovation can be considered eligible ancillary measures through the Federal Funding for Efficient Buildings - Individual Measures (BEG EM).

Why it is important to consider wall-nesters during a renovation.

Wall-nesters today almost exclusively use voids, niches, and cracks in buildings as breeding or roost sites. Originally, many of these species inhabited tree cavities and cliffs. With the spread of human settlements, species that inhabit buildings, such as swifts, swallows, and sparrows, have taken advantage of these “artificial cliffs.” Most species of birds and bats living in buildings are characterized by a strong fidelity to their breeding or roost sites, meaning they use the same breeding or roost sites for several years to raise their young.

Such niches and void structures often get lost during energy-efficient renovations. This leads to a paradox: despite increasing construction activity, wall-nesters are finding fewer and fewer suitable breeding and roost sites, and their populations have been declining for years. This is because facade and roof insulation in existing buildings often seals these structures off without replacement, and modern new buildings provide little potential as habitats due to their smooth and climate-friendly construction methods.

Simple solutions without conflict with energy efficiency.

Species protection and energy efficiency can today be easily combined. Already in the planning phase of an energy renovation, suitable measures for protecting species inhabiting buildings can be considered. These include, for example, species-specific nesting and roost stones that can be integrated into thermal insulation composite systems without thermal bridges. The installation usually involves minimal additional effort and allows for the permanent preservation or creation of important breeding and roost opportunities.

Funding possibility through BEG EM.

The eligibility of such measures is particularly interesting for consultation practice. In the course of applying for an energy renovation via the BEG EM funding program, the preservation or new creation of nesting sites for wall-nesting birds can be included in the cost estimates as eligible ancillary measures. The main funding object remains the energy renovation. However, the costs for nesting aids can be included as eligible ancillary measures in the cost estimation and co-funded proportionally through the basic funding rate of 15 percent for individual measures. After the funding approval and completion of the renovation and creation of nesting opportunities, the incurred costs must be evidenced through corresponding invoices in the verification report.

Opportunity for energy consulting.

Energy advisors can bridge an important gap between climate and species protection. With the relevant knowledge, it is possible to not only show energy potentials in the context of consultation and application for funded roof and facade renovations but also to consider opportunities for preserving existing and creating new breeding and roost sites as eligible measures.

The result: Energy-efficient renovations not only increase energy efficiency and contribute to climate protection but also promote biodiversity in the settlement area. Especially in times of increasingly energy-efficient and structurally poorer buildings, this offers a simple yet effective opportunity to actively preserve and promote urban nature.

Perhaps this is the most beautiful realization: Energy-efficient renovations can achieve much more than just saving energy. They offer the opportunity to think of climate protection and species protection together and make our buildings habitats for humans and nature. Sustainable building is thus understood in a holistic way - for the climate, for biodiversity, and for livable cities of tomorrow.

Solar deal strengthens partnership.

https://www.geb-info.de/solartechnik/pv-installation-neu-gefasste-vereinbarung-staerkt-zus

PV Installation: Newly Revised Agreement Strengthens Collaboration

The updated PV agreement establishes binding standards for the installation of photovoltaic systems starting in 2026. With new trades, clear responsibilities, and coordinated qualifications, occupational

safety, quality, and efficiency will be further optimized.

Since 2024, a joint agreement has provided craft businesses with a reliable framework for safe, cross-trade collaboration in the installation of photovoltaic systems. Effective September 1, 2026, the agreement has been expanded to include the metalworking and carpentry trades. The Central Association of Sanitary, Heating, and Air Conditioning (Zentralverband Sanitär Heizung Klima), previously representing the plumbing trade, is now also included, covering installation and heating trades.

Supplemented Participation and Clear Objectives

The agreement is supported by the following associations and professional insurance associations:

- Professional Association of the Construction Industry

- Professional Association Energy, Textile, Electrical Media Products

- Professional Association Wood and Metal

- National Association of Metal

- Wood Construction Germany – Association of German Carpenters

- Central Association of German Electrical and Information Technology Trades

- Central Association of German Roofer Crafts

- Central Association of Sanitary, Heating, and Air Conditioning (ZVSHK)

The main goal is to increase safety during the installation of photovoltaic systems. Binding requirements have been defined for safe work on roofs, the use of work and safety scaffolding, and training requirements for an electrically instructed person, enabling skilled workers from non-electrical trades to perform specific electrical tasks under supervision.

Benefits for Customers and Craft Businesses

Customers benefit from a central contact person and a clearly coordinated service offering among the participating trades. Additional model subcontractor agreements regulate cooperation with electrical trade businesses, specifying that critical tasks, such as work on the AC side of the inverter or with other electrical components, may only be carried out by electrical specialists, complying with the Low Voltage Connection Ordinance.

Focus on Quality and Occupational Safety The extended agreement is committed to the highest standards in quality and occupational safety, offering clear guidance to businesses to utilize their skills effectively and optimize cross-trade collaboration.

Voices from Practice

Willi Seiger, President of the National Association of Metal: "The energy transition will only be successfully implemented in the trades when the involved trades pool their competencies sensibly and establish clear responsibilities at the same time. The newly revised association agreement creates a practical and reliable framework for this. For our metalworking companies, this means clearly defined qualifications and processes, reliable cooperation with the electrical craft, and, above all, a high level of safety for employees."

Peter Aicher, Chairman of Wood Construction Germany – Association of German Carpenters: "We are very pleased to be part of this agreement. This allows us to achieve quality and safety at the highest level. Building structures capable of generating electricity through solar energy fit perfectly with our renewable and CO2-binding raw material, wood."

Dirk Bollwerk, President of the Central Association of German Roofer Crafts: "With the expanded association agreement, we are sending a clear signal: The involved trades are working together across trades to reliably ensure occupational protection, safety, and quality in the installation of photovoltaic systems."

Stefan Ehinger, President of the Central Association of German Electrical and Information Technology Trades: "We can only manage the energy transition and the renovation of infrastructure across trades. At the same time, we need processes that ensure safety for our employees and customers. The electrical trades demonstrate their willingness to contribute to efficient processes with this agreement. The fact that the wood and metalworkers are now also joining a well-proven and recognized procedure by associations and professional insurance organizations underscores the importance of occupational safety and quality within our trades."

Michael Hilpert, President of the Central Association of Sanitary, Heating, and Air Conditioning: "Photovoltaics have long been part of modern building technology. Therefore, it is correct that SHK businesses can take on clearly defined tasks during installation. The agreement provides a reliable framework for this: with clear responsibilities, coordinated qualifications, and clear boundaries between the trades. This facilitates collaboration on the construction site and gives customers security."

Michael Kirsch, Managing Director of the Professional Association of the Construction Industry: "The energy transition is also changing the working world. For BG BAU, it is crucial that the safety and health of workers are considered from the outset. Especially during the installation of photovoltaic systems, qualifications, clear responsibilities, and effective prevention are essential. The association agreement is a good example of this: it combines the practical implementation of the energy transition with safe and healthy working conditions."

Jörg Botti, Managing Director of the Professional Association Energy, Textile, Electrical Media Products: "When electrical workers are severely injured during the installation of photovoltaic systems, it is almost always

Hydrogen key to energy.

https://www.geb-info.de/erneuerbare-energien/welche-rolle-wasserstoff-fuer-die-energiewend

Hydrogen allows for the long-term storage of renewable energies. It can be easily transported and stored long-term. For the decarbonization of the chemical industry, steelworks, and aviation, green hydrogen is indispensable. However, hydrogen will not play a role in building heating and car traffic. This is explained in the guest contribution.

Worldwide, the share of renewable energies is increasing rapidly. Along with this, the role of electric power in the energy system is growing: mobility and heat provision are increasingly becoming electric. But will our energy system be fully electrified? What role can hydrogen (H2) play in this?

Hydrogen is an extremely versatile energy carrier and chemical raw material. It can be used for power generation with gas turbines or fuel cells, as a raw material for ship or aircraft fuel, or in steelworks for the climate-neutral production of raw steel. Furthermore, hydrogen can directly be used for heat generation, especially when very high temperatures are required. Hydrogen is also an energy carrier that can be stored long-term without losses.

For the transport of hydrogen over distances under 4000 km, pipelines are recommended. For longer distances, shipping in the form of ammonia (NH3) is an alternative. Ammonia can directly be used for the production of fertilizers. Hydrogen is preferably stored in the form in which it is also transported. For long-term storage of large gas quantities, salt caverns can be utilized, where natural gas is already stored today. In smaller quantities, hydrogen is stored in pressure cylinders at 200 to 700 bars.

It should be noted that the colorless gas will only become a sensible component in the future energy system if it is entirely produced from renewable electricity. This is done using electrolyzers, today with efficiencies between 70 and 80 percent. The hydrogen produced this way is referred to as "green hydrogen." Currently available, "gray hydrogen" is produced from natural gas, with the resulting carbon dioxide released into the atmosphere. If it is captured and stored underground, it is called "blue hydrogen." Since technically achievable capture rates are between 80 and 85 percent, blue hydrogen is considered carbon-reduced but not carbon-free. There is a risk of lock-in effects with the development of production capacities for blue hydrogen, meaning a potential dead end. This could turn a proposed bridging technology into a problematic, long-term carbon dioxide-emitting technology.

Occasionally, the use of hydrogen for heat generation in buildings with an H2 boiler, which burns the heating material directly like a natural gas boiler, is discussed. Technically, this is possible. Some gas suppliers promote the idea that we could simply switch to hydrogen in the current natural gas network in the future. However, a comparison of overall efficiencies shows that the use of hydrogen in residential buildings is vastly inferior to heat pumps.

The combustion of hydrogen in H2 boilers achieves an overall efficiency of about 60 percent, meaning only 60 percent of a kilowatt-hour used for hydrogen production reaches as heat in buildings. At the

same time, heat pumps typically achieve an annual performance factor of 2.5 to 4, meaning one kilowatt-hour of electricity can produce up to four kilowatt-hours of heat. This means that providing heat through hydrogen requires four to six times more wind energy and photovoltaic systems compared to heating with heat pumps. Studies show that heating with hydrogen will become very expensive.

The centralized heat supply of households through heat networks can be a cost-effective alternative in densely populated neighborhoods. Here, hydrogen can play a role in heat provision as a supplement to other renewable heat sources: hydrogen will be used prospectively in combined heat and power (CHP).

Heat demands at temperatures up to 200 degrees Celsius can be technically covered by heat pumps. For temperature levels up to 1,000 degrees Celsius, electric high-temperature generators can be used. However, there are numerous industrial manufacturing processes that rely on flames and will therefore continue to need fuels. Here, there is no alternative to green hydrogen.

For many years, hydrogen was considered the energy carrier for long-distance transport. At least in road traffic, the dynamic development of battery technologies is increasingly leading to the adoption of electric drives, even in truck transport. Currently, the use of hydrogen in air and sea transport seems indispensable.

Already today, large quantities of hydrogen are consumed, mainly gray hydrogen. Germany's current hydrogen demand could be met through a pipeline with a diameter of one meter. To produce the corresponding amount of hydrogen, approximately 200 square kilometers of PV area and 3,000 wind turbines of the 5-megawatt class are required. For the projected demand in 2045, the numbers should be multiplied by a factor of ten. The expansion of hydrogen production capacities is currently globally proceeding much slower than desired.

The production costs of hydrogen from the

Serial renovation cuts emissions.

https://www.geb-info.de/gebaeudekonzepte/serielle-sanierung-reduziert-emissionen-um-bis-zu

A dena study for the first time compares the life cycle analysis of serial and conventional renovations. It shows that serial renovations can significantly reduce greenhouse gas emissions and store carbon.

The German Energy Agency (dena) highlights the climate protection potential of serial renovations in a new study from the Competence Center for Serial Renovation. The study conducted a life cycle analysis (LCA) comparing the greenhouse gas emissions and carbon storage capacity of serial and conventional renovation methods. The results show that serial renovations can significantly reduce the total greenhouse gas emissions of residential buildings over their life cycle.

Methodology and Results of the Analysis

The study commissioned by dena, carried out by weber brunner pischetsrieder architektur and FrieNa – Friedel Sustainability Consulting in cooperation with TAG Immobilien AG, examined the climate impact of renovations over a period of 50 years. Two unrenovated multi-family houses built in 1962 (energy efficiency class F) in Salzgitter served as model projects. In 2026, these will be serially renovated with prefabricated wooden frame elements to achieve the efficiency house standard EH 55.

Three scenarios were analyzed: unrenovated, conventionally renovated, and serially renovated. A material-optimized serial variant with re-use was also considered. Compared to the unrenovated condition, the conventional renovation reduced greenhouse gas emissions by approximately 74%. The serial renovation achieved about 79%, and the material-optimized serial variant with re-use achieved around 81%. The main reasons for these reductions are lower emissions during the construction phase and reduced heat losses. The targeted use of renewable raw materials (NaWaRo) and re-use materials further improves the climate balance. In the examined model project, the serial renovation saved approximately 3000 tons of CO2 equivalents compared to the unrenovated building.

Role of TGA and Sustainable Materials

The study emphasizes that besides energy efficiency, the choice of materials, construction methods, TGA, and energy supply are crucial for the climate impact of a building. The effort for renovation and technical expansion already pays off energetically within the first two to three years due to the significant reduction in operational energy. The chosen energy mix has a decisive influence on the emissions balance. Therefore, building envelopes, TGA, and energy supply should be considered together for effective decarbonization.

Additionally, there is potential in combining renewable raw materials and re-use materials that can make buildings carbon sinks. Carbon from renewable raw materials will be long-term bound in components if a release at the end of life is avoided. Prefabricated components and detachable mechanical connections in serial renovation create good conditions for the later reuse of components and materials.

Recommendations for Action

Based on the study results, the housing industry and investors should prioritize serial renovations with bio-based materials and integrate circular principles into tenders. Politics and municipalities can improve the framework for climate-friendly renovations through appropriate funding conditions, for example, by considering carbon storage in funding and easing approvals for ecological materials. The life cycle analysis also shows that serial renovation can meet the requirements of the Quality Seal for Sustainable Buildings (QNG), making the use of the NH class an attractive funding incentive.

Buildings need flexible energy now.

https://www.geb-info.de/elektrotechnik/flexible-energieverteilung-warum-gebaeude-heute-auf

Flexible Energy Distribution: Why Buildings Need to be Prepared for Future Requirements

09.09.2026

The electrical infrastructure in buildings should not be exclusively designed for current needs but must also consider future performance and communication requirements.

The electrification of heating, mobility, and building technology fundamentally changes the requirements for electrical infrastructure. Energy distribution is thus becoming an increasingly strategic component of building planning.

Buildings are evolving from mere energy consumers to active participants in the energy system. Photovoltaic systems generate electricity locally, battery storage shifts loads temporally, heat pumps increase electrical connection capacity, and charging infrastructure for electric vehicles creates additional, sometimes highly dynamic loads.

This changes both the load profiles and the requirements for energy distribution within buildings. While electrical infrastructure was often designed for relatively constant consumption structures in the past, significantly more complex energy flows are emerging today. At the same time, the demands for transparency, controllability, and expandability of the systems are increasing.

New Requirements Due to Electrification

Particularly in residential and commercial buildings, it is increasingly apparent that the classic design based on a static peak load scenario is reaching its limits. The growing electrification means that electrical power in buildings must be more readily available, controllable, and flexibly distributable in the future.

Examples include:

- Charging infrastructure in underground garages and parking spaces

- Heat pump systems with high electrical power shares

- Decentralized energy generation through photovoltaics

- Battery storage and energy management systems

- Cross-sector control of heating, mobility, and electricity consumption

Regulatory developments such as grid-supporting control concepts, dynamic electricity tariffs, or requirements for load management according to §14a EnWG are also contributing to the increasing importance of the ability to intelligently control electrical loads. Energy distribution will thus no longer be merely a passive infrastructure but rather the technical foundation of flexible building operations.

Planning Must Consider Expandability

The ability of a building to integrate additional electrical consumers or decentralized energy generation is increasingly becoming a critical factor.

Buildings are typically used for several decades. Technical systems and usage requirements, on the other hand, often change within a few years. In many existing and new construction projects, it is already evident today that unplanned charging points, additional photovoltaic capacity, or later storage solutions can only be integrated at significant effort. Limited reserves in sub-distributions, a lack of space capacities, or inadequately sized riser zones severely hamper later expansions.

For planning, this means: Electrical infrastructure should not only be designed for current needs but also take future performance and communication requirements into account. This includes, among others:

- Power reserves in main and sub-distributions

- Scalable switchgear concepts

- Sufficiently sized cable trays and riser zones

- Space reserves for additional protection and control equipment

- Structured measurement and communication infrastructure

- Prepared interfaces for energy management systems

Particularly relevant will be the coordinated consideration of generation, storage, consumption, and control. Only when these systems are planned together at an early stage can later usage conflicts and costly renovations be avoided.

Energy Distribution Becomes an Evaluation Factor

With increasing electrification, the economic significance of electrical infrastructure is also changing. A building’s ability to integrate additional electrical consumers or decentralized energy generation is increasingly becoming a factor for:

- Operating costs

- Modernization capability

- ESG evaluation

- Taxonomy compliance

- Long-term usability of properties

A flexible infrastructure can help implement technical adjustments during ongoing operations more easily and reduce investment risks over the life cycle of a building. Particularly in the context of rising

demands for decarbonization and energy efficiency, energy distribution thus becomes a central component of sustainable building planning.

Conclusion

The transformation of the building sector affects not only individual technologies such as heat pumps or charging points. It changes the fundamental requirements for electrical infrastructure. Future-proof buildings require energy distribution systems that not only serve current loads but can also integrate future developments. Flexible and expandable infrastructure thus becomes an essential prerequisite for economically, technically, and energetically sustainable buildings.

GlasWelt

Housing construction permits rise.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/destatis-baugenehmigungen-im-wohnungsneubau-steigen-um-135

Destatis: Building permits for new residential buildings increase by 13.5%

09/18/2026

Residential construction is on the rise in 2026: From January to July, the number of approved apartments in residential buildings increased by 13.5%. However, growth is slowing down; in July 2026, building permits for apartments showed an increase of only 1.9% compared to the same month last year.

The Federal Statistical Office (Destatis) reports a total of 22,500 approved apartments in Germany for July 2026. This marks an increase of 1.9% or 400 more than in July 2025. Over the first seven months of the year, the number of permits is also above last year's figures. Destatis differentiates between new constructions and apartments resulting from renovations of existing buildings.

Slight Increase in July

In July 2026, authorities approved 18,400 new apartments. Compared to the same month last year, this represents an increase of 0.8% or 100 apartments. For apartments created through renovations of existing buildings, Destatis recorded 4,100 approvals—7.0% or 300 more than in July 2025. Destatis also points out a statistical effect: building permits often do not enter the statistics in the month of approval. Subsequent reports from building authorities are frequently recorded later.

Overall Number Increases Since Year Start

From January to July 2026, authorities granted permits for 148,800 apartments in both new and existing buildings. Compared to the same period in 2025, this amounts to an increase of 12.9% (17,000 apartments). The total includes apartments in new buildings as well as those created through renovations in existing residential and non-residential buildings.

Residential Buildings Drive the Upward Trend

In newly constructed residential buildings, building supervision authorities approved a total of 121,200 apartments in the first seven months of 2026. This is 13.5% or 14,400 more than in the same period last year. For single-family homes, authorities approved 27,900 apartments, which is 9.7% (2,500) more than in the same period of 2025.

Duplex homes increased to 8,900 apartments, which corresponds to a rise of 25.0% or 1,800 apartments. In multi-family homes, the most numerous type of buildings, building supervision authorities approved 79,700 new apartments—15.1% or 10,500 more than in the same period the

previous year. In the dormitory sector, the number of approved apartments decreased by 6.2% or 300 to 4,700.

Non-residential Buildings and Renovations Increase the Numbers

In new non-residential buildings, a total of 2,700 apartments were approved from January to July 2026. This represents an increase of 25.0% or 500 more than in the same period last year. Destatis counts, for example, caretaker apartments in school buildings or apartments located above commercial areas in city centers. As a renovation measure in existing residential and non-residential buildings, authorities granted approval for 24,900 apartments, which is an 8.9% or 2,000 increase compared to the first seven months of 2025. The upward trend in new residential buildings continues until July 2026.

Roto celebrates 30 years.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/jubilaeum-30-jahre-roto-produktion-loevo

Anniversary: 30 Years of Roto Production in Löv■

Roto has been producing in Löv■, Hungary for 30 years. From the newly established plant, one of the most important manufacturing sites of Roto Frank Window and Door Technology GmbH has developed. Today, hardware solutions for windows and window doors are produced there for worldwide use.

Löv■ will celebrate its 30th anniversary in 2026. Today, the Hungarian site is part of the international production network of Roto Frank Window and Door Technology GmbH, representing high manufacturing competence and efficient production processes.

The 30th anniversary was celebrated by Roto together with its employees. The next step will take place on January 1, 2027, when the previously separate companies of the production sites in Löv■ and galvanization in Sopron will be merged under Roto Elzett Certa Kft. Further investments in galvanization are planned. In early 2025, Roto took over the remaining shares of the joint venture partner in galvanization in Sopron and has since owned the company completely.

The galvanization in Sopron is a central element of Roto’s production chain and provides surface finishes for the components produced in Löv■. The galvanization has been an important part of the production chain for decades: there, the components produced in Löv■ receive their surface finishes. Through closer organizational integration, the processes along the value chain are to be further improved, synergies utilized, and the future viability of both sites strengthened. In addition, a comprehensive development program will further strengthen the galvanization.

With a joint anniversary celebration, the employees in Löv■ looked back at a successful Roto production history in Hungary.

Quality and Delivery Capability Secured in the Long Term

For window and door manufacturers, this means even greater process safety: short communication paths, joint investments, and the bundling of competencies contribute to ensuring the quality of the hardware solutions and long-term delivery reliability. Customers benefit from a strong production network that will continue to respond reliably and flexibly to market demands in the future. The planned investments in galvanization further strengthen capacities and establish the basis for stable supply to international markets.

Marcus Sander, CEO of Roto Window and Door Technology, emphasizes the importance of the Hungarian site in Löv■ as a key component of Roto's global production and sales network.

Löv■ is growing into a Competence Center

The history of Roto in Hungary began in 1991 with the participation in the privatization of the Sopron site. In 1996, the production site in Löv■ was established. Since then, a factory complex has developed from a production area of approximately 15,000 square meters on nearly 140,000 square meters of total operating area. Today, the production, storage, and administrative buildings cover 31,500 square meters.

For site manager Ern■ Kocsis, the employees are the most important success factor of the Roto plant in Löv■. Many of them have accompanied the site for decades.

The core competencies in Löv■ include stamping, assembly, and toolmaking. Hardware for tilt-turn, turn, and tilt windows, sliding systems, and components for roof windows are produced. Surface treatment in Sopron complements this production chain. Thus, Roto connects both sites in a seamless value chain for supplying window and door manufacturers.

Roto Celebrates Three Milestones

Marcus Sander, CEO of Roto Window and Door Technology, emphasizes: "We are celebrating three special milestones in Hungary: 35 years of Roto in Hungary, 30 years of production in Löv■, and 25 years of the sales company. This development would not have been possible without the dedicated work of our employees. Löv■ is an important building block of our global production and sales network." Roto includes 18 production plants, 31 logistics distribution centers, and over 30 worldwide sales offices.

Löv■ site manager Ern■ Kocsis adds: "Our success is based on the people who work here. Many colleagues have been with the site for decades, and in some cases, multiple generations of a family work at Roto. This strong sense of community, high professional competence, and willingness to actively shape change have characterized our site for many years and form a crucial foundation for its successful development.

Robots control access now.

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/dormakaba-pilotprojekt-roboter-fuer-zugangskontrollen

dormakaba: Pilot Project – Robots for Access Control

The three companies dormakaba, ANYbotics AG, and LEGIC Identsystems AG tested a robot at access control points. This robot requests entry digitally and checks permissions. The pilot project took place at the Whitegate power plant under real operational conditions.

dormakaba, ANYbotics AG (ANYbotics), and LEGIC Identsystems AG (LEGIC) tested a joint pilot project at the Whitegate power plant of GE Vernova in Ireland: they are introducing the solution at LEGIC connect26 in Zurich. The purpose of the project is to incorporate autonomous robots into existing access-controlled environments.

Pilot Trial Connects Robotics with Access Rules

The pilot trial demonstrates the interplay between robotics and digital identity as well as access management in an industrial environment. The “ANYmal” robot from ANYbotics uses a secure digital access credential and requests access to controlled areas. The access management and door automation from dormakaba apply the same access rules as for authorized personnel. This allows the robot to pass through doors without manual intervention.

Till Reuter, CEO of dormakaba, explains: “Autonomous robots are increasingly becoming part of the workforce in industrial environments. Just like humans, they need reliable and secure access to the areas where they perform their tasks. Together with our partners, we demonstrate how our access management enables robots to move safely and autonomously through controlled environments while access remains fully under the operator's control.”

Autonomous Inspections Reduce Deployments in Hazardous Areas

Industrial facilities are increasingly using autonomous mobile robots for inspection and monitoring tasks. They perform recurring tasks, collect data, and identify potential issues. At the same time, the need to send humans into potentially hazardous areas is decreasing. However, access-controlled doors can be a barrier for autonomous machines. The pilot project assigns the robot a secure digital identity and integrates it into existing access processes.

Whitegate Tests Operations in Practice

The “ANYmal” robot electronically requests access, the access management system checks predefined permissions and decides whether the door opens.

The pilot project took place at the Whitegate power plant in County Cork under real operating conditions. The ANYmal robot has been in operation there for several weeks: it repeatedly requests access, passes through access-controlled doors, and continues its inspection routes.

Péter Fankhauser, co-founder and CEO of ANYbotics, explains: The effect can be measured by how many critical installations our robots check, how often, and how reliably. Every access-controlled door represented a hard limit for this coverage. With dormakaba and LEGIC, ANYmal now has reliable access credentials managed within the plant's access control system and moves like any authorized employee through these doors - under the same rules and with the same verification protocol. The pilot trial has proven this in live operations, and we will now make this feature available as an add-on for the entire ANYmal fleet."

Companies Explore Further Applications

LEGIC connect26 brings technology and industry experts together to discuss the future of digital identity, secure access, and connected security infrastructure. At the same time, dormakaba, ANYbotics, and LEGIC are working to bring the solution to market. They are exploring further application possibilities, including access to elevators, locks, and turnstiles.

David Fuller, Chief Innovation Officer of dormakaba, summarizes: "The joint pilot project illustrates how access solutions evolve beyond traditional applications for human users. Through the secure authentication and authorization of autonomous machines, access management can become a significant enabler for the next generation of industrial automation."

4JET Group becomes 4JET GmbH

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/die-4jet-gruppe-fusioniert-zur-4jet-gmbh

The 4JET Group merges into 4JET GmbH

4JET is reorganizing its legal structure: four companies are becoming 4JET GmbH. Additionally, the company is consolidating glass processing in Alsdorf.

In August and September 2026, 4JET merged its previous companies 4JET Technologies GmbH, 4JET microtech GmbH, 4JET systech GmbH, and 4JET Holding GmbH into a single enterprise. The newly merged company will now be known as 4JET GmbH.

The merger and renaming were executed with entries in the commercial register. Economically, these steps take effect retroactively from January 1, 2026. By simplifying the legal structure of its corporate group, 4JET is reducing administrative expenses and optimizing internal processes.

Glass processing in Alsdorf will be consolidated: At the same time, 4JET is finalizing the integration of Corning Laser Technologies, which was acquired in 2025. Future activities in glass processing will be consolidated at the headquarters in Alsdorf near Aachen. The previous site in Krailling will close at the end of 2026.

Contracts automatically transfer to 4JET GmbH

For customers, partners, and suppliers, there will be no changes in collaboration since this is purely an internal corporate restructuring. All contracts, orders, offers, warranties, licenses, and other agreements with the previous companies will remain unchanged. They will automatically transfer to 4JET GmbH under statutory succession (§ 20 Transformation Act). A renewal or confirmation of existing contracts is not required.

Thin glass ISO series.

https://www.glaswelt.de/iso-aus-duennglas/skinny-triples-edgetech-und-forel-machen-duenngl

Skinny Triples: Edgetech and Forel make thin glass-ISO an economical standard product

More energy efficiency with as little weight as possible and slim glass structures is one of the central tasks in the insulating glass industry. Until now, technical hurdles, high investment costs, and the need for new manufacturing technology have hindered the widespread implementation of triple insulating glass units with a significantly thinner middle pane. Edgetech and Forel have developed an optimal solution for this: the so-called Skinny Triples can be produced after an equipment update on existing fully automated lines.

Thin glass opens new opportunities in the renovation market.

Processors can continue to use tried and tested profile systems, conventional soda-lime glass, common sealing solutions, and the Super Spacer® spacer system without the need for millions in investments.

This also opens up the growing renovation market for them. When replacing windows, the available installation space is often tight, for example, due to existing frame profiles or listed window casings. This is where Skinny Triples show their strengths: they can usually be installed without major structural adjustments in places where conventional triple glazing is simply too thick.

The flexible foam matrix of the Super Spacer® guarantees precise and efficient application.

The flexibility of the Super Spacer® is in every respect the trump card in processing on an insulating glass line, whether Skinny Triples or conventional double and triple glazing. Unlike rigid hollow profiles that need to be cut, bent, assembled into frames, and filled with desiccant, the Super Spacer® comes as a prefabricated silicone foam already equipped with desiccant, directly from the roll, and is applied immediately to the glass. There is also no need for separate butylizing.

Since the middle pane is thinner than the two outer panes, manufacturing places high demands on process accuracy. The flexible silicone structural foam allows for precise positioning and exact corners with tolerances significantly below one millimeter. The spacer applicator of the Forel system ensures additional speed with automatic roll change and corner closure, while a specially configured coupling press assembles the triple unit with just one cavity, so sealing is also done in one pass.

The moisture-permeable foam matrix of the Super Spacer® also ensures that the factory-integrated desiccant quickly adsorbs moisture, in conjunction with primary and secondary seals forming the basis for long-term water vapor and gas tightness and high energy performance.

Visit the window collection center.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/lichtblicke-aus-der-vergangenheit-zu-besuch-im-villum-wind

Light glimpses from the past

Visiting the VILLUM Window Collection Centre

A Roman drinking glass, a panel from the Sainte-Chapelle, a prison window from 1895, and a vacuum pane that recently came onto the market in the UK: the VKR Holding Museum in Copenhagen tells the story of the window – in such a way that one doesn't want to leave after several hours.

At the very beginning, there is a real Roman drinking glass in the showcase. And it is greenish. “The Romans had no access to manganese, so they couldn’t decolorize the glass,” explains Troels Rasmussen, who should know because he is a historian and Head of Company History at VKR Group. Iron oxide in the raw material then gives rise to the green tint. The Roman window glass shown next to it is a copy, but the color matches the original: translucent, not transparent. Light came in, but there was no view – one immediately understands what early glass was supposed to achieve and what it was not.

The myth of flowing glass

This unique museum also displays a reduced copy of a real church window. Troels Rasmussen would have preferred a complete copy, but that was not feasible. The economics behind it are interesting: In the so-called “crown glass” or cylinder-blown process, the panes were cut from a blown glass disc. The pieces were not equally valuable – the one shown here belonged to the cheaper cuts, while the most expensive came from another part of the disc. And because this glass was unevenly thick, thicker at one end than the other, the story persists that glass is a liquid and flows downward over the centuries. It is not. It never was.

Sainte-Chapelle: Light as proof of God

We have finally arrived in the most beautiful room of the exhibition. Here hangs a faithful copy of a panel from the Paris Sainte-Chapelle. The foundations of the house supported the restoration of the glazing there between 2008 and 2014; the CEO of Velux France then asked the French glassmakers for a copy. They got it; such a thing is rarely found in a museum. Less the window is shown than its effect: sunlight filtered through colored glass, in the church space. “That’s how you connected with God. That is God’s light.”

1638, borrowed and never reclaimed

The oldest original window of the house dates back to 1638 and comes from the Danish-German border area. The characteristic elaborations can be found in North Schleswig and Friesland, in the marshland. It does not actually belong to the museum, but to the Danish National Museum; the loan agreement is continuously renewed.

An observation I had not known before: Old Dutch documents record that window frames and glass were so expensive that they were not necessarily part of the house. “If the new owner did not want to pay enough, they would remove the frames and take them to the next house,” says Rasmussen. Similar occurrences are said to have happened in Germany and Switzerland.

Baroque: Selfie in the mirror hall

For the Baroque period, the museum lacked a suitable idea for a long time. It was found in metro trains in Paris, whose design quoted the mirror hall of Versailles. Exactly this is now here – with a bit of luck, you can get a passable selfie beneath it. Above all, however, the room explains in seconds what large 17th-century windows combined with mirrors do to the light.

Then a classicist window, built in the 1850s – already late for the style period. “Many window types continued for another 50 years after they fell out of tradition.” It is a remarkably well-designed window: ample light, evenly distributed, yet still a very intimate lighting mood. This is due to the glazing bars, which are shaped in such a way that they scatter the light. A type of window that remained influential from the 18th to the 19th century.

Next to the difference that is not discussed enough in Germany: In Denmark, the window sits flush with the facade outside. In Germany, it lies in the reveal center, with an outer windowsill in front of it. Scandinavia and the British Isles do it one way, the continent the other.

Jacques Gruber and the call from Le Figaro

A few steps away stands one of the pieces of the house that I fell in love with: an Art Nouveau window from France, probably from Paris. Little is known about its origin – but everything about its creator: Jacques Gruber, one of France's most famous glass artists. “For our 75th anniversary, Le Figaro was here for an interview,” he tells. “When the journalists saw the window, they were so impressed that they only wanted to know one thing: What did you

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K■ty challenges Italian Metra.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/grupa-kety-aluprof-greift-nach-italienischem-aluminium-rie

Grupa K■ty has signed an agreement to acquire the Italian Metra Group, an aluminum profile manufacturer with an annual capacity of 145,000 tons and facilities in Italy, the USA, and Canada. The €450 million deal allows the Polish company, which includes the brand Aluprof, to enter the North American market.

Grupa K■ty S.A. has signed a conditional agreement to acquire 100% of the shares of Fengari Holdings I B.V., the owner of the Metra Group. The transaction is considered a key step in implementing Grupa K■ty's development strategy and strengthens its ambitions to build one of the leading international groups in the aluminum sector.

The Metra Group, which includes the Italian Metra – Metallurgica Trafilati Alluminio S.p.A. headquartered in Rodengo-Saiano, operates nine production plants in Italy, the USA, and Canada and employs almost 1,400 people. The total capacity for aluminum extrusion is about 145,000 tons per year, with approximately 35% in Europe.

The Metra Group is a globally operating, vertically integrated manufacturer of aluminum profiles, including solutions for the rail sector and architectural systems, as well as a provider of high value-added services such as painting, anodizing, machining, and welding. The revenue of the Metra Group is estimated to be around €600 million for 2026, with EBITDA (excluding one-time events and transaction costs) of approximately €90 million.

Aluprof is an important part of the acquisition strategy.

Grupa K■ty is a publicly listed Polish group with several brands, including the well-known window system manufacturer Aluprof, the packaging specialist Alupol Packaging, and the company Selt. Aluprof, as one of the leading European providers of aluminum window systems, could particularly benefit from the Metra acquisition through expanded production capacities and access to new markets.

The planned acquisition aligns with Grupa K■ty's long-term development strategy, which aims to build an internationally operating organization with a strong position in Europe, particularly in the construction and industrial sectors. The transaction also opens up new expansion opportunities in North America, where 45% of Metra Group's revenues are generated.

From a strategic perspective, the transaction is expected to significantly strengthen Grupa K■ty's position in the European market and provide access to expertise and capabilities in high-margin segments, including rail products and new distribution channels in the Italian market. Furthermore, it aims to leverage Metra's international position in the architectural market to expand operations in North America.

"We highly appreciate the development of the Metra Group in recent years and the results achieved through measures implemented by KPS Capital Partners in cooperation with Metra's management. The company has successfully strengthened its position as an international provider of highest quality solutions in aluminum extrusion by combining advanced engineering know-how with operational and manufacturing competencies as well as experience in serving demanding and rapidly growing market segments," emphasizes Roman Przybylski, CEO of Grupa K■ty S.A. "We believe that the merger of the potential of both organizations will open a new chapter in the company's development and create additional opportunities to generate value for customers, employees, shareholders, and business

partners.”

The purchase price has been determined based on a company valuation of €645 million, minus bank debts and other liabilities as of March 31, 2026. The closing of the transaction is subject to the fulfillment of usual preconditions, including obtaining required antitrust and regulatory approvals. Grupa K■ty plans to finance the transaction through bank loans and equity. To this end, the company signed a term loan agreement for up to two billion zloty with Bank Polska Kasa Opieki S.A. on September 14, 2026.

According to the current assessment of the board, the transaction is not expected to have a significant impact on the existing dividend policy.

Fenster days move location.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/fachtagung-bad-wildunger-fenstertage-ziehen-die-wandelhall

Conference: Bad Wildunger Fenstertage Moves to the Wandelhalle

The conference combines exhibition, lectures, and catering at a new location: the Wandelhalle Bad Wildungen. The program addresses topics of law, standards, and digitalization.

The Association of Life Space Design Hessen/Rhineland-Palatinate invites participants to the Bad Wildunger Fenstertage on October 15 and 16, 2026. This year, the event will be held at the Wandelhalle Bad Wildungen, after several editions at the premises of the Wood Technical School Bad Wildungen. Attendees are expected to include owners and leaders from window manufacturing companies from Hesse, Rhineland-Palatinate, and the entire federal territory.

Wandelhalle Combines Exhibition and Lectures

The Wandelhalle is located in the approximately 50-hectare spa park of Bad Wildungen. The professional exhibition will be set up in the glass-covered corridors along the atrium and the spa park. The lecture hall, catering, and exhibition areas will be located close to each other. Standing tables between the booths and longer breaks in the program will create space for discussions between manufacturers, service providers, and companies.

Program Addresses Law, Standards, and AI

Stefan Höhn from the association and Marko Prentzel, chairman of the window and façade construction committee, will open the conference. The welcoming lecture will be given by Holger Dirks, editor-in-chief of the professional journal GFF.

In a live podcast, publicly appointed and sworn expert Dipl.-Ing. Peter Ertelt and lawyer Dr. jur. Hans-Michael Dimanski will address typical defect cases in windows and doors.

Further professional lectures will cover several topics. Martin Harder from GEZE will talk about pivot doors and innovations regarding DIN 18040 on barrier-free construction. Stefan Höchsmann, managing director of Höchsmann Maschinen, will discuss pitfalls when handling machinery in case of a business closure. Lara Santjer from Forterro will address the role artificial intelligence can play in craftsmanship. Jürgen Huber from BISS ID and Martin Stöger from Remmers will present ID4WIN, a sector solution for the digital product passport that will be implemented in line with the new construction product regulation.

The closing session on Friday afternoon will be led by Dr. Sven Ricks with the impulse lecture "People Are Like Wood." A craftsman evening will round off the first day of the event at the Maritim Hotel Bad Wildungen.

Important Information at a Glance

Participation costs 255.00 euros for members. From the second participant from a member company, the cost will be 235.00 euros. For non-member participants, the fee is 320.00 euros. The association will process registrations on a first-come, first-served basis. A limited number of hotel rooms at reduced prices has been pre-reserved in several hotels in Bad Wildungen under the keyword "Fenstertage 2026." Booking is done directly with the hotel.

NFF grows to 250.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/nff-wird-mit-250-teilnehmern-zur-festen-groesse-im-norden

NFF becomes a permanent fixture in the North

Sold out, oversold: The NFF in Brockel has developed into the most important industry meeting in the North. 250 participants informed themselves at 30 exhibitors about innovations in the window and façade industry. The enthusiasm can be seen in the advance bookings for 2027: already a quarter of the visitor places are booked.

The third North Meeting - Window Facade (NFF) in Brockel has again exceeded all expectations: 250 visitors – of which 45% were processors – informed themselves at 30 exhibitors about innovations and developments in the industry. The initiators Björn Schröder and Marc Nickel already announced the next date for September 10, 2027.

The NFF’s recipe for success lies in its direct, uncomplicated approach. Both for exhibitors and visitors.

As an exhibitor, one has the costs directly in view, and the organizers ensure transparency.

The visitor appreciates the successful networking opportunities and the overview of 30 companies presented here.

Specialist lectures provide relevant input

Criminal and intelligence analyst Dr. Mark T. Hofmann impressively demonstrated the real danger of cybercrime for companies in the industry.

Two specialist lectures rounded out the program: Criminal and intelligence analyst Dr. Mark T. Hofmann impressively demonstrated the real danger of cybercrime for companies in the industry. Frank Lange, managing director of the Window + Facade Association (VFF), provided an interim update on the current market situation: new construction has started again, but private renovation remains weak. After a sideways movement last year, the association forecasts a growth in the window market of 3.1%.

Processors show enthusiasm

The response from processors was overwhelmingly positive. Thomas and Marcus Lütje from FenTech GmbH in Wernigerode participated for the first time: "We will come back," they already confirmed for 2027. The reason: "The event is a great opportunity to gather information from suppliers. But the lectures also provided the right input."

Stephanie Hövel, head of purchasing at Heinrich Meyer-Werke Breloh, stated on LinkedIn: "I meet all my contacts from purchasing here. You can also clarify specific topics in person." Heiner Behnken from the Cord carpentry expressed similar sentiments: "I like the NFF because I can gather information quietly at the stands. The whole atmosphere is pleasant, accompanied by great lectures."

Exhibitors benefit from direct contact

Also the exhibitors were satisfied. Christian Klawitter from Alukon praised: "A great network has been created here." Stefan Gaschler from Alumat Frey was in constant exchange about product innovations such as the two-part closing flange for sealing floor-to-ceiling window elements.

Especially impressive was the presence of Forterro, where for the first time the entire sales team performed together with Forterro Windows & Doors, Forterro Klaes GmbH, and 3E Data Technology. "We greatly appreciate the opportunity to engage directly with customers, prospects, and partners. For us, the event was a great success," summarized the company.

Organizers exhausted but satisfied

Initiator Björn Schröder expressed exhaustion after the event: "PEOPLE, YOU HAVE DRAINED ME!! On Saturday we cleaned up some leftovers, after which I just fell onto the couch." Despite the effort, he was very satisfied with the event.

Especially surprising for Schröder was the reluctance of some companies to innovate: "When visitors walk through the coating area and marvel at how much easier the coating can be, I often do not understand why they do not just test this path. ‘We’ve been doing it this way for 30 years’ is not an argument."

Already a quarter of the places for 2027 booked

The success of the NFF is also reflected in the registration numbers: Already a quarter of the visitor places for September 10, 2027 are booked. VFF manager Frank Lange, who himself organized an excellent congress, paid respect to the initiators: "I am pleased that this works so well here. It helps to bring the industry together – and we really need that right now."

The NFF has proven that the North German window and facade industry has a great need for regional exchange.

Frerichs celebrates 150 years.

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/mut-zur-weiterentwicklung-150-jahre-frerichs-glas

Courage for Development – 150 Years of Frerichs Glass

The flat glass processor Frerichs Glass from Lower Saxony is celebrating its 150th anniversary. Founded in 1876 in Verden on the Aller as a trading company for paints, wallpapers, and varnishes, the company has repositioned itself several times throughout its history. Today, it processes glass and plastic at three locations for crafts, architecture, and industry.

Today, the family business is led in the fourth generation by Simon Cordes. “I was fortunate to take over a company that gave me a strong foundation while allowing me the space to find my own path,” Cordes says. “In this, I see my responsibility today: to honor the established, enable the new, and continue to develop Frerichs Glass so that the next generation will one day have opportunities for their own design.”

Milestones on the Way

The perhaps most important turning point took place in the early 1970s: Under Reinhard Cordes, the third generation, the company gradually distanced itself from the fields of paints and wallpapers and focused on glass. Not because flat glass had always been part of the company, but because Reinhard Cordes saw greater opportunities for refinement, differentiation, and its own value creation in this area. Thus, the foundation was laid for the development from a trader to a processor. Later, insulating and safety glass, new processing technologies, and hardware systems were added.

The central idea of thinking from material to solution continues to shape the growth strategy today.

In parallel to the expansion of the glass business, a plastics portfolio was created. This includes CNC-processed precision parts, prototypes, 3D printing, as well as assemblies for mechanical and plant engineering as well as laboratory and medical technology.

Diversification follows a clear logic: understanding customer requirements and translating them into producible solutions. Technical advice, manufacturing competence, and flexibility are essential components in this.

The three Locations of Frerichs Glass

Regionally, the company has also expanded. In addition to its headquarters in Verden, Frerichs Glass has been present in Lüneburg since 1987. Seven years ago, the logistics center in Nauen, on the outskirts of Berlin, also started operating. With the three locations, Frerichs Glass is now one of the largest flat glass processors in Northern Germany.

The product range includes intelligent insulating glass solutions, in-house manufacturing of ESG and VSG, vacuum glasses, as well as switchable glass and a wide variety of surface designs for interior and exterior use.

Frerichs Glass's willingness to change does not end with the business model. It also concerns what the material glass can achieve in the future – with energy-saving and recyclable products. Glass was once a building material; today, its performance is evident in its functions: it protects, insulates, shapes, creates privacy at the push of a button, and contributes to safety, comfort, and energy efficiency.

Sustainability: 5 MW Battery Storage at the Location

This claim is also evident at its own location. Since June, a 5 MW battery storage system has been on a part of the company’s premises. It serves load peak management and arbitrage trading, while also contributing to stabilizing the regional power grid.

For Simon Cordes, the future viability depends on this aspect: “As a company, we can very well ask ourselves what sense our own actions have. This means for us shaping the things we are responsible for in such a way that we create better framework conditions for our environment, so that healthy, intelligent, and above all safe construction remains sustainable for future generations. This is exactly what I envision as future-oriented entrepreneurship.”

Garden trade exchange meeting.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/wintergartentage-branche-trifft-sich-zum-austausch

Wintergarten Days: Industry Meets for Exchange

On November 12 and 13, 2026, the Federal Association of Winter Gardens will host its Wintergarten Days in Berlin. Market outlook, workshops, and exchange will be at the center.

The winter garden industry, along with terrace roofs and transparent components, will gather in Berlin for the 2026 Annual Conference.

The program on the first day will kick off with the keynote “New Entrepreneur Thinking.” The focus will be on how craft businesses can strengthen their future viability, attract skilled workers, and engage young people.

Afterward, Martin Langen, Managing Director of B+L Market Data GmbH, will provide an outlook on the development of the new construction and renovation market until 2027.

Additionally, a moderated live format will discuss current legal topics and their practical implications for businesses. Lawyers and association representatives will discuss legal matters, various interpretations, and practical consequences for companies.

In the evening of the first day, an event is planned at the Berlin Funkturm.

The lecture program will be complemented by workshops. On the first day, topics such as “Company Succession in Craftsmanship” and “Defect Notification on the Table - Responding Correctly Now!” will be available.

On the second day, participants can choose two from four workshops. Topics include “AI in Everyday Business” and “Selling in the Digital Age.”

The second day’s program starts with the general meeting of the Federal Association of Winter Gardens. Board elections will also take place. The closing session will be led by Markus Hofmann with “BRAIN-EVOLUTION: AI Meets Brain - Mastering the True Revolution.” Alongside this, there will be a foyer exhibition with system providers, suppliers, and service providers.

The professional conference is open to all interested parties. The participation fee is 565 euros for members, 465 euros for a second participant from a company, and 745 euros for guests or non-members.

Wheat separates from chaff.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/drivers-seat-46-die-spreu-trennt-sich-vom-weizen

Drivers Seat 46: The chaff is separated from the wheat

The window market is reorganizing itself – and that has consequences. While well-known companies are investing counter-cyclically and preparing for the future, others are fighting for survival. We analyze in the podcast who wins and who loses.

The window industry is experiencing decisive moments. While the new construction market has been in a weak phase for many years and still shows no signs of a recovery, the chaff is being separated from the wheat. Notably, there are prominent companies acting counter-cyclically, currently investing in acquisitions and automation.

Market consolidation is accelerating. The figures speak a clear language. As Reinhold Kober reports, a large window group is currently being offered a company as an acquisition candidate every week. This development shows how strong the pressure has become on medium-sized companies.

The start of the year was still euphoric, everyone was optimistic. Then came the big dampener due to the conflict in the Middle East with rising energy prices. Immediately followed price increases for preliminary products and a drastic decline in incoming orders.

The dilemma of the middle. Companies that are in a mid-range position are particularly affected – “Stuck in the Middle,” as Stefan Lackner calls it. These companies have neither clear cost leadership nor a pronounced quality leadership. They hang between two chairs and are hit first in the event of a drop in demand.

While crises act as a catalyst, they push companies out of their comfort zones. Things that have been neglected due to full order books suddenly come back to haunt them. Those who do not act soon risk being washed out of the market.

In episode 46, we discuss:

- Why large window companies invest counter-cyclically – and what it means for the market

- Why companies without a clear positioning are particularly at risk

- Market consolidation live

- Strategic loss-making business – when it makes sense to “buy” orders

- Innovation and customer retention as a way out for smaller companies

- Why it’s about survival now, not operating results

This is discussed by Prof. Dr. Stefan Lackner, Reinhold Kober, and Daniel Mund in the latest edition of the podcast Drivers' Seat – and the conversation may help you step on the gas again soon.

Revenue achieved in 2025.

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/forel-dieser-umsatz-wurde-2025-erzielt

Forel

With Forel-ISO lines, thin triple insulating glass can also be manufactured, here with Superspacer and 1 mm interlayer.

The Italian manufacturer of vertical machines for flat and insulating glass production closed the fiscal year 2025 with a revenue in the high double-digit million range. This represents a slight increase compared to the previous year's figure. 75 percent of the revenue was generated in international markets. Here are the numbers.

The Italian manufacturer Forel, specialized in machines for flat and insulating glass processing, concluded the fiscal year 2025 with a revenue of 80 million euros. Compared to the previous year's

figure of 79 million euros, this represents a slight increase. 75 percent of the revenue was generated in international markets.

Forel is now represented in more than 70 countries. The most important sales markets include Italy, the USA, Germany, Spain, and Belgium. In Germany, the company strengthened its presence in 2025 by establishing the subsidiary Forel North Europe based in Mönchengladbach. The new branch takes over sales and service tasks for the Northern European markets.

According to Riccardo Vianello, CEO and Vice President of Forel, geographic diversification serves to consolidate established markets and open up new ones. In an internationally tense environment, this strategy facilitates more stable development.

Investments in Infrastructure and Innovation

In the fiscal year 2025, Forel invested a total of 21 million euros in expanding the company infrastructure. Projects include the expansion of the headquarters and production site in Vallio di Roncade (Treviso), which has been fully operational in recent months, the improvement of employee facilities including the cafeteria, as well as the renovation of the facade of the headquarters.

At the same time, the company reported two new patents. This brings the company portfolio to a total of 33 valid patents. The workforce grew by 15 employees, representing a 5 percent increase. In total, Forel now employs 300 people at its Italian headquarters and in the four foreign subsidiaries.

New Production Hall for the 50th Anniversary

To celebrate its 50th anniversary in 2026, Forel inaugurated a new production hall with an area of 9000 m2 at the Vallio di Roncade site. The expansion strengthens industrial capacity, improves plant organization, and aims to enable a quicker response to the demands of the international market.

Clearer view of the frame.

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/gestellpool-europe-und-box-id-werden-partner-mehr-durchblick-

Gestellpool Europe and BOX ID Become Partners

More Clarity in the Frame Circulation

Where are our frames, and why does no one often know for sure? For many glass and window companies, the lack of transparency in the circulation of load carriers is a daily problem. Gestellpool Europe and BOX ID are now tackling this industry issue together as partners with GESAid, a connected tracking solution, whose trackers only cost one-third of the price of comparable systems on the market.

A transport frame is on the way – but where exactly, since when, and when will it be available again? Once frames leave the premises, many glass and window companies lose a clear view of their load carriers. The consequences are inquiries, search efforts, long handling times, and unnecessarily

tied-up capital.

Gestellpool Europe and BOX ID are now jointly solving this industry problem: with GESAid, a connected tracking solution whose trackers only cost one-third of what comparable solutions cost on the market.

Frames carry the supply chain.

However, digital transparency often ends at the factory gate. Location information lies in different systems, recordings are not conducted consistently, and gaps emerge at the transitions between glass processors, window manufacturers, construction sites, and return transport. Then not only is a location missing; a reliable basis for daily decisions is lacking: Which frames are available? Which have already been with a recipient for too long? Which can be planned for the next delivery?

This is exactly where GESAid comes in. The solution developed jointly by Gestellpool Europe and BOX ID connects affordable trackers with an industry-wide reception network and the existing processes of frame management. Thus, usable information arises from individual signals – even across company, location, and system boundaries.

The price opens the path to broader application.

Tracking has often failed due to price: Anyone wanting to equip large frame inventories must multiply every additional euro by the number of frames. High hardware costs frequently limit the rollout or prevent it altogether.

GESAid changes this calculation: The newly developed tracker solution costs only one-third of what comparable offers on the market currently cost.

This makes widespread application economically significantly more accessible. The benefit does not only arise when searching for a single frame. More visibility allows stocks and availabilities to be assessed more reliably, retrievals to be organized more precisely, and handling time to be shortened.

Frames can be deployed for deliveries more quickly. This reduces the need for additional inventory and cuts down on operational coordination efforts.

Matthias Piekarczyk, CSO of BOX ID, emphasizes: "Gestellpool Europe brings network and industry expertise into our partnership, while BOX ID brings digital transparency. Together, we enable glass and window companies to plan and manage the circulation of their transport frames and the respective stocks and their availability even more efficiently."

A network instead of an isolated solution.

However, the tracker alone does not solve the problem. It is crucial whether a frame is recognized repeatedly along its circulation. Therefore, GESAid connects digitally linked frames with stationary and mobile capture points, apps, software, and the involved companies. Each additional participant and

each new reception point increases network coverage and information density. Thus, the benefit for all parties involved grows with the network.

Felix Spangenberg, Managing Director of Gestellpool Europe, adds: "Our industry network has grown over many years. Together with BOX ID, we are further developing this network. This creates a new quality of transparency regarding the whereabouts of transport frames from glass processors, as well as from window manufacturers. This provides our members with added value for their frame management."

Pilot project at HoffmannGlas – From location to concrete decision.

How the joint reception network performs in everyday life is currently being tested under real conditions together with HoffmannGlas, a company of the Semco group and a member of Gestellpool Europe.

In this regard, Alexander Akgül, Technical Managing Director of Semcoglas Holding, explains: "When acquiring HoffmannGlas, Semcoglas came across the already proven frame pool system on the BOX ID technology on their frames, and we wondered how to bring both together. The new cooperation and the further development within the framework of a joint project offer us ideal conditions for very good results and lead to more efficient frame management."

In the pilot project, the components of GESAid are being tested in ongoing operations. The focus is on reception coverage, data quality, and practical use along the logistics chain. The findings will flow directly into further development.

Solar panels in buildings.

https://www.glaswelt.de/glas/bf-webinar-bauwerkintegrierte-photovoltaik-der-gebaeudehuelle

BF-Webinar: Building Integrated Photovoltaics in Building Envelopes

The Federal Association of Flat Glass is hosting an online seminar on October 27, 2026, focusing on solutions, legal requirements, and current developments in building-integrated photovoltaics (BIPV).

Building envelopes protect against the elements and shape architecture. With building-integrated photovoltaics, façades, roofs, and glazing serve as additional areas for energy generation. The Federal Association of Flat Glass invites participants to a webinar on this topic.

The event will highlight available solutions, necessary legal requirements, and future developments. Five experts from associations, research, and industry will examine building-integrated photovoltaics from various perspectives. They will discuss current developments, specific applications, and the contribution of BIPV to the energy transition in the building and real estate sectors.

Program and Speakers

The webinar will feature the following talks:

- Helmut Rohwetter, chairman of the Allianz Building Integrated Photovoltaics e.V., will present pathways and solutions for the energy transition in the construction and real estate sector.

- Christof Erban from Sunovation will speak on the topic "This is not going away."

- Sina Rüsse from Schüco International KG will discuss semi-transparent BIPV in the building envelope, especially concerning the balance between transparency and energy generation.

- Robert Kirchner from GES – Building and Energy Systems GmbH will explain legal requirements and selected implementations of BIPV.

- Stephan Heise from the German Aerospace Center will introduce photovoltaic sun protection glazing.

Following the presentations, participants will have the opportunity to ask questions during an open Q&A session.

Target Audience and Participation

The webinar is aimed at architects, specialist planners, glass processors, façade builders, developers, and project developers. It also targets anyone interested in sustainable building concepts and the integration of photovoltaics into the building envelope.

The online event will take place on October 27, 2026, from 2 PM to 5 PM via Microsoft Teams. Participation is free for members and supporters of the Federal Association of Flat Glass. Non-members pay 95 euros.

Otto-Chemie wins EcoVadis Gold

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/otto-chemie-erneut-mit-ecovadis-gold-ausgezeichnet

Otto-Chemie received the EcoVadis Gold medal for the second consecutive time. The company improved its rating and is now in the top 5 percent of companies assessed worldwide.

The manufacturer of sealants and adhesives was awarded the EcoVadis Gold medal for the second time in a row in August 2026. The company improved its score from 78 to 81 points and thus belongs to the best 5 percent of companies assessed by EcoVadis worldwide. This award confirms the company's sustainability strategy and systematic sustainability management.

The importance of sustainability, transparency, and reliable ESG evidence is increasing in industrial supply chains. With the renewed Gold award, Otto-Chemie meets these requirements.

EcoVadis is a provider of sustainability ratings. The assessment is carried out in four areas: environment, labor and human rights, ethics, and sustainable procurement. Worldwide, EcoVadis has assessed more than 85,000 companies.

For industrial customers, the award provides transparency and security when selecting a partner. It confirms that Otto-Chemie integrates sustainability into processes, decisions, and the entire value chain.

Diethard Bruhn, a member of the management board of Otto-Chemie, commented: "Customers today expect high-performing products and responsible supply chains. The renewed Gold award and the improvement to 81 points confirm that we combine both. At the same time, it motivates us to further develop our sustainability management and implement our vision of 'We build the future.'"

Facade becomes visitor card.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fassade/wagner-design-lab-so-wird-eine-fassade-zur-visitenkarte

Wagner Design Lab: How a Facade Becomes a Business Card

The Wagner Design Lab in Langenneufnach implements the corporate philosophy of design and movement architecturally – with large glass surfaces and Trespa facade panels. The XXL glasses measuring 3.04 x 19.21 m come from sedak.

Architects Titus Bernhard and Andreas Weißenbach designed a structure measuring 52 x 12 x 6 meters that rests on slender steel stilts and hovers above the existing building.

In Langenneufnach, Swabia, the Wagner Design Lab was created as a commercial building that expresses the corporate philosophy of the Wagner brand in its architecture. For the builders Peter and Rainer Wagner, who run the company Topstar, the preservation of the family home as the seed of the business was paramount, complemented by a new building aimed at the future. The project received the German Design Award even before its completion.

A “Showcase of Superlatives”

The glass surfaces symbolize insight and far-sightedness.

Architects Titus Bernhard and Andreas Weißenbach conceptualized a structure measuring 52 x 12 x 6 m, resting on slender steel stilts and hovering above the existing building, which they called a “showcase of superlatives.”

Four triple-glazed panels measuring 3.04 x 19.21 m and weighing seven tons each were installed. These glass surfaces symbolize insight and far-sightedness.

The Wagner Design Lab serves as an idea factory, creative space, and showroom for the office area. It aims to inspire creatives and visitors. The company focuses on the integration of design, movement, and space, which is reflected in dynamic sitting. This dynamics should also be visible in the architecture.

The building envelope reflects themes of dynamics and contrast. For this purpose, “Trespa Meteon” panels were used. The facade features polygons in the decor “Lumen Metropolis Black,” forming a geometric honeycomb structure. The undersides and interiors of the cantilevered roof and facade areas are in “Lumen Athens White,” contrasting with the recessed glass surfaces. The architects emphasize the dominant effect of the large glass surfaces in combination with the black polygonal Trespa elements.

Light plays an important role. Thanks to the large glass surfaces, it remains natural and finds its way from inside to outside through the light surfaces. This leads to a merging of architecture with nature. The selected “Lumen” decors from Trespa utilize natural light for facade design.

The surface “Diffuse” absorbs light evenly across the entire area. It is matte and smooth, free of gloss and patterns, which adds depth to the black and white and contributes to a calm appearance of the facade. The building integrates seamlessly and glare-free into its surroundings.

A minimalist approach demands precision.

Bernhard describes his design philosophy as “sensual minimalism,” a reduced form language, careful material selection, and craftsmanship details. The Wagner Design Lab illustrates this minimalism, demanding a high level of implementation. Bernhard emphasizes that minimalism forgives no mistakes, and everything must be thought out precisely.

The architects chose Trespa because it met the demands for precision, durability, and a cohesive design. The material is characterized by robustness and good processability. The installation was concealed using a manufacturer-certified system solution “TS200.” This employs clamps on an aluminum substructure and integrated adjusting screws. Thus, the panels can be aligned with millimeter precision both vertically and horizontally to achieve an exact joint pattern.

Weißenbach designed the facade with detailed planning and technical understanding, supported by Trespa.

PVC windows recycled increase

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/rewindo-pvc-altfenster-recycling-steigt-auf-141595-tonnen

Rewindo recorded a growth of 32.3 percent in the recycling quantities of PVC old windows and related products in 2025. The recycling rate reached 94.5 percent.

Rewindo GmbH, a window recycling service based in Bonn, reported a significant increase in recycling volumes for the year 2025. With a growth of 32.3 percent, this marks the highest growth rate since the company was founded in 2002. A total of 141,595 tons of PVC old windows and related products were recycled, up from 131,000 tons the previous year.

In the area of post-consumer products, according to Recovinyl (Database RecoTraceTM), 58,358 tons of PVC old windows, shutters and related products were recorded. This represents an increase compared to the 44,109 tons in 2024. Additionally, 83,237 tons of production and processing waste were generated. The company is contributing to the achievement of the recycling targets set by VinylPlus®, the self-commitment of the European PVC industry.

In 2025, Rewindo was able to halve the amount of thermal recovery from PVC old windows in waste incineration plants compared to 2024. This aligns with the environmental policy targets of the federal government, as reflected in the regulations of the Circular Economy Act and the Commercial Waste Ordinance. The recycling rate for collectable and available old windows increased in the same period to 94.5 percent, up from 87 percent in 2024. The result report for the recycling volumes in 2025 was created by Conversio and independently verified and audited by ecocycle.

The material cycle for PVC old windows contributes to resource conservation and reduces the carbon footprint as well as energy consumption. A study by myclimate for Rewindo shows that one ton of recyclate saves two tons of CO2 and 14,600 kWh of electricity. For the year 2025, Rewindo and its partners saved 283,200 tons of CO2 and over two million kWh of electric energy.

The obtained recyclates were used 70 percent for the production of new PVC window profiles. Another 20 percent were used for the production of PVC pipes, and 10 percent were allocated to other profile applications.

Michael Vetter, Managing Director of Rewindo, attributes the growth rates to several factors. These include an increase in energy refurbishments and demolition projects. According to him, housing companies are increasingly focusing on the existing building stock due to the current market environment in new construction. Another crucial factor was the expansion of the Rewindo network and recycling partnerships along the value chain for PVC windows. Furthermore, the number of acceptance points for smaller or smallest quantities of PVC old windows has been extended to over 100 nationwide. This system complements the pick-up system of the recycling partners and increased the available quantity of old windows.

In the coming years, the company expects further growth, although probably not to the same extent as in 2025. Vetter emphasizes that the demand for energy retrofitting in the existing building stock is high and offers potential for the future. Legal requirements and climate goals accelerate this development, which also benefits the PVC window industry. The industry offers products that provide solutions for the transformation of the existing building stock.

Modular sliding gate system.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/roto-patio-alversa-modulares-system-fuer-die-fertigung-von

Roto Patio Alversa offers window manufacturers a modular fitting system for sliding elements that optimizes production through uniform parts and streamlined processes.

With the fitting variant “Roto Patio Alversa | PS”, an economical parallel sliding element is created, which can be equipped with a gap ventilation. This gap ventilation, as well as the robust durability and intuitive operation make this sliding element variant suitable for public spaces with changing visitors.

The rising prices for building materials and manufacturing costs in new construction are changing the decision-making basis for planners, investors, and builders. The focus increasingly lies on economically balanced solutions. For window manufacturers, flexible and assembly-friendly fitting systems provide corresponding solutions.

One example is “Roto Patio Alversa” for sliding elements, which simplifies production through many uniform parts and is aimed at price-sensitive customers. Roto develops and produces all components of the fitting system itself, with the goal of ensuring quality and delivery reliability.

Heike Holfelder, Product Manager for Sliding at Roto Window and Door Technology, describes “Roto Patio Alversa” as a problem solver for window manufacturers. The system enables processing in streamlined processes and combines the advantages of tilt-and-turn technology for tightness with the comfort of large sliding elements. Sliding elements provide plenty of daylight, a space-saving opening, and flexible ventilation comfort, which justifies their recommendation in various price segments.

The modular design of the fitting system “Roto Patio Alversa” relieves production, assembly, storage, and logistics. Up to four variants can be produced without extensive modifications and with many uniform parts on one line. Only a few components will be added for higher demands on operation and ventilation comfort or burglary protection.

The modular structure of the fitting system relieves production, assembly, storage, and logistics. Up to four variants can be produced without major alterations and with many uniform parts on one line. Components such as drives, central locks, sliding scissors, rail sets, and handle levers are identical across all variants. Manufacturers already working with “Roto NX” or “Roto AL” already have most of these components in stock, as they are also used for the production of tilt-and-turn elements. Only a few components need to be added for higher demands on operation and ventilation comfort or burglary protection. This leads to an economically efficient sliding door solution.

The “Alversa” fitting system is available for all frame materials and for sashes weighing up to 200 kg. It allows the production of sliding elements with tilt or gap ventilation.

“Alversa | KS” is the entry-level variant as a tilt-slide fitting.

“Alversa | PS Air” offers additional comfort as a parallel-tilt-slide option through integrated opening damping.

“Alversa | PS Air Com” is aimed at the private residential sector and offers handle-controlled ventilation comfort: rotating the handle lever automatically tilts the sash, manual pulling on the sash is not required.

The fitting variant “Alversa | PS” enables a parallel sliding element that can optionally be equipped with a gap ventilation. This function allows for continuous ventilation of a room, even if the element is, for example, mounted on the ground floor, which is at risk of burglary, as the sashes securely appear locked from the outside. The gap ventilation, long-lasting durability, and intuitive operation also recommend sliding elements with “Alversa | PS” for public places.

Wired solutions such as the magnetic closing and opening monitoring system “Roto E-Tec Control | MVS” (in the picture) are compatible with “Alversa” sliding fittings. The same applies to sensors from the “Roto Com-Tec” program, which inform about the opening status via radio. Through the widely used EnOcean radio protocol, they can be integrated into common smart home systems.

Every “Alversa” sliding element can be equipped with “Roto Quadro Safe” security components, such as security mushroom pins, security locking pieces, and a lockable handle up to resistance class RC 2. Monitoring of the locking and opening status is managed by sensors from the “Roto Com-Tec” program, which transmit information wirelessly. The status can be accessed via app at any time. For integration into wired monitoring systems, an “Alversa” element can be connected with “Roto E-Tec | Control”. This allows for flexible adaptation of burglary protection to individual security needs and existing building installations. The sensors with EnOcean radio protocol can also be integrated into common smart home systems.

The handles for “Alversa” sliding elements are available in three designs, corresponding to the tilt-and-turn handles from Roto: “Roto Line”, “Roto Swing”, and from fall 2026 “Roto Square”. The operation of all “Alversa” sliding door variants is analogous to tilt-and-turn windows.

Kömmerling expands accessory range.

https://www.glaswelt.de/fenster/koemmerling-erweitert-zubehoer-portfolio-um-dr-hahn-tuerbe

Kömmerling expands its accessory portfolio with Dr. Hahn door fittings.

Dr. Peter Mrosik, Managing Partner of the profine Group, and Walter Back, Head of Sales and Member of the Executive Board of Dr. Hahn GmbH & Co. KG, have agreed on a cooperation between their companies.

The profine Group, with its Kömmerling brand, and the door hinge manufacturer Dr. Hahn are entering into a strategic sales cooperation. Since September 2026, customers can purchase Dr. Hahn surface-mounted and roller hinges directly from Kömmerling.

“With Dr. Hahn, we have found a reliable partner. This current sales cooperation is a first step to deepen our collaboration and develop system solutions that are technically and functionally significantly beyond classic individual components,” explains Dr. Peter Mrosik.

The profile system house is pursuing a strategy with this partnership to supply customers with high-quality accessories from a single source. The cooperation is expected to generate regulatory-compliant, highly efficient, and long-term future-proof product solutions in the field of modern door systems.

Walter Back sees this collaboration as an important milestone: “This cooperation means an important milestone for us. By working with a leading profile manufacturer, we can offer our customers powerful and regulatory-compliant product solutions as well-thought-out system solutions. Together, we can create system solutions that clearly exceed conventional individual components.”

Optimal coordination already in development

The close interplay between door hinge and profile technology allows for optimal product alignment already in the development phase. This creates room for new developments and provides a clear added value, especially concerning future European requirements, which can only be achieved through joint development.

Kunstof

Company insolvencies remain high.

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/branchen-news/insolvenzen_zahl_der_firmenpleiten_weiterhin_ho

The number of major insolvencies in Germany remains at a high level. According to the restructuring consultants from Falkensteg (Düsseldorf) in their current insolvency report “5-nach-12”, a total of 209 companies with sales of more than 10 million EUR filed for insolvency in the first half of 2026. This was eight cases fewer than in the first six months of the previous year, but the number still significantly exceeded the five-year average of 142 cases.

Among major companies relevant to plastics, Falkensteg’s experts recorded a total of twelve insolvency filings, one more than the previous year. In this year’s cases, the automotive suppliers ranked first.

Aramco considers Arlanxeo sale.

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/branchen-news/arlanxeo_aramco_soll_verkauf_des_elastomer-erze

KunststoffWeb: Industry Insights for the Plastics Industry

Facing a change of ownership? Elastomer Production in Dormagen.

Saudi Aramco is clearly hitting the brakes financially: According to Bloomberg news agency, the state-owned Saudi oil giant is reviewing the sale of stakes totaling approximately $35 billion USD. The sale of the elastomer manufacturer Arlanxeo is also planned, Bloomberg reports, citing sources familiar with the matter. Neither Arlanxeo nor Saudi Aramco initially responded to corresponding AI inquiries.

It is said that Aramco commissioned J.P. Morgan under the codename Project Atlas as early as July 2026 to handle the sale of Arlanxeo. The figures cited include a turnover of EUR 2.9 billion and an estimated EBITDA of EUR 140 million for 2026 for Arlanxeo. Saudi Aramco does not provide figures for individual stakes.

BASF starts new plant

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/branchen-news/schuetz_spatenstich_fuer_ibc-produktion_am_basf

KunststoffWeb: Industry Information for the Plastics Industry

Industrial Packaging Manufacturer Schütz is investing more than 40 million EUR in a production and logistics center for Intermediate Bulk Containers in Ludwigshafen. Construction began officially with the groundbreaking on September 14, 2026; commissioning is planned for summer 2027.

On an area of approximately 20,000 m² directly adjacent to the BASF headquarters, IBCs will be produced and stored in the future. Schütz initially plans to create around 60 new jobs, with up to 100 in later expansion phases. In addition to BASF, other industrial customers in the Rhine-Neckar region will also be supplied from Ludwigshafen.

Trinseo raises PMMA prices.

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/polymerpreis-news/trinseo_preiserhoehung_fuer_pmma_pp261032

Altuglas PMMA is set to become more expensive: Trinseo (Europe: Pfäffikon / Switzerland) has announced that it will raise prices in the region of Europe, the Middle East, and Africa.

The price increases of 250 EUR/t will take effect from October 1, 2026, as the company states.

Alpla expands Turkish operations.

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/branchen-news/alpla_zwei_werke_in_der_tuerkei_eroeffnet_t2610

At the opening of the new plant in Adana, Turkey, on September 14, Emre Canoglu (Managing Director of Alpla Turkey), Javier Delgado (Regional Manager for Africa, Middle East, and Turkey), Philipp Lehner (CEO), and Walter Ritzer (COO) gathered together.

The Austrian packaging manufacturer Alpla is expanding its production capacities in Turkey. The company has invested around 30 million EUR in two new locations in Izmir on the Turkish Aegean coast and in Adana in the south of the country.

The plant in Izmir has a production area of approximately 50,000 square meters and manufactures PET preforms, closures, and finished bottles made of polyethylene HD and PET. The smaller site in Adana, which is 20,000 square meters, focuses on PET preforms and packaging made of PE HD and polypropylene. Both plants serve customers in the beverage, food, and dairy industries as well as manufacturers of household and personal care products.

UBA pays out funds.

https://www.kunststoffweb.de/branchen-news/uba_einwegkunststofffonds_zahlt_erstmals_aus_t2

Cost factor public space: Municipalities receive money from the single-use plastic fund for the collection and disposal of certain waste.

The Federal Environment Agency (UBA, Dessau) has set the point value for the first payout from the single-use plastic fund. For the reporting year 2024, it amounts to 0.274 EUR per point. This will transfer around 205 million EUR to municipalities and public disposal authorities that have provided services for cleaning the public space as well as for the collection and disposal of waste.

Since January 2024, manufacturers and sellers of certain single-use plastic products in Germany must bear part of the costs for their disposal in public spaces. This is based on the Single-Use Plastic Fund Act (EWKFondsG), which implements extended producer responsibility.

Tech plans need resolution now.

https://www.cepro.com/news/the-unresolved-trade-why-getting-technology-onto-the-plans-is-n

The Unresolved Trade: Why Getting Technology Onto the Plans is Not Enough

How integrators can move upstream in construction by focusing on human experience, design intent, and coordinated technology that supports life inside the space.

Published: September 21, 2026

Our industry has spent years talking about getting involved earlier in construction.

The concern is valid. By the time many integrators arrive, walls are framed, mechanical systems are laid out, lighting decisions are made, and the interior designer is finalizing finishes. Decisions that directly affect our work have already been locked in.

Technology should be formally included alongside mechanical, electrical, and plumbing. MEP should be MEPT. In many parts of the industry, it already is.

But adding the T is not enough.

If technology means only pathways, wiring, racks, speakers, screens, and equipment locations, we may arrive earlier without becoming more valuable. The greater opportunity is not simply getting technology onto the plans. It is defining what technology should do for the people inside the building.

The Habit That Limits Us

Consider a typical job walk.

The MEP work is underway. The framer is active. The interior designer is working through finishes. The general contractor brought us in because the client requested us, or because the GC trusts us. We enter what will become the primary bedroom and ask a familiar question:

“Do you want speakers in this room?”

The client says, “We barely listen to music.”

The bedroom comes off the distributed audio plan, and everyone moves on.

The decision feels reasonable. But we did not simply remove a pair of speakers. We removed every experience the client might have valued individually.

Would sound masking help protect sleep from doors closing down the hall? Should the doorbell be audible upstairs without becoming disruptive? Could the room support meditation, reading, or a

nighttime wind-down? Would a controlled soundscape help someone rest while the rest of the house remains active? None of those are music questions. All of them are audio decisions. Different question, different answer, same room.

One Good Question Changes the Project

An experiential question rarely stays inside one system. Suppose the client tells us that protecting sleep is important in the primary bedroom.

The speakers may now require isolated back boxes rather than open joist cavities that transmit sound through the structure. That decision affects framing, pathways, and mechanical coordination before the ceiling is closed.

If the doorbell needs to be heard in the bedroom at a controlled level and only at appropriate times, the entry system must communicate with the audio system. Security and audio can no longer be treated as unrelated packages.

Sleep also does not begin at the pillow. Evening lighting may need to become warmer and lower as the day ends. Shades may need to respond to dusk and morning light. That becomes a lighting, electrical, shading, and programming conversation before rough-in is complete.

Mechanical systems matter as well. Low-velocity air, quieter equipment, nighttime temperature targets, and schedules that begin before bedtime all influence whether the room actually supports rest. Those requirements must be coordinated before the duct layout is fixed.

One meaningful question in one bedroom can place the integrator in conversation with the framer, electrician, HVAC contractor, interior designer, and other trades. Not because we are trying to control their work, but because the outcome the client cares about crosses all of it.

What Upstream Actually Means

Being upstream does not simply mean arriving earlier on the calendar. It means bringing questions that ripple across the building, understanding where those ripples land, and documenting them before they become field conflicts.

Integrators touch more systems in a modern building than nearly any other subtrade. We coordinate audio, video, networks, lighting control, shading, climate, access, alarm, surveillance, leak detection, energy monitoring, sensing, and automation.

Our work also intersects directly with framing, millwork, electrical, plumbing, HVAC, interior finishes, acoustical isolation, and architectural details. That reach should give our trade an important position. But reach alone does not earn it.

We Have to Think and Document Like Designers

Designers do not begin with products. They begin with intent.

An architect does not ask whether the client wants walls. The architect asks how the client wants to live, then designs walls, circulation, light, scale, and proportion around that life. Our trade needs to move the same way.

The vocabulary must shift from what should be installed to what the space should do.

Then intent must be translated into measurable performance and coordinated documentation: system behaviors, sensor strategies, acoustic requirements, infrastructure drawings, trade dependencies, control logic, commissioning criteria, and the construction phase in which each decision must be made.

A rack elevation is useful. A wire schedule is necessary. Neither, by itself, is a design methodology. A product list earns a vendor's seat. A design earns a

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New tool eases buying.

https://www.cepro.com/news/integration-controls-unveils-shop-the-look-buying-tool-for-clie

Integration Controls is launching a new tool for its customers aimed at making the buying process for home technology upgrades much simpler. Calling it "Shop the Look," Integration Controls says it's a first-of-its-kind digital planning experience to help its clients understand what's possible (and what it costs) before the design process begins.

"Consumers today expect to research major purchases before they ever schedule a consultation," said Jamie Briesemeister, co-founder and CEO of Integration Controls. "At the same time, it's often a challenge for those unfamiliar with technology to visualize how it will look and function in their home, with their aesthetic and lifestyle in mind.

"We asked luxury designers and builders in the St. Louis area which interior styles were most common, and we designed a resource that matches different styles, whether it's Mid-century or French modern. Shop the Look provides a consistent way to visualize personalized home technology solutions, bringing our clients' concepts to life."

According to Integration Controls, Shop the Look allows homeowners to explore curated levels of home technology from the comfort of their home, office or while meeting with design/build professionals for a project.

The platform organizes home technology into categories and tiers that are more intuitive to the average buyer, from foundational one-room technologies to fully bespoke, whole-home systems. This further allows users to compare different levels of performance across different price points while also exploring how different systems will appear in a variety of home styles.

While developed to improve Integration Controls' own client experience, Shop the Look addresses a challenge familiar to integrators across the industry: translating complex technology systems into an experience clients can easily understand.

In a way, the tool works to establish a common vocabulary, sometimes even before the first consultation, by giving everyone a clearer understanding of available solutions, investment options and lifestyle outcomes, reducing uncertainty and establishing more realistic expectations in the process.

"We built Shop the Look to solve a challenge within our own business," Briesemeister added. "The preliminary response we've received from our manufacturer partners and other integrators suggests this isn't just our challenge—it's an industry challenge. For over 20 years, we have led with 'experience-first' and now, we have the ability to help our clients visualize what that means earlier in the process. It's an opportunity to rethink how clients are introduced to technology, ultimately making the buying experience better for everyone."

For anyone looking to explore the tool themselves, Shop the Look is available now at integrationcontrols.com.

However, the launch also coincides with the Grand Opening of Integration Controls' new Technology Design Center, located at 10164 Watson Rd in Sunset Hills, Missouri. There attendees will get in-person access to Shop the Look.

On Friday, October 2, 2026, from 4 to 7 pm, a private VIP preview will host design/build partners, realtors, and other business connections to explore the design center and 'Shop the Look' in person.

This will be followed by a community-wide Open House on Saturday, October 3, 2026, for the Sunset Hills and surrounding communities to visit.

Sales team growth strategy.

https://www.cepro.com/news/audio-advice-to-grow-sales-team-in-response-to-further-national

Audio Advice to Grow Sales Team in Response to Further National Expansion

Following a period of significant company growth, Audio Advice will be adding and relocating several personnel to keep pace with service and expertise.

Published: September 21, 2026 Nick Boever

Following a period of significant company growth and market expansion, Audio Advice has announced it will be beefing up its sales force to continue to provide the level of customer service and product expertise that has earned the firm its national reputation in both custom integration and consumer electronics.

As part of this growth, Audio Advice is adding two key salespeople to its Miami location: Sebastian Simon and Aleksei Panov.

Simon is a Miami local with deep ties to the community, while Panov has served Audio Advice's Charlotte location for many years. As part of this new position, Panov will relocate to support the growing Miami team under Simon. Audio Advice says his extensive background in premium A/V solutions will be an immediate asset to the rapidly expanding Miami customer base.

Concurrent with strengthening the Miami team, Audio Advice is also welcoming industry veteran Chad Fagin to its Charlotte location. Fagin brings several decades of specialized experience in both high-performance audio and advanced home automation. Audio Advice says his vast knowledge will further elevate the premium, custom-tailored experiences that Charlotte-area clients have come to expect.

These strategic personnel moves represent Audio Advice's ongoing approach to growth across North America, ensuring that, as the company expands, its customer service retains the same level of quality and care that a more local business would have.

As home technology becomes increasingly sophisticated, Audio Advice recognizes that the foundation of an exceptional customer experience lies in the expertise of its staff.

By continually recruiting, relocating, and investing in top-tier talent like Simon, Panov, and Fagin, the company ensures that every customer—whether they are building a dedicated home theater, upgrading their two-channel audio system, or integrating full-scale home automation—receives unparalleled guidance and support.

Z-Wave programming summit announced.

https://www.cepro.com/news/z-wave-fall-summit-unveils-programming-for-2026-outing/628760/

The Z-Wave Fall Summit is coming up for 2026, and ahead of the event, the Z-Wave Alliance has released greater details on the programming for attendees, both confirmed and prospective. The event kicks off September 29 with the member-only Unplug Fest, where Z-Wave Alliance members can conduct informal device-to-device interoperability testing for Z-Wave and Z-Wave Long Range products, collaborate with other developers and manufacturers, and exchange knowledge across the ecosystem.

Following Unplug Fest, programming opens to integrators, installers, developers, and other industry professionals. The Fall Summit will run from September 29–October 1 in Boca Raton, Florida.

The Z-Wave Fall Summit is a three-day conference that brings together commercial and consumer IoT industry experts, manufacturers and practitioners for sessions spanning industry trends, market opportunities and Z-Wave technical development.

Upon opening to the public, programming for the 2026 Z-Wave Fall Summit opens with a Z-Wave Feature Demo led by Z-Wave expert Eric Ryherd. The Alliance explains that the demo will cover several Z-Wave features in action, including SmartStart commissioning, ZWLR, simultaneous Z-Wave Mesh and Z-Wave Long Range operation on the same controller, and sub-Gigahertz operation. The day will conclude with a welcome reception presented by Fall Summit diamond sponsor ADT and will include a panel session discussing how open standards are shaping the future of the connected home as well as an opportunity to tour ADT's Callahan Family Home.

On September 30, programming will open to include:

– What Consumers Really Want, hosted by Jennifer Pattison Tuohy, senior smart home reviewer at The Verge, who will share what drives smart home purchase decisions, where consumers still encounter friction and which features matter most in everyday use.

– The Professional Installation Market, where new CEDIA research sets the stage for a conversation with professional integrators about changing customer expectations, common project challenges and new opportunities.

– Beyond the Single-Family Home, hosted by Jennifer Kent, SVP and Principal Analyst at Parks Associates, alongside leaders across multifamily, hospitality and PropTech to examine what it takes to deploy connected technology at scale and where commercial markets are creating new opportunities for Z-Wave.

– Preparing for the Next Wave of Cybersecurity Requirements, where experts examine the latest developments around Europe's Cyber Resilience Act and the U.S. Cyber Trust Mark, what manufacturers need to do to prepare, and how Z-Wave's architecture can help support compliance with both programs.

The day will conclude with an informal networking event that offers attendees the chance to continue discussions from the day, exchange ideas, and connect with colleagues from across the smart home and commercial IoT markets.

The final day of Fall Summit will be dedicated to member-only Technical and Marketing Committee and Working Group sessions, giving Alliance members dedicated time to collaborate on ongoing initiatives and help shape priorities for the Z-Wave ecosystem.

Z-Wave Alliance members can register for the full Fall Summit for $699. Installers, integrators and non-members can register for $99. Non-Member registration includes access to the Z-Wave Feature Demo and opening reception on September 29 and the September 30 programming and networking event. Unplug Fest and the October 1 working sessions are exclusive to Z-Wave Alliance members.

TCL adds more features.

https://www.cepro.com/type-products/tcl-expands-follow-up-to-nxtframe-art-tvs-with-more-on

TCL has expanded its flush-mounted Designer Series in the U.S. with two new lines, the A300L QLED and A400U QD-Mini LED Series. Both series will run on Google TV and include TCL's Art Library, which offers users the option to display artwork at no subscription cost on the TV when not in use, allowing it to blend into the background. The TVs also include multiple matte options and a flush mount included in the box to help them better blend in with a home's design.

The A300L series comes in 55-, 65- and 75-inch models with an 85-inch model expected to arrive at an intermediate date. The 55- and 65-inch models measure 1.1 inches deep, allowing them to sit nearly flush against the wall. The 75- and 85-inch models still sport a slim profile, measuring 1.17 and 1.26 inches deep, respectively.

All models in the series come with an ultra-matte, anti-glare screen that is designed to reduce reflections while adhering to that canvas-like aesthetic. The series also come with off-white and light-wood magnetic frames that further help complete the look. Additional handcrafted options are also available through Laredo Factory Frames.

The screens themselves sport a 144 Hz refresh rate, according to TCL, with 4K UHD resolution that supports Dolby Vision, HDR10+, HDR10 and HLG formats. It also comes with a built-in 20W stereo system with Dolby Atmos and Dolby Digital+ processing. There's also 3.5mm connector options for external audio.

The A400U series comes in 55-, 65-, 75-, 85- and 95-inch models with all models except the 95-inch sporting a screen depth of 1.6 inches. The 95-inch model comes in at 1.8 inches.

The A400U series keeps all the same art TV features of the A300L line with the main distinction being the QD-Mini LEDs, using TCL's Halo Control System and Local Dimming Pro+ for improved backlight precision, contrast and blooming control. The A400U also adds DTS:X spatial audio support.

The Designer Series is TCL's follow-up to the NXTFRAME and NXTVISION TVs that originally marked TCL's entry into the art TV category, now populated by the likes of Samsung, LG, SKYWORTH, Hisense, along with TCL. While Samsung's The Frame still stands as one of the gold-standards for lifestyle TVs in the custom integration (CI) channel, companies like SKYWORTH note the strong popularity of their own art TV offerings, highlighting the sheer popularity of the product category among integrators.

Tuck Lights enter market

https://www.cepro.com/type-products/wac-spa-ready-tuck-lights-couldnt-arrive-at-a-better-t

WAC Group is releasing a new set of spa-grade lighting fixtures via its Modern Forms lineup. The TUCK series, which already exists as an outdoor luminary, has been updated for spas and saunas with added heat resistance to an already wet-rated design. According to WAC Group, "Spa and sauna

lighting has been needed for quite some time," with the updated TUCK fixtures looking to address that need.

The lights themselves come in three different iterations, yet all share a similar circular profile defined by a diffuser with banded ring design, which, when lit, emits a soft, even glow designed to provide ambient illumination starting at 600 max lumens.

While the outdoor version of the TUCK lights offers four different CCT colorways, the sauna option is only available in 3000K. It is, however, heat resistant up to 185 degrees Fahrenheit and sports a 90 CRI. Additionally, the lights can be mounted either on ceilings or walls in all orientations.

The Sauna-ready versions of TUCK, TUCK II, or TUCK III are also ADA-compliant, Title 24-compliant and ETL-listed.

While the custom integration (CI) industry is no stranger to specialty spa and sauna installs in the home, the 2026 CEDIA Expo put a particularly strong spotlight on the category as companies like Kohler and Thermasol have started to explore the channel more with connected bath solutions.

On its own, this would merit nothing more a curious intrigue, but both brands received considerable interest from integrators at the show, highlighting the appetite this channel has for being able to provide a connected sauna or spa solution. For this reason, CE Pro has identified the connected bath and spa as being a potential breakout category for integrators in the coming years given both homeowner and integrator interest.

And like other design-driven, wellness-focused spaces, lighting will ultimately sit as one of the pillars of experience.

Devialet Pulse Blue released.

https://www.cepro.com/type-products/devialet-unveils-pulse-blue-model-for-phantom-ultimate

Devialet Unveils Pulse Blue Model for Phantom Ultimate Speaker

The new exclusive model revisits the brand's original color identity while building upon the Phantom Ultimate's audio architecture.

Published: September 17, 2026

Key Takeaways

- The Phantom Ultimate 98db – Pulse Blue revisits Devialet's previously explored blue branding.

- The new Pulse Blue includes an extensive range of streaming protocols via AirPlay, Google Cast, Roon Ready, Spotify Connect, Tidal Connect, Qobuz Connect, and UPnP.

- The new edition and its matching Tree stand are available for pre-order starting today across all Devialet stores, on Devialet.com, and through authorized retailers.

One year after introducing the latest generation of its iconic speaker, Devialet has an all-new, limited edition marked by a new finish: the Phantom Ultimate 98 dB – Pulse Blue. The new look and model are part of a partnership the company has with Global Brand Ambassador Isack Hadjar, a Formula 1 driver for Oracle Red Bull Racing.

Pulse Blue revisits the brand's previously explored color identity, shifting the finish of the speaker's side panels from matte to gloss with a mirror-polished surface. A clear varnish further enhances the deep RAL 5011 blue, creating a vibrant, light-responsive finish. The logo has also been refined for total visual coherence.

The new speaker also comes with a new stand to complete the look.

The Tech Behind the Phantom Ultimate Pulse Blue

The Devialet Phantom Ultimate 98 dB – Pulse Blue builds on the Devialet DOS 3 software architecture while also integrating an extensive range of streaming protocols via AirPlay, Google Cast, Roon Ready, Spotify Connect, Tidal Connect, Qobuz Connect, and UPnP.

Beyond that, the Pulse Blue retains much of the original's acoustic performance in a more compact form. The Pulse Blue sports high-fidelity reproduction across frequency ranges from 18 Hz to 25 kHz (±6 dB), delivering up to 98 dB SPL.

An optimized audio chain supports files up to 24-bit / 192 kHz while a dedicated full-range driver broadens the acoustic field, to reproduce each note with precision and balance. Additionally, the Pulse Blue supports flexible listening in solo, stereo, or multi-room configurations, with compatibility across AirPlay, Google Cast, and Roon Ready.

Through the Devialet app, users can also access a 6-band equalizer to adjust frequencies as well as Bass Reducer and Loudness functionalities for added control over low-frequency intensity and improved acoustic compensation at lower volumes.

Price and Availability

The new edition and its matching Tree stand are available for pre-order starting today across all Devialet stores and through authorized retailers, priced at $2,200 for the speaker and $349 for the Tree stand.

Vintage speakers, high-resolution audio.

https://www.cepro.com/projects/symphony-of-old-and-new-vintage-speakers-meet-high-resoluti

Symphony of Old and New: Vintage Speakers Meet High-Resolution Audio in Brownsboro Smart Home

KLH electrostatic speakers serve as the centerpiece of this extensive audio project, with Mozaic Smart Technology Design adopting a hybrid system approach for a discerning client.

Published: September 17, 2026Nick Boever

When Mozaic Smart Technology Design took on this residence in Brownsboro, Alabama, the brief was simple: deliver top-tier audio in every corner of the home, from a dedicated theater to a fully distributed music system that matched with the client's discerning tastes. However, part of that also involved finding a way to incorporate the homeowner's vintage electrostatic speakers into the modern control ecosystem.

Honoring electrostatic legacy without compromising performance

The centerpieces of the project were the KLH electrostatic speakers, now decades old, that the client refused to part with. Beyond their size, the speakers carried deep sentimental value having been refurbished by David Janszen, son of the original designer behind the technology.

For Mozaic, the job was to make them the proud focal point of the main living area.

Elsewhere, Mozaic needed to get crafty to preserve the room's sightlines while building out the system's lower end to support the speakers. With no floor space to spare for subwoofers, the team designed concealed enclosures flanking the fireplace.

In this way, the team paired cherished legacy components with new high-resolution equipment throughout the house, creating a hybrid audio architecture both aesthetically and technologically.

From cinematic isolation to house-wide high-resolution audio

Moving into the home theater, Mozaic mechanically decoupled the room from the rest of the structure for true acoustic isolation. A 9.4.6 system built off JBL Synthesis speakers provides reference-level cinematic sound without a single decibel bleeding into the living spaces beyond.

Throughout the remainder of the house, Origin Acoustics speakers powered by AudioControl amplifiers drive the audio experience for the homeowners. Those whole-house speakers were chosen deliberately for their low-profile design, delivering acoustic performance while staying out of sight.

Tying it all together is an Autonomic streaming server, which feeds high-resolution tracks to every listening zone in the home.

"We embraced the complexity of a hybrid system. We expertly blended the client's cherished components with new high-resolution audio equipment, ensuring aesthetic harmony and uncompromising sonic performance throughout the entire residence," noted Michael Johnson, Founder and President of Mozaic Smart Technology Design.

LG denies privacy claims.

https://www.cepro.com/news/lg-releases-statement-following-privacy-accusations-against-its

LG Releases Statement Following Privacy Accusations Against Its Smart TVs

The initial report, released by the YouTube channel Gamers Nexus, claimed that LG smart TVs were being used to collect sensitive user data such as IP addresses and network devices.

Published: September 16, 2026 Nick Boever

Key Takeaways

- The YouTube Channel Gamers Nexus accused LG of using its smart TVs to gather sensitive user data through built-in microphones.

- LG's response seeks to clarify "misconceptions" regarding the privacy and security of its TVs.

- LG argues that audio used for commands is processed locally by the TV.

LG is responding following a privacy accusation made against the company that it allegedly uses its smart TVs to spy on its users. The original accusation, made by the YouTube channel, Gamers Nexus, claimed that LG TVs can and are engaged in the collection of sensitive user information in a report that has since made the rounds online. In its statement, LG has declared that such reporting has led to "misconceptions about how smart TVs work," while refuting many of the claims made in the original report.

The initial Gamers Nexus report

In its initial report, Gamers Nexus alleged that LG smart TVs can record private conversations even when no wake word has been spoken. Additionally, the video accused the company of collecting sensitive data such as IP addresses, the geographic location of the TV and nearby Wi-Fi networks, as well as the names of all connected devices.

The report also included demonstrations of these claims in conjunction with Level1 Techs and independent cybersecurity researchers.

The report was followed by a massive uproar online with many consumers voicing their concerns over the potential invasiveness of smart TVs. Additionally, prior statements made by LG had begun to be picked over by those online, leading to greater furor and dissatisfaction.

LG's response to the privacy accusations

In its response, LG stated that "recent media coverage may have contributed to misconceptions about how LG smart TVs work," with the company asserting that "LG smart TVs do not continuously record or transmit users' conversations."

“Speech-to-text processing begins only if a user activates a voice interaction through a supported wake-word feature or by pressing the voice (or AI) button on the remote control,” LG continues. “Audio used for wake-word detection is processed locally on the TV and, if no wake word is detected, audio is not converted to text, stored, or transmitted.

“Voice-recognition results and related technical logs may be generated as part of processing a voice command. These records are associated with specific voice interactions and do not indicate continuous recording of conversations occurring outside an active voice recognition session.”

The remainder of the response goes further into the functioning of the TVs in addition to clarifying data sharing policies and security measures.

Why integrators should take note

Regardless of whether who is right in this circumstance, the discussion overall sours the public perception of smart TVs in many ways. And in much the same vein as one bad smart home experience can negatively impact the perception of the industry at large, so too can worries of privacy impact how much technology prospective integration clients will let into their homes.

As public accusations such as this make the rounds, it behooves integrators to be able to navigate conversations regarding data privacy with clients.

Integration: Relationships, not products.

https://www.cepro.com/news/manufacturer-execs-at-cedia-expo-2026-the-future-of-integration

Channel leaders at CEDIA Expo 2026 outline the shift from products to experiences and installs to lasting client relationships.

Published: September 16, 2026

Earlier this month at CEDIA Expo 2026, five channel leaders told attendees that business is shifting from products to experiences, and from installs to relationships.

On the Smart Stage, a panel of manufacturer and distribution executives sat down to answer a deceptively simple prompt: what does custom integration look like five years from now and why.

The session, entitled “What Every Integrator Needs to Know About the Next Five Years,” brought together Nick Berry, CEO of Origin Acoustics; Michael Short, global vice president of marketing operations and residential at Crestron; Matt Kamp, vice president of product management at ADI; Melissa Andresko, chief corporate brand ambassador at Lutron; and Kathleen Thomas, head of custom integration sales at Sony Electronics. Dan Ferrisi, group director of content + editorial, industrial + tech, Forge, moderated the session.

The panel represented five different pieces of the custom integration channel: audio, control, distribution, lighting and displays. Nevertheless, three ideas united everyone on the Smart Stage: the selling experience has evolved, AI is a tool rather than a takeover and relationships with clients matter now more than the individual install.

Why Integrators Need to Pivot From Product to Experience

As the panel begins, Andresko frames the shift in the selling experience, remarking, “I think it’s going to be a lot less product-based and more experience-based.”

From her perspective, homeowners are no longer calling with a request for a specific product. They’re describing an outcome instead: a home that runs itself, a room that feels right, a life made simpler. She sums up where that leads in three words. “This concept of just invisible luxury,” says Andresko. That reframing changes what integrators sell and how they talk about it with clients.

Short sees artificial intelligence accelerating that same shift rather than working against it. He reveals that Crestron spent years building toward a single, standardized operating experience for every customer and AI is what lets integrators break from that uniformity again.

“I think now with AI coming, we’re going to be able to give a unique experience to everyone and put the power back into the integrator’s hands,” Short says. The tools get more capable, he observes, but the differentiation moves back to whoever is doing the install.

AI as Tool, Not Takeover

Continuing the topic of AI, Short describes a practical use case already built into Crestron’s platform: automating the tedious front end of a project.

“So we’re showing ways within the platform that you can upload a floor plan from an architect of a 10,000 square foot home and the system then automatically builds all the rooms,” he says. According to Short, the pitch isn’t a smarter house; rather, it’s a faster setup, freeing integrators to spend that time elsewhere.

Berry also pushes back on the idea that AI leads to fully autonomous, sentient homes. “I think everybody’s mind is going to race to AI controlling the house and being living, breathing,” he says. “I don’t think that that’s necessary and I don’t think that that’s something that we should race to.”

Berry frames the technology instead as an efficiency layer, useful for diagnosing systems and speeding up service rather than a selling point on its own.

Thomas goes further, arguing AI can’t touch the part of the job that actually keeps integrators in business. “There’s no chatbot that’s gonna replace what I hear in conversations with integrators. That’s just not gonna happen,” she says.

Lighting Has Its Time to Shine

In response to a question about which category has gone from niche to essential in the last five years, Andresko points to lighting. “Lighting was actually a number-one category,” she says.

Short goes a step further, framing lighting as close to a prerequisite for staying relevant with architects and designers. “Lighting is the gateway drug to many people’s hearts,” he says.

Andresko then extends the point beyond product into partnership, telling integrators to spend as much time cultivating architects and designers as they do clients. “Make yourself indispensable to builders, to designers and to architects,” she says.

Security and Service: The Quiet Priorities for Integrators

Turning to other categories, Kamp names one that rarely gets top billing: cybersecurity. He explains, “I actually think cyber is going to be a really big part of what we all are responsible for over the next several years.”

Kamp describes security less as a product line and more as a baseline expectation that clients won’t think to ask about until something goes wrong.

Orgalim

Steel vote hinders Europe.

https://orgalim.eu/en/europes-electrification-ambitions-threatened-by-vote-on-steel/

Europe’s electrification ambitions threatened by vote on steel

This article has been updated since its original publication on Wednesday 16 September 2026. Please see below for the outcome of the vote.

A major trade association that represents Europe’s grid technology industry, T&D Europe, and Orgalim are urging against the adoption of a safeguard measure for a type of steel needed in electrification.

Grain-Oriented Electrical Steel (GOES) is a strategic material for transformers. Transformers are an essential part of our energy infrastructure – and particularly our ambitions to electrify. The EU boasts strong domestic production of transformers, with manufacturing sites across 20 Member States, employing 23,000 people in quality, future-looking jobs.

Yet the future of this industry is under threat from a vote put to Member State representatives by the European Commission, scheduled to take place on Thursday 17 September.

If adopted, the measure will transfer over EUR 700 million per year from the EU transformer industry to just two domestic producers of grain-oriented electrical steel. And yet, there are no binding investment plans nor capacity commitments in place. It is deeply concerning.

- Diederik Peereboom, T&D Europe Secretary General

Despite over a decade of the current GOES Minimum Import Prices scheme, EU producers still do not produce the highest-performing GOES, nor have they generated meaningful additional production capacity. Furthermore, the new proposal asks for no guarantees that EU GOES producers will expand output, add production lines, or develop the high-permeability and specialty grades that EU mills do not currently manufacture. In short, the measure will likely not add a single tonne of new EU GOES capacity online within its lifetime.

In contrast, the European transmission and distribution industry has invested heavily in domestic production. In the past 24 months, T&D Europe’s 12 corporate members alone announced investments of EUR 12 billion in expanding global manufacturing capacity. The proposed measures would jeopardise the business case for these investments in Europe and imported transformers would become notably more competitive.

The measure is presented as a balanced proposal that would not have significant implications for downstream industries. Yet, in reality, it imposes a significant financial cost burden on a competitive and flourishing downstream industry – transformer manufacturing – that is essential to deliver Europe’s

electrification ambitions, while rewarding upstream EU GOES producers without reasonable assurances that they will expand quantity and quality of GOES production in the years to come.

- Ulrich Adam, Orgalim Director General

In place of this safeguard measure, we propose policy measures in line with a value-chain approach, including:

- clear investment commitments by GOES producers to expand capacity and deliver high-performance grades; and

- regular structured dialogue with transformer manufacturers, TSOs and DSOs, and targeted industrial policy measures that strengthen the whole electrification value chain.

Both T&D Europe and Orgalim fervently support further development of a strong and competitive EU GOES industry. But support for GOES producers must not come at the expense of the transformer industry nor threaten Europe's electrification ambitions.

When Europe's electrification ambitions need speed, stability and long-term predictability, this proposal will instead:

- Reduce the ability of Europe's transformer industry to deliver on the needs of the growing demand for electrification, and to compete with non-EU imports both in the internal market and in markets outside the EU;

- weaken the attractiveness of the EU as an investment destination for critical, strategic, net-zero clean energy technology; and

- do little to expand quantity and quality of GOES production in years to come.

For these reasons, we urge against the adoption of these measures.

About T&D Europe

T&D Europe is the voice of Europe's grid technology industry, representing more than 600 companies with more than 450 factories across the continent that design, manufacture, and supply the technologies underpinning Europe's electricity networks. Employing over 175,000 people, the sector is a key enabler of the energy transition, supporting grid modernisation, renewable energy integration, energy security, and the EU's objective of achieving climate neutrality by 2050.

Update:

Thursday 17 September, the Safeguards Committee delivered no opinion, meaning the measures were neither voted down nor approved by Member States. The outcome of the vote was 10 Member States in favour, while six voted against and 11 abstained. The European Commission can now either move ahead with temporary safeguards on transformer steel, or review the measure and resubmit it for a

second vote.

Orgalim remains committed to working with all partners across the European institutions and seeking an outcome that is beneficial for Europe's technology industries and demonstrates a holistic approach across the full industrial value chain.

Rules boost single market.

https://orgalim.eu/en/revising-product-rules-to-boost-one-of-eus-greatest-strengths-eu-sin

Revising product rules to boost one of EU’s greatest strengths: the EU Single Market

How quickly new products reach the market, and how easily European companies can sell across borders, and even the products available to us in the first place are all governed by a set of rules that are central to the running of the European Union's Single Market.

At its simplest, strengthening the Single Market makes it easier for a company to make a product in one European country, then sell it throughout the EU.

Having these common rules in place should remove barriers between national markets, reduce unnecessary costs and give manufacturers access to a market of hundreds of millions of consumers.

For European industry, scale matters. The Single Market is a phenomenal asset for the EU. If used well, it can help our companies grow, invest, innovate and compete globally.

The EU is currently looking at how to modernise and simplify the rules that underpin the Single Market, from standardisation and conformity assessment to market surveillance and product compliance. Much of this work will feed into the forthcoming European Product Act, alongside broader efforts to simplify EU rules and reduce barriers for businesses operating across Europe.

We want to keep what works, while addressing gaps, making better use of digitalisation and strengthening enforcement.

- Federica Boledi, Orgalim Policy Senior Manager - Internal Market

It was on these elements that Orgalim offered flash briefings to almost twenty APAs and attachés last week, looking at some of the technical rules for the Single Market and what they mean in practice.

Hosted by MEP Nikola Minchev, the event broke attendees into four groups, who moved from booth to booth to hear concrete examples in four key areas:

- How companies demonstrate that products meet EU requirements;

- how harmonised standards help ensure products can be placed on markets across Europe;

- how compliance information could become more accessible through digital documentation; and

- how market surveillance helps keep unsafe products off the market while ensuring fair competition.

These may sound like technical details, but they have very real consequences. For a manufacturer, clear and proportionate rules can mean less duplication, lower compliance costs and fewer obstacles when bringing a product to customers in another EU country.

- Rocio Mondaca Gherardelli, Orgalim Policy Senior Adviser - Internal Market

For consumers meanwhile, effective rules help provide confidence that products are safe and meet the necessary requirements.

Feedback from participants at the Orgalim event stressed that the modular design of the briefings was enormously helpful for understanding the technical details of this complex package.

The European Product Act therefore offers an opportunity to look at whether the EU's product framework is working as effectively as it could.

Getting this balance right matters. A strong Single Market is about removing barriers and creating the conditions for European businesses to compete, innovate and invest at scale.

The rules behind Europe's products may be invisible to most people. However, getting them right can make a very visible difference to Europe's economy and to the products people use every day.

Europe invests in industry.

https://orgalim.eu/en/strengthening-europes-industrial-heartbeat-from-stockholm-to-mannhei

Strengthening Europe's Industrial Heartbeat: From Stockholm to Mannheim

The human heart doesn't beat at the same speed all the time. That would be inefficient. Rather, it speeds up when you run and slows down when you rest. This is the same principle that Orgalim member ABB applies to variable speed drives: a technology that can help optimise processes and improve energy efficiency.

Orgalim Director General Ulrich Adam, Senior Managers Stéphanie Mittelham and Federica Boledi, and Policy Manager Laure Dulière visited the ABB Campus in Mannheim recently to see first-hand the tangible technologies powering the green transition and learnt an important statistic: 45% of the world's electricity is converted into motion by electrical motors. Yet 60% of electrical motors still lack variable speed drives, massively reducing efficiency.

The visit was followed a few days later by a trip to Stockholm by Orgalim President Javier Ormazabal, Director General Ulrich Adam and Policy Director Daniel Wennick to meet with one of our prominent national members, Teknikföretagen, as well as Scania Group, and IVA. Discussions reinforced the importance of strong cooperation between industry, research and policymakers to strengthen Europe's competitiveness and accelerate advanced manufacturing, electrification and innovation.

Both site visits emphasised the same point: the technology exists and is ready to use. The real challenge now is closing the deployment gap and improving Europe's industrial heartbeat.

Ormazabal’s message prioritizes member work.

https://orgalim.eu/en/what-we-do-matters-ceo-javier-ormazabals-town-hall-message-to-orgali

September 7, 2026

What We Do Matters: CEO Javier Ormazabal’s Town Hall Message to Orgalim

Wednesday, September 2nd: There was a familiar feeling in the air at Orgalim last Wednesday: the sense of a new beginning that comes with the start of a new school year and a return following the summer holidays.

For Orgalim President Javier Ormazabal, it was an opportunity to bring colleagues together, share some reflections from his own experience in industry and, above all, talk about the people behind Europe’s technology industries and the work they do every day.

Javier began with his own story. His family business was founded in Bizkaia in 1967, during a period of rebuilding for the Basque Country. Visiting the company as a young man, he was struck by its constant sense of forward movement. This is a quality that remains central today.

What was advanced in his father’s time is no longer advanced today. The same factory is now home to entirely different technologies, systems and capabilities, and he discussed how this is a powerful reminder that progress depends on a willingness to keep learning, adapting and improving.

That spirit of curiosity connects Javier’s experience at Ormazabal with his role at Orgalim. Europe has an extraordinary industrial and technological base, he said, but this strength brings responsibility as well as pride. At a time when global competition is intensifying and Europe must decarbonise while remaining competitive, the challenge is to ensure that sustainability and industrial strength reinforce one another.

For Javier, this means being a strong and constructive voice for industry: speaking up when legislation risks undermining Europe’s ability to invest, innovate and manufacture, while also bringing practical solutions grounded in the realities of factories, laboratories and engineering departments.

The strongest theme of the Town Hall was people.

Ambition is a contradiction. It is deeply personal, yet almost always makes you very dependent on others.

CEO Javier Ormazabal, Orgalim President

Javier stressed that a strong team is one where people are willing to engage, understand complexity, find solutions and show loyalty to their colleagues and their profession. The best organisations are those where people know they are not working alone, and understand that their individual contribution matters. After all, the policies and decisions taking place in Brussels ultimately affect factories, industries, regions, workers and families across Europe.

The Town Hall concluded with an engaging Q&A, giving colleagues the opportunity to put their questions directly to the President and continue the conversation.

EU ETS boosts decarbonization.

https://orgalim.eu/en/qa-the-eu-ets-driving-decarbonisation-while-keeping-europe-competiti

Q&A: The EU ETS: Driving decarbonisation, while keeping Europe competitive

What is the EU Emissions Trading System (ETS) and what role does it play in Europe's climate policy?

The EU ETS is the European Union's carbon market and its main tool for reducing greenhouse gas emissions. Established in 2005, it works on a 'cap-and-trade' principle: the EU sets a limit on the total emissions allowed from covered sectors, and companies must surrender allowances for the emissions they produce. This creates a carbon price that encourages emissions reductions and investment in cleaner solutions.

The EU ETS is widely considered the centrepiece of EU climate policy and the world's largest carbon market. Today, it covers around 40% of EU's greenhouse gas emissions, including emissions from power generation, energy-intensive industries and aviation. Its scope is expected to expand significantly in the coming years as additional sectors are brought into the system.

What is the difference between ETS 1 and ETS 2?

The current system is referred to as EU ETS 1, covering sectors such as energy intensive industries, power generation and aviation. A separate system, EU ETS 2, will extend carbon pricing to buildings and road transport. Together, these systems are expected to cover around 70% of EU greenhouse gas emissions by 2028.

How does the ETS support industrial decarbonisation, and why is it important for Europe's technology industries?

The EU ETS supports industrial decarbonisation by putting a price on carbon emissions and creating incentives for companies to invest in cleaner production processes, energy efficiency and low-carbon technologies.

Orgalim considers the ETS a market-based, technology-neutral and cost-efficient tool that has played an important role in driving investment in decarbonisation. Europe's technology industries are crucial to

this transition, as they develop and supply many of the solutions needed to reduce emissions, including carbon-neutral energy solutions, electrification technologies, advanced manufacturing systems and clean industrial equipment.

How can the ETS balance climate ambition with industrial competitiveness?

The EU ETS should continue supporting Europe’s climate objectives while ensuring a realistic pathway to decarbonisation. This requires a framework that supports innovation, enables industrial modernisation, provides the right investment conditions and addresses the risk of carbon leakage.

EU ETS 1 should not reach zero emissions by 2039. Instead, the reduction pathway should be extended so that ETS 1 reaches carbon neutrality in the mid-2040s, while remaining aligned with the EU's 2050 climate neutrality target.

In parallel, the phase-out of free allowances and the introduction of the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) should be delayed to avoid putting excessive pressure on sectors exposed to international competition. This additional time should be used to strengthen CBAM, particularly its ability to prevent carbon leakage and protect European companies competing in global markets. CBAM protection should apply not only to ETS sectors but also to downstream industries.

What changes are needed in the ETS to ensure companies have the certainty, flexibility and investment conditions required to decarbonise?

Orgalim identifies several priorities:

- Create a predictable long-term framework towards 2040 and 2050 so companies can plan investments with confidence.

- Maintain a technology-neutral approach, enabling companies to choose the most effective solutions for emissions reductions.

- Increase the use of ETS revenues to support innovation and industrial modernisation through tools such as the Innovation Fund, Industrial Decarbonisation Bank and Modernisation Fund.

- Adjust the Linear Reduction Factor (LRF) to ensure a more realistic transition while remaining aligned with climate objectives.

- Delay the phase-out of free allocation for sectors exposed to global competition and strengthen CBAM to reduce carbon leakage risks.

- Include permanent carbon removals within the ETS framework.

The Commission’s 2026 EU ETS review proposal includes several elements aligned with these priorities, including a lower post-2030 LRF, increased support for industrial decarbonisation through ETS revenues, the inclusion of permanent carbon removals and a delayed phase-out of free allocation

for CBAM sectors. However, extending the phase-out from 2034 to 2038 does not go far enough to provide the certainty and protection needed for industry.

How can Europe’s technology industries help deliver the goals of the ETS and support a competitive, climate-neutral Europe?

Europe’s technology industries are key enablers of the transition to a climate-neutral economy. They develop and manufacture the solutions needed to reduce emissions, including electrification technologies, clean energy systems, advanced manufacturing equipment and clean industrial technologies.

By investing in innovation, scaling up low-carbon technologies and supporting industrial modernisation, they can help reduce emissions while strengthening Europe's industrial competitiveness. Orgalim argues that a well-designed ETS

Electrification plan explained now.

https://orgalim.eu/en/why-europes-technology-industries-are-key-to-the-electrification-act

Q&A: Understanding the Electrification Action Plan

What is the Electrification Action Plan?

A political strategy designed by the European Commission to increase electrification of usages in Europe. The Plan includes a list of concrete measures aiming at stimulating the use of electricity for heating and cooling buildings, for transport and for manufacturing products and technologies.

Electrification has stagnated for a combination of reasons: The access to affordable, secure and stable electricity remains a challenge, and there is significant variation between Member States in terms of prices and infrastructure. At the same time, Europe is operating with ageing grids and still lacks a truly integrated Energy Union. Another challenge is that, after decades of subsidising fossil fuels, there is a need to better inform consumers about the technologies that already exist for electrification and those that are emerging in a continuous drive to find innovative solutions for more efficient and decarbonised energy use.

Why is the Electrification Action Plan particularly relevant now?

Electrification was initially driven by the need to decarbonise the economy, and it remains one of the fastest ways to achieve emissions reductions, particularly when combined with the deployment of renewable and low-carbon energy sources.

Today, it is a critical energy security issue. Europe's access to fossil fuels is increasingly unstable and our dependence on foreign governments comes at a significant cost. At the same time, investments in renewables and low-carbon energy have proven their value, meaning Europe is increasingly ready to

rely on its own energy sources rather than imported fuels. This is why electrification is attracting so much attention today: it can support decarbonisation, improve energy security and help Europe become more independent.

What does the Electrification Action Plan mean for Europe's technology industries?

For many years, Europe's technology industries have invested in innovation, energy efficiency and technologies that support decarbonisation. As a result, we already produce many of the solutions needed for electrification. These technologies can help industries make better use of local renewable energy sources, participate in flexibility markets and adapt their energy consumption to price signals through smart and automated systems.

In addition, as well as supporting climate and energy objectives, Orgalim believes that the increased adoption and deployment of electrification technologies will strengthen the competitiveness of European industry by helping companies become more efficient, resilient and less dependent on external energy sources.

If the technologies already exist, why isn't electrification happening faster?

For many industrial applications, especially low- and medium-temperature processes, electrification technologies are already commercially available. The two main barriers are:

1. Electricity prices

2. Grid access

The business case for electrification often depends on access to affordable and predictable electricity prices. Many companies have faced significant price volatility in recent years, making investment decisions more difficult.

Many industrial sites face challenges when connecting to the electricity grid or increasing their available grid capacity. In some cases, companies do not know when connection requests will be processed, creating uncertainty and delaying investment decisions.

While technology readiness is improving, these structural barriers continue to slow deployment.

How can the Electrification Action Plan help address these challenges?

The Electrification Action Plan can help in several ways. Firstly by sending a strong political signal that electrification is a key part of Europe's future industrial and energy strategy. This is important because it gives businesses greater confidence that investments in electrification are aligned with the long-term direction of EU policy.

Secondly, it can improve the business case for electrification by promoting measures that support electricity affordability and price stability. In particular, it can encourage greater flexibility in the

electricity system and explore how network charges can better reward consumers that participate in flexibility markets or act as prosumers.

Finally, the Action Plan can help raise awareness of existing electrification technologies and support ongoing efforts to modernise the grid, ensuring that consumers and industries are better equipped to electrify their operations.

What would a successful Electrification Action Plan look like from Orgalim's perspective?

Although the Electrification Action Plan is a political strategy rather than a legislative proposal, we hope it will include concrete actions that accelerate electrification across Europe. For Orgalim, success would mean greater electricity affordability and price stability, stronger support for industrial investments, and increased certainty for businesses considering electrification projects. This is particularly important when companies face high upfront capital expenditure costs.

We would also like to see a strong link between electrification and energy efficiency. Many electrification technologies can make industrial processes more efficient, so these two objectives should go hand in hand. Ultimately, a successful Action Plan would create the conditions that allow industries to invest with confidence and deploy electrification technologies at scale.

What would Orgalim not like to see in the Electrification Action Plan?

Sector-specific or overly-prescriptive approaches that create strict obligations or additional burdens for companies would be a concern. While we support the electrification of our economy as extensively as possible, we must also consider that companies operate in different circumstances. Not all industrial processes can be electrified in the same way

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Europe’s strategy fails now.

https://orgalim.eu/en/europes-industrial-strategy-goes-nowhere/

On 1 July, new import quotas and tariffs on steel entered into force. The measures are intended to further protect European steel producers from persistent global overcapacity and unfair competition from non-EU producers. The theory is that steel is a strategically important industry and that production must remain in Europe.

Yet the latest measures expose a much bigger question that the European Union must answer, as it tries to build a coherent industrial strategy. Namely, what counts as strategic?

Industrial policy requires choices. Europe cannot protect every single industry equally. But the choices must be guided by a coherent long-term strategy, rather than a series of ad hoc interventions.

Today, that coherence is increasingly difficult to see.

Resilience has come to mean one thing above all else: protecting selected upstream industries. This is often at the expense of downstream manufacturers who produce the technologies Europe says it wants to champion.

We are facing an industrial policy that strengthens the weak but weakens the strong.

The latest example is Grain-Oriented Electrical Steel (GOES).

Earlier this year, the European Commission launched a safeguard investigation into imports of GOES, opening the possibility of new trade restrictions, despite European production already falling well short of rising domestic demand.

At first glance, GOES appears to be just another technical trade case. In reality, it exposes a blatant and much broader inconsistency in Europe's industrial thinking.

GOES is the specialized electrical steel that allows transformers and large generators to operate efficiently by directing magnetic fields with minimal energy loss.

Without GOES, there are no transformers. Without transformers, there is no expansion of Europe's electricity grid. And without grid expansion, there is no large-scale electrification of the economy – needed to free Europe from its costly and longstanding dependencies on imported fossil fuels.

That makes the timing of the investigation particularly odd.

This week, the European Commission is considering trade measures that will make one of electrification's most essential raw materials significantly more expensive and less accessible to European transformer manufacturers.

Next week, it is expected to publish its Electrification Action Plan: a roadmap intended to accelerate Europe's transition towards an electrified economy.

Taken together, both measures are in a complete contradiction, at a moment when Europe desperately needs strategic coherence.

The steel industry's concerns are real; we acknowledge that. European producers face high energy costs, intense international competition and the consequences of global overcapacity. Supporting European manufacturing capacity matters.

However, strategic thinking requires looking beyond the first link in the value chain. This seems to be something which the European Commission ardently refuses to do. Europe cannot afford to build a one-sided industrial strategy that shields selected upstream sectors from competition while expecting the rest of the value chain to absorb ever-rising costs, pay the bill, and continue producing.

No region can electrify with raw steel alone. It electrifies through transformers, generators, electric motors, and the countless technologies designed and manufactured by Europe's downstream

industries. These are the companies that turn raw materials like steel into innovative cleantech products that make electrification possible.

At the same time, those manufacturers are being driven into the ground as the supply of critical inputs like GOES becomes more expensive and uncertain. As a result, Europe's wider strategic ambitions will become harder to achieve.

This reflects a broader challenge in European industrial policy. The old industrial policy simply focused on protecting production capacity. The new industrial policy must focus on enabling innovation, strengthening cleantech production and supporting the industries that will define Europe's future competitiveness.

That requires a proper strategy that informs long-term thinking and sound tactical decisions.

It also requires recognising that not every sector is able to contribute equally to our long-term objectives. If Europe is serious about electrification, clean technology and strategic autonomy, then the industries enabling those goals must be recognised as strategic.

The manufacturers of transformers is one such industry. Europe's transformer manufacturers employ tens of thousands of people across dozens of production sites, supplying the equipment needed to modernise and expand Europe's electricity grid. Without their products, electrification simply can and will not happen.

The irony is difficult to ignore.

GOES has already benefited from trade protection since 2015, yet European production still cannot satisfy European demand. The product was excluded from previous safeguard measures precisely because of that structural shortage. If more than a decade of protection has not solved the underlying competitiveness challenge, it is reasonable to ask whether additional trade restrictions are really the answer, or whether they simply transfer costs onto the industries Europe most needs to succeed.

The Commission rightly argues that Europe cannot rely excessively on volatile international supply chains. But if resilience is defined solely through the lens of steel production, Europe risks weakening the very manufacturers that produce the technologies essential for electrification, decarbonisation, and energy independence.

Ultimately, industrial strategy is about making coherent choices. What does Europe really consider strategic?

If the

Industry, academia need to sync.

https://orgalim.eu/en/it-takes-pillar-two-to-tango-are-industry-and-academia-in-step/

It was 90 minutes of thoughtful discussion and constructive debate from speakers at Orgalim's webinar: _"It Takes (Pillar) Two to Tango: Collaborative Research in the Next Horizon Europe."_

The exchange brought together representatives from industry, academia and the European Commission to discuss the future governance of collaborative research under FP10 and its relationship with the proposed European Competitiveness Fund (ECF). Speakers explored how Europe can strengthen innovation, close the competitiveness gap with global rivals and ensure that excellent research is translated into industrial deployment and societal impact.

Some of the key contributions from our speakers included:

Ulrich Adam, Director General, Orgalim:

Pillar Two is where excellent research can move in step with technological development, industrial needs and ultimately deployment in the market and in society. It is where collaborative research happens at scale. It brings companies, universities, research organisations and other partners onto the same dance floor across borders, disciplines and value chains. At a time when Europe is seeking to strengthen its competitiveness, resilience and technological leadership, a strong and well-funded collaborative research programme is more important than ever.

Matthias Björnmalm, Secretary General, CESAER:

Europe needs ambitious and well-funded programmes, collaborative research at scale and governance arrangements informed by excellence, expertise and a clear understanding of the outcomes we are trying to achieve. We are facing growing pressure to close the innovation gap with global competitors while preserving its strengths in excellence, openness and trust. Universities of science and technology play a central role in this effort by generating frontier knowledge, training talent and building long-term capacity through collaboration with industry and society.

Manuel Aleixo, Cabinet Expert, European Commissioner for Startups, Research and Innovation:

The Commission's proposals for FP10 and the European Competitiveness Fund are designed to place research and innovation at the heart of European competitiveness. While maintaining continuity with Horizon Europe, the proposals seek to improve coherence between research, innovation and industrial deployment, helping innovators move more effectively from knowledge creation to market impact. We are aiming to provide much better possibilities in the innovation-to-investment journey.

Laure Dulière, Manager for Energy, Climate and Innovation, Orgalim, and Louise Drogoul, Senior Adviser for Innovation and Sustainability, CESAER:

Presenting a joint vision from industry and academia, Laure and Louise highlighted the need for two strong and distinct programmes that work in complement. While FP10 should continue supporting collaborative research and innovation, the Competitiveness Fund should help ensure successful deployment and market uptake. The key challenge is creating an effective interface between the two.

They summarised by explaining that the EU needs both programmes: a strong FP10 where innovation and research happen, and a deployment instrument under the Competitiveness Fund that helps bring results to market and that both industry and academia need more coherence, not more confusion. With this in mind, FP10 and the ECF should remain distinct, but they must not be disconnected.

Lisa Ericsson, Head of KTH Innovation and CEO of KTH Ventures:

Europe does not lack excellence, talent or entrepreneurial ambition. The challenge lies in scaling innovation and turning breakthrough research into globally competitive companies and value chains. Universities have a critical role to play, not only through research and education but also by creating spin-offs, supporting deep-tech entrepreneurship and strengthening regional innovation ecosystems. As such, FP10 can be more than a tool for generating knowledge for existing industry and actually support future industries to be created.

Magnus Madfors, Head of Technical Regulations, Ericsson:

Europe has excellent research and excellent framework programmes but where we fail is in bringing our innovations successfully to market. Collaborative research remains one of Europe’s strengths, but research alone is not enough. To improve competitiveness, Europe must become better at deploying and scaling the innovations it develops. Research, standardisation, intellectual property, regulation and market uptake must all work together as part of a broader innovation ecosystem.

During the discussion, speakers repeatedly stressed the importance of **strong stakeholder involvement in programme design and implementation.** Industry, universities and research organisations all highlighted the value of being involved early in priority setting, ensuring that future research programmes remain aligned with Europe’s technological, industrial and societal needs.

Closing the event, **Ulrich Adam** underlined the scale of the challenge ahead and the importance of continued collaboration across the research and innovation ecosystem, repeating the messages that we need speed, and to bring our innovation and knowledge to the market, and streamlined industrial deployment. A strong Pillar Two, with a stable and ambitious budget and the right governance model, is one of the keys for Europe can address this challenge.

EUSEW 2026: Electrification Needs More

https://orgalim.eu/en/industrial-electrification-requires-more-than-technology-eusew-2026/

June 15, 2026

Industrial Electrification Requires More Than Technology, EUSEW 2026

Thursday 11 June 2026, Brussels: High upfront investment costs, grid constraints and electricity prices remain the biggest barriers to industrial electrification, according to speakers at the EU Sustainable Energy Week (EUSEW) panel "Paying for the Power Shift: Upfront Costs of Industrial Electrification."

As EUSEW celebrates its 20th anniversary, industry representatives, financiers and policymakers agreed that electrification is essential for reducing dependence on fossil fuels, strengthening industrial resilience and improving European competitiveness. However, progress has been slower than expected, with electricity's share of final energy consumption increasing only modestly from around 20% in 2006 to approximately 23% today.

"The question is no longer whether electrification matters to industry, but how to accelerate it in a way that companies can invest in confidently."

A recurring theme throughout the discussion was the challenge posed by high upfront capital expenditure (CAPEX), which remains one of the biggest barriers to industrial electrification.

Financing the transition

Isabel Blanco Alvarez, Head of Impact for Energy, Infrastructure and Climate at the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD), outlined how financial institutions evaluate electrification projects. Investors assess technical, environmental, social and financial factors, including technology maturity, future electricity prices, company balance sheets and repayment capacity.

"Projects must ultimately make financial sense and demonstrate a credible payback period."

Chemical industry calls for stronger policy support

Representing the European Chemical Industry Council (CEFIC), Senior Energy Manager Nicolai Romanowski highlighted the growing importance of electrification for the chemical sector. Many successful projects combine electrified processes with conventional fossil fuel-based systems in hybrid configurations. Romanowski called for harmonised regulatory frameworks, stronger support for anticipatory grid investments and greater involvement from Member States. He also urged governments to make better use of state aid mechanisms and available flexibility to reduce electricity taxation for industrial users.

"Grids should be recognised as a public good."

Energy efficiency and electrification must go hand in hand

Paula Iwaniuk, Vice President and Group Head of EU Government Relations and Public Affairs at ABB, presented examples demonstrating the immediate benefits of electrification technologies. Electric motors account for approximately 45% of global electricity consumption. By integrating Variable Speed Drives (VSDs), companies can reduce electricity consumption by between 20% and 50%, often achieving payback periods measured in months rather than years.

"Electrification and energy efficiency should be treated as complementary strategies rather than separate policy objectives."

One ABB-supported project in Bulgaria generated savings of approximately €3 million. Despite the availability of proven technologies, adoption remains slower than expected. ABB calls for closer coordination between industrial planning and grid development, warning against siloed approaches to energy policy.

Confidence in Europe's electricity system

Marion Labatut, Director of European Affairs at EDF, argued that Europe’s electricity system is well positioned to support increased electrification. EDF views dependence on imported fossil fuels as one of the continent’s most significant energy vulnerabilities. Labatut highlighted the reliability and resilience of European grids, describing them as among the most advanced in the world. However, she acknowledged that faster grid connections and anticipatory network investments would be essential to meet future industrial demand.

“To improve investment confidence, we need reduced electricity taxation, expanded eligibility for existing energy-efficiency support schemes, and targeted public funding mechanisms.”

European Commission wants measures that will help ‘electricity champions’

Closing the discussion, Lelde Kiela-Vilumsone, Team Leader for National Energy and Climate Plans, Financing and International at the European Commission’s Directorate-General for Energy (DG ENER), outlined ongoing efforts to support industrial electrification. Measures include improving grid connection processes, developing new approaches to network charges and promoting demand-side flexibility. Additional financing opportunities are expected through initiatives such as the Industrial Decarbonisation Bank, the European Investment Bank, the Innovation Fund and future energy-efficiency financing programmes. Kiela-Vilumsone also highlighted the importance of ensuring that electricity is taxed more favourably than fossil fuels where appropriate, reinforcing incentives for companies to transition toward cleaner energy sources.

Shared priorities across the sector

Despite representing different parts of the energy ecosystem, speakers largely converged around several common priorities. High upfront investment costs remain the primary obstacle to industrial electrification. Grid infrastructure, connection delays and congestion continue to constrain projects across Europe. Reforming electricity taxation emerged as another recurring recommendation, with several speakers arguing that current taxation policies hinder the transition.

Ambition drives tech sovereignty.

https://orgalim.eu/en/tech-sovereignty-is-as-much-about-ambition-as-it-is-the-right-condit

Tech sovereignty is as much about ambition as it is the right conditions.

This is a renewed commitment to strengthening Europe’s position in key digital and industrial technologies, was the reaction at Orgalim to the European Commission's Technology Sovereignty Package.

We believe the Commission is right to highlight Europe’s dependencies and to place greater emphasis on industrialisation and market uptake. At the same time, Orgalim believes that the concept of technological sovereignty must be approached with caution.

Europe’s competitiveness is built on openness, global partnerships and access to international supply chains: strengthening resilience should not come at the expense of these fundamentals.

The Chips Act 2 is a welcome step forward by moving beyond a purely supply-side approach and placing stronger emphasis on downstream industrial demand and ecosystem-building. It should be noted that for it to grow, demand needs ambitious regulatory simplification conducive of investments in industrial AI, data centers, industrial data and advanced manufacturing. Europe needs leading-edge chips. However, policy makers should understand the meaning of ‘advanced’ more broadly: there is more to it than just sub-2nm logic chips. Neuromorphic chips, photonics, quantum chips, and many other innovations are already present in Europe and need upscaling to enable the next generation of computing. Launching top-down semiconductors foundry projects should be approached with particular caution to avoid focusing on types of chips that are not driven by industrial demand and that may end up requiring disproportionate or even permanent subsidies.

Strengthening Europe’s semiconductor ecosystem, in particular, requires not only public support but also globally competitive framework conditions, including energy costs, access to capital and regulatory simplification. Competitive energy prices can be achieved via an ambitious reduction of national taxes and levies on electricity prices.

Technological leadership will ultimately depend on our ability to create globally competitive conditions for Europe. That requires genuine ambition.

The Strategic Roadmap for AI and digitalisation of the energy sector part of the Technology Sovereignty Package should recognise the dual dynamics at play: while the digitalisation of Europe’s energy infrastructure is a key lever to reduce overall energy consumption through smart grids, automation and advanced energy management systems, the rapid expansion of data centres is simultaneously driving significant increases in electricity demand. This highlights the need for a systemic approach that both maximises efficiency gains and manages rising consumption. Data centres and digital infrastructure should be incentivised to deploy state■of■the■art energy■efficient technologies and to operate as active participants in the energy system, notably through demand-side flexibility and waste heat recovery.

The Cloud and AI Development Act rightly acknowledges the importance of boosting development and deployment of data centres and physical AI in Europe. Both are important elements of an innovative

and competitive industrial ecosystems.

While details need to be assessed, Orgalim, representing chips suppliers (from equipment to back end and packaging), downstream industrial chip users, as well as industrial users of cloud, industrial AI developers and integrators and manufacturers of data centre equipment is ready to engage with the EU institutions to make this new package work in practice.

CodeConfiance

Card health security questioned.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/21/appli-carte-vitale-que-vaut-vraiment-son-tres-hau

Vital card app: what really is its “very high level of security”?

On September 22, more than 1,000 pharmacies will participate in a national operation to promote the Vital card app. The Health Insurance insists on its “very high level of security”. The digital version is indeed better protected against theft, lending, or identity theft than the plastic card. However, this claim should be taken with caution, as no system is entirely secure and fraudulent activities against Health Insurance predominantly occur elsewhere.

Health Insurance aims to integrate the Vital card app into daily usage. On September 22, its agents will be present in over 1,000 pharmacies across metropolitan France and the overseas departments and regions to help insured individuals activate and use it. According to the organization’s figures, more than 3.5 million people have already activated it, with a rate of 200,000 new users each month. Nine out of ten pharmacies now accept it, and nearly one million billings have been carried out through this channel.

The app does not replace the physical card. It serves as a second representation, installed on one smartphone and synchronized with the insured’s rights. With this app, there’s no need to find the green card, as rights are updated automatically and the last expenses made with the app can be checked for a few days.

The security gain is also tangible. Activation requires matching a civilian identity with the data known to Health Insurance. Two processes are offered: one involves France Identité and the new electronic national identity card; the other relies on a video of the identity document and the face, verified by a human operator. In practice, the phone must first be unlocked, and then the app opened with a password of at least ten characters or biometric data. Furthermore, the photo of the holder is visible to the healthcare professional.

These safeguards make the app much less easy to lend, steal, or use after theft compared to a physical card. The app can only be active on one phone. Its activation on a new device deactivates the old one, and the insurance can revoke the profile in case of loss. Each year, nearly one million physical Vital cards are reported lost or stolen within the general scheme, according to Health Insurance. In this specific regard, dematerialization does significantly reduce risk exposure.

“Very high level of security”: a promise more than a qualification

However, this expression repeatedly asserted by Health Insurance—that the app would be endowed with a “very high level of security”—should be contextualized. Technically, several elements support

this claim. Identification data is encrypted and stored locally within the application. This includes civil status, social security number, affiliated organization, dependents, and national health identity, but no medical data. Rights are checked with Health Insurance servers, and older systems that no longer receive updates are excluded. The QR code or NFC then allows the healthcare professional to retrieve the necessary information for billing.

In publicly available information, Health Insurance describes the protection mechanisms and mentions compliance with French and European standards. However, it does not refer to identifiable ANSSI certification, a public audit report, or a formal guarantee level comparable to the insurance levels set by eIDAS. The decree of February 5, 2026, does regulate the future use of the app as a means of remote authentication and imposes security requirements on the services that will connect to it.

Moreover, the primary vulnerability shifts toward enrollment and the terminal. If a fraudster manages to validate a false identity, compromise the Ameli account or associated messaging, divert the video pathway, or take control of the smartphone, the subsequent protections may secure... the wrong person. The phone’s biometric method is a useful lock but not an absolute guarantee of identity.

The proliferation of devices increases the attack surface. As long as the physical card continues to exist, the digital version does not replace it; it adds to it. The ecosystem thus includes the app, smartphone, operating system, Health Insurance servers, activation process, France Identité, healthcare professionals’ software, QR code or NFC readers, and, in the future, health insurance companies. Overall security remains that of its weakest link.

Fraud is not limited to the Vital card

The controversy over the number of cards in circulation has muddied the debate for a long time. The latest publicly accessible official data indicates **58.3 million active cards at the end of 2019**. At that time, 609,000 cards were classified as “surplus,” mainly due to discrepancies between old schemes. This figure was subsequently reduced to 41,000 by the end of 2020. A surplus card is not necessarily a fake card, let alone proof of fraud. It may correspond to a change of scheme, leaving France, or a deregistration that has not yet been

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Wallet: Fighting document fraud.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/18/le-wallet-nouvelle-arme-contre-la-fraude-document

The wallet, a new weapon against documentary fraud

Faced with increasingly credible fake documents, companies can no longer be content with checking a PDF or a scanned document. KIPMI advocates another approach: transforming the wallet into an active tool, capable of extracting, verifying, and converting data from a document into reliable attestations. This is a concrete response to secure KYC processes without waiting for the entire European ecosystem to be ready.

Document fraud has escalated. With artificial intelligence, producing a fake proof of address, bank statement, or convincing identification has become both simple and inexpensive. Yet, many organizations still request paper or PDF documents and check them one by one. This model has reached its limits, especially since a document can appear perfectly authentic while being falsified.

The eIDAS 2 regulation opens another path and, in the long run, aims to replace the circulation of documents with verifiable electronic attestations. However, the transition will be neither immediate nor uniform. Standards are evolving, and not all players have the appropriate tools yet.

“The framework exists, but the ecosystem will take time to establish,” emphasizes Matthieu de Montvallon, Technical Director at KIPMI. Waiting for every player to be compatible would allow a zone of vulnerability to persist.

From Document to Verifiable Attestation

KIPMI intends to take advantage of this transition period to view the wallet, not just as a simple digital safe, but as a tool capable of acting on the presented documents.

The user scans a receipt with their smartphone. The wallet extracts useful data and then queries external services via API to verify its consistency. An IBAN can thus be compared with data from Open Banking. An address can be verified against proof of address documents.

Once validated, the information can also be converted into attestations linked to a qualified identity and reusable in the customer journey. “The issue is no longer just to protect the document. It is necessary to verify the data it contains,” summarizes Matthieu de Montvallon.

This hybrid approach allows for the acceptance of documents still in use while integrating them into a more reliable, traceable model compatible with eIDAS.

An Integrated Wallet in Business Processes

KIPMI does not offer an isolated wallet. The solution is designed to fit into the processes of a bank, insurer, telecom operator, or online platform. These companies can thus create dedicated spaces within the wallet. With the user’s consent, they can trigger necessary verifications: age, identity, bank details, address, or onboarding. Thus, the user no longer transmits all their documents. They share only the attestations needed for the requested service.

This logic reduces friction, limits the circulation of sensitive copies, and lightens manual checks. According to KIPMI, it can reduce the complexity of certain KYC processes by up to 80%.

“The wallet should not be perceived only as a regulatory obligation and must become an active tool of trust,” insists Matthieu de Montvallon. It can indeed become, right now, a concrete and effective lever to reduce document fraud and streamline the customer relationship.

In the meantime, and despite a marked market interest in this hybrid approach, significant evangelization work remains to be done.

AI surveillance becomes permanent.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/17/videoprotection-algorithmique-lexception-olympiqu

Algorithmic Video Protection: The Olympic Exception Establishes Itself as Long-Term

Presented as an exceptional experiment to secure the Paris Games, algorithmic video protection will be used until the end of 2030 and in a wider range of locations. This extension comes without definitive proof of its effectiveness and rekindles the debate on automated surveillance of public spaces.

What was supposed to remain a temporary experiment will ultimately survive the Paris 2024 Olympic Games. Promulgated on August 18, 2026, the RIPOST law authorizes the continuation of algorithmic video protection until December 31, 2030.

The system allows the application of artificial intelligence processing to camera images to detect in real-time certain events considered potentially dangerous: intrusion into a forbidden area, unusual movement or density of crowds, wrong-way traffic, abandoned objects, a person on the ground, the start of a fire, or carrying a weapon.

The evolution is not merely chronological. Initially focused on sports, recreational, or cultural events and their surroundings, the experiment can now also involve certain buildings and public places “particularly exposed” to the risks of terrorist acts or serious harm to people’s safety. Their list will be established by order of the Minister of the Interior.

For sites facing a permanent risk, the authorization can last as long as the video protection system itself. In exceptional circumstances, it may be granted for three months and renewed. Despite the term “experiment,” a scale change is taking shape.

“These systems aim to help operators detect certain risky situations,” explains Stéphane Carré, commercial director for France at Axis Communications. The manufacturer of connected cameras emphasizes the supportive role of the technology: the algorithm generates an alert, but the decision to intervene remains in the hands of a human operator.

Results that do not yet demonstrate effectiveness

This extension could have appeared as the logical consequence of a positive assessment during the Games. However, the evaluations available say otherwise.

In its report dedicated to the experiment, the Senate recognizes “very variable” performance depending on the uses. For abandoned objects, only 23% of the 1,552 reports recorded by the SNCF and 22% of the 1,302 alerts noted by the RATP corresponded to actual detections. People sitting or immobile,

particularly homeless individuals, have sometimes been confused with abandoned objects.

The detection of crowd movements produced too few alerts to be truly evaluated. The results regarding weapon carrying, tested only in Cannes, are also deemed unequal. As for the detection of fire departures and people fallen on the ground, its performance has been rated as “very unsatisfactory.” Reflections, flashing lights, or signs could be misinterpreted as fires.

Above all, very few alerts led to an intervention that would not have occurred without the algorithm. The police prefecture recorded only one on the Olympic site of Vaires-sur-Marne. The evaluation committee concluded that the number of risky situations detected by AI appeared “extremely low given the financial resources deployed.”

But beware, these results do not prove that the technology is useless. The special conditions of the Games, with up to 45,000 police and gendarmes mobilized on certain days, mechanically reduced its added value. They nonetheless show that its effectiveness remains to be established, especially in changing environments that require precise parameterization of each camera. Extending the experiment can be justified. Expanding it before establishing robust performance indicators is much more debatable.

No facial recognition, but behavioral analysis

Axis reminds us that the system provided for by the law “does not correspond to facial recognition or to permanent individual surveillance.” Legally, this distinction is accurate. The allowed treatments must not enable identification of a person from their biometric characteristics, cross-referencing images with other files, or tracking an individual in their movements.

However, the absence of facial recognition does not render the technology neutral. People filmed are no longer merely visible on a screen: their shapes, movements, and behaviors are automatically analyzed to determine whether they correspond to a predefined situation. The CNIL mentions a technology “intrusive by nature,” likely to lead to massive processing of personal data without the knowledge of the concerned individuals.

The subject thus goes beyond just the duration of image retention. It also concerns the accuracy of algorithms, potential biases, the multiplication of false alerts, the cybersecurity of equipment, the traceability of decisions, and the authorities’ ability to control contractors. Direct processing embedded in some cameras may limit data flow, but it does not alone guarantee compliance or the protection of freedoms.

The law still requires human intervention before any operational decision and maintains the application of the GDPR, the Data Protection Act, and European requirements related to AI. A question remains more political than technical: at what duration and level of deployment does an experiment cease to really be one?

By extending until 2030 a system whose results remain

Digital sovereignty: intentions are done.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/16/souverainete-numerique-le-temps-des-intentions-es

Digital sovereignty: the time for intentions is over.

French citizens demand better control over their data and the digital tools used by public services. However, between this aspiration, the constraints of public procurement, and the domination of American suppliers, the transition to action remains complex. The conference “Digital Sovereignty: from concept to specifications” organized by Code Confiance on October 13 in Lille, aims precisely to transform this political ambition into concrete purchasing criteria.

Digital sovereignty has now become a major political concern. The first edition of the Sovereignty Barometer, conducted by Norstat for L’Hémicycle, reveals that 92% of French people see digital dependence as a risk to the country’s independence.

This sentiment is based on a harsh reality. For 64% of respondents, France is simultaneously lagging behind the United States and China in digital and artificial intelligence. And 89% believe that the development of AI will further exacerbate our dependence on foreign companies.

The desired response seems unequivocal. 94% of French citizens favor hosting their personal data in France or Europe. Additionally, 93% wish for the state and administrations to prioritize French or European solutions.

These figures reflect massive expectations. However, digital sovereignty is not a concept that can be applied overnight. It must be built through technological, legal, economic, and operational choices.

Buying sovereign does not only mean buying French. The Digital Pact and AI, signed on September 10, 2026, illustrates this difficulty. Led by the Interministerial Digital Directorate for a period of three years, it aims to better identify the needs of administrations, map available industrial skills, and promote the emergence of French and European solutions. The first areas of concern include collaborative office suites, AI-assisted penetration testing, and securing critical infrastructures.

However, the Pact does not grant any privileged access to state markets for participating companies. Public procurement remains governed by the principles of freedom of access, equality of treatment, and competition. An administration cannot exclude an offer solely because its supplier is not French.

The critical question is not just the nationality of the provider. It addresses the level of dependence created by the solution. Where is the data hosted? What laws could they be subject to? Who controls the essential technologies for the service? Does the buyer have an alternative solution? Can they recover their data in a usable format and migrate to another supplier under acceptable conditions?

The European Commission has begun to formalize this approach. For its sovereign cloud market awarded in April 2026, it used a framework composed of 48 criteria divided into eight categories. This evaluates, among other things, legal sovereignty, data control, technology, security, and the supply chain. Sovereignty does not appear as a binary certification but as a measurable level of autonomy.

The risk now would be to turn sovereignty into a mere slogan without consequences on purchasing decisions. European hosting constitutes a primary guarantee, but it is insufficient if the technology, support, encryption, or administration mechanisms remain controlled from a third country. Conversely, accumulating excessively restrictive requirements may reduce the number of candidates, increase costs, and recreate dependence on a few protected suppliers circumventing real competition.

This tension is clearly perceived by the French. While their demand for control is very strong, 61% recognize that giving up non-European tools could lead to a loss of performance or service quality. This result necessitates moving beyond simplistic discourses. Digital sovereignty neither involves abruptly closing the market nor accepting dependence in the name of immediate efficiency.

It primarily requires determining which data, infrastructures, and activities are truly critical. Buyers can subsequently translate identified risks into verifiable requirements concerning data location and protection, exposure to extraterritorial legislations, transparency of the subcontracting chain, interoperability, the use of open standards, or the ability to reverse.

This last aspect is fundamental. An organization is not sovereign if it cannot change providers without major disruption, data loss, or prohibitive costs. Proprietary formats, closed interfaces, and migration costs are mechanisms of dependence, even when the solution formally respects certain localization requirements.

This transition from concept to specifications will be at the heart of the conference that Code Confiance will host on October 13 in Lille. The objective will not be to artificially designate “good” suppliers but to identify the criteria that allow public actors to regain control over their digital choices.

Verified ID won't suffice.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/15/eudi-wallet-une-identite-verifiee-ne-suffira-pas-

EUDI Wallet: a verified identity will not be enough to perform KYC.

The European digital identity wallet promises to simplify and secure the remote relationship process. However, it will not replace the risk assessment and monitoring obligations imposed on banks, fintechs, and crypto platforms. As the implementation of the new anti-money laundering regulations approaches, confusion could be costly.

Presenting an official identity, certified contact details, or proof of age from a smartphone without disclosing more data than necessary is what the future EUDI Wallet promises. It is expected to

profoundly alter European digital pathways. For financial actors, the interest seems obvious. Verified identity information from the source can reduce errors, limit some fake documents, and accelerate account openings or service subscriptions.

The shortcut would be to think that with the Wallet, KYC would be resolved. This is false. The wallet provides verifiable attributes. It does not determine whether a customer poses a money laundering risk, acts on their own behalf, or seeks to evade sanctions.

A new source of evidence for KYC

The European anti-money laundering regulation AMLR, adopted in 2024 and primarily applicable from July 10, 2027, recognizes compliant electronic identification means under eIDAS as tools usable for verifying a customer's identity. Devices that provide a substantial or high level of assurance will therefore be able to play a central role in the relationship initiation process.

The EUDI Wallet is designed to allow the holder to present identity data and other electronic documents issued by trusted sources. A bank could, for example, request only the attributes necessary for verification, verify their origin, and retain proof of this verification. The process promises to be faster and more respectful of data minimization principles.

This evolution could reduce reliance on photos of identity documents, which are often easy to forge or manipulate. However, it will not eliminate stolen identities or fraudulent use of perfectly authentic identities. A fraudster can operate with a legitimate document, use an account opened by a mule, or gain control of a victim's phone. The reliability of the document does not guarantee the legitimacy of its use.

The Wallet does not replace vigilance

KYC is not limited to simply recording a name and date of birth in a client file. Subject entities must also understand the purpose of the business relationship, identify the beneficial owners of a company, verify politically exposed persons and applicable sanctions, assess the level of risk, and monitor operations over time.

However, the wallet does none of these tasks alone. It does not detect unusual transactions, reconstruct complex ownership chains, or report suspicious behavioral changes. It improves the quality of some input data but remains just one component of a wider compliance system.

This distinction will be particularly important for KYB. Certain identification of a company representative does not prove that they possess the necessary powers, that the declared beneficial owners are accurate, or that the company is not a shell created to commit fraud.

Integration becomes the real challenge

Banks, fintechs, insurers, and crypto platforms must not wait for the widespread deployment of wallets. They need to determine now what attributes to request, when, and on what basis, as well as organize their traceability and storage. They will also need to connect this data to existing filtering, scoring, and monitoring tools, anticipate revocation scenarios, and maintain alternative pathways for individuals without a Wallet.

Another crucial decision will be: to take advantage of the wealth of available documents or to strictly adhere to necessary information. Turning the wallet into a data reservoir would contradict its logic and expose organizations to new regulatory and cyber risks.

Thus, the EUDI Wallet will not end KYC. It can assure the starting point. Trust, however, will always need to be reevaluated throughout the relationship. For an authentic identity is not sufficient to render a transaction legitimate.

Cybersecurity products get bigger.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/14/cyber-resilience-act-la-cybersecurite-des-produit

Cyber Resilience Act: The cybersecurity of products is undergoing a transformation.

Since September 11, 2026, manufacturers of digital products sold in the European Union must report actively exploited vulnerabilities and serious incidents. A first deadline before the full application of the Cyber Resilience Act by the end of 2027. For the concerned companies, the challenge goes far beyond notification. Indeed, the CRA requires rethinking the design, monitoring, and documentation of products throughout their entire lifecycle.

Connected cameras, applications, routers, industrial software, smart household items, or components integrated into other equipment, the Cyber Resilience Act, or CRA, targets one of the weak links in European digital security. Until now, a product could be marketed with vulnerabilities, benefit from irregular patches, and then become unsupported without the user being clearly informed.

European Regulation 2024/2847 overturns this logic. It explicitly shifts part of the responsibility onto hardware and software manufacturers, even when they are established outside the Union but market their products in the European market. Importers and distributors must, on their side, verify compliance with several obligations.

Since September 11, 2026, manufacturers must report two categories of events:

- actively exploited vulnerabilities, meaning those whose malicious exploitation is supported by reliable evidence,

- incidents having a serious impact on the security of a product.

An initial alert must be sent within 24 hours of becoming aware of the event, followed by a completion within 72 hours. A final report is then expected no later than 14 days after the availability of a corrective or mitigation measure for an exploited vulnerability, and within one month for a serious incident. The declaration is made in a single instance on the European platform managed by ENISA. It is addressed to the competent coordinating CSIRT and made simultaneously available to the European agency, unless exceptional circumstances occur. These obligations also cover products already placed on the market when they fall within the scope of the CRA.

The main risk would be to treat this deadline as a mere declarative formality. Meeting a 24-hour deadline assumes detecting the event, determining which products and which versions are affected, assessing the reality of the exploitation, and then simultaneously mobilizing security, development, legal, and communication teams. Without a reliable inventory of products, components, and software dependencies, the company risks having to notify without having a sufficiently clear view of the compromise.

The CRA does not replace either NIS 2 or DORA. It operates on another level of European cybersecurity. NIS 2 governs the security of networks and information systems of essential or important entities in specific sectors. DORA organizes the digital operational resilience of financial actors, notably the management of risks related to technologies, resilience testing, incident handling, and management of ICT providers. The CRA focuses on the intrinsic security of products containing digital elements.

A company can therefore fall under multiple texts. A cybersecurity solution manufacturer may be subject to the CRA for its product and to NIS 2 for the protection of its own activities. A bank using this product remains responsible for its DORA obligations. And a given event may trigger multiple notification procedures, with different recipients, severity criteria, and deadlines.

Coherence must, therefore, be organized internally. A unique incident register can feed several regulatory circuits, but the qualification rules and responsibilities must be established in advance. Compliance with one text does not automatically imply compliance with others.

The essence of the CRA's requirements will apply from December 11, 2027. Manufacturers will then need to integrate cybersecurity from the design stage, deliver their products without known exploitable vulnerabilities, reduce their attack surface, protect data, and ensure vulnerability handling throughout the support period. Products must undergo a conformity assessment and an EU declaration before carrying the CE marking.

The first step involves mapping products, their versions, hardware and software components, open-source dependencies, and the remote services essential for their operation. This mapping must allow the determination of the company’s role in the value chain, the regulatory category of the product, and the applicable assessment procedure. A software bill of materials, or SBOM, becomes a central tool here to quickly identify exposure to a flaw affecting a third-party component.

The second step falls under governance. Companies must designate responsible parties, structure a vulnerability response team, define a coordinated disclosure policy, and test decision-making and notification circuits. Contracts with vendors must also manage the reporting of vulnerabilities, access to patches, and the preservation of evidence.

Finally, compliance must be documented. Cyber risk analysis, security architecture, test results, justification of technical choices, update procedures, support duration, handling of third-party components, and historical vulnerabilities must form a coherent and verifiable file.

The CRA therefore does not merely require manufacturers to state that their products are safe. It imposes the obligation to demonstrate safety and to continue securing those products after they are marketed

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France faces European wallet choice

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/11/d-you-face-a-france-identite-deux-chemins-vers-le

Germany will launch its digital identity application d-you on January 2, 2027. While France Identité has operational advances, the German project immediately shows strong ambition towards private services. This comparison reminds us that the success of a wallet depends not only on its technology but especially on its usages.

Its name means both "digital," "Deutschland," and "you." Presented by the German Digital Minister Karsten Wildberger, d-you will allow citizens to have a digital equivalent of their identity card on their smartphones. The driving license and other proofs will be added gradually.

The application will be optional. It will be used to prove one’s age, open a bank account, subscribe to an online contract, or identify oneself with an administration. According to information shared by the German government, about forty actors are expected to accept d-you from its launch. Among them would be banks, telecommunications operators, energy providers, universities, local authorities, and the Post Office.

D-you is the German version of the European digital identity wallet, or EUDI Wallet. This is intended to enable Europeans to present identity data and various proofs, both online and face-to-face, while limiting the information transmitted to the strict necessary.

France Identité has a head start.

France did not wait until 2027. Already available, France Identité allows integrating one’s identity card, driving license, and vehicle registration document into one’s phone. The application can also generate a one-time identity proof, connect to over 1,800 services via FranceConnect, carry out certain sensitive procedures, or facilitate checks in trains and French airports.

France Identité has also been designated as the future French wallet compliant with the European framework. However, the two applications are not at the same stage. The French solution has more accessible uses already, mainly around public services and mobility. d-you will arrive later, but with integration announced from its launch in private paths such as banking, energy, or telecommunications.

Thus, the real competition will not be about displaying an identity card on a screen. It will play out based on the number of compatible services, the simplicity of the processes, and user trust. A wallet without uses will remain a technological showcase. A wallet accepted everywhere could truly replace part of our documents and passwords.

AI chaos, regain control.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/10/donnees-critiques-reprendre-controle-avant-ia-acc

Critical Data: Regaining Control Before AI Accelerates Disarray

Companies now possess unprecedented amounts of data, yet many still lack knowledge regarding its location, access permissions, reliability, and integrity verification. This new issue of Code Confiance deciphers the conditions for true data mastery, encompassing governance, protection, traceability, resilience, and the exploitation of artificial intelligence.

Almost all companies today claim to be “data-driven.” However, simply accumulating data isn’t enough to transform it into strategic assets. Duplicates, conflicting databases, excessive access rights, outdated documents, and vulnerable backups create operational, regulatory, and cybersecurity risks.

This new issue of Code Confiance prioritizes critical data. It explains why organizations have historically delayed governance initiatives and why the rise of AI now compels them to act. An artificial intelligence connected to poorly qualified information does not resolve disorder; it merely accelerates it, making detection more difficult and, sometimes, more convincing.

The dossier also clarifies a complex market landscape. What are the distinctions between DLP, DSPM, and data catalogs? How can sensitive information scattered across the cloud, SaaS applications, collaborative spaces, and workstations be identified? How can protection, sharing, and exploitation be balanced without restricting data or exposing it unnecessarily?

Backup also gains strategic importance. In the face of ransomware, simply having a copy is no longer sufficient. One must guarantee its integrity, immutability, and true restoration capabilities. Traceability, auditability, and proof complete this chain of trust. An organization must be able to reconstruct the journey of a data point, identify its transformations, and demonstrate that it hasn’t been altered.

A Panorama of 44 Actors for Market Understanding

To translate these challenges into concrete decisions, Code Confiance presents a panorama of 44 actors structured around three main functions. The first group solutions governing and securing data,

from cataloging to MDM, including quality and lineage. The second covers the protection and control of sensitive information. The third brings together specialists in backup, cyber resilience, document management, archiving, and digital proof.

This panorama provides CIOs, CISOs, CDOs, DPOs, and business departments with benchmarks to differentiate positions, understand complementarities, and identify solutions aligned with their priorities.

A partner of this issue, DigDash illustrates the capabilities of a French and sovereign actor in bringing together data preparation, analysis, and exploitation. The feedback from Urssaf (a national social security agency) concretely demonstrates how rationalizing four data visualization tools around a common platform can enhance decision-making coherence, limit technological dependency, and support the work of 16,000 agents.

An issue to read to move beyond abstract promises surrounding data and AI, and then regain control of what is now one of the most sensitive assets of the enterprise.

Data security conference announced now.

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/10/code-confiance-n4-data/

All companies claim they want to better utilize their data. But do they really know where it is, who accesses it, how it moves, how it is protected, and if they can prove its integrity?

In this new special issue, Code Confiance deciphers a central issue for organizations: regaining control over their critical data. Because data is no longer just an asset to be valued. It is also a risk to be managed, a proof to be kept, a resource to be secured, and an essential condition for successful AI projects.

The contents include: data governance, DLP, DSPM, cataloging, lineage, backup, resilience, immutability, archiving, EDMS, data quality, and traceability. This issue helps decision-makers understand the major families of solutions, avoid tool overload, and ask the right questions before launching a project.

Why have companies been slow to take data governance seriously? How to protect without blocking business usage? Why is backup becoming strategic again in the face of ransomware? How to prove the integrity of a piece of data or document? And why is a solid EDMS indispensable before connecting AI to their informational assets?

With its in-depth articles, market player mapping, and operational keys, this issue is aimed at CIOs, CISOs, CDOs, DPOs, business departments, and executives who want to move from the "data-driven" discourse to action.

Download the issue and discover how to govern, protect, trace, and truly utilize your data.

Faulty parts, do we know?

https://www.codeconfiance.com/2026/09/10/pieces-defectueuses-dans-laeronautique-sait-on-vr

Defective parts in aviation: do we really know what flies?

Aviation imposes particularly rigorous documentation at every stage of an aircraft's life. However, several recent cases show that identifying a defective component does not always suffice for quickly locating all affected airplanes. Between global outsourcing, maintenance, and the market for used parts, trust depends as much on the physical quality of the equipment as on the reliability of their digital dossier.

The case went relatively unnoticed in Europe. In February 2024, the rudders of a Boeing 737 MAX 8 from United Airlines became stuck during landing in Newark. These controls allow pilots to act on the rudder and keep the aircraft aligned with the runway.

The investigation led to the rudder rollout guidance actuator, an actuator manufactured by Collins Aerospace and integrated into an optional automatic landing system. A bearing had been improperly assembled. Moisture could penetrate the mechanism, freeze, and limit its movements.

The defect was identifiable. Its location was much less so. Collins Aerospace had delivered 353 affected actuators to Boeing since 2017. According to the NTSB (National Transportation Safety Board), 271 could still equip aircraft operated by at least 40 foreign companies. Collins also supplied 75 directly to operators for later installations.

The NTSB then worried that some companies might be unaware of the presence of these components in their own planes. The problem was thus not just about the industrial quality of a component, but about the ability to link each serial number to an aircraft, an operator, and a specific technical configuration.

When the certificate is no longer enough

A few months earlier, another case revealed a similar weakness. Parts used by Boeing and Airbus had been produced with titanium accompanied by falsified compliance documents. The material came from a supply chain linking back to China and passing through several intermediaries.

Analyses eventually showed that the alloy had the expected characteristics. Over 1,000 tests were carried out, and manufacturers indicated that the aircraft in service could continue to fly. However, the physical compliance of the material did not address the underlying question. Why had the documents been falsified, and how had titanium of uncertain origin passed through several levels of scrutiny?

This case reminds us that a certificate is not absolute proof. It is also necessary to ensure the identity of its issuer, its authenticity, its link to the correct batch of material, and the continuity of the documentation chain. Accurate information but associated with the wrong component has no operational value.

The narrowly avoided accident on Alaska Airlines flight 1282 illustrated another break. Four bolts had not been reinstalled on the end cap door of the 737 MAX 9. Boeing later admitted that it had not found the documents tracing its opening and closing at the factory. Its hypothesis was even more concerning. These documents may have never been created.

Inspections multiply in 2026

Recent alerts show that this question remains very current. In March 2026, Boeing had to redo the wiring of a group of 737 MAX not yet delivered. Wires had been slightly scratched due to a machining error. In July, the FAA requested the inspection of 453 aircraft, some of which seats might have been incorrectly attached to their rails. A poorly mounted seat could detach under significant load, injure its occupants, or hinder an evacuation.

In August, a new directive concerned 471 Boeing 737 MAX potentially exposed to cracks around the front doors. No cracks had then been found on this generation of aircraft. The measure was taken because a comparable component had shown weaknesses on older 737s.

These inspections do not prove that hundreds of dangerous airplanes have been put into circulation. On the contrary, they show that the surveillance mechanisms work. But their effectiveness depends on the ability to quickly determine which aircraft possess the component, assembly, or manufacturing process in question.

Linking the physical part to its digital identity

The aviation chain brings together manufacturers, equipment suppliers, subcontractors, companies, lessors, maintenance shops, and dealers of used parts. The same part can be repaired, certified, stored, resold, and then installed on multiple aircraft during its life.

Its traceability cannot therefore be limited to a number recorded in a database. It must cover its origin, its manufacturing batch, its certifications, its repairs, its ownership changes, and each of its installations. Above all, the digital dossier must remain unequivocally linked to the physical object.

Signed certificates, unique identifiers, and tamper-proof histories can strengthen this chain of proof. However, they do not constitute a magic solution. A blockchain can make information impossible to modify without guaranteeing it was accurate to begin with. Technology will never compensate for a forgotten inspection, a document not created, or a component mounted under the wrong reference.

In aviation, trust also depends on the

Puertas y Automatismos

Doors now have tech.

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/U3WNDqFrrmBYihx3XTVJFJd3Md8.html

Five years ago, the Kronos panel revolutionized the concept of cladding for armored doors. Today, the reasons for its success are evident: quality, aesthetics, and an excellent value for money. Technology, aesthetics, and durability are the three terms that best describe it. Let’s see why.

Technology

Kronos Fiberglass is a monolith of heat-catalyzed fiberglass: a single piece, not a set of overlapping layers. This structure is responsible for all its performance, from the behavior of the material to the freedom of machining.

The panel is easy to work with: it can be cut to size and drilled with conventional tools for shields, handles, and knobs. It is manufactured in the most commonly used standard sizes, allowing for large volumes without generating waste or management costs. For non-standard sizes, there’s Apollon, with horizontal grain, available in an extra size 1030 × 2350 mm, well above the classic 920 × 2100 mm.

Apollon and Athena — standard size, vertical grain — are the smooth panels of the range: flat surfaces designed for engraving. And here lies the most interesting detail: the pantographing is carried out after lacquering. The milling bit reveals the base color of the panel and creates a contrast that enhances the design of the surface, generating a three-dimensional effect that is impossible to achieve through printing.

This is not a reserved service: any professional in the sector who has a pantograph, whether their own or someone else’s, can create personalized designs or texts, useful for identifying hotel establishments.

Aesthetics

Its characteristic grains reproduce the tactile and visual experience of wood, resulting in a unique outcome.

The collection starts with the Forms collection, which recovers the shapes of traditional panels: from models with frames, Ares and Uranus, to the flat Helios and Poseidon. It continues with the Art collection, which includes the pantographed models and those incorporating metal inserts, laminates, noble stone, and marble. Among them, three signed by architect Simone Micheli: Flux, Squares, and Drops.

Durability

The monolithic structure provides high mechanical resistance and complete resistance to rain, solar radiation, and salinity. No deformations, no breakages, no discoloration.

This feature makes it ideal where other claddings tend to give way: coastal areas, sulfurous atmospheres near spa resorts, industrial areas. The material's resistance to a wide range of chemical compounds also allows it to be cleaned with detergents that would damage any other cladding and, thanks to its tolerance of high temperatures, can be sterilized with steam without suffering any deterioration.

The right moment, in Spain

The Spanish housing stock has surpassed 27 million units and is one of the oldest in Europe: nearly 30% are over seventy years old, with an average age of over forty.

But the data that really matters is different. In 2024, around 650,000 second-hand sales were recorded in Spain compared to just over 65,000 new builds. Ten to one. When someone buys a home in Spain, they buy to renovate.

And in an armored door that continues to function perfectly, it is not the structure that ages: it is the covering. Replacing the panel costs a fraction of the entire door, is done in a few hours, and provides a completely new entrance. For distributors and installers, it is a quick intervention, with high margins and easy to propose.

A preview

The Kronos range has recently expanded with Elements, the new aluminum line: ribbed surfaces, stone effects, wavy textures, for a more contemporary language. We will present it in more detail in our next newsletter.

SmartDoors: Future construction access.

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/8xgpQFmU90A4ExJLQgbZVygtuKo.html

There are moments when a sector needs to pause, reflect, and decide where to move forward. SmartDoors 2026 is born precisely from this shared reflection. From November 10 to 13, at Ifema Madrid, the automatic doors sector will once again occupy its rightful place within the International Construction Week, consolidating as its own space, specialized and aligned with the great challenges that currently define contemporary construction.

This new edition arises from ongoing work, driven by Ifema Madrid and the Business Association of Manual and Automatic Doors (AEPA) through the National Federation of Manufacturers, Installers, and Maintainers of Doors and Automation (Fimpa) as the promoting entity, which has been able to interpret the evolution of the market, the change in technical and regulatory demands, as well as the growing prominence of intelligent access systems in increasingly complex, connected, and demanding buildings.

Access is changing. For decades, doors have been perceived as an almost invisible element within the building. A functional solution, necessary, yet rarely the protagonist. Today, that perception is behind us. Access points actively participate in the safety of people, in the energy efficiency of buildings, in the connectivity of systems, and in the user experience of increasingly complex and demanding spaces.

This evolution is not casual. It responds to a profound transformation of the construction model, driven by new regulations, by the digitalization of buildings, by the need to reduce environmental impact, and by an end user demanding safe, intelligent, and sustainable solutions. In this context, the automatic doors sector has ceased to be a secondary player to become a strategic piece in contemporary construction.

This new reality presents clear challenges affecting manufacturers, installers, maintenance companies, and prescribers:

- The first is safety. The constant updating of regulations, the protection of users, and the integration of access control systems require designs that are increasingly advanced, capable of responding to intensive use environments and various risk scenarios.

- The second challenge is digitalization. Connected doors, integration with IoT platforms, remote monitoring, and predictive maintenance are now part of the present of the sector. The ability to collect data, analyze it, and transform it into operational value is redefining how access points are conceived, installed, and maintained.

- Sustainability constitutes the third major axis. Energy efficiency, material durability, reduction of consumption, and circular economy are now determining criteria in decision making. Automatic doors directly influence the energy behavior of buildings, especially in commercial, health, or transport environments.

- The fourth challenge is industrialization. Modular construction, prefabrication, and the early integration of systems in projects require standardized, reliable, and easily integrable solutions. Access is no longer an added component but becomes part of the overall design of the building.

But the main concern of the leading companies in the automatic doors sector is the availability of qualified professionals, especially in activities like assembly and installation. These are jobs that cannot be replaced by technological evolution, including artificial intelligence. Someone has to manufacture and install the doors and the generational change is far from being guaranteed.

The difficulty in attracting new profiles, adequately training them, and retaining them long-term raises deep doubts about the sector's ability to maintain the quality, safety, and reliability standards that the market demands.

This situation forces an uncomfortable yet necessary reflection: whether the sector really fails to attract young professionals or if simply not enough is being done to communicate its value, structure clear

training itineraries, and offer stable and motivating professional projects. The future sustainability of the activity depends not only on technology or regulations but also on the people who make it possible for the solutions to be correctly delivered to the building.

In this scenario, the sector needs more than just showcasing products. It needs spaces to analyze trends, share technical knowledge, compare experiences, and anticipate where the market is heading. Forums where innovation is contextualized and where debates respond to real problems.

It is at this point that SmartDoors takes on real meaning. Not as a conventional fair, but as a response to a sector need. Its growth in recent editions, both in participation and exhibition space, confirms that there is a clear demand for a specialized space within a broader and more transversal construction environment.

Integrated into the International Construction Week, SmartDoors benefits from real synergies with other fields of construction, strengthening its role as a meeting point for all professionals linked to access systems.

The 2026 edition, taking place from November 10 to 13 at Ifema Madrid, is born with a clear ambition. To consolidate as a reference platform for the automatic doors and automation sector.

SmartDoors 2026 will bet on greater international projection, attracting companies, buyers, and prescribers from strategic markets. It will also be a showcase of innovation, where technology applied to access is presented with a practical focus aligned with the real needs of the market.

The technical sessions and knowledge spaces will address key issues such as

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Persax celebrates 50 years.

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/Sn28dK0zkmoAVUlypBfu.RuPsjw.html

The company gathered its entire staff and their partners at a gala intended as a tribute to the people, commitment to quality, and the continuity of the industrial project.

Persax Celebrates 50 Years Reaffirming the Business Culture that has Guided its Growth

Marketing Department Persax 19/08/2026

Some anniversaries invite reflection. Others serve to affirm that the true value of a company lies in what remains unchanged over time. On the occasion of its 50th anniversary, Persax recently gathered its entire staff for a very special gala.

Far from being an institutional act or a simple commemorative celebration, the company wanted this event to be a collective recognition of the people who have made its evolution possible for five decades.

Because one thing became clear throughout the evening: the growth of Persax cannot be understood solely through innovation, industrial development, or product evolution.

Its true heritage is its people.

Persax celebrated its 50th anniversary paying tribute to its human team, commitment to quality, and the business culture that has led it to its current market position.

A Story of Evolution... Without Giving Up Its Essence

Since its foundation in 1976, Persax has accompanied the transformation of the solar protection and enclosure sector.

The incorporation of new technologies, expansion of product lines, development of increasingly efficient solutions, and constant commitment to innovation have marked a trajectory of sustained growth.

However, during the gala, it became clear that there is a principle that remains the same as fifty years ago: quality. Not just as the final result of the product, but as a way of understanding work. A philosophy that the company has wanted to summarize in the motto created for this commemoration: ‘We manufacture quality, we inspire comfort.’

The Greatest Recognition: People

After the screening of a video showcasing the evolution of the company, the management focused on expressing gratitude for the commitment of all those who have been part of this history. One of the most emotional moments of the night was the presentation of awards to employees who represent different values of the Persax culture.

The company wanted to highlight attitudes that have defined its identity over five decades:

- The trajectory: Juan José Tomás.

- The Persax spirit: Francisco Payá.

- The know-how: Roque Miralles.

- The operational commitment: Ildefonso González.

- The ability to represent the brand as true ambassadors: Eva Bonilla.

Five recognitions that reflect that the success of an organization does not solely depend on results, but also on the people who build it every day.

Oil as a Symbol of Origin

The gala reserved one of its most symbolic moments for the presentation to all employees of a bottle of extra virgin olive oil from the family farm adjacent to the company.

This was not a randomly chosen gift. It was early-harvest oil, collected at dawn to preserve all its qualities. A product made with patience, respect for time, and attention to detail. Values that also represent how Persax understands its own work.

During the presentation, it was recalled that both the company and those olive trees have grown under the same Mediterranean light. A simple metaphor, but one deeply connected to the territory and the origin of the company.

Three Families. One Shared Project.

Another of the most representative moments of the celebration came with the toast led by representatives of the three founding families. Each voiced a concept.

The legacy.

The continuity.

And the future.

A simple gesture that symbolized the unity of a business project that has been able to evolve from generation to generation without losing the values that gave it origin.

During the speeches, there was also a special remembrance of those who started the journey half a century ago and those who are no longer with us, but whose legacy continues to be part of Persax's identity.

The Next Fifty Years Have Already Begun

The institutional closing of the gala did not intend to remain in the celebration of the path traveled. On the contrary.

The management conveyed a clear message: the true success of a family business is not only to reach fifty years but to arrive at that point with the enthusiasm, talent, and capability needed to continue building the future.

With a second and third generation fully involved in the continuity of the project and a consolidated human team, Persax faces a new stage while maintaining the commitment that has guided its entire trajectory: to manufacture quality to continue inspiring comfort.

Fifty years after its foundation, Persax continues to demonstrate that innovation, technology, and growth only make sense when they are underpinned by solid values.

Because companies change. Markets evolve. Products improve.

But what truly remains is the way of doing things.

And in Persax, that way of doing things still has the same name it had fifty years ago: quality.

Locksmiths meet on October 3

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/njL1nV5g3NjOy_zqhNt931R31A0.html

The 6th Technical Day of UCES will have the participation of the Ministry of Education and Vocational Training and leading companies such as Silca, JMA, and CISA Allegion.

UCES will bring together the locksmithing sector on October 3rd to address AI, vocational training, and the latest technological innovations.

The Union of Security Locksmiths (UCES) will celebrate its 6th Technical Day on Saturday, October 3, 2026, a meeting aimed at locksmiths accredited by UCES from member associations, with the goal of offering up-to-date content for the sector, fostering the exchange of experiences among professionals, and holding the General Assembly of the organization.

The event will take place in Torrejón de Ardoz (Madrid) and will have a predominantly practical and participatory character, combining technical presentations, commercial presentations of interest to the sector, and a working space to address the main challenges of UCES.

One of the central themes of the meeting will be the Artificial Intelligence applied to locksmithing and security, a technology that is beginning to transform processes, tools, and services related to access control and facility protection. Attendees will learn about practical applications of AI aimed at the daily work of professionals and discuss its impact on the future of the sector.

Another highlight will be the intervention of representatives from the Ministry of Education and Vocational Training, who will present the lines of work related to future studies in Locksmithing and professional qualification, emphasizing the importance of having highly qualified professionals to respond to the new technological and security demands.

The event will also feature the participation of prominent companies like Silca, JMA, and CISA Allegion, which will present their latest innovations, solutions, and technological developments of interest to professionals in security locksmithing.

Program of the UCES Technical Day 2026:

09:00 h – Reception of attendees.

09:30 h – Inauguration by UCES president, José Luis García de Vicuña.

10:00 h – Technical presentation: ‘Artificial Intelligence applied to the locksmithing and security sector’.

11:00 h – Coffee break.

11:30 h – Institutional presentation: intervention by representatives from the Ministry about future studies in Locksmithing.

12:30 h – Commercial presentations from sponsors: Silca, JMA, CISA Allegion.

14:30 h – Lunch.

16:00 h – General Assembly of UCES.

17:30 h – Closure of the day.

A space for debate about the future of the sector:

The General Assembly will be an active participation space for all member associations. In the upcoming weeks, work will be done together to define the agenda and collect the issues deemed priorities.

Proposed topics for discussion include:

- Current situation of the sector and future perspectives.

- Institutional relations with Public Administrations.

- Regulatory development and professional regulation.

- Fight against intrusion.

- Training and qualification of professionals.

- Digitalization, new technologies, and Artificial Intelligence.

- Communication strategy and strengthening of UCES.

- Action plan and objectives for 2027.

José Luis García de Vicuña, president of UCES, emphasizes that "continuous training, innovation, and collaboration among professionals, companies, and institutions are essential elements to ensure technical excellence and modernization of security locksmithing. We have been committed since 2009 to spaces of encounter that contribute to professional development, technical excellence, and modernization of security locksmithing."

Thus, the UCES Technical Day 2026 consolidates itself as one of the main meeting points of the sector in Spain, bringing together associations, locksmiths, companies, experts, and institutions around the challenges and opportunities that will mark the future of the profession.

Interempresas partners with amec Forum

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/orambCylevD6cSvMRh_SlGiGiOA.html

Interempresas reinforces its commitment to the industry as a media partner of the Forum amec

The Forum amec has established itself as one of the main meeting points for industrial companies with an international vocation, bringing together executives, experts, and business leaders to share knowledge, experiences, and growth strategies in an increasingly demanding global environment.

As a media partner of the event, Interempresas has been supporting this reference point for the industry for a couple of years, contributing to raising visibility to the key debates, trends, and success stories presented during the day.

Interempresas provided comprehensive coverage of the event, with interviews with the main protagonists of Forum amec 2026.

In this short video, Aleix Torné, executive director of Interempresas, explains the relationship that unites Interempresas and amec, as well as the value of a collaboration built on a shared vision of support for the industry and business internationalization.

He also details the role played by the editorial group as a media partner of Forum amec and the importance of bringing industry content, reflections, and experiences that arise in these types of meetings closer to the sector.

The executive asserts that this collaboration has always been carried out with “the companies in mind, as they are the ones who will benefit from these initiatives.” He concludes that going solo is faster, but “walking together allows things to be done better and reach further.”

Doorcats rebrands for clarity.

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/kdCqV2PBszdAq51k1X3GtOUjDPQ.html

Doorcats Group has begun deploying a new brand architecture to reorganize its corporate identity after more than sixty years of experience. The company is transitioning from operating under a single brand and communication channel to a hybrid structure consisting of Grupo Doorcats as the corporate brand, and Los Gatos and Doorcats as service brands, each aimed at a distinct audience and activity.

The reorganization responds to the need to more clearly differentiate the various lines of business within the company. According to the company, until now, activities such as interior design projects and the hardware catalog coexisted under the same identity, making it difficult to identify the target audience for each proposal. With the new structure, Grupo Doorcats assumes institutional representation for the whole, while Los Gatos and Doorcats develop their activities under their own identities.

Los Gatos continues its operations as a specialized brand supplying products and advice for professionals and individuals, with establishments in Íscar and Valladolid. Meanwhile, Doorcats remains focused on tailor-made carpentry projects for architects, interior designers, and builders, with a showroom in Ibiza and more than twenty-five years of experience on the island.

The implementation of the new identity is being carried out progressively at various contact points of the company. The change has already started in stores, facades, vehicles, websites, social media profiles, and corporate attire, although the company notes that there are still materials awaiting adaptation to the new image.

Regarding this process, Neftalí CH, Marketing Manager of Grupo Doorcats, states: “We have made difficult decisions. But there is criteria, there is strategy, and there is a lot of care behind what we have done."

School uses Vicaima solutions

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/sMp_AD6qHUw77407WFQgKEI.eQw.html

The new campus of King’s College School Cascais, the first site in Portugal of the prestigious international educational institution, has incorporated solutions from Vicaima to meet the demands of security, acoustic insulation, functionality, and design characteristic of a state-of-the-art educational center. The complex, which has required an investment of 75 million euros and occupies more than 40,000 square meters, reinforces the institution’s commitment to creating innovative and safe learning environments.

King’s College School Cascais has trusted Vicaima for the outfitting of its new campus, a project designed to offer high-level educational spaces adapted to students of different ages. The complex integrates fully equipped classrooms, scientific laboratories, facilities dedicated to creative and performing arts, extensive sports areas, a covered swimming pool, and an auditorium, which required solutions capable of responding to intensive use and high technical and architectural demands.

One of the prominent elements of the project has been the installation of the Portaro system, a solution that integrates door, frame, and accessories into a single technical unit. Its implementation in various areas of the campus maintains the aesthetic uniformity of the building while facilitating circulation and meeting the functional needs of a large educational infrastructure.

In terms of safety, the campus incorporates Portaro EI30 and Portaro EI60 solutions, with fire resistance of 30 and 60 minutes, respectively. These doors, certified by accredited international organizations, reinforce passive fire protection in the strategic areas of the building and contribute to compliance with the safety standards required in this type of facility.

Acoustic comfort has also been a priority through the installation of Portaro AC32dB solutions, designed to improve sound insulation in classrooms and other learning spaces. This feature fosters a quieter environment, enhances student concentration, and facilitates teaching activities.

The functionality of the building has further been strengthened with the incorporation of ‘Portaro Corredera Interior de Tabique’ and ‘Sobre Tabique’ solutions, aimed at optimizing mobility and accessibility between the different spaces of the campus. These installations are complemented by

glazed openings and supports that enhance the entry of natural light, increasing the sense of spaciousness and well-being for students and teachers.

Vicaima's solutions are distributed throughout different areas of the complex, including classrooms, gymnasiums, auditoriums, and hallways. The supply is completed with Transform lockers, adapted to the needs of the educational environment, and technical registers intended to facilitate the integration of the building's various infrastructures.

Regarding finishes, the project predominantly opts for Dekordor HD White cladding, which adds brightness and visual uniformity to the interior spaces. In certain areas, Dekordor HD Black has also been used, personalized to maintain the aesthetic coherence of the architectural ensemble. Both laminates stand out for their high resistance to wear and ease of cleaning, qualities especially valued in educational buildings with high daily traffic.

From Vicaima, they emphasize the importance of this project as an example of the application of technical solutions adapted to the new teaching spaces. "Participation in this project reinforces Vicaima's experience in the school sector, where the combination of technical performance, durability, mobility, and design plays a decisive role in creating safe and functional environments for students, teachers, and the rest of the educational community," the company states.

Doors boost energy savings.

https://www.interempresas.net/CC/NpjGDRt9c_237suSIln81POS1aY.html

Digitalization improves the management of loading and unloading points in packaging plants.

Connected sectional doors improve operational efficiency and reduce energy consumption.

Automation, traceability, and energy efficiency are transforming the packaging industry, where loading and unloading points play a strategic role in the logistics chain. In this context, industrial sectional doors and dock equipment are evolving into connected solutions capable of providing real-time information to optimize operations.

ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems incorporates this technology in solutions such as the insulated Crawford OH1142P Dual Drive sectional door. This model does away with traditional upper compensation springs and uses dual motorization, providing smoother and more reliable operation while reducing maintenance needs. Its high thermal insulation also helps maintain the stability of production processes.

IoT monitoring of doors and loading docks allows for optimizing logistical flows and anticipating incidents in real time.

The integration of IoT connectivity allows for real-time monitoring of the usage, condition, and performance of doors and loading docks. According to Vitor Santos, commercial director of the

Industrial Division of ASSA ABLOY Entrance Systems in Spain, "In the packaging sector, every second counts. IoT connectivity turns access points into strategic control points." Through the Insight platform, equipment generates data that allows optimizing operations, anticipating incidents, and reducing unplanned downtime.

This capability is expanded with the integration of systems like Docking Management System (DMS) and Docking Assignment System (DAS), which centralize the management of docks, doors, and vehicles. In this way, companies gain greater visibility of logistics activities, improve coordination, and reduce bottlenecks. As Santos states, "With a unified digital platform, decisions stop being based on estimates and feelings and are supported by concrete data."

Another benefit of these solutions is the improvement of energy efficiency. Continuous monitoring allows for the detection of unnecessary openings or excessive opening times, factors that increase thermal losses in facilities with high traffic. Combined with high-insulation doors, these tools help reduce energy consumption without affecting productivity. As Santos points out, "Energy efficiency does not depend only on product design but on the intelligent use of equipment."

The digitalization of doors and loading docks allows for real-time monitoring of their operation, optimizing logistical flows, reducing unforeseen stoppages, and improving the energy efficiency of packaging plants.